

Conformal Blocks:

Vector bundle structures, Sewing, and Factorization

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Last update: June 15, 2026

Note. The main body of this monograph was completed and made available on the author's website in November 2020. Since then, only minor revisions and corrections have been made.

This monograph has been uploaded to arXiv because it has been cited by others. However, it was originally intended as an informal note on the theory of conformal blocks, and a large part of its content has since been adapted and expanded in works of the author and his collaborator, notably [arXiv:2011.07450](#), [arXiv:2110.04774](#), [arXiv:2305.10180](#), and [arXiv:2411.07707](#). In particular, readers should refer to these official works for formal mathematical treatments and references.

This monograph has not been fully polished or elaborated, and may contain immature or even incorrect mathematical ideas and results. The references are also imprecise and incomplete. Use at your own risk!

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Introduction

Conformal blocks are central objects in 2-dimensional conformal field theory (CFT). Mathematically rigorous definitions of conformal blocks were first introduced for special examples (e.g. minimal models, Weiss-Zumino-Witten models, see [BFM91, TUY89]), and were later given for general vertex operator algebras (VOAs) (see [Zhu94, FB04]). Conformal blocks are the building blocks of correlation functions of CFT. They are mainly discussed in the literature of algebraic geometry, although they have important applications also to many other areas related to CFT, such as low-dimensional topology, tensor categories, VOAs, von Neumann algebras and subfactors, etc.. Thus, we believe it is worthwhile to introduce the beautiful theory of conformal blocks to the people working in these areas without assuming they have previous knowledge in algebraic geometry. This is a main goal of the present monograph.

We shall give a comprehensive exploration of the theory of conformal blocks in the framework of VOAs and complex *analytic* geometry. Unlike most approaches, we work in the complex analytic setting rather than algebraic one, using the language of complex manifolds and complex spaces¹ rather than schemes or stacks. This is partly due to the author's own taste, but also due to the following reason: Despite that an analytic theory of conformal blocks is necessary for application to many areas, some results of conformal blocks (e.g. proving that spaces of conformal blocks form a holomorphic vector bundle) cannot be directly translated without suitable adaption from algebraic to analytic setting, and certain results (e.g. convergence of sewing conformal blocks) can only be proved using analytic methods. Let me explain this in more details.

Vector bundle structures

Given a (CFT-type) VOA $\mathbb{V}$, an N -pointed compact Riemann surface $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ (i.e. C has N distinct marked points $x_1, \dots, x_N$) and $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$, a conformal block ϕ is a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet := \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$ invariant under the action of the sections of **sheaf of VOAs** $\mathcal{V}_C$ defined using

¹Nodal curves and their open subsets are the only singular complex spaces (i.e. complex spaces which are not complex manifolds) we will consider in this monograph.

$\mathbb{V}$ and C . The vector space of all conformal blocks associated to C and these $\mathbb{V}$ -modules is called the **space of conformal blocks** $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ satisfies C_2 -cofinite property, a natural finiteness condition introduced by Zhu [Zhu96]. Then $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is expected to be finite-dimensional. Moreover, one should expect that its dimension is independent of the complex structure of C and the positions of marked points, and these vector spaces should form a holomorphic vector bundle over the moduli space of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces (with possibly extra data). In other words, suppose we have a holomorphic family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ where $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{B}$ are complex manifolds, $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ are sections (i.e. families of mark points). Let $\mathcal{C}_b$ be the fiber $\pi^{-1}(b)$ for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, which is a compact Riemann surface. Let $\mathfrak{X}_b$ be $\mathcal{C}_b$ with marked points $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$. Then $b \in \mathcal{B} \mapsto \dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ should be locally constant, and the vector spaces $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ (for all $b \in \mathcal{B}$) should form a holomorphic vector bundle over $\mathcal{B}$.

A usual way of constructing vector bundle structures for spaces of conformal blocks is to first define **sheaf of covacua** $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. This is an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module (where $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ is the structure sheaf of $\mathcal{B}$), which is locally a quotient of the sheaf $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} = \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$ -valued holomorphic functions. Its dual module $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is called **sheaf of conformal blocks**. Using some basic results in complex analytic or algebraic geometry, one can identify the fibers of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ with the spaces of covacua (the dual spaces of the spaces of conformal blocks) in a natural way (Thm. 3.2.1). Thus, once we have proved that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is locally free (of finite rank), i.e., $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is a vector bundle, then $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is also locally free, which is the vector bundle structure we are looking for.

In the algebraic setting, one proves that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ admits local connections [FB04, DGT19a], and that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is coherent [DGT19b]. Then a standard argument shows that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is locally free. It is obvious that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is quasi-coherent, i.e., is the cokernel of a morphism between two possibly infinite-rank locally free sheaves. Thus, once we can show that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is a finite-type $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module, we can conclude that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is coherent, thanks to the fact that $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ is Noetherian. In the analytic setting, $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ is not Noetherian, and $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is not quasi-coherent (in the sense of [EP96]). Thus, although one can still define connections and show that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is finite-type, one cannot conclude that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is coherent or locally free. In this monograph, we fix this issue by proving a stronger finiteness theorem for $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ (Thm. 3.7.3), and show that this result together with the existence of connections imply the local freeness (Thm. 1.8.5).

Convergence of sewing

Suppose we have an $(N + 2)$ -pointed compact Riemann surface

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; x_1, \dots, x_N, x', x'').$$

Then we can sew $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ along the pair of points x', x'' to obtain another Riemann surface with possibly higher genus. More precisely, we choose ξ, ϖ to be local coordinates of $\tilde{C}$ at x', x'' . Namely, they are univalent (i.e. holomorphic and injective) functions defined respectively in neighborhoods $U' \ni x', U'' \ni x''$ satisfying $\xi(x') = 0, \varpi(x'') = 0$. For each $r > 0$ we let $\mathcal{D}_r = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z| < r\}$ and $\mathcal{D}_r^\times = \mathcal{D}_r - \{0\}$. We choose $r, \rho > 0$ so that the neighborhoods U', U'' can be chosen to satisfy that $\xi(U') = \mathcal{D}_r$ and $\varpi(U'') = \mathcal{D}_\rho$, that $U' \cap U'' = \emptyset$, and that none of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ is in U' or U'' . Then, for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$, we remove the closed subdiscs of U', U'' determined respectively by $|\xi| \leq \frac{|q|}{\rho}$ and $|\varpi| \leq \frac{|q|}{r}$, and glue the remaining part using the relation $\xi\varpi = q$. Then we obtain an N -pointed compact Riemann surface

$$\mathfrak{X}_q = (\mathcal{C}_q; x_1, \dots, x_N)$$

which clearly depends on ξ and ϖ . By varying q , we obtain a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$.

Now, if we associate $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N, \mathbb{M}, \mathbb{M}'$ (where $\mathbb{M}'$ is the contragredient (i.e. dual) module of $\mathbb{M}$) to $x_1, \dots, x_N, x', x''$, and choose a conformal block ψ associated to $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ and these $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, then its **sewing** $S\psi$ is an $\mathbb{W}_\bullet^* = (\mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N)^*$ -valued formal series of q defined by sending each $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$ to

$$S\psi(w_\bullet) = \psi(w_\bullet \otimes q^{L_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft) \in \mathbb{C}\{q\}$$

where $\blacktriangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft$ is the element of the “algebraic completion” of $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ corresponding to the identity element of $\text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathbb{M})$, and L_0 is the zero mode of the Virasoro operators $\{L_n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. The sewing problem is about proving that $S\psi(w_\bullet)$ converges absolutely to a (possibly) multivalued function on $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$. Moreover, for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$, $S\psi(\cdot, q)$ defines a conformal block associated to $\mathfrak{X}_q$ and $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$. If we sew $\tilde{C}$ along n pairs of points, and if we let $x_1, \dots, x_N$ and $\tilde{C}$ and ψ vary and be parametrized holomorphically by variables $\tau_\bullet = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_m)$ (see Sec. 1.6 for details), then sewing conformal blocks is also absolutely convergent with respect to $q_1, \dots, q_n$ and (locally) uniform with respect to $\tau_\bullet$. The sewing problem is analytic by nature. It cannot be proved using purely algebro-geometric method since $\mathfrak{X}$ is not an algebraic family; in particular, $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$ is not an algebraic variety or scheme, and is not considered in algebraic geometry. In the monograph, we will give a detailed proof of the sewing problem using analytic methods. See Section 4.3.

Factorization

In the above setting, the factorization property of conformal blocks says that if $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational (which means that certain classes of generalized

$\mathbb{V}$ -modules are completely reducible), then for any $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$, any conformal block associated to $\mathfrak{X}_q$ and $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ is a sum of $\mathcal{S}\psi(q)$ where $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$ (i.e. ψ is a conformal block associated to $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ and $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N, \mathbb{M}, \mathbb{M}'$) and $\mathbb{M}$ is simple. One can phrase the factorization as a relation between the dimensions of spaces of conformal blocks associated to $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ and to $\mathfrak{X}_q$ as follows. For each equivalence class of simple $\mathbb{V}$ -module we choose a representative and let them form a set $\mathcal{E}$. Then for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$,

$$\dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \sum_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}} \dim \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}').$$

Factorization in this form was proved in [TUY89] for WZW models and in [DGT19b] for any C_2 -cofinite rational VOA. Note that the left hand side is independent of q , and is a priori no less than the right hand side since the linear map $\psi \mapsto \mathcal{S}\psi(q)$ is indeed injective (Thm. 4.4.1).

Let us call the right hand side of this equation to be D . So $D \leq \dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. To prove the factorization, we add $\mathfrak{X}_0$, which is an N -pointed nodal curve, to the family $\mathfrak{X}$. Then $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed complex curves with base manifold $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$. We can still define the sheaf of covacua $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and show that it is finitely generated (Thm. 3.7.3). Then by Nakayama's lemma (Prop. 1.8.1), the dimension of fibers of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ (which can be identified with spaces of conformal blocks (Thm. 3.2.1)) is upper-semicontinuous with respect to $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$. Thus, for each $q \neq 0$, $\dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \leq \dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Therefore, it suffices to prove the **nodal factorization**: that $\dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \leq D$.

To prove the nodal factorization, we should realize each $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ as an element of $\bigoplus_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}} \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$. For that purpose, we consider $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ as a Riemann surface with input points $x_1, \dots, x_N$ and output points x', x'' . Then we can define the **dual $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ -tensor product** of $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ (associated to $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively) to be a vector space $\square_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, which is the subspace of linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$ satisfying certain properties that ϕ satisfy. The difficulty of this approach is to define an action of $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ on $\square_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ which makes the latter a weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module. Then using the C_2 -cofiniteness and rationality, it is not hard to show that $\square_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ (or a suitable $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -submodule containing ϕ) is a direct sum of irreducible $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ modules which must be of the form $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ for some $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}$. Nodal factorization follows.

[DGT19b] defines the weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module structure on $\square_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ using Zhu's algebras. Our approach does not use Zhu's algebra, but relies heavily on the **propagations of conformal blocks** (Sec.3.4) and more generally, **propagations of dual tensor product elements** (Sec. 4.6). Moreover, our proofs of propagations and some related properties are analytic and different from those in [FB04] or [DGT19b]: we use the sewing of an N -pointed compact Riemann surface and a 3-pointed $\mathbb{P}^1$; the convergence of the corresponding sewing of conformal blocks is

due to the strong residue theorem for *families* of compact Riemann surfaces (Thm. 1.4.1).

Prerequisite and outline

We assume the readers know some basic properties of complex manifolds; sheaves, sheaves of modules, and their morphisms; sheaf (Čech) cohomology. See for instance [GH78, Sec. 0.2, 0.3], [Huy06, Chapter B], [GR84, Annex]. Some familiarity with computations in VOA (cf. for instance [FHL93]) is helpful but not necessary. No knowledge in algebraic geometry is required.

More advanced topics in complex geometry will be discussed in Chapter 1. In particular, we review the basic properties of compact Riemann surfaces, which will be generalized to nodal curves. Since we do not assume the readers have any previous knowledge on complex spaces or nodal curves, we give complete and self-contained account of these properties. We also introduce the necessary tools for studying families of compact Riemann surfaces and, more generally, families of complex curves. We give a detailed description of how to sew a family of compact Riemann surfaces along several pairs of points to obtain a family of complex curves. We prove strong residue theorem for families of compact Riemann surfaces, which is necessary for proving the propagations of conformal blocks. Basic properties of holomorphic differential equations are recalled, which will be used to prove the convergence of sewing conformal blocks. We also give criteria on local freeness of sheaves.

In Chapter 2 we discuss sheaves of VOAs for families of complex curves introduced in [FB04] (for smooth curves) and [DGT19a] (for nodal curves). These sheaves are infinite rank holomorphic vector bundles whose transition functions are discovered in [Hua97]. We also give a formula for Lie derivatives of sheaves of VOAs, generalizing those of tangent fields and tensor fields. This formula is due to the author, and is used in the next chapter to define connections on sheaves of conformal blocks.

Following [FB04, DGT19a], we define in Chapter 3 sheaves of conformal blocks for families of complex curves. We define the sewing of conformal blocks which corresponds to the geometric construction of sewing families of compact Riemann surfaces. We prove that the sewing of conformal blocks are also conformal blocks in the formal sense, which is due to [DGT19b]. We then prove propagation of conformal blocks. Single propagation is due to [FB04], and multiple propagations are due to the author. Double propagations play an important role of defining weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module structures on dual tensor products in Chapter 4. As mentioned previously, our treatment of single propagation is new and relies on sewing. We then prove that sheaves of conformal blocks support locally logarithmic connections. This result is due to [FB04] and [DGT19a] for smooth families and general families respectively. Our treatment is different from theirs and uses

the result on Lie derivatives in Chapter 2. With the help of connections, we then prove that for C_2 -cofinite VOAs, the sheaves of conformal blocks are locally free.

The first three sections of Chapter 4 are devoted to the proof that sewing conformal blocks is convergent when $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite. Our treatment of projective structures is motivated by [FB04, Sec. 8.2]. We also prove that the sewing map is injective. We then define the vector space of dual tensor products, and use (single and double) propagations of dual tensor product elements to define weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module structures. For an approach using Zhu's algebra, see [DGT19b]. We then prove factorization for conformal blocks associated to C_2 -cofinite rational VOAs, which is originally due to [DGT19b].

The connections defined locally in Chapter 3 are in general not flat but only projectively flat. In chapter 5, we explain how to slightly modify the definition and obtain flat connections on sheaves of conformal blocks. Typically, the construction of flat connections uses determinant line bundles. It turns out that tensor products of these line bundles are equivalent to sheaves of conformal blocks associated to holomorphic VOAs. We use the latter sheaves instead of determinant line bundles. This treatment is motivated by [AU07a, AU07b]. We also provide in this chapter all the necessary results for constructing modular functors from conformal blocks. In the last section, we explain how the famous and mysterious factor $q^{-\frac{c}{24}}$ appears in genus 1 CFT.

We remark that before [FB04, DGT19a, DGT19b], the definition of conformal blocks, and the proof of propagation, local freeness, and factorization of conformal blocks were given in [BFM91, TUY89] for minimal models and WZW-models respectively, and in [NT05] for general VOAs (satisfying C_2 -cofiniteness, rationality, and some other small conditions) but only genus 0 curves. Proofs of convergence of sewing and factorization were also given in [Hua95, Hua98, Hua05a] for general VOAs as above for genus 0 curves, and in [Zhu96, Hua05b] for genus 1 curves.

Chapter 1

Basics of complex geometry

1.1 Sheaves of modules

Let us fix some notations.

$$\mathbf{i} = \sqrt{-1}.$$

$$\mathbb{N} = \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}, \quad \mathbb{Z}_+ = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}.$$

Throughout this monograph, $\mathcal{O}_X$ of a given complex manifold X (or more generally, a complex space) always denotes the sheaf (of germs) of holomorphic functions on X . Thus, $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is the space of holomorphic functions on X . We will sometimes write $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ as $\mathcal{O}(X)$ for short. For any $x \in X$, $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ denotes the stalk of $\mathcal{O}_X$ at x , and $\mathfrak{m}_x$ denotes the ideal of all germs $f \in \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ satisfying $f(x) = 0$.

In general, if $\mathcal{E}$ is a sheaf on X then $\mathcal{E}_x$ denotes the stalk at x . If U is an open set containing x , and if $s \in \mathcal{E}(U)$, then $s_x \in \mathcal{E}_x$ denotes the germ of s at x . If $\mathcal{E}$ is a (sheaf of) $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, then $\mathcal{E}_x/\mathfrak{m}_x\mathcal{E}_x$ is a complex vector space, called the **fiber** of $\mathcal{E}$ at x . (Fibers can also be defined using pull backs of sheaves; see Section 1.3. It will be denoted by $\mathcal{E}|_x$ in the future.) It's dimension r_x is called the **rank** of $\mathcal{E}$ at x . The function $r : x \in X \mapsto r_x$ is called the **rank function**.

A homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules $\mathcal{E} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ is an isomorphism (i.e., the induced homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -modules $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$ is an isomorphism for any open subset U) if and only if the corresponding stalk map $\mathcal{F}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_x$ is an isomorphism for each $x \in X$. $\mathcal{E}$ is called **locally free** if each $x \in X$ has a neighborhood U such that $\mathcal{E}|_U \simeq \mathcal{O}_U^n$ for some natural number n . $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free if and only if it is the sheaf of germs of a holomorphic (finite rank) vector bundle. Thus, locally free sheaves and vector bundles are regarded as the same things. It is clear that the rank function is locally constant for any locally free sheaf. Unless otherwise stated, we assume that locally free sheaves have (locally) finite rank.

If U is an open subset of X , and $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$, we say that $s_1, \dots, s_n$ **generate** $\mathcal{E}_U$, if for each $x \in U$, the stalk $\mathcal{E}_x$ is generated by (the germs of) $s_1, \dots, s_n$. This

is equivalent to saying that the $\mathcal{O}_U$ -module homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_U^n \rightarrow \mathcal{E}_U$ defined by

$$\mathcal{O}_U^n(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}_U(V), \quad (f_1, \dots, f_n) \mapsto f_1 s_1 + \dots + f_n s_n$$

(where V is any open subset of U) is a surjective sheaf map. Also, it is equivalent to that for any $x \in U$, $V \subset U$ a neighborhood of x , and $s \in \mathcal{E}(V)$, there exists a neighborhood W of x inside V such that $s = f_1 s_1 + \dots + f_n s_n$ for some $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathcal{O}(W)$. If the above homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_U^n \rightarrow \mathcal{E}_U$ is an isomorphism, then we say that $s_1, \dots, s_n$ **generate freely** $\mathcal{E}_U$. If $s_1, \dots, s_n$ generate $\mathcal{E}_U$, then they generate freely $\mathcal{E}_U$ if and only if for any open subset $V \subset U$ and any $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathcal{O}(V)$, $f_1 s_1|_V + \dots + f_n s_n|_V = 0$ implies $f_1 = \dots = f_n = 0$. We say that $\mathcal{E}$ is a **finite-type** $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module if each $x \in X$ is contained in a neighborhood U such that $\mathcal{E}_U$ is generated by finitely many elements of $\mathcal{E}(U)$.

The above notion of generating sections can be generalized to any subset E of $\mathcal{E}(U)$, i.e., that (the elements of) E **generate** $\mathcal{E}_U$ if for each $x \in U$, the germs of the elements of E at x generate the $\mathcal{O}_{U,x}$ -module $\mathcal{E}_x$. This is not the same as saying that E generates (the $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -module) $\mathcal{E}(U)$, which means that each element of $\mathcal{E}(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -linear combination of elements of E .

Most sheaves we will encounter in this monograph are locally free. However, sometimes we need to consider quotients of locally free sheaves, which are not necessarily locally free. Here is the precise definition: An $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module $\mathcal{E}$ is called a **coherent** $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module (or coherent sheaf) if each $x \in X$ is contained in a neighborhood U such that the restriction $\mathcal{E}_U$ is isomorphic to $\text{coker}(\varphi)$ where $\varphi : \mathcal{O}_U^m \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_U^n$ is a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules and $m, n \in \mathbb{N}$. A locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module is clearly coherent.

Let $\mathcal{E}$ and $\mathcal{F}$ be $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. For any open U in X , let $\mathcal{E}_U$ and $\mathcal{F}_U$ be respectively the restrictions of $\mathcal{E}$ and $\mathcal{F}$ to U . Let $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}_U, \mathcal{F}_U)$ be the set of $\mathcal{O}_U$ -morphisms from $\mathcal{E}$ to $\mathcal{F}$. So any element $\phi \in \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}_U, \mathcal{F}_U)$ is described as follows. For any open $V \subset U$, we have an $\mathcal{O}(V)$ -module homomorphism $\phi = \phi_V : \mathcal{E}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(V)$. ϕ is compatible with the restriction of sections, i.e., for any open $W \subset V \subset U$ and $s \in \mathcal{E}(V)$, we have

$$\phi(s)|_W = \phi(s|_W).$$

For each $x \in V$, ϕ induces homomorphisms of $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ -modules and vector spaces

$$\phi : \mathcal{E}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_x, \quad \phi : \mathcal{E}_x / \mathfrak{m}_x \mathcal{E}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_x / \mathfrak{m}_x \mathcal{F}_x. \quad (1.1.1)$$

It is clear that

$$\phi(\mathcal{E})_x = \phi(\mathcal{E}_x) \quad (1.1.2)$$

where $\phi(\mathcal{E})$ is the image sheaf. For each section s of $\mathcal{E}$ defined near x , if we let s_x and $s(x)$ denote the values of s in $\mathcal{E}_x$ and $\mathcal{E}_x / \mathfrak{m}_x \mathcal{E}_x$, and adopt similar notations for $\phi(s)$, then

$$\phi(s_x) = \phi(s)_x, \quad \phi(s(x)) = \phi(s)(x). \quad (1.1.3)$$

Note that $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}_U, \mathcal{F}_U)$ is clearly an $\mathcal{O}(U)$ module. Then we have the so called sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -homomorphisms $\underline{\text{Hom}}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{F})$, where for any open $U \subset X$, $\underline{\text{Hom}}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{F})(U) = \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}_U, \mathcal{F}_U)$ whose sections are all those ϕ_U . $\underline{\text{Hom}}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{F})$ is obviously an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. We call

$$\mathcal{E}^* := \underline{\text{Hom}}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{O}_X)$$

the **dual sheaf** of $\mathcal{E}$. Choose $s \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ and $t \in \mathcal{E}^*(U)$, then $t(s)$, as a section in $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$, is also denoted by $\langle s, t \rangle$ or $\langle t, s \rangle$. Note that when $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free, then $\mathcal{E}^*$ is also locally free, and $\mathcal{E}^*$ is dual to $\mathcal{E}$ as holomorphic vector bundles. In particular, $\mathcal{E}^{**}$ can be naturally identified with $\mathcal{E}$.

The collection $\{\mathcal{E}(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}(U)} \mathcal{F}(U)\}$ over all open $U \subset X$ forms a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. The restriction of sections of this presheaf is defined in an obvious way. Its sheafification $\mathcal{E} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{F}$, which is clearly an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, is called the tensor product of $\mathcal{E}$ and $\mathcal{F}$ over $\mathcal{O}_X$. Unless otherwise stated, we will write $\mathcal{E} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{F}$ as $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{F}$ for short. If we consider the tensor product over $\mathbb{C}$, we will write $\mathcal{E} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{F}$ instead. Note that when the two $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules are locally free, their tensor product is nothing but the tensor product of holomorphic vector bundles. Another easy fact is the isomorphisms $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_X \simeq \mathcal{E} \simeq \mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathcal{E}$ in a natural way. We write $\mathcal{E}^{\otimes n}$ as the n -th tensor power of $\mathcal{E}$ for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Note also that $\mathcal{L} \otimes \mathcal{L}^* \simeq \mathcal{O}_X$ for a (holomorphic) line bundle $\mathcal{L}$ (i.e., $\mathcal{L}$ is a rank 1 locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module). In this case we write $\mathcal{L}^{-1} = \mathcal{L}^*$, and more generally, $\mathcal{L}^{\otimes(-n)} = (\mathcal{L}^*)^{\otimes n}$.

A useful method of constructing sheaves is called **gluing**. Let $(U_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}}$ be an open cover of X . Suppose that for each $\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}$, we have an $\mathcal{O}_{U_\alpha}$ -module $\mathcal{E}^\alpha$, that for any $\alpha, \beta \in \mathfrak{A}$, we have an $\mathcal{O}_{U_\alpha \cap U_\beta}$ -module isomorphism $\phi_{\beta, \alpha} : \mathcal{E}_{U_\alpha \cap U_\beta}^\alpha \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{E}_{U_\alpha \cap U_\beta}^\beta$, that $\phi_{\alpha, \alpha} = 1$, and that $\phi_{\gamma, \alpha} = \phi_{\gamma, \beta} \phi_{\beta, \alpha}$ when restricted to $U_\alpha \cap U_\beta \cap U_\gamma$. Then we can define a sheaf $\mathcal{E}$ on X as follows. For any open $V \subset X$, $\mathcal{E}(V)$ is the set of all $(s_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}} \in \prod_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}} \mathcal{E}^\alpha(V \cap U_\alpha)$ (where each component s_α is in $\mathcal{E}^\alpha(V \cap U_\alpha)$) satisfying that $s_\beta|_{U_\alpha \cap U_\beta} = \phi_{\beta, \alpha}(s_\alpha|_{U_\alpha \cap U_\beta})$ for any $\alpha, \beta \in \mathfrak{A}$. If W is an open subset of V , then the restriction $\mathcal{E}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(W)$ is defined by that of $\mathcal{E}^\alpha(V \cap U_\alpha) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}^\alpha(W \cap U_\alpha)$. The action of $\mathcal{O}(V)$ on $\mathcal{E}(V)$ is defined by the one of $\mathcal{O}(V \cap U_\alpha)$ on $\mathcal{E}^\alpha(V \cap U_\alpha)$. It is easy to see that $\mathcal{E}$ is a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Moreover, for each $\beta \in \mathfrak{A}$, we have a canonical isomorphism (trivialization) $\phi_\beta : \mathcal{E}_{U_\beta} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{E}_{U_\beta}^\beta$ defined by $(s_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}} \mapsto s_\beta$. It is clear that for each $\alpha, \beta \in \mathfrak{A}$, we have $\phi_\beta = \phi_{\beta, \alpha} \phi_\alpha$ when restricted to $U_\alpha \cap U_\beta$.

For instance, any locally free sheaf is obtained by gluing a collection of free sheaves associated to an open cover of X .

1.2 Compact Riemann surfaces

Serre duality

Let C be a compact Riemann surface, and let $\mathcal{E}$ be a (sheaf of) locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module. We list some basic facts about the cohomology groups of $\mathcal{E}$. Choose

$q \in \mathbb{N}$. The first important fact is that $H^q(C, \mathcal{E})$ is finite dimensional. Moreover, $\dim H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ when q is greater than 1, the complex dimension of C . These facts can be proved by Hodge theory. Moreover, let ω_C be the **dualizing sheaf** (also called canonical line bundle) of C . In other words, ω_C is the line bundle of holomorphic 1-forms on C . So the sections of ω_C look locally like $f(z)dz$ where f is a holomorphic function. Then **Serre duality** (which can also follow from Hodge theory) says that for any $p \in \{0, 1\}$ there is an isomorphism of vector spaces

$$H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) \simeq H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C^{1-p})^*, \quad (1.2.1)$$

where $\omega_C^0 = \mathcal{O}_C$ and $\omega_C^1 = \omega_C$. (Cf. [Huy06] Proposition 4.1.16.) In other words, there is a perfect pairing

$$\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) \otimes H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C^{1-p}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}. \quad (1.2.2)$$

We now describe such a pairing, called the **residue pairing**. This explicit description will be used in the proof of strong residue theorem.

Recall that the Čech cohomology group $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$ is the direct limit of $H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) = Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) / B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$ over all open covers $\mathfrak{U}$ of C . Now choose any $N \in \mathbb{Z}_+$. The data $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ is called an **N -pointed compact Riemann surface**, if $x_1, \dots, x_N$ are distinct points on C . Choose mutually disjoint connected open subsets $U_1, \dots, U_N \subset C$ containing $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively, and define $U_0 = C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N\}$. Then $\mathfrak{U} = \{U_0, U_1, \dots, U_N\}$ is an open cover of C . We now construct some cocycles in $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$. For any $1 \leq n \leq N$, choose

$$\sigma_n \in (\mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)(U_n - \{x_n\}).$$

Note that $U_n - \{x_n\} = U_n \cap U_0$. We now define Čech 1-cocycle $s = (s_{m,n})_{m,n=0,1,\dots,N} \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$ (where each $s_{m,n} \in (\mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)(U_m \cap U_n)$) in the following way. Set $s_{0,0} = 0$; if $m, n > 0$ then $s_{m,n}$ is not defined since $U_m \cap U_n = \emptyset$; if $n > 0$ then $s_{n,0} = -s_{0,n} = \sigma_n$. Then s can also be regarded as an element in $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$. (Indeed, any element in $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$ arises in such way. One way to see this is to note that since each U_j is Stein manifold, $H^p(U_j, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) = 0$ when $p > 0$ by Cartan's Theorem B. (See Sec. 1.5.) So by Leray's theorem, $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) = H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$.) Choose any $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C^{1-p})$, which is a global section of $\mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C^{1-p}$ on C . Then for any n , the evaluation $\langle \sigma_n, t \rangle$ is an element of $\omega_C(U_n - \{x_n\})$. So we have the residue

$$\text{Res}_{x_n} \langle \sigma_n, t \rangle = \frac{1}{2i\pi} \oint_{\gamma_n} \langle \sigma_n, t \rangle, \quad (1.2.3)$$

where γ_n is an arbitrary loop around x_n whose orientation is anticlockwise in any local coordinate at x_n . Now, the residue pairing of Serre duality (1.2.1) is described by

$$\langle s, t \rangle = \sum_{n=1}^N \text{Res}_{x_n} \langle \sigma_n, t \rangle. \quad (1.2.4)$$

Let us explain, assuming the existence of an isomorphism (1.2.1), why an explicit isomorphism can be realized by the above pairing. It is an easy exercise that $\langle s, t \rangle = 0$ when s is inside the coboundary $B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$, hence when s is zero when regarded as in $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p) = H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$. Use the residue pairing to define a linear map from the left to the right hand side of (1.2.1). It suffices to prove that this map is surjective. It is easy to see that this map is independent of the sizes of $U_1, \dots, U_N$. So we may assume the vector bundle $\mathcal{E}$ can be trivialized on each $U_1, \dots, U_N$. Now, for each linear functional $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C^{1-p}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, using linear algebra, it is easy to realize it as the residue pairing with some element of $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C^p)$. This proves the surjectivity.

Vanishing theorems

When studying a family of vector bundles $\{\mathcal{E}_b : b \in \mathcal{B}\}$ over a family of compact Riemann surfaces $\{C_b : b \in \mathcal{B}\}$, it is important to know if the collection $\{H^0(C_b, \mathcal{E}_b) : b \in \mathcal{B}\}$ forms a vector bundle on $\mathcal{B}$ in a natural way. Clearly, a necessary condition is that $\dim H^0(C_b, \mathcal{E}_b)$ is locally independent of b . As we shall see, a theorem of Grauert implies that this is also a sufficient condition.

The constancy of $\dim H^0(C_b, \mathcal{E}_b)$ is not always true in general. However, if we define the **character** of $\mathcal{E}$ to be

$$\chi(C, \mathcal{E}) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (-1)^n \dim H^n(C, \mathcal{E}) = \dim H^0(C, \mathcal{E}) - \dim H^1(C, \mathcal{E}), \quad (1.2.5)$$

then $\chi(C_b, \mathcal{E}_b)$ is indeed always constant over b . On the other hand, if one can use vanishing theorems to show that $\dim H^1(C_b, \mathcal{E}_b) = 0$ for all b , then the constancy of $\dim H^0$ immediately follows from that of the characters. In the following, we discuss several vanishing results which will be useful for the study of conformal blocks.

Let D be a **divisor** of C . In other words, D is a finite formal sum $D = \sum_i n_i x_i$, where $\{x_i\}$ are points of C , and each $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}$. We say D is **effective** and write $D \geq 0$ if any n_i is non-negative. Recall that the **degree** $\deg D$ of $D = \sum_i n_i x_i$ is $\sum_i n_i$. Regard $\mathcal{E}$ as a holomorphic vector bundle. For any open $U \subset C$, let $\mathcal{E}(D)(U)$ be the set of all $s \in \mathcal{E}(D)(U - \{x_i\})$ satisfying that for any x_i and any local coordinate η_i near x_i , $\eta_i^{n_i} s$ has removable singularity at x_i . Then the collection $\{\mathcal{E}(D)(U)\}$ over all open $U \subset C$ forms an $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{E}(D)$.

Note that $\mathcal{O}_C(D)$ is a line bundle, and it is well known that any line bundle is isomorphic to some $\mathcal{O}_C(D)$. (A proof is sketched in Remark 1.5.6.) One has a natural isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C$ -modules $\mathcal{E}(D) \simeq \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(D)$. Therefore $\mathcal{E}(D)$ is locally free. We understand $\mathcal{E}(D)$ as $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(D)$ even when $\mathcal{E}$ is not locally free. One also has $\mathcal{O}_C(-D) \simeq \mathcal{O}_C(D)^*$, and $\mathcal{O}_C(D_1 + D_2) \simeq \mathcal{O}_C(D_1) \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(D_2)$ for two divisors D_1, D_2 .

Proposition 1.2.1. *Assume that C is connected, $\mathcal{E}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module, and D is a non-zero effective divisor of C . Then there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-nD)) = 0$ for any $n > N$.*

Proof. Consider $\mathcal{E}$ as a vector bundle. Write $D = \sum_i x_i$. For any $x = x_i$, $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-D))$ is a subspace of $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-x))$. Thus it suffices to prove that $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-nx)) = 0$ when n is large enough.

Since $H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$ is finite dimensional, there exist finitely many global sections $\{s_k : k = 1, 2, \dots\}$ of $\mathcal{E}$ spanning $H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$. Regard a neighborhood U of x as an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$, and assume that $x = 0 \in \mathbb{C}$. Assume also that $\mathcal{E}_U$ has trivialization $\mathcal{E}_U \simeq E \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U$ where E is a finite dimensional vector space. Then for any k , s_k has expansion $s_k(z) = \sum_{j=0}^{\infty} v_{k,j} z^j$ near $z = 0$, where each $v_{k,j} \in E$.

For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $\vec{v}_k|_n$ be $(v_{k,0}, v_{k,1}, \dots, v_{k,n})$ in $E \otimes \mathbb{C}^{n+1}$. Let F_n be the subspace of $E \otimes \mathbb{C}^{n+1}$ spanned by $\{\vec{v}_k|_n : k = 1, 2, \dots\}$. Then $\dim F_n$ is an increasing function of n whose values are bounded from above. Choose $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\dim F_n$ is the constant K for all $n \geq N$. Assume without loss of generality that $\vec{v}_1|_N, \dots, \vec{v}_K|_N$ are linearly independent. So for any $n \geq N$, $\vec{v}_1|_n, \dots, \vec{v}_K|_n$ are also linearly independent, which therefore form a basis of F_n . Choose any k . Then for any $n \geq N$, $\vec{v}_k|_n = c_{1,n} \vec{v}_1|_n + \dots + c_{K,n} \vec{v}_K|_n$ for some unique $c_{1,n}, \dots, c_{K,n} \in \mathbb{C}$. By such uniqueness, we conclude that $c_{1,n} = c_{1,N}, \dots, c_{K,n} = c_{K,N}$ for all $n \geq N$. Therefore $s_k = c_{1,N} s_1 + \dots + c_{K,N} s_K$ near x . This equation holds globally since C is connected. We thus conclude that $s_1, \dots, s_K$ form a basis of $H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$. In particular, $K = \dim H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$.

Now choose any $n > N$ and any $\sigma \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-nx)) \subset H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$. Then there exist $c_1, \dots, c_K \in \mathbb{C}$ such that $\sigma = c_1 s_1 + \dots + c_K s_K$. Near x one has series expansion $\sigma(z) = \sum_{j=0}^{\infty} \nu_j z^j$. Then $(\nu_0, \nu_1, \dots, \nu_N) = c_1 \vec{v}_1|_N + \dots + c_K \vec{v}_K|_N$. Since $n > N$ and $z^{-n} \sigma(z)$ has removable singularity near 0, we have $\nu_0 = \dots = \nu_N = 0$. Therefore $c_1 = \dots = c_K = 0$ by the linear independence of $\vec{v}_1|_N, \dots, \vec{v}_K|_N$. This proves that $\sigma = 0$. $\square$

Let Θ_C be the **tangent sheaf** of C , i.e., the sheaf of holomorphic tangent vectors on C . So $\Theta_C \simeq \omega_C^{-1}$. Consequently, $\Theta_C \otimes \omega_C \simeq \mathcal{O}_C$.

Corollary 1.2.2. *Assume that C is connected, $\mathcal{E}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module, and D is a non-zero effective divisor of C . Then there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $H^1(C, \mathcal{E}(nD)) = 0$ for any $n > N$.*

Proof. By the above proposition, $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C(-nD)) = 0$ for any sufficiently large n . Note that $(\mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C(-nD))^* \otimes \omega_C \simeq \mathcal{E} \otimes \Theta_C \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(nD) \otimes \omega_C \simeq \mathcal{E}(nD)$. Thus, by Serre duality, $H^1(C, \mathcal{E}(nD)) = 0$ for any sufficiently large n . $\square$

The above corollary is also true when D has positive degree. See [Huy06, Prop. 5.2.7]

Remark 1.2.3. In Corollary 1.2.2, if we know that $H^1(C, \mathcal{E}(ND)) = 0$, then $H^1(C, \mathcal{E}(nD)) = 0$ for any $n \geq N$. Indeed, by Serre duality, we have $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C(-ND)) = 0$. Then $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C(-nD))$, which is naturally a subspace of $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C(-ND))$, must also be trivial. By Serre duality again, we obtain $H^1(C, \mathcal{E}(nD)) = 0$.

It will be important to know what N precisely is in the above corollary. When $\mathcal{E}$ is a line bundle, we can find such N with the help of Kodaira vanishing theorem and Riemann-Roch theorem. To begin with, recall:

Theorem 1.2.4. (Kodaira vanishing theorem) Assume that C is connected. Let D be a divisor on C with $\deg D > 0$. Then $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(-D)) = 0$ and $H^1(C, \omega_C(D)) = 0$.

Proof. Suppose $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(-D))$ is nontrivial. Choose any non-zero $f \in H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(-D))$. Then f is a global meromorphic function on C which is not always zero on any open subset of C . Thus its degree $\deg f$ must be 0.¹ But $\deg f - \deg D$ must be non-negative by the definition of $\mathcal{O}_C(-D)$, which contradicts $\deg D > 0$. So $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(-D)) = 0$. By Serre duality, $H^1(C, \omega_C(D)) = 0$. $\square$

For any line bundle $\mathcal{L}$, we choose a divisor D such that $\mathcal{L} \simeq \mathcal{O}_C(D)$, and define the degree $\deg \mathcal{L}$ of $\mathcal{L}$ to be $\deg D$. This is well defined and independent of the choice of D . Now assume that C is connected. Then $\dim H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = 1$. Since C admits a Kähler structure, we have the Hodge structure $\dim H^1(C, \mathbb{C}) = \dim H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C) + \dim H^0(C, \omega_C)$ ([Huy06] corollary 3.2.12), which together with Serre duality implies $\dim H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = \frac{1}{2} \dim H^1(C, \mathbb{C})$. Thus the **genus** $g := \dim H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C)$ of C depends only on the topological structure but not the complex structure of C . (This fact also follows from the base change Theorem 1.3.1.) Now, the **Riemann-Roch theorem** tells us that

$$\chi(C, \mathcal{L}) = 1 - g + \deg \mathcal{L}. \quad (1.2.6)$$

(See also Remark 1.5.6.) Apply this formula to ω_C and use Serre duality, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} 1 - g + \deg \omega_C &= \chi(C, \omega_C) = \dim H^0(C, \omega_C) - \dim H^1(C, \omega_C) \\ &= \dim H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C) - \dim H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = g - 1. \end{aligned}$$

This shows that

$$\deg \omega_C = 2g - 2, \quad \deg \Theta_C = 2 - 2g. \quad (1.2.7)$$

Theorem 1.2.5. Let C be a compact connected Riemann surface with genus g , let D be a divisor of C , and let $\mathcal{L}$ be a line bundle on C . Then $H^1(C, \mathcal{L}(D)) = 0$ when $\deg D > 2g - 2 - \deg \mathcal{L}$.

¹For any $x \in C$ with an arbitrary local coordinate η_x (so $\eta_x(x) = 0$), let n_x be the smallest integer such that $f/\eta_x^{n_x}$ has removable singularity at x . Then $\deg f$ is defined to be $\sum_{x \in C} n_x$. Clearly $n_x = \text{Res}_x f^{-1} df$. Thus we have $\deg f = 0$ by residue theorem.

Proof. Choose divisors T, L such that $\Theta_C \simeq \mathcal{O}_C(T), \mathcal{L} \simeq \mathcal{O}_C(L)$. Then $\mathcal{L}(D) \simeq \omega_C \otimes \Theta_C \otimes \mathcal{L}(D) \simeq \omega_C(T + L + D)$. By (1.2.7), $\deg T = 2 - 2g$. Therefore, when $\deg D > 2g - 2 - \deg \mathcal{L}$, we have $\deg(T + L + D) > 0$, which implies $H^1(C, \mathcal{L}(D)) = 0$ by Kodaira vanishing theorem. $\square$

Corollary 1.2.6. *Let C be a compact connected Riemann surface with genus g , let D be a divisor of C , and choose $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $H^1(C, \Theta_C^{\otimes n}(D)) = 0$ when $\deg D > (n+1)(2g-2)$.*

Proof. This follows immediately from the above theorem and (1.2.7). $\square$

This corollary will be the most useful vanishing result for our future study of VOA bundles. The most remarkable point is that the threshold $(n+1)(2g-2)$ for H^1 to vanish is independent of the complex structure of C .

1.3 Families of compact Riemann surfaces

Higher direct images

Let $\pi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a holomorphic map of complex manifolds. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. For any open $U \subset Y$, we let $\pi_*(\mathcal{E})(U) = \mathcal{E}(\pi^{-1}(U))$. Then $\pi_*(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -module: if $s \in \mathcal{E}(\pi^{-1}(U))$ and $f \in \mathcal{O}(U)$, then the product $f \cdot s$ is defined to be the section $(f \circ \pi)s$. The collection $\{\pi_*(\mathcal{E})(U)\}$ over all open $U \subset Y$ forms a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module $\pi_*(\mathcal{E})$, called the **direct image** of $\mathcal{E}$ (under π).

More generally, for any $q \in \mathbb{N}$, the collection $\{H^q(\pi^{-1}(U), \mathcal{E})\}$ over all open $U \subset Y$ forms a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module, whose sheafification $R^q\pi_*(\mathcal{E})$ is called the q -th order **higher direct image** of $\mathcal{E}$ under π . Then $R^0\pi_*(\mathcal{E})$ is just $\pi_*(\mathcal{E})$. Note that when Y is a single point and π is surjective, higher direct images are nothing but the cohomology groups of $\mathcal{E}$. Similar to cohomology groups, whenever there is a short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{E} \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0$, there is a long exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{E}) \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{F}) \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{\delta} R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{E}) \rightarrow R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{F}) \rightarrow R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{\delta} R^2\pi_*(\mathcal{E}) \rightarrow \cdots. \quad (1.3.1)$$

All the maps in this exact sequence, except the connecting homomorphism δ , are understood in an obvious way. We now describe the first δ , i.e. $\delta : \pi_*(\mathcal{G}) \rightarrow R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{E})$, which is sufficient for the purpose of this monograph. Choose any open $U \subset Y$ and any $s \in \mathcal{G}(\pi^{-1}(U))$. Then by the surjectivity of the stalk map $\mathcal{F}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_x$ for all $x \in X$, $\pi^{-1}(U)$ has an open cover $\mathfrak{V} = (V_\alpha)_\alpha$ such that for each α there exists $\sigma_\alpha \in \mathcal{F}(V_\alpha)$ whose image in $\mathcal{G}(V_\alpha)$ equals $s|_{V_\alpha}$. Define the 1-cochain $\varsigma = (\varsigma_{\alpha,\beta})_{\alpha,\beta}$ such that for any V_α, V_β in $\mathfrak{V}$, $\varsigma_{\alpha,\beta} = \sigma_\alpha|_{V_\alpha \cap V_\beta} - \sigma_\beta|_{V_\alpha \cap V_\beta}$. Then $\varsigma_{\alpha,\beta} \in \mathcal{E}(V_\alpha \cap V_\beta)$, and hence $\varsigma \in Z^1(\mathfrak{V}, \mathcal{E})$. So ς can be regarded as an element of $H^1(\pi^{-1}(U), \mathcal{E})$ and hence of $R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{E})(U)$. Then $\delta(s)$ is just this ς .

Pulling back sheaves

We now assume that $\mathcal{E}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module. We define an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module $\pi^*(\mathcal{E})$, called the **pull back** of $\mathcal{E}$ under π , as follows.

Let U be an open subset of X . For any open subset V of Y satisfying $\pi(U) \subset V$, the ring $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ -module: if $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ and $g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$, then the action of g on f is $(g \circ \pi)|_U \cdot f$, noticing that $g \circ \pi \in \mathcal{O}_X(\pi^{-1}(V))$ and hence $(g \circ \pi)|_U \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$. Then the tensor product $\mathcal{O}_X(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V)$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -module. The collection over all open $U \subset X$ of the $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -modules

$$\varinjlim_{V \supset \pi(U)} \mathcal{O}_X(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V)$$

form a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, whose sheafification is $\pi^*(\mathcal{E})$. We can thus define for any open $V \subset Y$ an $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ -module homomorphism

$$\pi^* : \mathcal{E}(V) \rightarrow \pi^*\mathcal{E}(\pi^{-1}(V)), \quad s \mapsto \pi^*s, \quad (1.3.2)$$

such that $1 \otimes s \in \mathcal{O}_X(\pi^{-1}(V)) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V)$, regarded as an element of $\pi^*\mathcal{E}(\pi^{-1}(V))$, is our π^*s . That π^* is an $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ -module homomorphism means that for any $g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$,

$$\pi^*(gs) = (g \circ \pi)\pi^*s.$$

Then for any $q \in \mathbb{N}$ we have a natural linear map

$$\pi^* : H^q(Y, \mathcal{E}) \rightarrow H^q(X, \pi^*\mathcal{E}),$$

called the pull back of cohomology groups.

When $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free, for any $x \in X$, choose a neighborhood $W \subset Y$ of $\pi(x)$ such that $\mathcal{E}_W \simeq \mathcal{O}_W \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E$, where E is a finite dimensional vector space. Then for any open $U \subset \pi^{-1}(W)$ and $V \subset W$, the $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -module $\mathcal{O}_X(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V)$ is naturally isomorphic to $\mathcal{O}_X(U) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E$. So $\pi^*(\mathcal{E})$ is also locally free whose rank is the same as that of $\mathcal{E}$. Indeed, the pull back of locally free modules is just the pull back of holomorphic vector bundles.

If $\iota : X \rightarrow Y$ is an embedding of complex manifolds, for any $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module $\mathcal{E}$, we call

$$\mathcal{E}|_X \equiv \mathcal{E}|_X := \iota^*\mathcal{E}$$

the **restriction** of $\mathcal{E}$ to X . For any open $V \subset Y$, we have the $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ -module homomorphism

$$\iota^* : \mathcal{E}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}|_X(V \cap X), \quad s \mapsto \iota^*s.$$

We write

$$s|_X \equiv s|_X := \iota^*s$$

and call it the **restriction** of s to X . Similar notation will be used for restrictions of elements in cohomology groups.

Note that $\mathcal{E}|_V$ is just $\mathcal{E}_V$, the usual restriction of $\mathcal{E}$ to the open subset V . For any $y \in Y$, $\mathcal{E}|_y$ is a vector space isomorphic to the fiber $\mathcal{E}_y/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y$. Indeed, notice that

$$\mathcal{E}|_y = \varinjlim_{V \ni y} \mathbb{C}_y \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V).$$

Here $\mathbb{C}_y$ is the same as $\mathbb{C}$ as a vector space. But it is also an $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ -module, where for any $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}_y$ and any $g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$, the action of g on λ is $\lambda g(y)$. It is then not hard to check that the linear map $1 \otimes s \in \mathbb{C}_y \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y(V)} \mathcal{E}(V) \mapsto s \in \mathcal{E}_y/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y$ induces an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{E}|_y \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{E}_y/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y.$$

We will not distinguish between $\mathcal{E}|_y$ and $\mathcal{E}_y/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y$ in the future. $s|_y$, the restriction of s to the 0-dimensional submanifold y , is precisely the value of s in $\mathcal{E}_y/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y$. We also write

$$s(y) := s|_y,$$

which should not be confused with the germ s_y in $\mathcal{E}_y$.

A theorem of Grauert

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ be complex manifolds, and $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ be a surjective proper holomorphic map. (The word “proper” means that the preimage of any compact subset of $\mathcal{B}$ is compact.) Assume that π is a (holomorphic) submersion, which means that the linear map $d\pi$ between tangent spaces is always surjective. We say that $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ is a (holomorphic) **family of compact Riemann surfaces** (or a smooth family of complex curves), if for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b := \pi^{-1}(b)$ is a compact Riemann surface. As an obvious fact, the complex dimensions of $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ differ by 1. To simplify discussions, we also assume that $\mathcal{B}$ has finitely many connected components.

The following theorem of Grauert [Gra60] is extremely helpful in studying families of compact Riemann surfaces.

Theorem 1.3.1. *Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module.*

(a) *The function*

$$\mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad b \mapsto \chi(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$$

is locally constant.

(b) For any $q \in \mathbb{N}$, the function $b \mapsto \dim H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ is upper semi-continuous. Moreover, if this function is locally constant, then $R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E}$ is locally free of rank $\dim H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$, and for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the linear map $(R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E})_b \rightarrow H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ defined by restriction of sections $s \mapsto s|_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ induces an isomorphism of vector spaces

$$\frac{(R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E})_b}{\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot (R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E})_b} \simeq H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b}). \quad (1.3.3)$$

To be more precise, note that $(R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E})_b$ is the direct limit of $H^q(\pi^{-1}(U), \mathcal{E})$ over all open $U \ni b$. Then the pull back $H^q(\pi^{-1}(U), \mathcal{E}) \rightarrow H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ induced by the inclusion $\mathcal{C}_b \hookrightarrow \pi^{-1}(U)$ provides the desired map $(R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E})_b \rightarrow H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$.

The above theorem is indeed true for any proper submersion of complex manifolds $\pi : X \rightarrow Y$, assuming that $\mathcal{E}$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. Even more generally, [Gra60] proves this theorem when X and Y are complex spaces, Y is reduced, $\mathcal{E}$ is coherent, and $\mathcal{E}$ is π -flat. The actual meanings of these three terms are not so important for understanding this monograph. Roughly speaking, complex spaces are generalizations of complex manifolds which may have singularities. If Y (together with an associated structure sheaf $\mathcal{O}_Y$) is a complex space, then $(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ looks locally like the solution space of finitely many holomorphic functions. (See [GR84] chapter 1.) The only non-smooth complex spaces that we will encounter in this monograph are nodal curves. Y is called reduced if any stalk $\mathcal{O}_y$ has no non-zero nilpotent elements. That $\mathcal{E}$ is π -flat means that for any $x \in X$, the natural action of $\mathcal{O}_{Y, \pi(x)}$ on $\mathcal{E}_x$ makes $\mathcal{E}_x$ a flat $\mathcal{O}_{Y, \pi(x)}$ -module. We refer the reader to [GPR94] section III.4.2 and the reference therein for the general form of the theorem and its proof. (See especially theorem 4.7 of that section.) A proof in English can be found in [BS76, Thm. III.4.12] as well as [EP96, Thm. 9.4.8].

As an immediate consequence of Theorem 1.3.1, for a family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ and a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module $\mathcal{E}$, we have $R^q\pi_*\mathcal{E} = 0$ when $q > 1$, since $\dim H^q(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ is constantly 0.

Relative tangent sheaves

In the remaining part of this section, we apply Theorem 1.3.1 to the families of tangent sheaves and their tensor products. Again, we fix a family of compact Riemann surfaces $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$.

The first obvious question is how the tangent bundles over all fibers can be assembled into a vector bundle on $\mathcal{C}$. Consider the tangent sheaves $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}$ and $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}$ of $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ respectively. Then we have a natural $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module homomorphism $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \pi^*\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}$ described as follows. Locally the map π looks like the projection $U \times V \rightarrow V$ where U is an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$ and V is an open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$. (So m is the dimension of $\mathcal{B}$.) Let z be the standard coordinate of U , and $\tau_1, \dots, \tau_m$ be the standard coordinates of V . Then $\partial_z, \partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_m}$ are sections in $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(U \times V)$, and $\partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_m}$ can also be regarded as sections in $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(V)$. We thus define the

$\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(U \times V)$ -module homomorphism $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(U \times V) \rightarrow \pi^*\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(U \times V)$ by sending $\partial_z, \partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_m}$ to $0, \pi^*\partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \pi^*\partial_{\tau_m}$ respectively. We write each $\pi^*\partial_{\tau_j}$ simply as ∂_{τ_j} . Then for any holomorphic functions $f, g_1, \dots, g_m$ on $U \times V$, we have

$$d\pi(f\partial_z + g_1\partial_{\tau_1} + \dots + g_m\partial_{\tau_m}) = g_1\partial_{\tau_1} + \dots + g_m\partial_{\tau_m}. \quad (1.3.4)$$

So $d\pi$ is the projection onto “horizontal components”. The map $d\pi$ is independent of local coordinates. Thus we have an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}} \xrightarrow{d\pi} \pi^*\Theta_{\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow 0, \quad (1.3.5)$$

where $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ is the kernel sheaf of $d\pi$, called the **relative tangent sheaf** of the family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$. One checks easily that if $\zeta, t_1, \dots, t_m$ are also local coordinates chosen in a similar way, then the two sections ∂_z and ∂_{ζ} of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ are related by $\partial_z = \frac{\partial \zeta}{\partial z} \partial_{\zeta}$. From this one sees that the restriction $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ of the relative tangent sheaf on each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is isomorphic to the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ -module $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}$. Therefore one can regard $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ as the sheaf of “vertical sections” of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}$, or the sheaf of vectors that are tangent to the fibers. Since $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ is a line bundle, we call its dual sheaf $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} := \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{-1}$ the **relative dualizing sheaf** of the family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$. The restriction of $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ to each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is therefore $\omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}$.

We next discuss families of divisors. A family of points can be represented by a section $\varsigma : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$, i.e., a holomorphic map such that $\pi \circ \varsigma = \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{B}}$. The image of ς is a hypersurface of $\mathcal{C}$. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module, let U be an open subset of $\mathcal{C}$, and choose $s \in \mathcal{E}(U - \varsigma(\mathcal{B}))$. We say that s has **removable singularity** at $\varsigma(\mathcal{B})$ if s can be extended to an element in $\mathcal{E}(U)$.

A **local coordinate** η of the family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ at ς is a holomorphic function on a neighborhood U of $\varsigma(\mathcal{B})$ such that for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, $\eta(\varsigma(b)) = 0$, and η restricts to a biholomorphic map from $U \cap \mathcal{C}_b$ to an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$. (The second condition is equivalent to saying that $\eta|_{U \cap \mathcal{C}_b}$ is injective, i.e. univalent.) Then (η, π) is a biholomorphic map from U to an open subset of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$. It is obvious that any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ is contained in a neighborhood $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ such that the subfamily $\pi : \pi^{-1}(V) \rightarrow V$ has a local coordinate at $\varsigma|_V$.

If $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ is a family of compact Riemann surfaces, we say that $(\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ is a **family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces**, if:

- (a) $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ are sections.
- (b) For any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and any $1 \leq i < j \leq N$, $\varsigma_i(b) \neq \varsigma_j(b)$.
- (c) For any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, each connected component of $\mathcal{C}_b$ contains $\varsigma_i(b)$ for some $1 \leq i \leq N$.

(The third condition is not essential. It is introduced only to simplify the statement of vanishing theorems in the future.) If, moreover, $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are local coordinates at $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N$ respectively, we say that

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$$

is a **family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates**. (In the case that $\mathcal{B}$ is a single point, $\mathfrak{X}$ is called an N -pointed compact Riemann surface with local coordinates, and is denoted by $(C; x_1, \dots, x_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$, where $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are respectively local coordinates at the distinct points $x_1, \dots, x_N$ on a compact Riemann surface C .)

Now, if we have $(\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$, each hypersurface $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ is also a divisor of $\mathcal{C}$. Set $D = \sum_{i=1}^N n_i \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ where each $n_1, \dots, n_N \in \mathbb{Z}$. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module. Then the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module $\mathcal{E}(D)$ can also be defined in a similar way as in the case of Riemann surfaces: For each open $U \subset \mathcal{C}$, $\mathcal{E}(D)(U)$ is the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(U)$ -module of all $s \in \mathcal{E}(U - \bigcup_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B}))$ such that for any $1 \leq i \leq N$, any open subset $V \subset U$, and any (holomorphic) submersion $\eta : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ vanishing at $V \cap \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$, $\eta^{n_i} s$ has removable singularity at $V \cap \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. When there are local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ at $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N$ respectively, this is equivalent to saying that $\eta_i^{n_i} s$ has removable singularity at $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ for any i . In particular we have defined $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$. We then have natural isomorphism $\mathcal{E}(D) \simeq \mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$. In the general case that $\mathcal{E}$ is not necessarily locally free, we define $\mathcal{E}(D)$ simply to be $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$. Notice that for any exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{E} \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0$, one also has exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(D) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(D) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(D) \rightarrow 0$. Indeed, the line bundle $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$ is locally equivalent to $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$, thus tensoring by $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$ preserves the exactness of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module homomorphisms (i.e. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$ is a flat $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module).

For a family $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces, we always define divisors $S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ of $\mathcal{C}$ and $S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)$ of $\mathcal{C}_b$ to be

$$S_{\mathfrak{X}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B}), \quad S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b) = \sum_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(b).$$

Proposition 1.3.2. *Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module. Then for any precompact open subset $V \subset \mathcal{B}$, there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $k \geq k_0$ and $b \in V$, we have $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{\mathcal{C}_b}) = 0$.*

Proof. We shall prove that each $b \in \mathcal{B}$ is contained in a neighborhood $U_b \subset \mathcal{B}$ such that one can find $k_b \in \mathbb{N}$ satisfying $H^1(\mathcal{C}_{\tilde{b}}, \mathcal{E}(k_b S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{\mathcal{C}_{\tilde{b}}}) = 0$ for any $\tilde{b} \in U_b$. Then by Remark 1.2.3, the same is true when k_b is replaced by any $k \geq k_b$. Therefore, the claim of this proposition follows since we can cover $\overline{V}$ by finitely many such neighborhoods.

Choose any $b \in \mathcal{B}$. Then, by Corollary 1.2.2, we can find $k_b \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}(k_b S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{\mathcal{C}_b}) = 0$. By the upper semi-continuity Theorem 1.3.1-(b), we can find a neighborhood U_b of b such that for each $\tilde{b} \in U_b$, $H^1(\mathcal{C}_{\tilde{b}}, \mathcal{E}(k_b S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{\mathcal{C}_{\tilde{b}}}) = 0$. $\square$

If $\mathcal{B}$ is connected, then by a result of Ehresmann, all fibers are diffeomorphic (cf. [Huy06] proposition 6.2.2). We have the following:

Theorem 1.3.3. *Suppose that $\mathcal{B}$ is connected, and g is the maximal genus of the connected components of each fiber of $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$. Then for any integers $n \geq -1$ and $k > (n +$*

1)(2g - 2), $\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module, and for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ there is a natural isomorphism of vector spaces

$$\frac{\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})_b}{\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})_b} \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \quad (1.3.6)$$

defined by restriction of sections. In particular, $\dim H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is constant over b .

When $n < -1$ and g is the minimal genus of the connected components of any fiber, the same result holds.

Proof. Note that the restriction of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ to each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is naturally equivalent to $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}$. Thus the restriction of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ to $\mathcal{C}_b$ is $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))$. Therefore, by Theorem 1.3.1-(a), $\chi(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is constant over b . By corollary 1.2.6, $\dim H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is always 0. So $\dim H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is constant over b . The remaining part of the theorem follows from Theorem 1.3.1-(b). $\square$

An important consequence of the above theorem is that any global section of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))$ on $\mathcal{C}_b$ can be extended to a *holomorphic* family of global sections over a neighborhood of $b \in \mathcal{B}$. More precisely, for any $s \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ there exists a neighborhood V of b and $\tilde{s} \in H^0(\pi^{-1}(V), \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ such that $\tilde{s}$ restricts to s on $\mathcal{C}_b$.

We will not use this theorem directly. However, $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}$ is closely related to sheaves of VOAs. (Cf. Proposition 2.5.4.) We will prove a similar theorem for sheaves of VOAs in the next chapter; see Theorem 2.5.6.

1.4 Strong residue theorem

Suppose that $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ is an N -pointed compact Riemann surface, and $\mathcal{E}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module. By our notation in the last section, $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. Set

$$\mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) = \varinjlim_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathcal{E}(nS_{\mathfrak{X}}). \quad (1.4.1)$$

Then $\mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is the sheaf of meromorphic sections of $\mathcal{E}$ whose only possible poles are $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Let $E_i = \mathcal{E}|_{x_i}$ be the fiber of $\mathcal{E}$ at x_i . In a neighborhood U_i of x_i , $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}$ has a trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{U_i} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i$, and $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}^*$ has the corresponding dual trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}^* \simeq \mathcal{O}_{U_i} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i^*$. Choose any $s \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$. Then at any x_i the section s has formal Laurent series expansion

$$s_i = \sum_n e_{i,n} \eta_i^n \in E_i((\eta_i)),$$

where $e_{i,n} \in \mathcal{E}|_{x_i}$ equals 0 when n is sufficiently small. (Its meaning is obvious when we regard $\mathcal{E}$ as a vector bundle.) Suppose now that $\sigma \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes_{\omega_C} (\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$. Let

$$\sigma_i \in E_i^*((\eta_i)) d\eta_i$$

be similarly the formal Laurent series expansion of σ at x_i (with respect to the variable η_i). Then $\langle s, \sigma \rangle \in H^0(C, \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ and $\langle s_i, \sigma_i \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\eta_i)) d\eta_i$. Thus, by residue theorem,

$$\sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \langle s_i, \sigma_i \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N \oint_{x_i} \langle s, \sigma \rangle = 0. \quad (1.4.2)$$

The strong residue theorem ([FB04] section 9.2.9) says that if $s_1 \in E_1((\eta_1)), \dots, s_N \in E_N((\eta_N))$ satisfy (1.4.2) for any $\sigma \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes_{\omega_C} (\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$, then $s_1, \dots, s_N$ are series expansions of an $s \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ at $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively. In particular, each $s_i = \sum_n e_{i,n} \eta_i^n$ converges absolutely when $\eta_i \in U_i$. A proof of this theorem can be found in [Ueno08] theorem 1.22. In the following, we prove a strong residue theorem to families of compact Riemann surfaces.

Strong residue theorem for families of compact Riemann surfaces

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ be a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates, and let $\mathcal{E}$ be a (holomorphic) vector bundle on $\mathfrak{X}$. We assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is small enough such that for each i , $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ is contained in a neighborhood U_i such that $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}$ has trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{U_i} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i$, where E_i is a finite dimensional complex vector space. The result for this subsection is local with respect to $\mathcal{B}$. So the reader can regard $\mathcal{B}$ as an open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$ for convenience.

By shrinking U_i , we assume that η_i is defined on U_i , and $U_i \cap U_j = \emptyset$ when $i \neq j$. Fix trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}^* \simeq \mathcal{O}_{U_i} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i^*$ to be dual to $\mathcal{E}_{U_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{U_i} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i$. Identify U_i with an open subset of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ (containing $0 \times \mathcal{B}$) via the embedding $(\eta_i, \pi) : U_i \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$, and identify $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}$ and $\mathcal{E}_{U_i}^*$ with their respective trivializations. Then η_i is identified with the standard coordinate z of $\mathbb{C}$.

For each i we choose

$$s_i = \sum_n e_{i,n} \cdot z^n \in (\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i)((z)). \quad (1.4.3)$$

So $e_{i,n} = 0$ when n is sufficiently small, and each $e_{i,n} \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} E_i$ can be viewed as an E_i -valued holomorphic function on $\mathcal{B}$. For each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, set

$$s_i(b) = \sum_n e_{i,n}(b) z^n \in E_i((z)). \quad (1.4.4)$$

Define $\mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ again using (1.4.1). Now suppose that s is a section of $\mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ defined on an open set containing U_i . Then $s|_{U_i} = s|_{U_i}(z, b)$ is an E_i -valued meromorphic function on U_i with poles at $z = 0$. We say that s **has series expansion** s_i **near** $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ if for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the meromorphic function $s|_{U_i}(z, b)$ of z has series expansion (1.4.4) near $z = 0$.

For any given $b \in \mathcal{B}$, choose $\sigma_b \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$. Then in $U_{i,b} := U_i \cap \pi^{-1}(b)$, σ_b can be regarded as an $E_i^* \otimes dz$ -valued meromorphic function with pole at $z = 0$. So it has series expansion at $z = 0$:

$$\sigma_b|_{U_{i,b}}(z) = \sum_n \phi_{i,n} z^n dz \in E_i^*((z))dz \quad (1.4.5)$$

where $\phi_{i,n} \in E_i^*$. We define the residue pairing $\text{Res}_i \langle s_i, \sigma_b \rangle \in \mathbb{C}$ to be

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Res}_i \langle s_i, \sigma_b \rangle &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \langle s_i(b), \sigma_b|_{U_{i,b}}(z) \rangle \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \left(\left\langle \sum_n e_{i,n}(b) z^n, \sum_n \phi_{i,n} z^n \right\rangle dz \right). \end{aligned} \quad (1.4.6)$$

Theorem 1.4.1. *For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, choose s_i as in (1.4.3). Then the following statements are equivalent.*

(a) *There exists $s \in H^0(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ whose series expansion near $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ (for each $1 \leq i \leq N$) is s_i .*

(b) *For any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and any $\sigma_b \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$,*

$$\sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_i \langle s_i, \sigma_b \rangle = 0. \quad (1.4.7)$$

Moreover, when these statements hold, there is only one $s \in H^0(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ satisfying (a).

Proof. That (a) implies (b) follows from Residue theorem. If s satisfies (a), then for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, $s|_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ is uniquely determined by its series expansions near $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$ (since each component of $\mathcal{C}_b$ contains some $\varsigma_i(b)$ by the definition of families of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces). Therefore the sections satisfying (a) is unique.

Now assume (b) is true. Suppose we can prove that any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ is contained in a neighborhood V such that there exists a unique section s of $\mathcal{E}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ on $\pi^{-1}(V)$ whose series expansion near each $\varsigma_i(V)$ is the restriction of s_i to V . Then (a) clearly follows. Thus, by replacing $\mathcal{B}$ with an arbitrary precompact open subset and applying Proposition 1.3.2, we can assume that there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and any $k \geq k_0$,

$$H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(k S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) = 0.$$

Choose $p \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, the $e_{i,n}$ in (1.4.3) equals 0 when $n < -p$. For any $k \geq k_0$, the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}})/\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow 0$$

induces a long exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \pi_* \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \pi_* (\mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}})/\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \xrightarrow{\delta} R^1 \pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}). \quad (1.4.8)$$

By Serre duality, $\dim H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, (\mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) = \dim H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) = 0$ for any b . Note also that $(\mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))$ is the restriction of $\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ to $\mathcal{C}_b$. Therefore $\pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) = 0$ by Theorem 1.3.1-(b).

For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, set $s_i|_k = \sum_{n < k} e_{i,n} \cdot z^n$, which can be regarded as a section in $\mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}})(U_i)$ via the identification $\eta_i = z$. Let $U_0 = \mathcal{C} - \varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}) \cup \dots \cup \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$. Then $\mathfrak{U} = \{U_0, U_1, \dots, U_N\}$ is an open cover of $\mathcal{C}$. Define Čech 0-cocycle $\psi = (\psi_i)_{0 \leq i \leq N} \in Z^0(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}})/\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ by setting $\psi_0 = 0$ and $\psi_i = s_i|_k$ ($1 \leq i \leq N$). Then $\delta\psi = ((\delta\psi)_{i,j})_{0 \leq i,j \leq N} \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ is described as follows: $(\delta\psi)_{0,0} = 0$; if $i, j > 0$ then $(\delta\psi)_{i,j}$ is not defined since $U_i \cap U_j = \emptyset$; if $1 \leq i \leq N$ then $(\delta\psi)_{i,0} = -(\delta\psi)_{0,i}$ equals $s_i|_k$ (considered as a section in $\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})(U_i \cap U_0) \simeq \mathcal{E}(U_i - \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B}))$).

Consider $\delta\psi$ as an element in $R^1 \pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ whose restriction to $\mathcal{C}_b$ is denoted by $\delta\psi|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \in H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$. Then the residue pairing for the Serre duality

$$H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))^*$$

(see Section 1.2), applied to $\delta\psi|_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ and any $\sigma_b \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{E}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$, is given by

$$\langle \delta\psi|_{\mathcal{C}_b}, \sigma_b \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_i \langle s_i|_k, \sigma_b \rangle.$$

Since for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, $\langle s_i - s_i|_k, \sigma_b \rangle$ has removable singularity at $z = 0$, we have $\text{Res}_i \langle s_i - s_i|_k, \sigma_b \rangle = 0$. Therefore,

$$\langle \delta\psi|_{\mathcal{C}_b}, \sigma_b \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_i \langle s_i, \sigma_b \rangle = 0.$$

Thus $\delta\psi|_{\mathcal{C}_b} = 0$ for any b . By Theorem 1.3.1-(a), $\dim H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, (\mathcal{E}|_{\mathcal{C}_b})(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is locally constant over $b \in \mathcal{B}$. So by Theorem 1.3.1-(b), $\delta\psi$ is constantly 0 in each fiber of the locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module $R^1 \pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$. This proves that $\delta\psi = 0$.

By (1.4.8) and that $\pi_* \mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) = 0$, for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ there exist an open $V_b \subset \mathcal{B}$ containing b and a unique $s|_k \in (\pi_* \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V_b) = H^0(\pi^{-1}(V_b), \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ which is sent to $\psi \in \pi_* (\mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}})/\mathcal{E}(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V_b)$. So near $\varsigma_i(V_b)$, $s|_k$ has series expansion

$$s|_k = s_i|_k + \bullet z^k + \bullet z^{k+1} + \dots \quad (1.4.9)$$

By such uniqueness, these locally chosen $s|_k$ (over all V_p) are compatible with each other, which produce a global $s|_k \in H^0(\pi^{-1}(\mathcal{B}), \mathcal{E}(pS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ which has series expansion (1.4.9) near $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. Note that this result holds for any $k \geq k_0$. So we have $s|_{k_0} = s|_{k_0+1} = s|_{k_0+2} = \dots$, again by the uniqueness. Let $s = s|_{k_0}$. Then s has series expansion s_i near $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ for each i . $\square$

1.5 Nodal curves

The structure sheaf $\mathcal{O}_C$, and the invertible sheaves Θ_C and ω_C

Choose $M \in \mathbb{N}$, and let $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; y'_1, \dots, y'_M; y''_1, \dots, y''_M)$ be a $2M$ -pointed compact Riemann surface. (Here we do not require that each component of $\tilde{C}$ contains a point. In particular, M could be 0.) One can define a (possibly singular) **complex curve** C in the following way. As a topological space, C is the quotient space of $\tilde{C}$ defined by the identification $y'_1 = y''_1, \dots, y'_M = y''_M$. The quotient map is denoted by $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$. The points $x'_1 = \nu(y'_1), \dots, x'_M = \nu(y'_M)$ in $\tilde{C}$ are called **nodes**, and $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ (or just $\tilde{C}$) is called the **normalization** of C . To define the structure sheaf $\mathcal{O}_C$, we choose any open $U \subset C$. Then $\mathcal{O}(U) \equiv \mathcal{O}_C(U)$ is the set of all $f \in \mathcal{O}_{\tilde{C}}(\nu^{-1}(U))$ such that $f(y'_j) = f(y''_j)$ whenever $x'_j \in U$. When $M = 0$, C is just a compact Riemann surface. If $M > 0$, we say that C is a **nodal curve**.

We now describe locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -modules in terms of vector bundles. Suppose that $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}$ is a (holomorphic) vector bundle on $\tilde{C}$. For any $j = 1, \dots, M$, we fix an identification of fibers $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y'_j} \simeq \tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y''_j}$. Then the sheaf $\mathcal{E}$ is defined such that for any open $U \subset C$, $\mathcal{E}(U)$ is the set of all $s \in \tilde{\mathcal{E}}(\nu^{-1}(U))$ satisfying $s(y'_j) = s(y''_j)$. Then $\mathcal{E}$ is obviously an $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module, which is easily seen to be locally free. ($\mathcal{E}$ is indeed equivalent to the pull back of $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}$.) Conversely, it is not hard to show that any locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{E}$ arises in such a way.

Next we define an **invertible** $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module Θ_C (i.e., a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module with rank 1). Its dual sheaf $\omega_C := \Theta_C^{-1}$ will be called the **dualizing sheaf of C** . For any $1 \leq j \leq M$ we choose local coordinates ξ_j, ϖ_j of y'_j, y''_j respectively. If an open subset $U \subset C$ contains no $x'_1, \dots, x'_M$, then $\Theta_C(U)$ is defined to be $\Theta_{\tilde{C}}(\nu^{-1}(U))$. If U is neighborhood of some x'_j such that $\nu^{-1}(U)$ is a disjoint union of neighborhoods $V'_j \ni y'_j$ and $V''_j \ni y''_j$, and that ξ_j and ϖ_j are defined on V'_j, V''_j respectively, then $\Theta_C(U)$ is the $\mathcal{O}_C(U)$ -submodule of $\Theta_{\tilde{C}}(V'_j \cup V''_j)$ generated by

$$\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j} - \varpi_j \partial_{\varpi_j}. \quad (1.5.1)$$

To be more precise, $\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j} - \varpi_j \partial_{\varpi_j}$ is the section in $\Theta_{\tilde{C}}(V'_j \cup V''_j)$ whose restrictions to V'_j and V''_j are $\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j}$ and $-\varpi_j \partial_{\varpi_j}$ respectively. One checks easily that $\Theta_C(U)$ is a free $\mathcal{O}_C(U)$ -module. Such definition is independent of the choice of local coordinates. For a general U , $\Theta_C(U)$ is defined by gluing as described in Section 1.2.

Alternatively, consider the line bundle on $\tilde{C}$ defined by

$$\tilde{\Theta}_C = \Theta_{\tilde{C}} \left(- \sum_{j=1}^M (y'_j + y''_j) \right), \quad (1.5.2)$$

which will be the pull back of Θ_C . For any $1 \leq j \leq M$, we need to choose identification of the lines (one dimensional fibers) $\tilde{\Theta}_C|_{y'_j} \simeq \tilde{\Theta}_C|_{y''_j}$. For this purpose we choose a local coordinate ξ_j of y'_j . Note that the restriction $\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j}|_{y'_j}$ of $\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j}$ to y'_j , which is an element of the fiber $\tilde{\Theta}_C|_{y'_j} \simeq \Theta_{\tilde{C}}(-y'_j)|_{y'_j}$, is independent of the choice of the local coordinate. Choose similarly a local coordinate ϖ_j of y''_j . Then the identification $\tilde{\Theta}_C|_{y'_j} \simeq \tilde{\Theta}_C|_{y''_j}$ is defined by

$$\xi_j \partial_{\xi_j}|_{y'_j} = -\varpi_j \partial_{\varpi_j}|_{y''_j}. \quad (1.5.3)$$

One can then define Θ_C using $\tilde{\Theta}_C$ and the chosen identification. For the dualizing sheaf ω_C , its pull back $\tilde{\omega}_C$ is

$$\tilde{\omega}_C = \omega_{\tilde{C}} \left(\sum_{j=1}^M (y'_j + y''_j) \right), \quad (1.5.4)$$

and the identification $\tilde{\omega}_C|_{y'_j} \simeq \tilde{\omega}_C|_{y''_j}$ is given by

$$\frac{d\xi_j}{\xi_j}|_{y'_j} = -\frac{d\varpi_j}{\varpi_j}|_{y''_j}. \quad (1.5.5)$$

Vanishing of higher order cohomology groups

We shall generalize some results for compact Riemann surfaces to the nodal curve C . Our first result is that $H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ for any $q > 1$ and any locally free $\mathcal{E}$. Again, we let $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; y'_1, \dots, y'_M; y''_1, \dots, y''_M)$ be the normalization of C . So $x'_1 = \nu(y'_1), \dots, x'_M = \nu(y'_M)$ are the nodes. For each $1 \leq j \leq M$, we choose a neighborhood $U_j \subset C$ of x'_j such that $\nu^{-1}(U_j)$ is the disjoint union of neighborhoods $V'_j \ni y'_j$ and $V''_j \ni y''_j$, and that the complex manifolds with marked points (V'_j, y'_j) and (V''_j, y''_j) are biholomorphic to the open unit disc $\mathcal{D}_1 = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z| < 1\}$ with marked point 0. Then U_j (as a complex space) is biholomorphic to the complex subspace of $\mathcal{D}_1 \times \mathcal{D}_1$ defined by $\{(z, w) \in \mathcal{D}_1 \times \mathcal{D}_1 : zw = 0\}$.

The complex manifold $\mathcal{D}_1 \times \mathcal{D}_1$ belongs to a very important class of complex spaces, called **Stein spaces**, which satisfy Cartan's theorems A and (equivalently) B. If X is a Stein space and $\mathcal{F}$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module (in particular, if $\mathcal{F}$ is locally free), then **Theorem B** says that $H^q(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ when $q > 0$, and **Theorem A** says that the global sections of $\mathcal{F}$ generate every stalk $\mathcal{F}_x$ as an $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ -module. All non-compact connected Riemann surfaces are Stein spaces. A product of two

Stein spaces is a Stein space. Closed complex subspaces of Stein spaces are Stein spaces. A finite intersection of Stein open subsets is Stein. References of these results can be found in [GR84] section 1.4 or [GPR94] section III.3.

As U_j ($1 \leq j \leq M$) is biholomorphic to a (singular) hypersurface of $\mathcal{D}_1 \times \mathcal{D}_1$, U_j is a Stein space. Set $U_0 = C - \{x'_1, \dots, x'_M\}$. Then $\mathfrak{U} = \{U_j : 0 \leq j \leq M\}$ is an open cover of C .

Theorem 1.5.1. *Let $\mathcal{E}$ be locally free. Then $H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ for any $q > 1$.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that C is connected. We know $H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ when C is smooth (i.e., a compact Riemann surface). Thus it suffices to assume that C contains at least one node. Then each connected component of U_0 is not compact. The same is true for $U_0 \cap U_j$ for any $1 \leq j \leq M$. We assume that $U_1, \dots, U_M$ are small enough so that they are mutually disjoint. Then for any $0 \leq i, j \leq M$, U_j and $U_i \cap U_j$ are Stein spaces, thus $H^p(U_i) = H^p(U_i \cap U_j) = 0$ for any $p > 0$. Notice that the intersection of any three distinct open sets in $\mathfrak{U}$ is $\emptyset$. Thus $H^p(U_{i_1} \cap \dots \cap U_{i_n}, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ for any $1 \leq i_1, \dots, i_n \leq M$ and $p > 0$. Therefore, by Leray's theorem, $H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = H^q(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E})$. When $q \geq 2$, $U_{i_1} \cap U_{i_2} \cap \dots \cap U_{i_{q+1}} = \emptyset$ for any $0 \leq i_1 < i_2 < \dots < i_{q+1} \leq M$. Thus any Čech q -cocycle is zero, which shows $Z^q(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ and hence $H^q(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E}) = 0$. $\square$

Serre duality

Serre duality holds for the nodal curve C ; see [ACG11] section 10.2. In the following, we present a proof using the Serre duality for compact Riemann surfaces. The pairing for duality is also constructed in the proof. Let us first introduce the following notation. Let $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; y_1, \dots, y_N; y'_1, \dots, y'_M; y''_1, \dots, y''_M)$ be $(N + 2M)$ -pointed. We assume each component of $\tilde{C}$ contains y_i for some $1 \leq i \leq N$. Then the quotient map $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$ identifying $y'_1, \dots, y'_M$ with $y''_1, \dots, y''_M$ respectively defines an N -**pointed complex curve** $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$, where $x_1 = \nu(y_1), \dots, x_N = \nu(y_N)$ are the marked points of C , and $x'_1 = \nu(y'_1), \dots, x'_M = \nu(y'_M)$ are the nodes. Again, we call $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ the normalization of $\mathfrak{X}$. Set $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_N$ to be a divisor either of C or of $\tilde{C}$.

Theorem 1.5.2 (Serre duality). *For the nodal curve C and a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{E}$, the relation (1.2.1) holds.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that C is connected. We shall prove (1.2.1) for $p = 1$, i.e.,

$$H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \simeq H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)^*.$$

Then, by replacing $\mathcal{E}$ with $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{O}_C$, we obtain the relation for $p = 0$. For simplicity, we assume $M = 1$ and write $y'_1 = y_{-1}, y''_1 = y_{-2}, x'_1 = x_{-1}$. Thus $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$

is a nodal curve with node x_{-1} , and it is obtained from the smooth curve $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; y_1, \dots, y_N; y_{-1}; y_{-2})$ by gluing y_{-1} and y_{-2} . We identify $C - \{x_{-1}\}$ with $\tilde{C} - \{y_{-1}, y_{-2}\}$ in a natural way. So $x_1 = y_1, \dots, x_N = y_N$. Choose mutually disjoint Stein neighborhoods $U_1, \dots, U_N$ of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively disjoint from x_{-1} (and hence from y_{-1}, y_{-2}). Choose open discs $V_{-1} \ni y_{-1}, V_{-2} \ni y_{-2}$ in $\tilde{C}$ and disjoint from $U_1, \dots, U_N$. Then $U_{-1} := \nu(V_{-1} \cup V_{-2})$ is obtained from V_{-1} and V_{-2} by gluing y_{-1}, y_{-2} . U_{-1} is also a Stein space. Set $U_0 = C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N, x_{-1}\}$, which has no compact connected component and is hence a Stein space. It follows that $\mathfrak{U} := \{U_{-1}, U_0, U_1, \dots, U_N\}$ is a Stein cover of C . Hence, by Leray's theorem, we have $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \simeq H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Set $V_0 = U_0, V_1 = U_1, \dots, V_N = U_N$. Then $\mathfrak{V} := \{V_{-1}, V_{-2}, V_0, V_1, \dots, V_N\}$ is a Stein cover of $\tilde{C}$.

Define a linear map

$$\Psi : Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)^* \quad (1.5.6)$$

as follows. Choose any Čech 1-cochain $s = (s_{m,n})_{m,n=-1,0,1,\dots,N} \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Then all the components of s , except possibly $s_{n,0}$ and $s_{0,n}$ (where $-1 \leq n \leq N$), are zero. We set $\sigma_n = s_{n,0} = -s_{0,n}$ for $-1 \leq n \leq N$ (in particular, $\sigma_0 = 0$), and let $\sigma_{-2} = \sigma_{-1}$. For each $-2 \leq n \leq N$, we choose an anticlockwise circle γ_n in $V_n - \{y_n\}$ surrounding y_n . The anticlockwise-ness is understood under local coordinates of $\tilde{C}$ at y_n . Then $\Psi(s)$ is defined such that for any $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$, the evaluation of $\Psi(s)$ with t is

$$\langle s, t \rangle = \sum_{n=-2}^N \oint_{\gamma_n} \langle \sigma_n, t \rangle. \quad (1.5.7)$$

The proof will be completed if we can show that Ψ is surjective with kernel $B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. We divide the proof into several steps.

Step 1. We first show that Ψ is surjective. Let $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. Then for sufficiently large k , we have $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0$. (See the proof of Proposition 1.5.4.) Therefore, from the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*) \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{G})$$

where $\mathcal{G} = \mathcal{E}^*/\mathcal{E}^*(-kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$, we see that $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$ is naturally a subspace of $H^0(C, \mathcal{G})$. For each $1 \leq n \leq N$, choose a trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_n} \simeq E_n \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_n}$ which yields the dual trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{U_n}^* \simeq E_n^* \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_n}$. Let η_n be a coordinate of U_n satisfying $\eta_n(x_n) = 0$. Then we have a natural equivalence $H^0(C, \mathcal{G}) \simeq \bigoplus_n E_n^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^k$ such that each $(v_n^0, \dots, v_n^{k-1})_{1 \leq n \leq N} \in \bigoplus_n E_n^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^k$ corresponds to the section of $\mathcal{G}$ whose restriction to each U_n is $\sum_{0 \leq l \leq k-1} v_n^l \eta_n^l$, and whose restriction to $C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N\}$ is 0. Choose any $\psi \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)^*$ and extend it to a linear functional on $H^0(C, \mathcal{G})$. Then, for each n , one can choose $\alpha_n^0, \dots, \alpha_n^{k-1} \in E_n$ such that the evaluation of ψ with any $(v_n^0, \dots, v_n^{k-1})_{1 \leq n \leq N}$ is $\sum_{1 \leq n \leq N} \sum_{0 \leq l \leq k-1} \alpha_n^l (v_n^l)$.

Choose $s = (s_{m,n})_{m,n=-1,0,1,\dots,N} \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ whose only possibly non-zero components are $s_{n,0} = -s_{0,n} = \sum_{0 \leq l \leq k-1} \alpha_n^l \eta_i^{-l-1} d\eta_i$ (where $1 \leq n \leq N$). One checks easily that $\Psi(s) = \psi$.

Step 2. To finish the proof, we need to show that $\text{Ker}(\Psi) = B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Note that $\mathcal{E}$ can be obtained from a vector bundle $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}$ on C by identifying the fibers $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y_{-1}}$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y_{-2}}$ via an isomorphism. Under this viewpoint, $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$ is naturally a subspace of $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)$ consisting of global sections whose values at y_{-1} and at y_{-2} agree. In particular, this is true when the two values are 0. We thus have

$$H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*(-y_{-1} - y_{-2})) \subset H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*) \subset H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*).$$

Therefore, $\text{Ker}(\Psi)$ vanishes when evaluating on $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*(-y_{-1} - y_{-2}))$. Also, since $U_m \cap U_n$ does not contain the node x_{-1} whenever $m \neq n$, we have natural identifications

$$Z^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})) = Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) = Z^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}).$$

It is easy to see that the pairing of the smooth Serre duality

$$H^1(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})) \simeq H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*(-y_{-1} - y_{-2}))^* \quad (1.5.8)$$

is compatible with the one of (1.5.6) defined by (1.5.7). Thus, if we regard any $s \in \text{Ker}(\Psi)$ as an element of $Z^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}))$, then it becomes zero in $H^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}))$. Therefore,

$$\text{Ker}(\Psi) \subset B^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})).$$

Choose any

$$\varsigma \in B^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})).$$

We shall show that $\varsigma \in B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ if and only if $\varsigma \in \text{Ker}(\Psi)$. This will finish the proof.

Step 2-(a). Choose

$$\sigma \in C^0(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}))$$

(i.e., $\sigma = (\sigma_n)_{-2 \leq n \leq N}$ is a 0-cochain of $\tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})$ over the cover $\mathfrak{V}$) such that

$$\varsigma = \delta(\sigma).$$

Since ς can be regarded as an element of $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$, we can calculate the pairing $\langle \varsigma, t \rangle$ defined by (1.5.7) for any

$$t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*).$$

Write $\varsigma = (\varsigma_{m,n})_{-2 \leq m, n \leq N}$. The only possibly non-zero components of ς are $\varsigma_{n,0} = -\varsigma_{0,n}$ where $-2 \leq n \leq N$ and $n \neq 0$. It is clear that $\varsigma_{n,0} = (\sigma_n - \sigma_0)|_{U_n \cap U_0}$ for any such n . Then

$$\langle \varsigma, t \rangle = \sum_{n=-2}^N \oint_{\gamma_n} \langle \sigma_n - \sigma_0, t \rangle.$$

By residue theorem (or Stokes theorem), we have $\sum_{n=-2}^N \oint_{\gamma_n} \langle \sigma_0, t \rangle = 0$. Moreover, when $n \geq 1$, since σ_n can be defined as a section of $\mathcal{E}$ on U_n , $\langle \sigma_n, t \rangle$ is a holomorphic function on U_n . So $\langle \sigma_n, t \rangle = 0$. We thus have

$$\langle \varsigma, t \rangle = \oint_{\gamma_{-1}} \langle \sigma_{-1}, t \rangle + \oint_{\gamma_{-2}} \langle \sigma_{-2}, t \rangle.$$

We set $E = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y_{-1}} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}|_{y_{-2}}$. Then its dual space is $E^* = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*|_{y_{-1}} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*|_{y_{-2}}$. We choose trivialization $\mathcal{E}_{V_n} \simeq E \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{V_n}$ which yields the dual one $\mathcal{E}_{V_n}^* \simeq E^* \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{V_n}$ for $n = -1, -2$. Let ξ (resp. ϖ) be a coordinate of V_{-1} (resp. V_{-2}) satisfying $\xi(y_{-1}) = 0$ (resp. $\varpi(y_{-2}) = 0$). Since $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$, t can be viewed as an element of $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)$ such that $t(y_{-1}) = t(y_{-2})$ (which are elements of E^*). Set

$$e_1 = \oint_{\gamma_{-1}} \sigma_{-1}, \quad e_2 = - \oint_{\gamma_{-2}} \sigma_{-2}$$

(which are vectors in E), i.e.

$$\sigma_{-1} = e_1 d\xi/\xi + \sum_{l \geq 0} \bullet \xi^l d\xi, \quad \sigma_{-2} = -e_2 d\varpi/\varpi + \sum_{l \geq 0} \bullet \varpi^l d\varpi \quad (1.5.9)$$

We thus have

$$\langle \varsigma, t \rangle = \langle e_1 - e_2, t(y_{-2}) \rangle. \quad (1.5.10)$$

By (1.5.5), we have $\sigma \in C^0(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ (i.e., σ is a 0-cochain of $\mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C$) if and only if $e_1 - e_2 = 0$. If $\varsigma \in B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$, then one can choose σ (which satisfies $\varsigma = \delta(\sigma)$) to be an element of $C^0(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$, which implies $e_1 - e_2 = 0$ and hence $\langle \varsigma, t \rangle = 0$ for any $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$. So $\varsigma \in \text{Ker}(\Psi)$.

Step 2-(b). We now prove the other direction. Assume $\varsigma \in \text{Ker}(\Psi)$. We shall show that $\varsigma \in B^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Note that (1.5.10) is zero for each $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$. Consider the short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{C}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}) \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow 0$$

where $\mathcal{F} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}) / \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}$. Then we have an exact sequence

$$H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2})) \rightarrow H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{F}) \xrightarrow{\delta} H^1(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}).$$

For any $e_0 \in E$, we choose $\varepsilon \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{F})$ (which clearly depends on e_0) such that

$$\varepsilon|_{V_{-1}} = e_0 d\xi/\xi, \quad \varepsilon|_{V_{-2}} = (-e_0 + e_2 - e_1) d\varpi/\varpi, \quad \varepsilon|_{\tilde{C} - \{y_{-1}, y_{-2}\}} = 0.$$

We claim that there exists e_0 such that $\delta(\varepsilon) = 0$. Suppose this has been proved. Then there exists $\lambda \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}))$ which is sent to ε . We treat $\lambda = (\lambda_n)_{-2 \leq n \leq N}$ as an element of $Z^0(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(y_{-1} + y_{-2}))$. Then

$$\lambda_{-1} = e_0 d\xi/\xi + \sum_{l \geq 0} \bullet \xi^l d\xi, \quad \lambda_{-2} = (-e_0 + e_2 - e_1) d\varpi/\varpi + \sum_{l \geq 0} \bullet \varpi^l d\varpi.$$

If we compare this relation with (1.5.9), we see that $(\sigma + \lambda)_{-1} = (e_1 + e_0) d\xi/\xi + \dots$ and $(\sigma + \lambda)_{-2} = -(e_1 + e_0) d\varpi/\varpi + \dots$. Thus $\sigma + \lambda$ can be viewed as an element of $C^0(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Since $\delta(\lambda) = 0$, we have $\delta(\sigma + \lambda) = \delta(\sigma) = \varsigma$, which finishes the proof.

Let us prove the existence of e_0 such that $\delta(\varepsilon) = 0$. Notice that $H^1(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}) = H^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}})$, and $\delta(\varepsilon)$ can be represented by an element $(\delta(\varepsilon)_{m,n})_{-2 \leq m, n \leq N}$ in $Z^1(\mathfrak{V}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}})$ whose only non-zero components are $\delta(\varepsilon)_{-1,0} = -\delta(\varepsilon)_{0,-1} = e_0 d\xi/\xi$ and $\delta(\varepsilon)_{-2,0} = -\delta(\varepsilon)_{0,-2} = (-e_0 + e_2 - e_1) d\varpi/\varpi$. Notice the smooth Serre duality

$$H^1(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}) \simeq H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)^*$$

defined by residue pairing. If we regard $\delta(\varepsilon)$ as a linear functional on $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)$, then its evaluation with any $\tau \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)$ is

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \delta(\varepsilon), \tau \rangle &= \langle e_0, \tau(y_{-1}) \rangle + \langle -e_0 + e_2 - e_1, \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle \\ &= \langle e_0, \tau(y_{-1}) - \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle - \langle e_1 - e_2, \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Then $\delta(\varepsilon) = 0$ will follow if we can find $e_0 \in E$ satisfying

$$\langle e_0, \tau(y_{-1}) - \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle = \langle e_1 - e_2, \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle$$

for any $\tau \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)$. Indeed, one first defines e_0 as a linear functional on $T := \{\tau(y_{-1}) - \tau(y_{-2}) : \tau \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}^*)\}$ using the above relation. Then e_0 is well defined: if $\tau(y_{-1}) - \tau(y_{-2}) = 0$, then $\tau \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)$; since we assume $\varsigma \in \text{Ker}(\Psi)$, according to (1.5.10), we have $\langle e_2 - e_1, \tau(y_{-2}) \rangle = 0$. Now, as T is a subspace of E^* , we can extend e_0 to a linear functional on E^* . Then e_0 is in E and satisfies the desired relation. $\square$

Corollary 1.5.3. *If $\mathcal{E}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module, then $\dim H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) < +\infty$ for any $q \in \mathbb{N}$.*

Thus one can define the character $\chi(C, \mathcal{E})$ using (1.2.5).

Proof. We have proved that $H^q(C, \mathcal{E}) = 0$ when $q > 1$. Let $\tilde{\mathcal{E}} = \nu^* \mathcal{E}$ where $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$ is the normalization. Since $H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$ is naturally a subspace of $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}})$ where the latter is finite dimensional, so is $H^0(C, \mathcal{E})$. Similarly, $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^* \otimes \omega_C)$ is finite dimensional. So is $H^1(C, \mathcal{E})$ by Serre duality. $\square$

Vanishing theorems

Proposition 1.5.4. *Assume that each connected component of $\tilde{C}$ (equivalently, each irreducible component of C) contains one of $x_1, \dots, x_N$, and set $D = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. Then Proposition 1.2.1 and Corollary 1.2.2 hold verbatim.*

Proof. The pull back of $\mathcal{E}$ along the normalization $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$ is denoted by $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}$. We know that $\mathcal{E}$ can be obtained by gluing the fibers of $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}$ at the double points. So $H^0(C, \mathcal{E}(-nD))$ is naturally a subspace of $H^0(\tilde{C}, \tilde{\mathcal{E}}(-nD))$ (consisting of sections whose values at y'_j and at y''_j agree), which vanishes when n is sufficiently large. This proves Proposition 1.2.1. Corollary 1.2.2 follows as in the smooth case by Serre duality. $\square$

As an application of Prop. 1.5.4, we now give a better description of the pairing in Serre duality. Let $x_1, \dots, x_N$ be distinct smooth points on C as in the proof of Serre duality Thm. 1.5.2. (Namely, each connected component of the normalization $\tilde{C}$ of C contains at least one element of the preimage of $x_1, \dots, x_N$.) We choose $U_0^+ = C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N\}$ and $U_1, \dots, U_N$ mutually disjoint disks around $x_1, \dots, x_N$ that do not intersect the nodes. Choose an anticlockwise circle $\gamma_i \subset U_i$ around x_i .

Theorem 1.5.5. *Let $\mathfrak{U}^+ = \{U_0^+, U_1, \dots, U_N\}$. Then $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) = H^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$. Moreover, Serre duality*

$$H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \simeq H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)^* \quad (1.5.11)$$

holds, and the isomorphism is realized by

$$\Phi : Z^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^*)^* \quad (1.5.12)$$

such that for each $s = (s_{m,n})_{m,n=0,1,\dots,N} \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ and $t \in H^0(C, \mathcal{E}^)$, by setting $\sigma_n = s_{n,0} = -s_{0,n}$, we have*

$$\langle s, t \rangle = \sum_{n=1}^N \oint_{\gamma_n} \langle \sigma_n, t \rangle. \quad (1.5.13)$$

Proof. This theorem follows directly from the fact that U_0^+ is indeed Stein, and hence that $\mathfrak{U}^+$ is a Stein cover. (A quick argument is to embed C as a closed complex subspace of $\mathbb{P}^n$ for some n and show that U_0^+ is the intersection of C and the complement of a hyperplane in $\mathbb{P}^n$.) But here we give a different argument which avoids showing that U_0^+ is Stein.

Assume for simplicity that C has only one node x_{-1} ; the general case follows from a similar argument. Following the notations in the proof of Thm. 1.5.2, we let $\mathfrak{U} = \{U_{-1}, U_0, U_1, \dots, U_N\}$ where U_{-1} is a small Stein neighborhood of the node x_{-1} , and $U_0 = C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N, x_{-1}\}$. (So $U_0^+ = U_0 \cup U_{-1}$.) Then

$Z^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ is naturally a subspace of $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ consisting of 1-cocycles $s = (s_{m,n})_{m,n=-1,0,1,\dots,N}$ vanishing on $U_0 \cap U_{-1}$, i.e. $s_{-1,0} = s_{0,-1} = 0$. Moreover, an element in $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ is a coboundary with respect to $\mathfrak{U}^+$ if and only if it is so with respect to $\mathfrak{U}$. Therefore, the theorem follows from Thm. 1.5.2 and the pairing (1.5.6) (1.5.7) if we can show that every element of $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) = H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ is represented by an element of $Z^1(\mathfrak{U}^+, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$, i.e., represented by an element $s \in Z^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C)$ such that $s_{-1,0} = -s_{0,-1} = 0$.

Let $D = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. By Prop. 1.5.4, there is $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C(kD)) = 0$. The short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C \rightarrow \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C(kD) \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0$$

(where $\mathcal{G}$ is the quotient of the previous two sheaves) gives a long one

$$H^0(C, \mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{\delta} H^1(\mathfrak{U}, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C) \rightarrow H^1(C, \mathcal{E} \otimes \omega_C(kD)) = 0.$$

So δ is surjective. Since $\mathcal{G}$ has support in $x_1, \dots, x_N$, by the explicit description of δ , it is clear that any element in the image of δ is represented by a cocycle satisfying $s_{-1,0} = -s_{0,-1} = 0$. $\square$

Remark 1.5.6. If C is connected, the number $g = \dim H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C)$ is called the (arithmetic) **genus** of C . Thus $\chi(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = 1 - g$. Again, any line bundle $\mathcal{L}$ is equivalent to $\mathcal{O}_C(D)$ for some divisor $D = k_1x_1 + \dots + k_Nx_N$. (For the nodal curve, we assume none of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ is a node.) The argument is the same as for smooth curves: By Proposition 1.5.4, one may find a divisor D_0 such that $H^1(C, \mathcal{L}(-D_0 - x)) = 0$, where x is any smooth point of C . Thus, the short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(-D_0 - x) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(-D_0) \rightarrow k_x \rightarrow 0$ (where $k_x \simeq \mathcal{L}(-D_0)/\mathcal{L}(-D_0 - x)$ is the skyscraper sheaf) yields a surjective $H^0(C, \mathcal{L}(-D_0)) \rightarrow H^0(C, k_x)$. So $H^0(C, \mathcal{L}(-D_0))$ is nonzero. Thus we may find a non-zero global meromorphic section s of $\mathcal{L}$. Let $D = -\sum n_x \cdot x$ where the sum is over all smooth points of C , and n_x is the unique integer such that (by choosing any local coordinate z_x at x) $z_x^{n_x}s$ can be extended to a section of $\mathcal{L}$ on a neighborhood of x whose value at the fiber $\mathcal{L}|_x$ is non-zero. Then D is a finite divisor, and $f \mapsto fs$ defines an isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_C(D) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}$.

Define $\deg(\mathcal{L}) = \deg(D)$. Then the Riemann-Roch theorem (1.2.6) holds for C and can be proved in exactly the same way: Identify $\mathcal{L}$ with $\mathcal{O}_C(D)$. Notice $\chi(C, k_x) = \dim H^0(C, k_x) = 1$. Then we have a short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_C(D) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_C(D + x) \rightarrow k_x \rightarrow 0$ and hence a long one

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D)) \rightarrow H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D + x)) \rightarrow H^0(C, k_x) \\ \rightarrow H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D)) \rightarrow H^1(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D + x)) \rightarrow H^1(C, k_x) = 0, \end{aligned}$$

which gives $\chi(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D)) - \chi(C, \mathcal{O}_C(D + x)) = -\chi(C, k_x) = -1$. Thus, (1.2.6) follows from induction and the base case $\chi(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = 1 - g$. Therefore, (1.2.7) also holds in the nodal case.

As a consequence, we obtain again $\deg \omega_C = -\deg \Theta_C = 2g - 2$.

As usual, a divisor D of C is called **effective** if $D = \sum_{i=1}^k n_i x_i$ where each x_i is a smooth point and each $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ is non-negative.

Theorem 1.5.7. *Let C be a complex curve with M nodes and normalization $\tilde{C}$. Let $x_1, \dots, x_N$ be smooth points of C , and assume that any connected component of $\tilde{C}$ contains one of these points. Set $D = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, let D' be an effective divisor of C , and let $\tilde{g}$ be the maximal (resp. minimal) genus of the connected components of $\tilde{C}$ if $n \geq -1$ (resp. $n < -1$). Then for any $k > (n+1)(2\tilde{g}-2) + 2M + \deg D'$, we have $H^1(C, \Theta_C^{\otimes n}(kD - D')) = 0$.*

Proof. Choose any such k . By Serre duality, it suffices to prove $H^0(C, \omega_C^{\otimes(n+1)}(-kD + D')) = 0$. Let $x'_1, \dots, x'_M$ be the nodes of C . For each j , let y'_j, y''_j be the double points of $\tilde{C}$ mapped to x'_j by ν . Let $D_0 = D' + \sum_{j=1}^M (y'_j + y''_j)$. Then, by (1.5.4), $H^0(C, \omega_C^{\otimes(n+1)}(-kD + D'))$ is naturally a subspace of $H^0(\tilde{C}, \omega_{\tilde{C}}^{\otimes(n+1)}(-kD + D_0))$. Thus, it suffices to prove that for each connected component $\tilde{C}_0$ of $\tilde{C}$, $H^0(\tilde{C}_0, \omega_{\tilde{C}_0}^{\otimes(n+1)}(-kD + D_0))$ is trivial. This follows from Theorem 1.2.4 and the computation $\deg(\omega_{\tilde{C}_0}^{\otimes(n+1)}(-kD + D_0)) \leq (n+1)(2\tilde{g}-2) - k + 2M + \deg D' < 0$. $\square$

1.6 Families of complex curves

Smoothing the nodes

For any $r > 0$, let $\mathcal{D}_r = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z| < r\}$ and $\mathcal{D}_r^\times = \mathcal{D}_r - \{0\}$. If $r, \rho > 0$, we define

$$\pi_{r,\rho} : \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}, \quad (\xi, \varpi) \mapsto \xi\varpi. \quad (1.6.1)$$

$d\pi_{r,\rho}$ is surjective at (ξ, ϖ) whenever $\xi \neq 0$ or $\varpi \neq 0$. So if $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ is not 0, the fiber $\pi^{-1}(q)$ is smooth. But $\pi_{r,\rho}^{-1}(0)$ is singular, which is just a neighborhood of a node of a nodal curve. Denote also by ξ and ϖ the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_r$ and $\mathcal{D}_\rho$, and set $q = \pi_{r,\rho}$ i.e.,

$$q : \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \quad q = \xi\varpi.$$

Then (ξ, ϖ) , (ξ, q) , (ϖ, q) are coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho$, $\mathcal{D}_r^\times \times \mathcal{D}_\rho$, $\mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho^\times$ respectively. The standard tangent vectors of the coordinates (ξ, ϖ) , (ξ, q) are related by

$$\begin{cases} \partial_\xi = \partial_\xi - \xi^{-1}\varpi \cdot \partial_\varpi \\ \partial_q = \xi^{-1}\partial_\varpi \end{cases} \quad \begin{cases} \partial_\xi = \partial_\xi + \xi^{-1}q \cdot \partial_q \\ \partial_\varpi = \xi\partial_q \end{cases} \quad (1.6.2)$$

The formulae between (ξ, ϖ) , (ϖ, q) are similar.

It is easy to see that $(\xi, q)(\mathcal{D}_r^\times \times \mathcal{D}_\rho)$ (resp. $(\varpi, q)(\mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho^\times)$) is precisely the subset of all $(\xi_0, q_0) \in \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ (resp. $(\varpi_0, q_0) \in \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$) satisfying

$$\frac{|q_0|}{\rho} < |\xi_0| < r \quad \text{resp.} \quad \frac{|q_0|}{r} < |\varpi_0| < \rho. \quad (1.6.3)$$

We choose closed subsets $E'_{r,\rho} \subset \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ and $E''_{r,\rho} \subset \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} (\xi, q) : \mathcal{D}_r^\times \times \mathcal{D}_\rho &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} - E'_{r,\rho}, \\ (\varpi, q) : \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho^\times &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} - E''_{r,\rho}. \end{aligned} \quad (1.6.4)$$

Sewing families of compact Riemann surfaces

Choose $M \in \mathbb{N}$. Consider a family of $2M$ -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}}; \zeta'_1, \dots, \zeta'_M; \zeta''_1, \dots, \zeta''_M; \xi_1, \dots, \xi_M; \varpi_1, \dots, \varpi_M). \quad (1.6.5)$$

We do not assume that every component of any fiber contains a marked point. For each $1 \leq j \leq M$ we choose $r_j, \rho_j > 0$ and a neighborhood U'_j (resp. U''_j) of $\zeta'_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ (resp. $\zeta''_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$) such that

$$(\xi_j, \tilde{\pi}) : U'_j \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad \text{resp.} \quad (\varpi_j, \tilde{\pi}) : U''_j \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad (1.6.6)$$

is a biholomorphic map. We also assume that these r_i and ρ_j are small enough so that the neighborhoods $U'_1, \dots, U'_M, U''_1, \dots, U''_M$ are mutually disjoint. Identify

$$U'_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad \text{resp.} \quad U''_j = \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$$

via the above maps. Then ξ_j, ϖ_j (when restricted to the first components) become the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_j}, \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}$ respectively, and $\tilde{\pi}$ is the projection onto the $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ -component. Set $q_j = \xi_j \varpi_j : \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j}$ as previously.

We now construct a family of complex curves $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ as follows. Let

$$\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} = \mathcal{D}_{r_1 \rho_1} \times \dots \times \mathcal{D}_{r_M \rho_M}, \quad \mathcal{B} = \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}. \quad (1.6.7)$$

We shall freely switch the order of Cartesian product. For each $1 \leq j \leq M$, we also define $\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j}$ to be the product of all $\mathcal{D}_{r_1 \rho_1}, \dots, \mathcal{D}_{r_M \rho_M}$ except $\mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j}$. So

$$\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} = \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j}.$$

Recall that by (1.6.4), $E'_{r_j, \rho_j} \subset \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j}$ and $E''_{r_j, \rho_j} \subset \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j}$. So

$$F'_j := E'_{r_j, \rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \subset \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad (= U'_j \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}),$$

$$F_j'' := E_{r_j, \rho_j}'' \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \subset \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad (= U_j'' \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet})$$

are subsets of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}$. They are the subsets we should discard in the sewing process. Set

$$W_j := \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}. \quad (1.6.8)$$

We glue $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}$ (with F_j', F_j'' all removed) with all W_j and obtain a complex manifold $\mathcal{C}$.

To be more precise, we define

$$\mathcal{C} = \left(\prod_{j=1}^M W_j \right) \amalg \left(\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} - \bigcup_{j=1}^M F_j' - \bigcup_{j=1}^M F_j'' \right) / \sim \quad (1.6.9)$$

where the equivalence $\sim$ is described as follows. Consider the following subsets of W_j :

$$W_j' = \mathcal{D}_{r_j}^\times \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}, \quad (1.6.10)$$

$$W_j'' = \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}^\times \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}. \quad (1.6.11)$$

Then the relation $\sim$ identifies W_j' and W_j'' respectively via $(\xi_j, q_j, 1)$ and $(\varpi_j, q_j, 1)$ (where 1 is the identity map of $\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$) to

$$\mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} - F_j' \quad (\subset U_j' \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}), \quad (1.6.12)$$

$$\mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} - F_j'' \quad (\subset U_j'' \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}). \quad (1.6.13)$$

(recall (1.6.4)), which are subsets of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} - \bigcup_j F_j' - \bigcup_j F_j''$. (In particular, certain open subsets of (1.6.12) and (1.6.13) are glued together and identified with $W_j' \cap W_j''$.)

It is easy to see that the projection

$$\tilde{\pi} \times 1 : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} = \mathcal{B}, \quad (1.6.14)$$

agrees with

$$\pi_{r_j, \rho_j} \times 1 : W_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r_j, \rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = \mathcal{B} \quad (1.6.15)$$

for each j when restricted to W_j', W_j'' . (Indeed, recalling (1.6.12) and (1.6.13), they are the standard projections $(\xi_j, q_\bullet, \tilde{b}) \mapsto (q_\bullet, \tilde{b})$ and $(\varpi_j, q_\bullet, \tilde{b}) \mapsto (q_\bullet, \tilde{b})$.) Thus, we have a well-defined surjective holomorphic map

$$\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$$

whose restrictions to $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} - \bigcup_j F_j' - \bigcup_j F_j''$ and to each W_j are $\tilde{\pi} \otimes 1$ and $\pi_{r_j, \rho_j} \otimes 1$ respectively. We say that $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ is obtained from $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ via **sewing**.

The discriminant locus Δ and the critical locus Σ

For each j we set

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta_j &= \{0\} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \\ &(\subset \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = \mathcal{B}).\end{aligned}$$

Then

$$\Delta = \bigcup_{j=1}^M \Delta_j \tag{1.6.16}$$

is the set of all points $b \in \mathcal{B}$ such that the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is singular, called the **discriminant locus**. Roughly speaking, if b is (for example) in $\Delta_1, \dots, \Delta_j$ but not in $\Delta_{j+1}, \dots, \Delta_M$, then $\mathcal{C}_b$ is obtained by attaching $\varsigma'_1, \dots, \varsigma'_M$ with $\varsigma''_1, \dots, \varsigma''_M$ respectively and smoothing the last $M-j$ nodes. Therefore $\mathcal{C}_b$ has j nodes. If b is outside Δ then $\mathcal{C}_b$ is smooth (i.e. a compact Riemann surface). Set also

$$\begin{aligned}\Sigma_j &= \{0\} \times \{0\} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \\ &(\subset \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = W_j \subset \mathcal{C}).\end{aligned}$$

Then

$$\Sigma = \bigcup_{j=1}^M \Sigma_j$$

is the set of nodes, called the **critical locus**. The linear map $d\pi$ is not surjective precisely at Σ . Clearly we have $\pi(\Sigma) = \Delta$.

Sewing families of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces

Remark 1.6.1. Suppose, moreover, that we are sewing a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \varsigma'_1, \dots, \varsigma'_M; \varsigma''_1, \dots, \varsigma''_M; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi_1, \dots, \xi_M; \varpi_1, \dots, \varpi_M).$$

Then, we assume that *each connected component of each fiber $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}_{\tilde{b}}$ of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$ contains one of $\varsigma_1(\tilde{b}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\tilde{b})$, and $\varsigma_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ are disjoint from the neighborhoods $U'_1, \dots, U'_M, U''_1, \dots, U''_M$. One thus have a family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates*

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N),$$

where each section ς_i is defined on $\mathcal{B} = \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}$, takes values in $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} - \bigcup_j U'_j - \bigcup_j U''_j$, is constant over $\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}$, and equals the original one over $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. Similarly, the local coordinate η_i of $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ at $\varsigma_i(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ is extended constantly to one of $\mathfrak{X}$ at $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. We say that the N -points $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N$ and the local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ of $\mathfrak{X}$ are **constant with respect to sewing**.

In the case that the local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are not assigned to $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$, then $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ is a family of N -pointed complex curves.

Families of complex curves

We now give a general definition of families of complex curves. Suppose that $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ is a surjective holomorphic map of complex manifolds, where $\mathcal{B}$ has finitely many connected components. We say that $\mathfrak{X}$ is a **family of complex curves** if $\mathfrak{X}$ is either smooth or obtained via sewing. We let Σ be the set nodes, i.e., the set of all $x \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $\mathcal{C}_{\pi(x)}$ is nodal and x is a node of the nodal curve $\mathcal{C}_{\pi(x)}$. Equivalently, Σ is the set of all $x \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $d\pi$ is not surjective at x . We define

$$\Delta = \pi(\Sigma), \quad \mathcal{C}_\Delta = \pi^{-1}(\Delta).$$

Then $\mathcal{C}_\Delta$ is the union of all singular fibers. Δ and $\mathcal{C}_\Delta$ will be considered later as (normal crossing) divisors.

Theorem 1.6.2. *Grauert's Theorem 1.3.1 holds verbatim for a family of complex curves $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$.*

As mentioned in the paragraphs after Theorem 1.3.1, Grauert's theorem holds in general when $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ are complex spaces, $\mathcal{E}$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module, π is proper, and $\mathcal{E}$ is π -flat. To apply that theorem to the family of complex curves $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ and a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module $\mathcal{E}$, we need to check that π is proper and $\mathcal{E}$ is π -flat. One can check the properness of π by checking, for example, the sequential compactness of the preimages of compact subsets. Also, one checks easily that π is an open map. Thus $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ is π -flat by [Fis76, Sec. 3.20] (see also [GPR94, Thm. II.2.13] and [BS76, Thm. V.2.13]). (One simply says that π is flat.) Since $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free, $\mathcal{E}$ is π -flat.

Remark 1.6.3. Apply Grauert's theorem to $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$, we see that $b \mapsto \chi(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ is constant on each connected component of $\mathcal{B}$. If we assume that all the fibers of $\mathcal{C}$ are connected, then the genus of the fiber $g(\mathcal{C}_b) = 1 - \chi(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}_b})$ is locally constant over b . We conclude that the genus of a complex curve is unchanged under deformation. Consequently, the genus of a nodal curve equals the genus of its "smoothing".

Consider a family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ of complex curves. Let $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be (holomorphic) sections whose images are mutually disjoint and are also disjoint from

Σ . For each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, we assume that $(\mathcal{C}_b; \varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b))$ is an N -pointed complex curve. Thus every connected component of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}_b$ (the normalization of $\mathcal{C}_b$) contains one of $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$. Equivalently, every irreducible component of $\mathcal{C}_b$ contains one of $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$. Notice that $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$ are not nodes since they are not in Σ . Then we say that $(\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ is a **family of N -pointed complex curves**. Assume moreover that for each $1 \leq j \leq N$, the family $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ has a **local coordinate** η_j at ς_j . This means that $\varsigma_j(\mathcal{B})$ is contained in an open set $U_j \subset \mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ such that $\eta_j : U_j \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is holomorphic and equals 0 on $\eta_j(\mathcal{B})$, and that $\eta_j|_{U_j \cap \mathcal{C}_b}$ is a univalent function for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$. So (η_j, π) is a biholomorphic map from U_j to an open subset of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ containing $\{0\} \times \mathcal{B}$. Then we say that

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$$

is a **family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates**. As usual, we define a divisor

$$S_{\mathfrak{X}} = \sum_{j=1}^N \varsigma_j(\mathcal{B}).$$

Note that even if $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ is obtained by sewing a smooth family $\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$, the N -points and their local coordinates are not assumed to be constant with respect to sewing.

Proposition 1.6.4. *Proposition 1.3.2 holds verbatim if $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed complex curves.*

Proof. The proof is the same as in Proposition 1.3.2. □

The invertible sheaves $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ and $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$

Given a family of complex curves $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$, we can define a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}$ in a similar way as for families of compact Riemann surfaces. However, this map is not necessarily a surjective sheaf map, which means that we do not have a long exact sequence from this map. To remedy this issue we consider $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta}) \rightarrow \pi^*(\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))$ defined as follows. (We shall write $\pi^*(\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))$ as $\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$ for short.)

Let us first describe $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$. Choose any $b \in \mathcal{B}$. Then one can always find a neighborhood V of b such that

$$V \simeq \mathcal{D}_{r, \rho_{\bullet}} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = \mathcal{D}_{r_1 \rho_1} \times \cdots \times \mathcal{D}_{r_M \rho_M} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$$

where $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is an open subset of $\mathbb{C}^n$, and

$$\Delta \cap V = \{q_{\bullet, 0} \in \mathcal{D}_{r, \rho_{\bullet}} : q_{1, 0} \cdots q_{M, 0} = 0\} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}.$$

Let $q_1, \dots, q_M$ be the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_1\rho_1}, \dots, \mathcal{D}_{r_M\rho_M}$. Let also $\tau_\bullet = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_n)$ be the standard coordinate of $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ inside $\mathbb{C}^n$. Then $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)_V$ is defined to be the $\mathcal{O}_V$ -submodule of $\Theta_V = \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}|_V$ generated (freely) by

$$q_1 \partial_{q_1}, \dots, q_M \partial_{q_M}, \partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_n}. \quad (1.6.17)$$

By gluing, we obtain a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$.

Next, we describe $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta})$ and the map $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta}) \rightarrow \pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$. Choose any $x \in \mathcal{C}$.

Case I. $x \notin \Sigma$. Then one can find a neighborhood U of x disjoint from Σ , and a neighborhood V of $b = \pi(x)$ described as above, such that

$$U \simeq \mathcal{D}_{r_0} \times V = \mathcal{D}_{r_0} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}},$$

and that $\pi : \mathcal{D}_{r_0} \times V \rightarrow V$ is the projection on to the V -component. Let z be the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_0}$. Notice that

$$\mathcal{C}_{\Delta} \cap U = \mathcal{D}_{r_0} \times \{q_{\bullet, 0} \in \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} : q_{1,0} \cdots q_{M,0} = 0\} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}},$$

which suggests that we define $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta})_U$ to be the $\mathcal{O}_U$ -submodule of $\Theta_U = \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}|_U$ generated (freely) by

$$\partial_z, q_1 \partial_{q_1}, \dots, q_M \partial_{q_M}, \partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_n}. \quad (1.6.18)$$

The homomorphism

$$d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta})_U \rightarrow (\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))_U \quad (1.6.19)$$

is defined by sending ∂_z to 0 and keeping all the other elements in (1.6.18). (Here we do not differentiate between $\partial_{q_\bullet}, \partial_{\tau_\bullet}$ and their pull backs.) It is clear that $d\pi$ is surjective. We leave it to the reader to check that the above definitions are independent of the choice of local coordinates.

Case II. $x \in \Sigma$. Then one can find neighborhoods U of x and V of $b = \pi(x)$ described as above, such that

$$\begin{aligned} U &\simeq \mathcal{D}_{r_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus 1} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}, \\ \pi &= \pi_{r_1, \rho_1} \otimes \mathbf{1} \otimes \mathbf{1} : \mathcal{D}_{r_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus 1} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = V. \end{aligned}$$

From this we deduce that

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathcal{C}_{\Delta} \cap U \\ &= \{(\xi_{1,0}, \varpi_{1,0}, q_{2,0}, \dots, q_{M,0}) \in \mathcal{D}_{r_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_1} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus 1} : \xi_{1,0} \cdot \varpi_{1,0} \cdot q_{2,0} \cdots q_{M,0} = 0\} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}. \end{aligned}$$

Let ξ_1, ϖ_1 be respectively the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_1}, \mathcal{D}_{\rho_1}$. Again $q_\bullet$ and $\tau_\bullet$ are respectively the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. Note also the relation

$q_1 = \xi_1 \varpi_1$. The description of $\mathcal{C}_\Delta \cap U$ suggests that we define $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta)_U$ to be the $\mathcal{O}_U$ -submodule of $\Theta_U = \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}|_U$ generated (freely) by

$$\xi_1 \partial_{\xi_1}, \varpi_1 \partial_{\varpi_1}, q_2 \partial_{q_2}, \dots, q_M \partial_{q_M}, \partial_{\tau_1}, \dots, \partial_{\tau_n}. \quad (1.6.20)$$

The homomorphism $d\pi$ of (1.6.19) is defined by setting

$$d\pi(\xi_1 \partial_{\xi_1}) = d\pi(\varpi_1 \partial_{\varpi_1}) = q_1 \partial_{q_1} \quad (1.6.21)$$

and keeping all the other elements in (1.6.20). Again $d\pi$ is surjective and independent of the choice of local coordinates. Also, using (1.6.2), it is easy to see that the $d\pi$ constructed in case I and II are compatible.

We may now glue the two cases together and obtain the locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta)$ and a surjective homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules $d\pi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta) \rightarrow \pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$, whose kernel is denoted by $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$. Thus, there is a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta) \xrightarrow{d\pi} \pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta) \rightarrow 0 \quad (1.6.22)$$

Choose any $x \in \mathcal{C}$ and a small neighborhood U of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$. Then in case I resp. in case II $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_U$ is generated freely by

$$\partial_z \quad \text{resp.} \quad \xi_1 \partial_{\xi_1} - \varpi_1 \partial_{\varpi_1}. \quad (1.6.23)$$

Therefore, $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ is an invertible $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module, whose dual sheaf is denoted by $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$. We leave it to the reader to check that there are natural equivalences

$$\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \simeq \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}, \quad \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \simeq \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}$$

for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$. One may use the following fact: in case II, by (1.6.2), in the $(\xi_1, q_\bullet, \tau_\bullet)$ - resp. $(\varpi_1, q_\bullet, \tau_\bullet)$ -coordinate, the section $\xi_1 \partial_{\xi_1} - \varpi_1 \partial_{\varpi_1}$ equals

$$\xi_1 \partial_{\xi_1} \quad \text{resp.} \quad -\varpi_1 \partial_{\varpi_1}. \quad (1.6.24)$$

We close this section with the following generalization of Theorem 1.3.3.

Theorem 1.6.5. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $k \geq k_0$, the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module $\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is locally free, and for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ there is a natural isomorphism of vector spaces*

$$\frac{\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})_b}{\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})_b} \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \quad (1.6.25)$$

defined by restriction of sections. In particular, $\dim H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes n}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is locally constant over b .

Proof. This follows easily from theorems 1.5.1 and 1.5.7, and Grauert's Theorem 1.6.2. $\square$

1.7 Linear differential equations with simple poles

We first introduce the following notations. If W is a vector space and z is a (formal) variable, we define

$$\begin{aligned} W[[z]] &= \left\{ \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} w_n z^n : \text{each } w_n \in W \right\}, \\ W[[z^{\pm 1}]] &= \left\{ \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} w_n z^n : \text{each } w_n \in W \right\}, \\ W((z)) &= \left\{ f(z) : z^k f(z) \in W[[z]] \text{ for some } k \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}, \\ W\{z\} &= \left\{ \sum_{n \in \mathbb{C}} w_n z^n : \text{each } w_n \in W \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

In this section, we fix $m, N \in \mathbb{N}, r > 0$, and let V be an open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$. Let q be the standard coordinate of $\mathcal{D}_r \subset \mathbb{C}$, and let $\tau_\bullet = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_m)$ be the standard coordinates of V . A is an $\text{End}(\mathbb{C}^N)$ -valued holomorphic function on $\mathcal{D}_r \times V$, i.e.

$$A \in \text{End}(\mathbb{C}^N) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r \times V).$$

First, recall the following well-known fact.

Theorem 1.7.1. *For any $\varphi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)$, there exists a unique $\psi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r \times V)$ satisfying the differential equation $\partial_q \psi(q, \tau_\bullet) = A(q, \tau_\bullet) \psi(q, \tau_\bullet)$ and the initial condition $\psi(0, \tau_\bullet) = \varphi(\tau_\bullet)$.*

Proof. This is an easy consequence of Picard iteration. We provide the details for the readers' convenience. It suffices to prove the existence and the uniqueness of such ψ on any precompact open subset of $\mathcal{D}_r \times V$. Thus, we may well assume that $\|A(q, \tau_\bullet)\|$ (where $\|\cdot\|$ is the operator norm) is uniformly bounded by a positive (finite) number C , and $\|\varphi(\tau_\bullet)\|$ is also uniformly bounded. Fix any $\delta \in (0, 1)$. We claim that for any $q_0 \in \mathcal{D}_r$, if we let $\mathcal{D}_{\delta/C}(q_0)$ be the open disc with center q_0 and radius δ/C and set $W(q_0) = \mathcal{D}_{\delta/C}(q_0) \cap \mathcal{D}_r$, then for any uniformly bounded $\varphi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)$, there exists a unique $\psi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W(q_0) \times V)$ satisfying $\partial_q \psi = A\psi$ and $\psi(q_0, \tau_\bullet) = \varphi(\tau_\bullet)$. Then the theorem is proved by covering $\mathcal{D}_r$ by finitely many open discs with radius δ/C .

Fix $q_0 \in \mathcal{D}_r$ and a uniformly bounded $\varphi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)$. Let $\mathfrak{H}$ be the Banach space of uniformly bounded elements of $\mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W(q_0) \times V)$, whose norm is given by $\|\cdot\|_\infty$. Define a map $T : \mathfrak{H} \rightarrow \mathfrak{H}$ such that for any $\psi \in \mathfrak{H}$,

$$T\psi(q, \tau_\bullet) = \varphi(\tau_\bullet) + \int_{\gamma_q} A(z, \tau_\bullet) \psi(z, \tau_\bullet) dz.$$

where γ_q is any path in $W(q_0)$ from q_0 to q . Then ψ is a solution satisfying $\psi(q_0, \tau_\bullet) = \varphi(\tau_\bullet)$ if and only if $T\psi = \psi$. It is easy to see that $\|T(\psi_1 - \psi_2)\| \leq$

$\delta\|\psi_1 - \psi_2\|$. So T is a contraction, which proves the existence and the uniqueness of the fixed point of T . $\square$

The above theorem clearly holds also when $\mathcal{D}_r$ is replaced by a simply connected domain.

Consider the following differential equation with simple pole

$$q\partial_q\psi = A\psi \quad (1.7.1)$$

where $\psi \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)((q))$ is a formal solution of this equation. By our assumption on ψ , we can write

$$\psi(q, \tau_{\bullet}) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{\psi}_n(\tau_{\bullet}) q^n, \quad (1.7.2)$$

where $\hat{\psi}_n \in \mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)$, and $\hat{\psi}_n = 0$ when n smaller than some negative integer.

Theorem 1.7.2. *Suppose that the formal series ψ is a formal solution of (1.7.1). Then ψ is an element of $\mathbb{C}^N \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r^{\times} \times V)$.*

Proof. Suppose the mode $\hat{\psi}_n$ is zero when $n < -K$. Then $\phi := q^K \psi$ has no negative modes and satisfies a similar differential equation $q\partial_q\phi = (K + A)\phi$. Thus, we may well assume that $\hat{\psi}_n = 0$ when $n < 0$. Consider the series expansion of A :

$$A(q, \tau_{\bullet}) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \hat{A}_n(\tau_{\bullet}) q^n,$$

where each $\hat{A}_n$ is in $\text{End}(\mathbb{C}^N) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V)$. Then for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$n\hat{\psi}_n = \sum_{j=0}^n \hat{A}_{n-j} \hat{\psi}_j.$$

Choose any open subset U of V with compact closure, and choose $M \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\|\hat{A}_0(\tau_{\bullet})\| \leq M$ whenever $\tau_{\bullet} \in U$. (Here $\|\cdot\|$ is the operator norm.) Then for any $n > M$, $n\mathbf{1} - \hat{A}_0(\tau_{\bullet})$ is invertible (with inverse $n^{-1} \sum_{j=0}^{\infty} (\hat{A}_0(\tau_{\bullet})/n)^j$). Thus, whenever $n > M$,

$$\hat{\psi}_n = (n - \hat{A}_0)^{-1} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \hat{A}_{n-j} \hat{\psi}_j. \quad (1.7.3)$$

Choose any $r_1 < r$ and set

$$\alpha = \sup_{(q, \tau_{\bullet}) \in \overline{\mathcal{D}_{r_1}} \times U} \|A(q, \tau_{\bullet})\|. \quad (1.7.4)$$

Using the fact that $\hat{A}_n(\tau_\bullet) = \oint_{\partial\mathcal{D}_{r_1}} A(q, \tau_\bullet) q^{-n-1} \frac{dq}{2i\pi}$, we have

$$\|\hat{A}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq \alpha r_1^{-n} \quad (1.7.5)$$

for all n and all $\tau_\bullet$ in U .

Choose $\beta > 0$ such that $\|(n - \hat{A}_0(\tau_\bullet))^{-1}\| \leq \beta n^{-1}$ for any $n > M$ and $\tau_\bullet \in U$. (Such β can be found using the explicit formula of inverse matrix given above.) Set $\gamma \geq \max\{1, \alpha\beta\}$. Then, from (1.7.3) and (1.7.5), we see that for any $n > M$ and $\tau_\bullet \in U$,

$$r_1^n \|\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq \gamma n^{-1} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} r_1^j \|\hat{\psi}_j(\tau_\bullet)\|. \quad (1.7.6)$$

By induction, one can show that there exists $c > 0$ such that

$$r_1^n \|\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq c\gamma^n$$

for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\tau_\bullet \in U$. Indeed, if this is true for $0, 1, 2, \dots, n-1$ where $n > N$, then by (1.7.6),

$$r_1^n \|\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq \gamma n^{-1} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} c\gamma^j \leq \gamma n^{-1} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} c\gamma^{n-1} = c\gamma^n.$$

Thus $\|\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq c\gamma^n r_1^{-n}$ for all n and $\tau_\bullet \in U$. Therefore, if we choose any $r_0 \in (0, \gamma^{-1}r_1)$, then the series $\sum_n \|\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)\| \cdot |q|^n$ is uniformly bounded by some positive number for all $|q| \leq r_0$ and $\tau_\bullet \in U$. Since each $\hat{\psi}_n(\tau_\bullet)$ is holomorphic over $\tau_\bullet$, the series (1.7.2) must converge uniformly to a holomorphic function on $\mathcal{D}_{r_0} \times U$.

By Theorem 1.7.1, for any simply connected open subset $W \subset \mathcal{D}_r^\times$ which overlaps with $\mathcal{D}_{r_0}$, there exists a unique holomorphic solution of (1.7.1) on $W \times U$ which agrees with ψ on $(W \cap \mathcal{D}_{r_0}) \times U$. Thus, ψ can be extended to a holomorphic $\mathbb{C}^N$ -valued function on $\mathcal{D}_r \times U$. Since U is an arbitrary precompact open subset of V , ψ is holomorphic on $\mathcal{D}_r \times V$. $\square$

Remark 1.7.3. The proof of the above proposition shows that if $M \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\|\hat{A}_0(\tau_\bullet)\| \leq M$ whenever $\tau_\bullet \in V$, then ψ is holomorphic on $\mathcal{D}_r^\times \times V$ provided that the first $(M+1)$ non-zero modes of ψ are holomorphic on $\tau_\bullet \in V$.

1.8 Criteria on local freeness

Let X be a complex manifold and $\mathcal{E}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. We say that $\mathcal{E}$ is a **finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module** if any $x \in X$ is contained in an open subset U such that

$\mathcal{E}_U$ is generated by some $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$. Note that this does not mean that the $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -module $\mathcal{E}(U)$ is generated by $s_1, \dots, s_n$.

Recall that for each open subset U of X , and for each $x \in U$ and $s \in \mathcal{E}(U)$, $s(x)$ denotes the value of s in $\mathcal{E}|_x \simeq \mathcal{E}_x/\mathfrak{m}_x\mathcal{E}_x$. It is clear that if $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ generate $\mathcal{E}_U$, then $s_1(x), \dots, s_n(x)$ span the vector space $\mathcal{E}|_x$. Conversely, we have:

Proposition 1.8.1 (Nakayama's lemma). *Suppose that $\mathcal{E}$ is a finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, $x \in X$, U is an open set containing x , $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$, and $s_1(x), \dots, s_n(x)$ span the vector space $\mathcal{E}|_x$. Then there exists an open subset V of U containing x such that $s_1|_V, \dots, s_n|_V$ generate $\mathcal{E}_V$.*

Consequently, the rank function of a finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module is upper semi-continuous.

Proof. Since $\mathcal{E}$ is finite-type, we may assume that U is small enough such that $\mathcal{E}_U$ is generated by $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_m \in \mathcal{E}(U)$. Thus the germs $\sigma_{1,x}, \dots, \sigma_{m,x}$ generate the $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ -module $\mathcal{E}_x$. In particular, $\sigma_{1,x}, \sigma_{2,x}, \dots, \sigma_{m,x}, s_{1,x}, \dots, s_{n,x}$ generate $\mathcal{E}_x$. We now show that $\sigma_{2,x}, \sigma_{3,x}, \dots, \sigma_{m,x}, s_{1,x}, \dots, s_{n,x}$ generate $\mathcal{E}_x$. Since $s_1(x), \dots, s_n(x)$ span $\mathcal{E}_x/\mathfrak{m}_x\mathcal{E}_x$, there exist complex numbers $c_1, \dots, c_n$ such that $\sigma_{1,x} \in \sum_{k=1}^n c_k s_{k,x} + \mathfrak{m}_x\mathcal{E}_x$. Therefore, there exists $f_1, \dots, f_m, g_1, \dots, g_n \in \mathfrak{m}_x$ such that

$$\sigma_{1,x} = \sum_{k=1}^n c_k s_{k,x} + \sum_{i=1}^m f_i \sigma_{i,x} + \sum_{j=1}^n g_j s_{j,x}.$$

Since $f_1(x) = 0$, the element $1 - f_1$ has inverse in $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. For each $j = 1, \dots, n$, set $\tilde{g}_j = c_j + g_j$ which is an element in $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. Then we clearly have

$$\sigma_{1,x} = (1 - f_1)^{-1} \left(\sum_{i=2}^m f_i \sigma_{i,x} + \sum_{j=1}^n \tilde{g}_j s_{j,x} \right).$$

This shows that $\sigma_{2,x}, \sigma_{3,x}, \dots, \sigma_{m,x}, s_{1,x}, \dots, s_{n,x}$ generate $\mathcal{E}_x$. A similar argument shows that $\sigma_{3,x}, \sigma_{4,x}, \dots, \sigma_{m,x}, s_{1,x}, \dots, s_{n,x}$ generate $\mathcal{E}_x$. If we repeat this argument several times, we arrive at the conclusion that $s_{1,x}, \dots, s_{n,x}$ generate $\mathcal{E}_x$. Thus, there exists an open subset V of U containing x such that for each $i = 1, \dots, m$, there exist $h_{i,1}, \dots, h_{i,n} \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ satisfying $\sigma_i|_V = \sum_{j=1}^n h_{i,j} s_j|_V$. Therefore, as $\sigma_1|_V, \dots, \sigma_m|_V$ generate $\mathcal{E}_V$, so do $s_1|_V, \dots, s_n|_V$. $\square$

Theorem 1.8.2. *Suppose that $\mathcal{E}$ is finite-type. Then $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free if and only if the rank function $x \in X \mapsto r_x = \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{E}|_x)$ is locally constant.*

Proof. The only if part is obvious. Let us prove the if part. Suppose that the rank function is locally constant. Choose any $x \in X$ and let $r = r_x$. There exists a neighborhood U of x and $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ generating $\mathcal{E}_U$. We may also assume that U is small enough such that for any $y \in U$, $r_y = r$. Since $s_1(x), \dots, s_n(x)$

span $\mathcal{E}|_x$, we must have $n \geq r$. By rearranging $s_1, \dots, s_n$, we may assume that $s_1(x), \dots, s_r(x)$ form a basis of the vector space $\mathcal{E}_x$. Thus, by Nakayama's lemma, there exists a neighborhood V of x contained in U such that $s_1|_V, \dots, s_r|_V$ generate $\mathcal{E}|_V$. We prove that $\mathcal{E}|_V$ is a free $\mathcal{O}_V$ -module with basis $s_1|_V, \dots, s_r|_V$. Choose any open subset $W \subset V$. We need to show that $s_1|_W, \dots, s_r|_W$ are $\mathcal{O}(W)$ -linear independent. Suppose that $f_1, \dots, f_r \in \mathcal{O}(W)$ and $f_1 s_1|_W + \dots + f_r s_r|_W = 0$. Then for any $y \in W$, $f_1(y)s_1(y) + \dots + f_r(y)s_r(y) = 0$. Clearly $s_1(y), \dots, s_r(y)$ span $\mathcal{E}|_y$. Since $\mathcal{E}|_y$ has dimension r , $s_1(y), \dots, s_r(y)$ are linearly independent. So $f_1(y) = \dots = f_r(y) = 0$. Since this is true for any $y \in W$, we conclude that $f_1 = \dots = f_r = 0$. $\square$

Definition 1.8.3. A **connection** ∇ on $\mathcal{E}$ associates to each open subset $U \subset X$ a bilinear map

$$\nabla : \Theta_X(U) \times \mathcal{E}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(U), \quad (\mathfrak{x}, s) \mapsto \nabla_{\mathfrak{x}} s$$

satisfying the following conditions.

- (a) If V is an open subset of U , then $\nabla_{\mathfrak{x}|_V} s|_V = (\nabla_{\mathfrak{x}} s)|_V$.
- (b) If $f \in \mathcal{O}(U)$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_{f\mathfrak{x}} s &= f \nabla_{\mathfrak{x}} s, \\ \nabla_{\mathfrak{x}}(fs) &= \mathfrak{x}(f)s + f \nabla_{\mathfrak{x}} s. \end{aligned}$$

Lemma 1.8.4. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module equipped with a connection ∇ . Let $x \in X$ and $U \subset X$ a connected neighborhood of x . Choose $s_1, \dots, s_n \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ and assume that $s_1(x), \dots, s_n(x)$ form a basis of the fiber $\mathcal{E}|_x$. Then $s_1, \dots, s_n$ are $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -linear independent elements of $\mathcal{E}(U)$, i.e., if $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ satisfy $f_1 s_1 + \dots + f_n s_n = 0$, then $f_1 = \dots = f_n = 0$.

Proof. Assume U is open in $\mathbb{C}^m$ and $x = 0 \in \mathbb{C}^m$. Since $f_1(0)s_1(0) + \dots + f_n(0)s_n(0) = 0$ and $s_1(0), \dots, s_n(0)$ form a basis of $\mathcal{E}|_0$, we obtain $f_1(0) = \dots = f_n(0) = 0$.

Apply ∇_{∂_1} to $\sum_j f_j s_j = 0$ and take value at 0, we get $\sum_j \partial_1 f_j(0)s_j(0) + \sum_j f_j(0)(\nabla_{\partial_1} s_j)(0) = 0$, which shows $\partial_1 f_j(0) = 0$ for all j . Similarly, apply $\nabla_{\partial_1}, \dots, \nabla_{\partial_m}$ successively to $\sum_j f_j s_j = 0$ and take values at 0. Then an induction on $|k_{\bullet}| = k_1 + \dots + k_m$ shows that $\partial_1^{k_1} \dots \partial_m^{k_m} f_j(0) = 0$ for all $1 \leq j \leq n$ and $k_1, \dots, k_m \in \mathbb{N}$. This proves $f_1 = \dots = f_n = 0$ on U because U is connected. $\square$

Theorem 1.8.5. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module equipped with a connection ∇ . Assume that each $x \in X$ is contained in a neighborhood U such that the following conditions hold. Then $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free.

- (a) $\mathcal{E}|_U$ is equivalent to the cokernel of a homomorphism of (possibly infinite rank) free $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules, i.e., there exist cardinalities I, J and a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules $\varphi : \mathcal{O}_U^I \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_U^J$ such that $\mathcal{E}|_U \simeq \text{coker}(\varphi)$.

(b) Write $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{O}_U^I$ and $\mathcal{G} = \mathcal{O}_U^J$. Then $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$ is a finitely generated $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -module.

Note that $\varphi(\mathcal{F})$ is the image sheaf of φ , which is defined by sheafifying the collection $\{\varphi(\mathcal{F}(V))\}$ over all open subsets $V \subset U$. (So $\varphi(\mathcal{F}(V))$ is only a subset of $\varphi(\mathcal{F})(V)$.) $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$ is naturally an $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -submodule of $\text{coker}(\varphi)(U)$.

Also, if $s_1, \dots, s_n$ are generating elements of $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$, then for any open subset $V \subset U$, $s_1|_V, \dots, s_n|_V$ generate $\mathcal{G}(V)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(V)$. This is due to the obvious fact that sections of $\mathcal{G}(U)$, when restricted to V , generate the $\mathcal{O}(V)$ -module $\mathcal{G}(V)$. We will use this property in the following proof.

Proof. Since (the stalks of) $\text{coker}(\varphi)$ are generated by elements of $\mathcal{G}(U)$, it is clear that $\mathcal{E}$ is finite-type. Choose any $x \in X$. We shall show that the rank function $y \in X \mapsto r_y = \dim(\mathcal{E}|_y)$ is constant in a neighborhood U of x . Then $\mathcal{E}|_U$ is locally free by Theorem 1.8.2, which will finish the proof.

Choose a connected U as in the assumption of this theorem, and identify $\mathcal{E}|_U$ with the cokernel of φ . We may assume that U is small enough such that there exist $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ such that $\sigma_1(x), \dots, \sigma_r(x)$ form a basis of the fiber $\mathcal{E}|_x$. We may shrink U such that one can find $\hat{\sigma}_1, \dots, \hat{\sigma}_r \in \mathcal{G}(U)$ whose corresponding equivalence classes in $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$ (and hence in $\mathcal{E}(U)$) are $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$. Thus $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_n$ are in $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$. Suppose that $s_1, \dots, s_n$ are generating elements of $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$. By Proposition 1.8.1 (Nakayama's lemma), we may shrink U so that $s_1, \dots, s_n$ are $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -linear combinations of $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$. Therefore, the $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -module $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$ is generated by $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$, i.e., each element of $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -linear combination of $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$.

Since $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$ generate $\mathcal{E}|_U$, for each $y \in U$, we know that $\sigma_1(y), \dots, \sigma_r(y)$ span $\mathcal{E}|_y$. If we can show that $\sigma_1(y), \dots, \sigma_r(y)$ are linearly independent, then they form a basis of $\mathcal{E}|_y$, which implies that $r_y = r = r_x$. This will finish the proof. Choose any $c_1, \dots, c_r \in \mathbb{C}$ satisfying $c_1\sigma_1(y) + \dots + c_r\sigma_r(y) = 0$. Then the germ of $c_1\sigma_1 + \dots + c_r\sigma_r$ at y belongs to $\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{E}_y$. Thus, the germ of $c_1\hat{\sigma}_1 + \dots + c_r\hat{\sigma}_r$ at y belongs to $\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{G}_y + \varphi(\mathcal{F})_y$. (Note that $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ descends to $\mathcal{F}_y \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_y$ and furthermore to $\mathcal{F}|_y \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_y$; see (1.1.1) and (1.1.3).) This means precisely that $c_1\hat{\sigma}_1(y) + \dots + c_r\hat{\sigma}_r(y) \in \varphi(\mathcal{F}_y)/\mathfrak{m}_y\mathcal{G}_y = \varphi(\mathcal{F}|_y)$.

It is clear that each fiber of $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{O}_U^I$ is spanned by the values of all global sections. Thus, we can choose $\hat{t} \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ satisfying $c_1\hat{\sigma}_1(y) + \dots + c_r\hat{\sigma}_r(y) = \varphi(\hat{t}(y))$. Set $\hat{u} = c_1\hat{\sigma}_1 + \dots + c_r\hat{\sigma}_r - \varphi(\hat{t})$. Then $\hat{u}(y) = 0$. Regard $\hat{u}$ as a $\mathbb{C}^J$ -valued holomorphic function, and notice that its value at y is 0. If we let $\{\hat{e}_j\}_{j \in J}$ be the standard basis of $\mathbb{C}^J$, regarded as constant sections of $\mathcal{O}_U^J(U)$, then there exist a finite subset $\{\hat{e}_{j_1}, \dots, \hat{e}_{j_m}\}$ of $\{\hat{e}_j\}_{j \in J}$ and $f_1, \dots, f_m \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ satisfying $\hat{u} = f_1\hat{e}_{j_1} + \dots + f_m\hat{e}_{j_m}$, and that $f_1(y) = \dots = f_m(y) = 0$. Let $e_{j_1}, \dots, e_{j_m} \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ be the corresponding equivalence classes, which are clearly in $\mathcal{G}(U)/\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U)$. Then $c_1\sigma_1 + \dots + c_r\sigma_r = f_1e_{j_1} + \dots + f_me_{j_m}$. Since $e_{j_1}, \dots, e_{j_m}$ are $\mathcal{O}(U)$ -linear combinations of $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$, one can find $g_1, \dots, g_r \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ whose values at y are all 0, such that $c_1\sigma_1 + \dots + c_r\sigma_r =$

$g_1\sigma_1 + \cdots + g_r\sigma_r$. Let $h_1 = c_1 - g_1, \dots, h_r = c_r - g_r$. Then $h_1(y) = c_1, \dots, h_r(y) = c_r$, and $h_1\sigma_1 + \cdots + h_r\sigma_r = 0$. By Lemma 1.8.4, we have $h_1 = \cdots = h_r = 0$. Thus $c_1 = \cdots = c_r = 0$. $\square$

Corollary 1.8.6. *If $\mathcal{E}$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module equipped with a connection ∇ , then $\mathcal{E}$ is locally free.*

Chapter 2

Sheaves of VOAs

2.1 Vertex operator algebras

Let $\mathbb{V}$ be a complex vector space with grading $\mathbb{V} = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{V}(n)$ satisfying $\dim \mathbb{V}(n) < \infty$ for each n and $\dim \mathbb{V}(0) = 1$ (the **CFT type condition**)¹. We assume that there is a linear map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{V} &\rightarrow (\text{End } (\mathbb{V}))[[z^{\pm 1}]] \\ u &\mapsto Y(u, z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} Y(u)_n z^{-n-1} \end{aligned} \quad (2.1.1)$$

where each $Y(u)_n \in \text{End}(\mathbb{V})$ is called a **mode** of the operator $Y(u, z)$. Note that we have for any $u \in \mathbb{V}, n \in \mathbb{Z}$ that

$$\text{Res}_{z=0} Y(u, z) \cdot z^n dz = Y(u)_n. \quad (2.1.2)$$

Definition 2.1.1. We say that $(\mathbb{V}, Y)$ (or $\mathbb{V}$ for short) is a (positive energy) **vertex operator algebra** (VOA), if for any $u \in \mathbb{V}$ the following conditions are satisfied.

(a) (**Lower truncation**) For any $v \in \mathbb{V}$,

$$Y(u, z)v \in \mathbb{V}((z)).$$

(b) (**Jacobi identity**) For any $u, v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $m, n, h \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} &\sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} Y(Y(u)_{n+l} \cdot v)_{m+h-l} \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} (-1)^l \binom{n}{l} Y(u)_{m+n-l} Y(v)_{h+l} - \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} (-1)^{l+n} \binom{n}{l} Y(v)_{n+h-l} Y(u)_{m+l}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.1.3)$$

¹The only reason we assume $\dim \mathbb{V}(0) = 1$ is to apply Buhl's result in [Buhl02]; see Theorem 3.7.1.

- (c) There exists a vector $\mathbf{1} \in \mathbb{V}(0)$ (the **vacuum vector**) such that $Y(\mathbf{1}, z) = \mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{V}}$.
 (d) (**Creation property**) For any $v \in \mathbb{V}$, we have

$$Y(v, z)\mathbf{1} - v \in z\mathbb{V}[[z]].$$

This is equivalent to that $Y(v)_{-1}\mathbf{1} = v$ and $Y(v)_n\mathbf{1} = 0$ for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

- (e) There exists a vector $\mathbf{c} \in \mathbb{V}$ (the **conformal vector**) such that the operators $L_n := Y(\mathbf{c})_{n+1}$ ($n \in \mathbb{Z}$) satisfy the Virasoro relation:

$$[L_m, L_n] = (m - n)L_{m+n} + \frac{1}{12}(m^3 - m)\delta_{m, -n}c. \quad (2.1.4)$$

Here the number $c \in \mathbb{C}$ is called the **central charge** of V .

- (f) If $v \in \mathbb{V}(n)$ then $L_0v = nv$. n is called the **conformal weight** (or the **energy**) of v and will be denoted by $\text{wt}(v)$. L_0 is called the **energy operator**. We say that a vector $v \in \mathbb{V}$ is **homogeneous** if $v \in \mathbb{V}(n)$ for some $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

- (g) (L_{-1} -**derivative**) $\frac{d}{dz}Y(v, z) = Y(L_{-1}v, z)$ for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$.

Note that from the creation property, we have $\mathbf{c} = Y(\mathbf{c})_{-1}\mathbf{1} = L_{-2}\mathbf{1}$. Since $L_0\mathbf{1} = 0$, by the Virasoro relation, we have $L_0\mathbf{c} = L_0L_{-2}\mathbf{1} = L_{-2}L_0\mathbf{1} + 2L_{-2}\mathbf{1} = 2\mathbf{c}$. We conclude

$$\mathbf{c} \in \mathbb{V}(2).$$

We explain the meaning of Jacobi identity. Let $\mathbb{V}' = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{V}(n)^*$ where each $\mathbb{V}(n)^*$ is the dual vector space of $\mathbb{V}(n)$. Then $\mathbb{V}'$ is a subspace of the dual space $\mathbb{V}^*$ of $\mathbb{V}$. A vector $w' \in \mathbb{V}^*$ is inside $\mathbb{V}'$ if and only if there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\langle u, w' \rangle = 0$ whenever $u \in \mathbb{V}(n)$ and $n > N$. For each $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, the transpose $Y(v)_n^t$ of $Y(v)_n$ is a linear map on $\mathbb{V}^*$. We then define

$$Y(v, z)^t = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} Y(v)_n^t z^{-n-1} \quad \text{End}(\mathbb{V}^*)[[z]]$$

to be the transpose of $Y(v, z)$. Then $Y(v, z)^t dz = -\sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} Y(v)_m^t (z^{-1})^{m-1} d(z^{-1})$, which shows that for each $n \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\text{Res}_{z^{-1}=0} Y(v, z)^t \cdot z^n dz = -Y(v)_n^t. \quad (2.1.5)$$

We assume that the lower truncation property is satisfied, and that for any $v, w \in \mathbb{V}$, $w' \in \mathbb{V}'$,

$$Y(v, z)^t w' \in \mathbb{V}'((z^{-1})). \quad (2.1.6)$$

Then we have

$$\langle Y(v, z)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}[z, z^{-1}],$$

namely, $z \mapsto \langle Y(v, z)w, w' \rangle$ is a meromorphic function on $\mathbb{P}^1$ with poles possibly at $0, \infty$, namely, it is an element of $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(\bullet(0 + \infty)))$. We will see that if $\mathbb{V}$ is a VOA then these conditions hold automatically. Let $\mathbb{C}^\times = \mathbb{C} - \{0\}$. For each $z \in \mathbb{C}^\times$, $\langle Y(v, z)w, w' \rangle$ is a complex number. Choose any $u \in \mathbb{V}$, and let ζ be also a standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. Then $\zeta - z$ (where z is a fixed complex number) is the standard coordinate of a neighborhood of z . By lower truncation property and condition (2.1.6), we have

$$\langle Y(v, z)Y(u, \zeta)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta)), \quad (2.1.7)$$

$$\langle Y(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, z)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta - z)), \quad (2.1.8)$$

$$\langle Y(u, \zeta)Y(v, z)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta^{-1})). \quad (2.1.9)$$

Theorem 2.1.2. *Let $(\mathbb{V}, Y)$ satisfy the lower truncation property, and assume that for any $v, w \in \mathbb{V}, w' \in \mathbb{V}'$, condition (2.1.6) holds. Then the Jacobi identity is equivalent to the requirement that for any $u, v, w \in \mathbb{V}, w' \in \mathbb{V}', z \in \mathbb{C}^\times$, there exists $f \in H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(\bullet(0 + z + \infty)))$ whose Laurent series expansions near $0, z, \infty$ are (2.1.7), (2.1.8), and (2.1.9) respectively.*

Proof. We apply the strong residue Theorem 1.4.1 to the single 3-pointed Riemann sphere $(\mathbb{P}^1; 0, z, \infty)$ and the sheaf $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$. Then such f exists if and only if for any $\lambda \in H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \omega_{\mathbb{P}^1}(\bullet(0 + z + \infty)))$,

$$\text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} f_z \lambda = -\text{Res}_{\zeta^{-1}=0} f_\infty \lambda - \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} f_0 \lambda, \quad (2.1.10)$$

where f_0, f_z, f_∞ are defined by (2.1.7), (2.1.8), and (2.1.9) respectively. It is easy to see that $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \omega_{\mathbb{P}^1}(\bullet(0 + z + \infty)))$ is spanned by $\zeta^m(\zeta - z)^n d\zeta$ (where $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$). Thus, f exists if and only if (2.1.10) holds whenever $\lambda = \zeta^m(\zeta - z)^n d\zeta$. Assuming λ is defined like this. Then, using (2.1.2), we compute

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} f_z \lambda &= \text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} \langle Y(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, z)w, w' \rangle \zeta^m(\zeta - z)^n d(\zeta - z) \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} \langle Y(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, z)w, w' \rangle (\zeta - z)^{n+l} z^{m-l} d(\zeta - z) \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \langle Y(Y(u)_{n+l}v, z)w, w' \rangle z^{m-l}. \end{aligned}$$

Similar computations using (2.1.2) and (2.1.5) give the explicit expression of the two terms on the right hand side of (2.1.10), which show that (2.1.10) is equivalent to

$$\begin{aligned} &\sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \langle Y(Y(u)_{n+l}v, z)w, w' \rangle z^{m-l} \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^l \langle Y(u)_{m+n-l} Y(v, z)w, w' \rangle z^l \end{aligned}$$

$$- \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^{n-l} \langle Y(v, z) Y(u)_{m+l} w, w' \rangle z^{n-l}. \quad (2.1.11)$$

Note that by lower truncation property and condition (2.1.6), the three terms in the above equation are all finite sums. We conclude that the requirement in this theorem holds if and only if for any $u, v, w \in \mathbb{V}$ and $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, (2.1.11) holds where z is considered as a variable. This means that we are now considering (2.1.11) as an equation of elements in $\mathbb{C}[[z^{\pm 1}]]$. For each $h \in \mathbb{Z}$, apply $\text{Res}_{z=0}(\cdot)z^h dz$ to both sides of (2.1.11), we get precisely (2.1.3) evaluated between w and w' . Since w, w' are arbitrary, we see that our requirement is equivalent to the Jacobi identity. $\square$

From now on, we shall always assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is a VOA (of CFT type). From the Jacobi identity and the L_{-1} -derivative, one has for each n that

$$[L_0, Y(v)_n] = Y(L_0 v)_n - (n+1)Y(v)_n,$$

This shows that if $v, w \in \mathbb{V}$ are homogeneous, then $Y(v)_n w$ is also homogeneous with conformal weight $\text{wt}(v) + \text{wt}(w) - (n+1)$. Thus condition (2.1.6) follows easily. Note also that $[L_0, L_n] = -nL_n$ implies for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}, s \in \mathbb{C}$ that

$$L_n \mathbb{V}(s) = \mathbb{V}(s-n). \quad (2.1.12)$$

In particular, when $n \in \mathbb{Z}_+$, we have $L_n \mathbf{1} = 0$ since it is inside the trivial subspace $\mathbb{V}(-n)$.

Remark 2.1.3. When $n > 2$, we have $L_n \mathbf{c} = 0$ since $\mathbb{V}(2-n)$ is trivial. Using the fact that $\mathbf{c} = L_{-2} \mathbf{1}$, that $L_n \mathbf{1} = 0$ when $n \geq 0$, and the Virasoro relation (2.1.4), we compute $L_1 \mathbf{c} = L_1 L_{-2} \mathbf{1} = [L_1, L_{-2}] \mathbf{1} = 3L_{-1} \mathbf{1} = 0$ since $Y(L_{-1} \mathbf{1}, z) = \partial_z Y(\mathbf{1}, z) = \partial_z \mathbf{1} = 0$. Also, $L_2 \mathbf{c} = L_2 L_{-2} \mathbf{1} = [L_2, L_{-2}] \mathbf{1} = 4L_0 \mathbf{1} + \frac{c}{2} \mathbf{1} = \frac{c}{2} \mathbf{1}$ where c is the central charge. We conclude

$$L_0 \mathbf{c} = 2\mathbf{c} \quad L_1 \mathbf{c} = 0, \quad L_2 \mathbf{c} = \frac{c}{2} \mathbf{1}.$$

2.2 VOA modules

Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a vector space equipped with a linear map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{V} &\rightarrow (\text{End } \mathbb{W})[[z^{\pm 1}]] \\ u &\mapsto Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_n z^{-n-1}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.2.1)$$

Definition 2.2.1. We say that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_{\mathbb{W}})$ (or $\mathbb{W}$ for short) is a **weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module** if the lower truncation property holds, i.e., for any $u \in \mathbb{V}, w \in \mathbb{W}$, $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, z)w \in \mathbb{W}((z))$,

if $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{1}, z) = \mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{W}}$, and if for any $m, n, h \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $u, v \in \mathbb{V}$, the Jacobi identity (2.1.3) holds with Y replaced by $Y_{\mathbb{W}}$, i.e.,

$$\begin{aligned} & \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u)_{n+l} \cdot v)_{m+h-l} \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} (-1)^l \binom{n}{l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_{m+n-l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{h+l} - \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} (-1)^{l+n} \binom{n}{l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{n+h-l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_{m+l}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.2.2)$$

Homomorphism and endomorphisms of weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules are the linear maps commuting with the actions of vertex operators.

Set $n = 0$ in (2.2.2), we obtain the commutator formula

$$[Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_m, Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_h] = \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u)_l \cdot v)_{m+h-l}. \quad (2.2.3)$$

If $\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}_2$ are weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, we set $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{V}}(\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}_2)$ to be the space of homomorphisms from $\mathbb{W}_1$ to $\mathbb{W}_2$. We set $\text{End}_{\mathbb{V}}(\mathbb{W}) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{V}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{W})$.

For a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, we set $L_n = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c})_{n+1}$. Then the Virasoro relation (2.1.4) holds for the same central charge c . Moreover, the L_{-1} -derivative property holds:

$$\frac{d}{dz} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z) = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(L_{-1}v, z) \quad (2.2.4)$$

for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$. We refer the reader to [DLM97] for the proof. The L_{-1} -derivative property and the Jacobi identity implies

$$[L_0, Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n] = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(L_0v)_n - (n+1)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n, \quad (2.2.5)$$

for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Definition 2.2.2. A weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ is called an **admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module** if there exists $A \in \text{End}_{\mathbb{V}}(\mathbb{W})$ such that $\tilde{L}_0 := L_0 + A$ is diagonal (on $\mathbb{W}$), and that the eigenvalues of $\tilde{L}_0$ are natural numbers. If, moreover, each eigenspace of $\tilde{L}_0$ is finite-dimensional, we say that $\mathbb{W}$ is a **finitely admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module**.

Remark 2.2.3. According to (2.2.5), that $\mathbb{W}$ is admissible is equivalent to that there is a diagonalizable $\tilde{L}_0 \in \text{End}(\mathbb{W})$ with spectrum in $\mathbb{N}$ satisfying $[\tilde{L}_0, Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n] = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\tilde{L}_0v)_n - (n+1)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n$. Equivalently, $\mathbb{W}$ has grading $\mathbb{W} = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}(n)$ such that

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m \mathbb{W}(n) \subset \mathbb{W}(n + \text{wt}(v) - m - 1) \quad (2.2.6)$$

for any $m, n \in \mathbb{N}$ and homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}$. Indeed, $\mathbb{W}(n)$ is the n -eigenspace of $\tilde{L}_0$. Moreover, $\mathbb{W}$ is finitely admissible if and only if each $\mathbb{W}(n)$ is finite dimensional. We write $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) = n$ if $w \in \mathbb{W}(n)$, equivalently, $\tilde{L}_0 w = \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w)w$. We say that w is **$\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous** (with weight n) if w is an eigenvector of $\tilde{L}_0$ (with eigenvalue n).

Definition 2.2.4. We say that $\mathbb{W}$ is a **(grading-restricted ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module**, if $\mathbb{W}$ is a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module, if there exists a finite subset $E \subset \mathbb{C}$ such that $\mathbb{W}$ has grading $\mathbb{W} = \bigoplus_{s \in E + \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}_{(s)}$, and if for each $s \in \mathbb{C}$ we have $\dim \mathbb{W}_{(s)} < +\infty$ and $L_0|_{\mathbb{W}_{(s)}} = s1_{\mathbb{W}_{(s)}}$. A vector $w \in \mathbb{W}$ is called **homogeneous** if $w \in \mathbb{W}_{(s)}$ for some $s \in \mathbb{C}$. In this case, we write $\text{wt}(w) = s$ and call it the **(conformal) weight** of w .

Note that when v is homogeneous, (2.2.5) is equivalent to

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m \mathbb{W}_{(s)} \subset \mathbb{W}_{(s+\text{wt}(v)-m-1)}. \quad (2.2.7)$$

Remark 2.2.5. If $\mathbb{W}$ is a $\mathbb{V}$ -module, then $\mathbb{W}$ is finitely admissible. Indeed, one suffices to assume that any two elements in E do not differ by an integer. By (2.2.7), for each $\alpha \in E$, $\mathbb{W}_{\alpha+\mathbb{N}} := \bigoplus_{s \in \alpha+\mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}_{(s)}$ is a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$. Moreover, $\mathbb{W}$ is the direct sum of all such $\mathbb{W}_{\alpha+\mathbb{N}}$. One then defines $\tilde{L}_0$ whose action on each $\mathbb{W}_{\alpha+\mathbb{N}}$ is $L_0 - \alpha$. This makes $\mathbb{W}$ finitely admissible.

Note that $\mathbb{V}$ itself is a $\mathbb{V}$ -module, called the **vacuum $\mathbb{V}$ -module**. For a $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, we can give a similar interpretation of Jacobi identity as in Theorem 2.1.2. We leave the details to the reader.

For a $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, consider the dual vector space $\mathbb{W}^*$ and the graded dual $\mathbb{W}' := \bigoplus_{s \in \mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{(s)}^*$ where each $\mathbb{W}_{(s)}^*$ is the dual vector space of $\mathbb{W}_{(s)}$. Then $\mathbb{W}'$ is equipped with a natural $\mathbb{V}$ -module structure: the vertex operator $Y_{\mathbb{W}'}$ is defined such that for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$, $w \in \mathbb{W}$, $w' \in \mathbb{W}'$,

$$\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}'}(v, z)w', w \rangle = \langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}}(e^{zL_1}(-z^{-2})^{L_0}v, z^{-1})w \rangle. \quad (2.2.8)$$

Here, if v is homogeneous, then $(-z^{-2})^{L_0}v$ is understood as $(-z^{-2})^{\text{wt}(v)}v$. In general, $(-z^{-2})^{L_0}v$ is defined by linearity. We briefly write

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}'}(v, z) = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(e^{zL_1}(-z^{-2})^{L_0}v, z^{-1})^t. \quad (2.2.9)$$

The meaning of $e^{zL_1}(-z^{-2})^{L_0}$ will be explained in example 2.3.2. We call $\mathbb{W}'$ the **contragredient module** of $\mathbb{W}$. We have $\mathbb{W}'' = \mathbb{W}$. See [FHL93] chapter 5 for more details. When v is homogeneous, it is easy to check that for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}'}(v)_n = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{wt}(v)}}{m!} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(L_1^m v)_{-n-m-2+2\text{wt}(v)}^t. \quad (2.2.10)$$

As a consequence, we have

$$L_n^t = L_{-n}. \quad (2.2.11)$$

Let $\tilde{L}_0$ act on $\mathbb{W}'$ as the transpose of $\tilde{L}_0 \curvearrowright \mathbb{W}$, i.e., set for any $w \in \mathbb{W}$, $w' \in \mathbb{W}'$ that

$$\langle \tilde{L}_0 w, w' \rangle = \langle w, \tilde{L}_0 w' \rangle. \quad (2.2.12)$$

Then $\tilde{L}_0$ makes $\mathbb{W}'$ admissible. $\tilde{L}_0$ yields the grading $\mathbb{W}' = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}_{(n)}^*$. Thus $\mathbb{W}'$ is also finitely admissible under $\tilde{L}_0$.

Convention 2.2.6. For a $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, we always assume $\tilde{L}_0$ is chosen such that $\mathbb{W}$ is finitely admissible (see Remark 2.2.5). For its contragredient module $\mathbb{W}'$, we always assume that the actions of $\tilde{L}_0$ on $\mathbb{W}$ and on $\mathbb{W}'$ satisfy (2.2.12). If $\mathbb{W}$ is semi-simple, i.e., a finite direct sum of irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, except when $\mathbb{W} = \mathbb{V}$, we assume each irreducible submodule $\mathbb{M}$ of $\mathbb{W}$ is $\tilde{L}_0$ -invariant, and the lowest eigenvalue of $\tilde{L}_0|_{\mathbb{M}}$ (with non-trivial eigenspace) is 0. These assumptions are compatible. For the vacuum module $\mathbb{V}$, we set $\tilde{L}_0 = L_0$. Thus $\mathbb{V}(n) = \mathbb{V}_{(n)}$.

The following fact will be used later without explicit mentioning.

Proposition 2.2.7. *Let $\mathbb{W}$ be an irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -module, and let T be an endomorphism of $\mathbb{W}$. Then T is a scalar multiplication.*

In particular, if $\tilde{L}_0$ makes $\mathbb{W}$ admissible, then $\tilde{L}_0 - L_0$ is a scalar multiplication.

Proof. Choose any $s \in \mathbb{C}$ so that the L_0 -weight space $\mathbb{W}_{(s)}$ is nontrivial. Note that $\mathbb{W}_{(s)}$ is also finite-dimensional by the definition of ordinary modules. Since T commutes with L_0 , T preserves the eigenvalues of the eigenvectors of L_0 . So $T\mathbb{W}_{(s)} \subset \mathbb{W}_{(s)}$. Thus, we can find an eigenvalue λ of $T|_{\mathbb{W}_{(s)}}$. It follows that the kernel of $T - \lambda 1_{\mathbb{W}}$ is a nontrivial $\mathbb{V}$ -invariant subspace of $\mathbb{W}$, which must be $\mathbb{W}$. So $T = \lambda 1_{\mathbb{W}}$. $\square$

Definition 2.2.8. Let $\mathbb{V}_1, \mathbb{V}_2$ be VOAs. If $\mathbb{W}$ is a vector space which is both a weak $\mathbb{V}_1$ -module $(\mathbb{W}, Y_+)$ and a weak $\mathbb{V}_2$ -module $(\mathbb{W}, Y_-)$. We say that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_+, Y_-)$ is a weak $\mathbb{V}_1 \times \mathbb{V}_2$ -module if $[Y_+(u)_m, Y_-(v)_n] = 0$ for any $u \in \mathbb{V}_1, v \in \mathbb{V}_2, m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

2.3 Change of coordinates

We define a group $(\mathbb{G}, \circ)$ as follows. As a set $\mathbb{G}$ consists of all $\rho \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ such that $\rho(0) = 0$ and $\rho'(0) \neq 0$. If $\rho_1, \rho_2 \in \mathbb{G}$, then their multiplication is just the composition $\rho_1 \circ \rho_2$. We should understand elements in $\mathbb{G}$ as maps but not functions. $\mathbb{G}$ acts on $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ as $\rho \star f = f \circ \rho^{-1}$ if $\rho \in \mathbb{G}, f \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$. The Lie algebra $\text{Lie}(\mathbb{G})$ of $\mathbb{G}$ is spanned by $L_0, L_1, L_2, \dots$, where for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$L_n = z^{n+1} \partial_z, \quad (2.3.1)$$

whose action on each $f \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$, denoted by $L_n \star f$, is defined by

$$L_n \star f := -L_n f = -z^{n+1} \partial_z f. \quad (2.3.2)$$

The Lie bracket relation is defined using above relation, i.e., satisfying $[L_m, L_n] \star f = L_m \star L_n \star f - L_n \star L_m \star f$. It is the negative of the usual Lie bracket for vector fields. One easily checks that $[\cdot, \cdot]$ is compatible with the Virasoro relation (2.1.4).

Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Given any $\rho \in \mathbb{G}$, one can define $\mathcal{U}(\rho) \in \text{End}(\mathbb{V})$ as follows. Choose $c_0, c_1, c_2, \dots \in \mathbb{C}$ such that $c_0 \neq 0$, and

$$\rho = c_0^{L_0} \circ \exp \left(\sum_{n>0} c_n L_n \right) \quad (2.3.3)$$

when acting on any $f \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ by $\star$. Then

$$\mathcal{U}(\rho) = c_0^{\tilde{L}_0} \cdot \exp \left(\sum_{n>0} c_n L_n \right), \quad (2.3.4)$$

where the Virasoro operators $\tilde{L}_0, L_n$ are acting on $\mathbb{W}$. (The reason we use $\tilde{L}_0$ but not L_0 is that $c_0^{L_0}$ might not be single-valued on $\mathbb{W}$.)

Let z be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$, regarded as an element in $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$. It is the identity element of $\mathbb{G}$. Then, for any $f \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$, we have $\rho \star f = f \circ \rho^{-1} = f(\rho^{-1}(z)) = f(\rho \star z)$. We conclude

$$\rho \star f = f(\rho \star z), \quad (2.3.5)$$

which shows that the action of $\mathbb{G}$ on $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ is determined by its action on z . For example, since $z \partial_z z = z$ and hence $(z \partial_z)^n z = z$ for each n , we have

$$c_0^{-L_0} \star z = c_0^{z \partial_z} z = \exp(\log c_0 \cdot z \partial_z) z = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{1}{n!} (\log c_0)^n (z \partial_z)^n z = c_0 z.$$

Therefore, we conclude that

$$c_0^{-L_0} \star f = f(c_0 z). \quad (2.3.6)$$

We now give a more direct relation between ρ and the coefficients $c_0, c_1, c_2, \dots$ in (2.3.3). It is clear that $\rho(z)$, as an element in $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$, equals

$$\begin{aligned} \rho(z) &= z \circ \rho = \rho^{-1} \star z = \exp \left(- \sum_{n>0} c_n L_n \right) \star c_0^{-L_0} \star z \\ &= \exp \left(- \sum_{n>0} c_n L_n \right) \star (c_0 z) \stackrel{(2.3.5)}{=} c_0 \cdot \exp \left(- \sum_{n>0} c_n L_n \right) \star z, \end{aligned}$$

which, together with (2.3.2), shows that

$$\boxed{\rho(z) = c_0 \cdot \exp \left(\sum_{n>0} c_n z^{n+1} \partial_z \right) z} \quad (2.3.7)$$

One can use the above equation to completely determine the coefficients $c_0, c_1, \dots$. For instance, if we write

$$\rho(z) = a_1 z + a_2 z^2 + a_3 z^3 + \dots, \quad (2.3.8)$$

then one has

$$\begin{aligned} c_0 &= a_1, \\ c_1 c_0 &= a_2, \\ c_2 c_0 + c_1^2 c_0 &= a_3. \end{aligned}$$

In particular, one has $c_0 = \rho'(0)$. Thus (2.3.4) could be rewritten as

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}(\rho) = \rho'(0)^{\tilde{L}_0} \cdot \exp\left(\sum_{n>0} c_n L_n\right)} \quad (2.3.9)$$

Notice $a_n = \rho^{(n)}(0)/n!$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} c_0 &= \rho'(0), \\ c_1 &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{\rho''(0)}{\rho'(0)}, \\ c_2 &= \frac{1}{6} \frac{\rho'''(0)}{\rho'(0)} - \frac{1}{4} \left(\frac{\rho''(0)}{\rho'(0)} \right)^2. \end{aligned} \quad (2.3.10)$$

The following is (essentially) proved in [Hua97] section 4.2:

Theorem 2.3.1. *For each $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, $\mathcal{U}$ is a representation of $\mathbb{G}$ on $\mathbb{W}$. Namely, we have $\mathcal{U}(\rho_1 \circ \rho_2) = \mathcal{U}(\rho_1)\mathcal{U}(\rho_2)$ for each $\rho_1, \rho_2 \in \mathbb{G}$.*

Example 2.3.2. We have seen that

$$c_0^{z\partial_z} z = c_0 z. \quad (2.3.11)$$

We now calculate $\exp(c_1 z^2 \partial_z) z$. It is easy to see that $(c_1 z^2 \partial_z)^n z = n! c_1^n z^{n+1}$. Thus $\exp(c_1 z^2 \partial_z) z = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} c_1^n z^{n+1} = z/(1 - c_1 z)$. We conclude

$$\exp(c_1 z^2 \partial_z) z = \frac{z}{1 - c_1 z}. \quad (2.3.12)$$

Then it is easy to see that $\exp(c_1 z^2 \partial_z) c_0^{z\partial_z} z = c_0 z/(1 - c_0 c_1 z) = c_0^{z\partial_z} \exp(c_0 c_1 z^2 \partial_z) z$. We conclude

$$e^{c_1 L_1} c_0^{\tilde{L}_0} = c_0^{\tilde{L}_0} e^{c_0 c_1 L_1}. \quad (2.3.13)$$

Set

$$\boxed{\gamma_{\xi}(z) = \frac{1}{\xi + z} - \frac{1}{\xi}.} \quad (2.3.14)$$

Then the inverse of γ_ξ is $\gamma_{\xi^{-1}}$. By (2.3.11) and (2.3.12), it is easy to see that the following identity holds when acting on any $\mathbb{W}$:

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}(\gamma_\xi) = e^{\xi L_1}(-\xi^{-2})^{\tilde{L}_0}.} \quad (2.3.15)$$

Thus (2.2.9) could be rewritten as

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z) = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathcal{U}(\gamma_z)v, z^{-1})^t. \quad (2.3.16)$$

It is easy to see that $\gamma_\xi(\xi z) = \xi^{-1}\gamma_1(z)$. Therefore,

$$\mathcal{U}(\gamma_\xi)\xi^{\tilde{L}_0} = \xi^{-\tilde{L}_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1). \quad (2.3.17)$$

Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $\mathcal{U}(\rho)$ does not preserve the vector space $\mathbb{W}(n)$ (the n -eigenspace of $\tilde{L}_0$). However, $\mathbb{W}$ has filtration $\emptyset = \mathbb{W}^{\leq -1} \subset \mathbb{W}^{\leq 0} \subset \mathbb{W}^{\leq 1} \subset \mathbb{W}^{\leq 2} \subset \dots$, where

$$\mathbb{W}^{\leq n} = \bigoplus_{k \leq n} \mathbb{W}(k). \quad (2.3.18)$$

Then, by (2.2.6), $L_m \mathbb{W}^{\leq n} \subset \mathbb{W}^{\leq n-m}$ for any $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Thus, by (2.3.9), we conclude that $\mathcal{U}$ restricts to a representation of $\mathbb{G}$ on $\mathbb{W}^{\leq n}$. Moreover, if $w \in \mathbb{W}$ is $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous, then

$$\mathcal{U}(\rho)w = \rho'(0)^{\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w)}w \quad \text{mod} \quad \mathbb{W}^{\leq \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w)-1}. \quad (2.3.19)$$

In other words, the action of $\mathcal{U}(\rho)$ on $\mathbb{W}^{\leq n}/\mathbb{W}^{\leq n-1}$ is $\rho'(0)^n \mathbf{1}$.

Finally, we discuss holomorphic families of transformations. Let X be a complex manifold and $\rho : X \rightarrow \mathbb{G}, x \mapsto \rho_x$ a function. We say that ρ is a **holomorphic family** of transformations if for any $x \in X$, there exists an open subset $V \subset X$ containing x and an open $U \subset \mathbb{C}$ containing 0 such that $(z, y) \in U \times V \mapsto \rho_y(z)$ is a holomorphic function on $U \times V$. Then it is clear that the coefficients $a_1, a_2, \dots$ in (2.3.8) depend holomorphically on the parameter $x \in X$. Hence the same true for $c_0, c_1, c_2, \dots$. Thus, by the formula (2.3.9), for any $w \in \mathbb{W}^{\leq n}$, $x \in X \mapsto \mathcal{U}(\rho_x)w$ is a $\mathbb{W}^{\leq n}$ -valued holomorphic function on X . Thus $\mathcal{U}(\rho)$ can be regarded as an isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules

$$\mathcal{U}(\rho) : \mathbb{W}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_X \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{W}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_X \quad (2.3.20)$$

sending each constant function w to the section $x \mapsto \mathcal{U}(\rho_x)w$. Its inverse is $\mathcal{U}(\rho^{-1})$.

Convention 2.3.3. For any open subset $V \subset X$, any $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$ (resp. $w \in \mathbb{W}^{\leq n}$) is also understood as the constant section $v \otimes 1$ (resp. $w \otimes 1$) in $(\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_X)(V)$ (resp. $(\mathbb{W}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_X)(V)$).

The following lemma will be used in Section 2.6. We let $\tilde{L}_n$ be L_n if $n \neq 0$.

Lemma 2.3.4. *Let T be an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$ containing 0. Let $\rho : T \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$, $\zeta \mapsto \rho_\zeta$ be a holomorphic family of transformations satisfying $\rho_0(z) = z$. Then, for any $w \in \mathbb{W}$,*

$$\partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w \Big|_{\zeta=0} = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{1}{n!} \left(\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta^{(n)}(0) \Big|_{\zeta=0} \right) \tilde{L}_{n-1} \cdot w \quad (2.3.21)$$

where $\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta^{(n)}(z) = \partial_z^n \partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta(z) = \partial_\zeta \partial_z^n \rho_\zeta(z)$.

Note that when w is a (non-necessarily constant) section of $\mathbb{W} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_T$, one needs to take $\partial_\zeta w$ into account when calculating the left hand side of (2.3.21). Also, as the derivative of $w = \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta)^{-1} w$ is 0, we obtain

$$\partial_\zeta (\mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta)^{-1} w) \Big|_{\zeta=0} = - \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{1}{n!} \left(\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta^{(n)}(0) \Big|_{\zeta=0} \right) \tilde{L}_{n-1} \cdot w. \quad (2.3.22)$$

Proof. Let $c_1, c_2, \dots \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}(T)$ such that

$$\rho_\zeta(z) = \rho'_\zeta(0) \exp \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} c_n(\zeta) z^{n+1} \partial_z \right) (z).$$

Then $\rho_\zeta(z)$ equals

$$\rho'_\zeta(0) \left(z + \sum_{n \geq 1} c_n(\zeta) z^{n+1} \right)$$

plus some polynomials of z multiplied by at least two terms among $c_1(\zeta), c_2(\zeta), \dots$. Since $\rho_0(z) = z$, we have $\rho'_0(0) = 1$ and $c_1(0) = c_2(0) = \dots = 0$. Therefore,

$$\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta(z) \Big|_{\zeta=0} = \partial_\zeta \rho'_\zeta(0) z \Big|_{\zeta=0} + \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} \partial_\zeta c_n(0) z^{n+1} \right),$$

which implies that when $n \geq 2$,

$$\frac{1}{n!} \partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta^{(n)}(0) \Big|_{\zeta=0} = \partial_\zeta c_{n-1}(0).$$

Thus, using (2.3.9) and again $\rho'_0(0) = 1, c_1(0) = c_2(0) = \dots = 0$, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w \Big|_{\zeta=0} &= \partial_\zeta \left(\rho'_\zeta(0)^{\tilde{L}_0} \cdot \exp \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} c_n(\zeta) \tilde{L}_n \right) \right) w \Big|_{\zeta=0} \\ &= \partial_\zeta \rho'_\zeta(0) \tilde{L}_0 w \Big|_{\zeta=0} + \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} \partial_\zeta c_n(0) \tilde{L}_n w \right). \end{aligned}$$

Now equation (2.3.21) follows from the last two equations. $\square$

Remark 2.3.5. Let $A = L_0 - \tilde{L}_0$. Then using the fact that $\text{Res}_{z=0} z^n Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, z) = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c})_n = L_{n-1}$, we can write (2.3.21) and (2.3.22) in the following form:

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w \Big|_{\zeta=0} &= - \partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta^{-1}) w \Big|_{\zeta=0} \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta(z) Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, z) w dz \Big|_{\zeta=0} - \partial_\zeta \rho'_\zeta(0) A w \Big|_{\zeta=0}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.3.23)$$

2.4 Sheaves of VOAs on complex curves

Let C be a (non-necessarily compact) Riemann surface. Let U, V be open subsets of C , and $\eta : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \mu : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ univalent maps. Define a holomorphic family $\varrho(\eta|\mu) : U \cap V \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$ as follows. For any $p \in U \cap V$, $\eta - \eta(p)$ and $\mu - \mu(p)$ are local coordinates at p . We set $\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p \in \mathbb{G}$ satisfying

$$\eta - \eta(p) = \varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(\mu - \mu(p)). \quad (2.4.1)$$

Let $z \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ be the standard coordinate. Then, by composing both sides of (2.4.1) with $\mu^{-1}(z + \mu(p))$, we find the equivalent formula

$$\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(z) = \eta \circ \mu^{-1}(z + \mu(p)) - \eta(p), \quad (2.4.2)$$

which justifies that $\varrho(\eta|\mu)$ is analytic. It is also clear that if η_1, η_2, η_3 are three local coordinates, then on their common domain the following cocycle condition holds:

$$\varrho(\eta_3|\eta_1) = \varrho(\eta_3|\eta_2)\varrho(\eta_2|\eta_1). \quad (2.4.3)$$

Note that the linear map (2.2.1) can be extended to a homomorphism of $\mathbb{C}((z))$ -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{V}((z)) &\rightarrow (\text{End } \mathbb{W})[[z^{\pm 1}]] \\ u \otimes f \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}((z)) &\mapsto Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u \otimes f, z) = f(z)Y(u, z). \end{aligned} \quad (2.4.4)$$

Moreover, for any $w \in \mathbb{W}$ and $v \in \mathbb{V}((z))$, it is clear that $Y(v, z)w \in \mathbb{W}((z))$. The following theorem is one of the main results of [Hua97].

Theorem 2.4.1. *Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Let $U \subset \mathbb{C}$ be a neighborhood of 0. Let $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ be a local coordinate at 0, let $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}} \in \mathbb{G}$ be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$ (i.e. the identity element of $\mathbb{G}$), and let z be the standard complex variable of $\mathbb{C}$ (different from $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}}$). Then for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $w \in \mathbb{W}$, we have the following equation of elements in $\mathbb{W}((z))$:*

$$\mathcal{U}(\alpha)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)\mathcal{U}(\alpha)^{-1} \cdot w = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\alpha|\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}}))v, \alpha(z)) \cdot w. \quad (2.4.5)$$

Note that $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\alpha|\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}}))v$ is in $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(U)$ and hence can be regarded as an element of $\mathbb{V}((z))$. Of course, (2.4.5) also holds in an obvious way for any $v \in \mathbb{V}((z))$.

For instance, take $\alpha(z) = \lambda z$ where $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}^{\times}$. Then $\varrho(\alpha|\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}})$ is constantly λ . It follows that

$$\lambda^{\tilde{L}_0} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z) \lambda^{-\tilde{L}_0} = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\lambda^{L_0} v, \lambda z). \quad (2.4.6)$$

The **sheaf of VOA** associated to $\mathbb{V}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{V}_C$ defined by

$$\mathcal{V}_C = \varinjlim_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}, \quad (2.4.7)$$

where for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$ is a locally free sheaf of rank $\dim \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$ described as follows. For any open subset $U \subset C$ and a univalent $\eta : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, we have an isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta) : \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}|_U \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U. \quad (2.4.8)$$

These isomorphisms are defined in such a way that if $\mu : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is also univalent, then on $U \cap V$ we have

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))} \in \text{End}_{\mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}}(\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}). \quad (2.4.9)$$

From (2.3.19), we can compute that for any section v of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}$,

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \cdot v = (\partial_\mu \eta)^n \cdot v \quad \text{mod} \quad \mathbb{V}^{\leq n-1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}. \quad (2.4.10)$$

Now assume that C is a (compact and possibly nodal) complex curve. We define for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ a locally free sheaf $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$ as follows. ($\mathcal{V}_C$ is defined again using (2.4.7).) Let $\Sigma = \{x'_1, x'_2, \dots, x'_M\}$ be the set of nodes, and let $C_0 = C - \Sigma$. Then $\mathcal{V}_{C_0}^{\leq n}$ is defined as above. Let U be an open subset of C containing only one of Σ , say x'_j . Let $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$ be the normalization of C as in Section 1.5, and let $\{y'_j, y''_j\} = \nu^{-1}(x'_j)$. Then $\nu^{-1}(U)$ is a disjoint union of two open subsets $V' \ni y'_j, V'' \ni y''_j$ of $\tilde{C}$. We assume that U is small enough such that there exit local coordinates $\xi_j : V' \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ and $\varpi_j : V'' \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ at y'_j and y''_j respectively. This means that ξ_j, ϖ_j are univalent, and $\xi_j(y') = \varpi_j(y'') = 0$. We also identify

$$U - \{x'_j\} \simeq (V' - \{y'_j\}) \sqcup (V'' - \{y''_j\}) \quad (2.4.11)$$

via ν . Now, let $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}(U)$ be the $\mathcal{O}_C(U)$ -submodule of $\mathcal{V}_{C_0}^{\leq n}(U - \{x'_j\})$ generated by

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi_j)^{-1}(\xi_j^{L_0} v) + \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi_j)^{-1}(\varpi_j^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v)} \quad (\forall v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}), \quad (2.4.12)$$

where we recall from example 2.3.2 that $\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) = e^{L_1}(-1)^{L_0}$. To be more precise, (2.4.7) is a section on $(V' - \{y'_j\}) \sqcup (V'' - \{y''_j\})$ which equals $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi_j)^{-1}(\xi_j^{L_0} v)$ on $(V' - \{y'_j\})$ and $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi_j)^{-1}(\varpi_j^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v)$ on V'' . Also, $\xi_j^{L_0}$ is an element of $\mathcal{O}_{C_0}(V' - \{y'_j\})$ acting on the constant section $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{C_0}(V' - \{y'_j\})$, and $\varpi_j^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v$ is understood in a similar way. It is easy to see that $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}(U)$ is generated freely by

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi_j)^{-1}(\xi_j^{\text{wt}(v)} v) + \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi_j)^{-1}((-\varpi_j)^{\text{wt}(v)} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v) \quad (2.4.13)$$

for all $v \in E$ where E is any basis of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$ whose elements are homogenous. Since $\gamma_1 = \gamma_1^{-1}$, $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}(U)$ is also generated freely by

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi_j)^{-1}(\xi_j^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v) + \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi_j)^{-1}(\varpi_j^{L_0} v)$$

for all $v \in E$. By the gluing construction, we obtain the locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$.

Proposition 2.4.2. *Let C be a complex curve and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then we have the following isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C$ -modules:*

$$\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} / \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n-1} \simeq \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_C^{\otimes n}. \quad (2.4.14)$$

Under this isomorphism, if $U \subset C$ is open and smooth, and $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ is univalent, then for any $v \in \mathbb{V}(n)$, $v \otimes \partial_\eta^n$ is identified with the equivalence class of $\mathcal{U}_\eta(\eta)^{-1}v$.

Proof. Recall that Σ is the set of nodes. By the transition function (2.4.10), we obtain a surjective $\mathcal{O}_{C-\Sigma}$ -module morphism $\Psi : \mathcal{V}_{C-\Sigma}^{\leq n} \rightarrow \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes \Theta_{C \setminus \{x\}}^{\otimes n}$ sending $\mathcal{U}_\eta(\eta)^{-1}v$ to $v \otimes \partial_\eta^n$ if $v \in \mathbb{V}(n)$, and to 0 if $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n-1}$. Ψ has kernel $\mathcal{V}_{C-\Sigma}^{\leq n-1}$. Now let U be a neighborhood of x'_j as in the setting of (2.4.12). Then Ψ sends (2.4.12) to $v \otimes \xi_j^n \partial_{\xi_j}^n|_{V'-\{y'\}} + v \otimes (-\varpi_j)^n \partial_{\varpi_j}^n|_{V''-\{y''\}}$ whenever $v \in \mathbb{V}(n) \cap E$. (Recall that E is a homogeneous basis of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$.) From this and (1.5.1) we see that Ψ restricts to a surjective $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module morphism $\Psi : \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \rightarrow \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes \Theta_C^{\otimes n}$ and that $\text{Ker} \Psi(U)$ is $\mathcal{O}_C(U)$ -generated by (2.4.12) for all $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n-1} \cap E$. Thus Ψ descends to an isomorphism (2.4.14). $\square$

As a consequence, we now prove a vanishing theorem for the sheaf of VOA.

Theorem 2.4.3. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ be an N -pointed complex curve with M nodes. Let $\tilde{C}$ be the normalization of C , and let $\tilde{g}$ be the largest genus of the connected components of $\tilde{C}$. Then for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{Z}$ depending only on $n, \tilde{g}, M$ such that*

$$H^1(C, \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_C(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0 \quad (2.4.15)$$

for any $k > k_0$.

Recall that the divisor $S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ is defined by $x_1 + \dots + x_N$. Also, by our definition of pointed complex curves, each connected component of $\tilde{C}$ contains at least one of (the pre-image of) $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Recall also that the dualizing sheaf ω_C is the inverse of Θ_C .

We will see from the proof that k_0 can be chosen to be $n|2\tilde{g} - 2| + 2M$. Note that by Proposition 1.5.4, one can always find $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that (2.4.15) holds for any $k > k_0$. The importance of the present theorem is, however, that we may find k_0 which is independent of the complex structure of C .

Proof. $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq -1}$ is trivial since $\mathbb{V}^{\leq -1}$ is so. Since the vacuum vector $\mathbf{1}$ is killed by $L_0, L_1, L_2, \dots$, it is fixed by the action of $\mathbb{G}$. From this and the fact that $\mathbb{V}(0)$ is spanned by $\mathbf{1}$, it is clear that

$$\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq 0} / \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq -1} \simeq \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq 0} \simeq \mathcal{O}_C. \quad (2.4.16)$$

Thus, by Theorem 1.5.7, the vanishing property (2.4.15) holds for any $k > 2M$.

We now prove the theorem by induction. By Proposition 2.4.2, there is a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n-1} \otimes \omega_C(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_C(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_C^{\otimes(n-1)}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow 0,$$

which induces a long exact sequence

$$\begin{aligned} H^1(C, \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n-1} \otimes \omega_C(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) &\rightarrow H^1(C, \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_C(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \\ &\rightarrow H^1(C, \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_C^{\otimes(n-1)}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})). \end{aligned} \quad (2.4.17)$$

Suppose the statement in our theorem is true for $n-1$ and any $k > (n-1)|2\tilde{g}-2| + 2M$. Then, by induction and Theorem 1.5.7, the first and the last terms of (2.4.17) equal 0 for any $k > n|2\tilde{g}-2| + 2M$. So the same is true for the middle term. $\square$

Remark 2.4.4. Let D be an effective divisor on C . Using the same argument, one can show that Theorem 2.4.3 holds verbatim if $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$ is replaced by $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}(-D)$, except that k_0 should now also depend on $\deg D$.

2.5 Sheaves of VOAs on families of complex curves

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ be a family of complex curves. Recall that Σ is the critical locus. Let U, V be open subsets of $\mathcal{C} - \Sigma$, and let $\eta : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \mu : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be holomorphic functions such that (η, π) and (μ, π) are biholomorphic maps from U resp. V to open subsets of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$. This requirement is equivalent to that η and μ are univalent on each fiber of U and V respectively. For each $p \in U \cap V$, we define $\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C},0}$ by

$$\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(z) = \eta \circ (\mu, \pi)^{-1}(z + \mu(p), \pi(p)) - \eta(p). \quad (2.5.1)$$

Then $\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p$ is a holomorphic function of z on $\mu((U \cap V)_{\pi(p)})$ where $(U \cap V)_{\pi(p)}$ is the fiber $U \cap V \cap \pi^{-1}(\pi(p))$. It is easy to check that for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\partial_z^n \varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(0) = \partial_\mu^n \eta(p), \quad (2.5.2)$$

where the partial derivative ∂_μ is defined to be vertical to $d\pi$. From this, we see that $\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(0) = 0$ and $\partial_z \varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(0) \neq 0$. So $\varrho(\eta|\mu)_p$ is an element of $\mathbb{G}$. We thus obtain a family of transformations $\varrho(\eta|\mu) : U \cap V \rightarrow \mathbb{G}, p \mapsto \varrho(\eta|\mu)_p$, which is clearly holomorphic.

As in Section 2.4, $\varrho(\eta|\mu)$ is also described by

$$\eta - \eta(p)|_{(U \cap V)_{\pi(p)}} = \varrho(\eta|\mu)_p(\mu - \mu(p)|_{(U \cap V)_{\pi(p)}}). \quad (2.5.3)$$

To see this, one composes both sides of (2.5.3) with $(\mu, \pi)^{-1}(z + \mu(p), \pi(p))$. This relation shows that, if for $j = 1, 2, 3$ we have $\eta_j \in \mathcal{O}(U_j)$ which is univalent on each fiber of U_j , then on $U_1 \cap U_2 \cap U_3$ we have

$$\varrho(\eta_3|\eta_1) = \varrho(\eta_3|\eta_2)\varrho(\eta_2|\eta_1). \quad (2.5.4)$$

Definition of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$

We set

$$\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} = \varinjlim_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}, \quad (2.5.5)$$

where for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module defined as follows. Suppose that U is an open subset of $\mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ and $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ is univalent on each fiber of U . Then we have an isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_U \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U. \quad (2.5.6)$$

These isomorphisms are defined in such a way that if V is another open subset of $\mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ and $\mu \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(V)$ is also univalent on each fiber, then on $U \cap V$ we have

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu)^{-1} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))} \in \text{End}_{\mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}}(\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}). \quad (2.5.7)$$

Recall that $\varrho(\mu|\eta)$ is a family of transformations on $U \cap V$, and $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu|\eta))$ is defined as by (2.3.20). Thus, we can define $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{\mathcal{C}-\Sigma}$ by gluing. Note that by (2.3.19) and (2.5.2), we can compute that for any section v of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}$,

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu)^{-1} \cdot v = (\partial_{\mu}\eta)^n \cdot v \quad \text{mod } \mathbb{V}^{\leq n-1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U \cap V}. \quad (2.5.8)$$

To define $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}$ near Σ , let $x' \in \Sigma$, and assume that near the fiber $\mathcal{C}_{\pi(x')}$, the family $\mathfrak{X}$ is obtained via sewing a family $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ of Riemann surfaces with local coordinates as in Section 1.6. Then, by (1.6.8) and (1.6.15), one can identify a neighborhood W_j of x' as $\mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}\rho_{\bullet} \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ such that, by setting $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}\rho_{\bullet} \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$, the projection $\pi|_{W_j}$ equals

$$\pi : W_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j \xrightarrow{\pi_{r_j, \rho_j} \times 1} \mathcal{D}_{r_j \rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j. \quad (2.5.9)$$

We thus have

$$\begin{aligned} W_j &= \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j, \\ W_j \cap \Sigma &= (0, 0) \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j. \end{aligned} \quad (2.5.10)$$

As in (1.6.10) and (1.6.11), we have open subsets of W_j :

$$W'_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_j}^{\times} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j, \quad W''_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}^{\times} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j.$$

Then it is clear that

$$W_j - \Sigma = W'_j \cup W''_j.$$

Let ξ_j, ϖ_j be the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_{r_j}, \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}$, and extend them constantly to $W_j \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r_j}, W_j \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}$ respectively. Then (ξ_j, π) and (ϖ_j, π) are holomorphic open embeddings of W'_j, W''_j respectively; equivalently, ξ_j, ϖ_j are univalent on each fiber of W'_j and W''_j respectively.

We shall define $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{W_j}$ to be an $\mathcal{O}_{W_j}$ -submodule of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{W_j - \Sigma}$ generated (freely) by some sections on W_j whose restrictions to W'_j and W''_j are described under the trivializations $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi_j)$ and $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\varpi_j)$ respectively. For that purpose, we need to first calculate the transition function

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\varpi_j)\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi_j)^{-1} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)) : \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'_j \cap W''_j} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'_j \cap W''_j}.$$

Set $q_j = \pi_{r_j, \rho_j} = \xi_j \varpi_j$.

Lemma 2.5.1. *Choose any $p \in W'_j \cap W''_j$. Then we have*

$$\varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)_p(z) = q_j(p)\gamma_{\xi_j(p)}(z)$$

and hence

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)_p) = q_j(p)^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_{\xi_j(p)}).$$

Proof. Choose any $x \in (W'_j \cap W''_j)_{\pi(p)}$. Then $\pi(x) = \pi(p)$ and hence $q_j(x) = q_j(p)$. Since $\varpi_j = \xi_j^{-1}q_j$, we have

$$\varpi_j(x) - \varpi_j(p) = q_j(p)(\xi_j(x)^{-1} - \xi_j(p)^{-1}).$$

By (2.5.3), we have

$$\varpi_j(x) - \varpi_j(p) = \varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)_p(\xi_j(x) - \xi_j(p)).$$

If we compare these two equations and set $z = \xi_j(x) - \xi_j(p)$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)_p(z) &= \varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j)_p(\xi_j(x) - \xi_j(p)) = q_j(p)(\xi_j(x)^{-1} - \xi_j(p)^{-1}) \\ &= q_j(p)((\xi_j(p) + z)^{-1} - \xi_j(p)^{-1}) = q_j(p)\gamma_{\xi_j(p)}(z). \end{aligned}$$

□

We define $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{W_j}$ to be the $\mathcal{O}_{W_j}$ -submodule of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{W_j - \Sigma}$ generated by any section on $W_j - \Sigma$ whose restrictions to W'_j and W''_j are

$$\boxed{\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi_j)^{-1}(\xi_j^{L_0}v) \quad \text{resp.} \quad \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\varpi_j)^{-1}(\varpi_j^{L_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)v)} \quad (2.5.11)$$

where $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. Since $\gamma_1 = \gamma_1^{-1}$ and hence $\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) = \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)^{-1}$, this definition is symmetric with respect to ξ_j and ϖ_j . To check that (2.5.11) is well-defined, we need:

Lemma 2.5.2. *The two sections defined in (2.5.11) agree on $W'_j \cap W''_j$.*

Proof. Using (2.3.17) and Lemma 2.5.1, we check that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi_j)\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi_j)^{-1}\xi_j^{L_0}v &= \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\varpi_j|\xi_j))\xi_j^{L_0}v = q_j^{L_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_{\xi_j})\xi_j^{L_0}v \\ &= q_j^{L_0}\xi_j^{-L_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)v = \varpi_j^{L_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)v. \end{aligned}$$

□

It is easy to see that, if we take $v \in E$ where E is a basis of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$ consisting of homogeneous vectors, then $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{W_j}$ is generated freely by sections defined by (2.5.11) for all $v \in E$. Thus, by the gluing construction, we obtain a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -module $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}$.

Remark 2.5.3. Since the vacuum vector $\mathbf{1}$ is annihilated by L_n ($n \geq 0$), we see that $\mathbf{1}$ is fixed by any transition function $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))$. Thus, we can define unambiguously an element $\mathbf{1} \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathcal{C} - \Sigma)$ (the **vacuum section**) such that for any open $U \subset \mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ and any $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ univalent on each fiber, $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)\mathbf{1}$ is the vacuum vector $\mathbf{1}$ (considered as a constant function). Also, by (2.5.11), it is clear that

$$\mathbf{1} \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathcal{C}).$$

Restriction to fibers

As in Section 2.4, we may use (2.5.8), (2.5.11), and (1.6.24) to show:

Proposition 2.5.4. *For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have the following isomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules:*

$$\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}/\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n-1} \simeq \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}. \quad (2.5.12)$$

Under this isomorphism, if $U \subset \mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ is open and smooth, and $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ is univalent on each fiber of U , then for any $v \in \mathbb{V}(n)$, $v \otimes \partial_\eta^n$ is identified with the equivalence class of $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1}v$.

By comparing the transition functions and looking at the generating sections near the nodes, it is easy to see:

Proposition 2.5.5. *For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $b \in \mathcal{B}$, we have a natural isomorphism*

$$\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}|_{\mathcal{C}_b} \simeq \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n}. \quad (2.5.13)$$

The following theorem is a generalization of Theorem 1.6.5.

Theorem 2.5.6. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $k \geq k_0$, the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ is locally free, and for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ there is a natural isomorphism of vector spaces*

$$\frac{\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b}{\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b} \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \quad (2.5.14)$$

defined by restriction of sections. In particular, $\dim H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ is locally constant over b .

Proof. Recall that by Ehresmann's result, if $\mathfrak{X}$ is smooth, then by our assumption in Section 1.3, $\mathcal{B}$ has finitely many connected components, and all the fibers over a connected component are diffeomorphic. Thus, by theorems 1.5.1 and 2.4.3 and Remark 1.6.3, for sufficiently large k , $H^r(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ vanishes for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and $r \geq 1$. Since the restriction of $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ to $\mathcal{C}_b$ is $\omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}$, by Proposition 2.5.5, the restriction of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ to $\mathcal{C}_b$ is equivalent to $\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))$. Thus, our theorem follows easily from Grauert's Theorem 1.6.2. $\square$

Corollary 2.5.7. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves, and let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then for any Stein open subset V of $\mathcal{B}$, there is $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any integer $k \geq k_0$ and any $b \in V$, the elements of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V)$ (more precisely, their germs at b) generate the stalk $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b$, and their restrictions to $\mathcal{C}_b$ form the vector space $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 2.5.6 and Cartan's theorem A (see Section 1.5). $\square$

As a variant (and easy consequence) of the above corollary, we have:

Corollary 2.5.8. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves. Then for any Stein open subset V of $\mathcal{B}$ and any $b \in V$, the elements of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V)$ (more precisely, their germs at b) generate the stalk $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b$, and their restrictions to $\mathcal{C}_b$ form the vector space $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$.*

The subsheaf $\mathcal{V}ir_c$

We now define an important $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -submodule $\mathcal{V}ir_c$ of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq 2}$ related to the conformal vector $\mathbf{c} \in \mathbb{V}(2)$. If U is an open subset of $\mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ equipped with a holomorphic $\eta : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ univalent on each fiber, then $\mathcal{V}ir_c|_U$ is the $\mathcal{O}_U$ -submodule of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_U$ generated (freely) by $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)^{-1}\mathbf{c}$ and the vacuum section $\mathbf{1}$, which is locally free of rank 2. This definition is independent of the choice of η . Indeed, if $\mu : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is also univalent on each fiber, then $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu)\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)^{-1}\mathbf{c} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu|\eta))\mathbf{c}$, which can be calculated using the actions of L_n ($n \geq 0$) on $\mathbf{c}$, is an $\mathcal{O}_U$ -linear combination of $\mathbf{c}$ and $\mathbf{1}$ by

Remark 2.1.3. Thus, by gluing all such U , we get $\mathcal{V}ir_c|_{\mathcal{C}-\Sigma}$. Now assume that U is a small neighborhood of a point of Σ . We let $\mathcal{V}ir_c|_U$ be the submodule generated by the sections described in (2.5.11), in which we set v to be $\mathbf{c}$ and $\mathbf{1}$. This completes the definition of the $\mathcal{O}_C$ -submodule $\mathcal{V}ir_c$. Note that the action of $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu|\eta))$ and $\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)$ on $\mathbf{c}$ and $\mathbf{1}$ depends only on the central charge c since this is true for L_n ($n \geq 0$) by Remark 2.1.3. Thus, the $\mathcal{O}_C$ -module $\mathcal{V}ir_c$ depends only on the number c but not on $\mathbb{V}$ or $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$.

By Proposition 2.5.4, we have a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq 1} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq 2} \xrightarrow{\lambda} \mathbb{V}(2) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2} \rightarrow 0$$

where λ is described locally (outside Σ) by sending $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}^{-1}(\eta)v$ (where $v \in \mathbb{V}(2)$) to $v \cdot \partial_{\eta}^2$ and sending the submodule $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq 1}$ to 0. Using this description of λ , it is easy to see that the restriction of λ to the subsheaf $\mathcal{V}ir_c$ has image $\mathbf{c} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2} \simeq \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}$, and that its kernel is $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq 0} = \mathbf{1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_C \simeq \mathcal{O}_C$. Thus, we obtain an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_C \rightarrow \mathcal{V}ir_c \xrightarrow{\lambda} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2} \rightarrow 0. \quad (2.5.15)$$

If we choose $U \subset \mathcal{C} - \Sigma$ and $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ holomorphic on each fiber, then

$$\lambda : \quad \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)^{-1}\mathbf{c} \mapsto \partial_{\eta}^2, \quad \mathbf{1} \mapsto 0.$$

By tensoring with $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$, we get an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\lambda} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow 0 \quad (2.5.16)$$

whose local expression outside Σ is

$$\lambda : \quad \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)^{-1}\mathbf{c} \, d\eta \mapsto \partial_{\eta}, \quad \mathbf{1} \, d\eta \mapsto 0. \quad (2.5.17)$$

2.6 Lie derivatives

Fix a family of compact Riemann surfaces $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$. From Proposition 2.5.4, we see that the sheaf of VOA $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$ can be viewed as a twisted version of a direct sum of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}$. It is well known that Lie derivatives can be defined for sections of $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}$ (whose restriction to $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ is given by the usual Lie bracket of vector fields). In this section, we define Lie derivatives for sections of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$. The results of this section can be generalized easily to sections of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_{\mathcal{C}-\Sigma}$ when $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of complex curves.

Let $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$ be a biholomorphic map where U, V are open subsets of $\mathcal{C}$ and $\varphi(U) = V$. We assume that φ preserves fibers, i.e. $\varphi(U_{\pi(p)}) = V_{\pi \circ \varphi(p)}$ for each $p \in U$. Then we have an equivalence

$$\varphi_* : \mathcal{O}_U \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_V, \quad f \mapsto f \circ \varphi^{-1},$$

which makes each $\mathcal{O}_V$ -module also an $\mathcal{O}_U$ -module. φ_* can be extended to

$$\varphi_* : \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V, \quad v \mapsto v \circ \varphi^{-1}.$$

Choose any $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ univalent on each fiber. Then we have a similar equivalence $(\eta, \pi)_* : \mathcal{O}_V \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{O}_{(\eta, \pi)(V)}$. Recall $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_V \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$. Define an isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_U &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_V, \\ \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta) \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi) &= \varphi_* \cdot \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta \circ \varphi), \end{aligned} \tag{2.6.1}$$

noting that $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta \circ \varphi) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_U \rightarrow \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U$.

The definition of $\mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi)$ is independent of the choice of η . Indeed, if $\mu \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ is also univalent on each fiber, then, using (2.5.3), it is not hard to show

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta \circ \varphi | \mu \circ \varphi)) = \varphi_*^{-1} \cdot \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta | \mu)) \cdot \varphi_*,$$

and hence equivalently that

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta \circ \varphi) \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu \circ \varphi)^{-1} = \varphi_*^{-1} \cdot \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta) \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu)^{-1} \cdot \varphi_*, \tag{2.6.2}$$

The independence follows easily from the above relation and (2.6.1). Moreover, using the definition (2.6.1), it is also not hard to show

$$\mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\psi \circ \varphi) = \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\psi) \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi) \tag{2.6.3}$$

where $\psi : V \rightarrow W$ is another such fiber-preserving biholomorphic map. In particular, we have $\mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi^{-1}) = \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\varphi)^{-1}$.

Let now W be an open subset of $\mathcal{C}$, and let V be a precompact open subset of W whose closure is also in W . Note that since π is (clearly) an open map, $\pi(W)$ is open. Recall the short exact sequence (1.3.5):

$$0 \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}} \xrightarrow{d\pi} \pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow 0.$$

Let $\mathfrak{x} \in \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(W)$ such that $d\pi(\mathfrak{x})$ equals $\pi^*(\mathfrak{y})$ for some $\mathfrak{y} \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(\pi(W))$. In other words, $\mathfrak{x}$ is a vector field on W whose projection to $\mathcal{B}$ depends only on the points of $\mathcal{B}$. Suppose that W is small enough so that we can choose $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(W)$ univalent on fibers, and choose coordinates $\tau_{\bullet} = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_m)$ of $\pi(W)$. Denote $\tau_{\bullet} \circ \pi$ also by $\tau_{\bullet}$ for simplicity. Then $(\eta, \tau_{\bullet}) : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \times \mathbb{C}^m$ is a coordinate of V , and $\mathfrak{x}$ takes the form

$$\mathfrak{x} = h(\eta, \tau_{\bullet}) \partial_{\eta} + \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_{\bullet}) \partial_{\tau_j} \tag{2.6.4}$$

for some holomorphic functions h on $(\eta, \tau_\bullet)(W)$ and $g_1, \dots, g_m$ on $\tau_\bullet(W)$. Choose $\varphi^\mathfrak{r} \in \mathcal{O}_{T \times V}(T \times V)$, $(\zeta, p) \mapsto \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(p)$, where T is an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$ containing 0, and the following conditions are satisfied for any $p \in V$:

$$\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_0(p) = p. \quad (2.6.5)$$

$$\partial_\zeta \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(p)|_{\zeta=0} = \mathfrak{r}(p). \quad (2.6.6)$$

The second condition is equivalent to that for any (local) section f of $\mathcal{O}_V$,

$$\partial_\zeta (f \circ \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)|_{\zeta=0} = \mathfrak{r}f. \quad (2.6.7)$$

The first condition implies that $\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_0)$ is the identity map on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_V$.

Definition 2.6.1. For any $v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}(W)$ and $\mathfrak{r}$ as above, we define $\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{r}}v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}(W)$ as follows. Choose any $V \subset W$ whose closure is compact and contained in W , and choose $\varphi^\mathfrak{r}$ as above. Then

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{r}}v|_V = \lim_{\zeta \rightarrow 0} \frac{\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)^{-1}(v|_{\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(V)}) - v|_V}{\zeta}. \quad (2.6.8)$$

We now give an explicit formula of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{r}}v$, which shows in particular that the above definition is independent of the choice of $\varphi^\mathfrak{r}$ satisfying (2.6.5) and (2.6.6). If u is a section of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_W$, we say that a section of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}|_W$ equals u in the η -coordinate if this section is $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1}u$.

Theorem 2.6.2. Suppose that $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(W)$ is univalent on each fiber of W , $\mathfrak{r}$ takes the form (2.6.4), and $v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}^{\leq n}(W)$ equals $u \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W)$ in the η -coordinate. Then in the η -coordinate, $\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{r}}v$ equals

$$h(\eta, \tau_\bullet) \partial_\eta u + \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} u - \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_\eta^k h(\eta, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} u. \quad (2.6.9)$$

Proof. Choose $V, \varphi^\mathfrak{r}$ as above. We have $v = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1}u$. Then, in the η -coordinate, $\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)^{-1}(v|_{\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(V)})$ equals

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta) \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)^{-1}(v|_{\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(V)}) = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta) \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)^{-1} \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1}(u|_{\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(V)}),$$

which by (2.6.1) equals

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta) \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta \circ \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)^{-1} (\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)_*^{-1} (u|_{\varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta(V)}) \\ &= \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|_{\eta \circ \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta})) (u \circ \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta)|_V \end{aligned}$$

It is easy to see that the derivative over ζ of the above expression at $\zeta = 0$ equals (2.6.9). Indeed, the first two terms of (2.6.9) come from the derivative of $u \circ \varphi^\mathfrak{r}_\zeta$.

The last term comes from the derivative of $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau|\eta)^{-1})$. Identify V with $(\eta, \tau_\bullet)(V) \subset \mathbb{C} \times \mathbb{C}^m$ via $(\eta, \tau_\bullet)$. Then by (2.5.1),

$$\varrho(\eta|\eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau)_p(z) = \eta \circ \varphi_{-\zeta}^\tau(z + \eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau(p), \tau_\bullet(p)) - \eta(p).$$

So, as $\varphi_0^\tau = 1$, using (2.6.7), we get

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\zeta \varrho(\eta|\eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau)_p(z) \big|_{\zeta=0} &= \partial_\zeta \eta \circ \varphi_{-\zeta}^\tau(z + \eta(p), \tau_\bullet(p)) \big|_{\zeta=0} + \partial_\zeta (z + \eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau(p)) \big|_{\zeta=0} \\ &= -h(z + \eta(p), \tau_\bullet(p)) + h(p), \end{aligned}$$

noting that $p = (\eta(p), \tau_\bullet(p))$. So

$$\partial_\zeta \varrho(\eta|\eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau)_p^{(k)}(0) \big|_{\zeta=0} = -\partial_\eta^k h(p).$$

Thus, by Lemma 2.3.4, we have

$$\partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta \circ \varphi_\zeta^\tau|\eta)^{-1}) \big|_{\zeta=0} = - \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_\eta^k h(\eta, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1}.$$

□

Remark 2.6.3. Note that if $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$ is biholomorphic and fiber-preserving, then φ maps any (complex and holomorphic) path in each U_b to one in $V_{\varphi(b)}$. Thus $\varphi_* \equiv d\varphi$ maps tangent vectors of U_b to those of $V_{\varphi(b)}$. Thus one can define an isomorphism $d\varphi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_U \xrightarrow{\cong} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_V$, and hence

$$\varphi_* \equiv d\varphi : \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}|_U \xrightarrow{\cong} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}|_V$$

for each $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. One can thus use (2.6.8) (with $\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\varphi_\zeta^\tau)$ replaced by $d\varphi_\zeta^\tau$) to define the Lie derivatives on $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}$. When $n \in \mathbb{N}$, it is easy to see that the Lie derivatives on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} / \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n-1}$ is the same as those on $\mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes n}$. One can also define Lie derivatives on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ (recall that $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} = \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{-1}$), and the formula of Lie derivatives is exactly the same as (2.6.9), except that L_0 should be replaced by $L_0 - 1$. (In other words, there is an extra term $\partial_\eta h(\eta, \tau_\bullet)u$ contributed by the Lie derivatives on $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$.) In the next chapter, we will use the Lie derivatives on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ to define connections on sheaves of conformal blocks.

Chapter 3

Sheaves of conformal blocks

3.1 Spaces of conformal blocks

Let $\mathbb{V}$ be always a (CFT-type) VOA. Let $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ be an N -pointed complex curve with local coordinates. Recall that if $\mathbb{W}$ is a $\mathbb{V}$ -module, the vertex operator $Y_{\mathbb{W}}$ can be regarded as a $\mathbb{C}((z))$ -module homomorphism $\mathbb{V}((z)) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W} \rightarrow \mathbb{W}((z))$ sending each $v \otimes w$ to $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w$. (See (2.4.4); here $v \in V$ is considered as the constant section in $\mathbb{V}((z))$.) Let $\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}_2, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. Set $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} = \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{W}_2 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$.

Convention 3.1.1. By $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we mean a vector of $\mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$. By $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we mean a vector of the form $w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N$, where $w_1 \in \mathbb{W}_1, \dots, w_N \in \mathbb{W}_N$.

Recall that $S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ is the divisor $x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_N$. For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, we choose a neighborhood U_i of x_i on which η_i is defined. Then, by tensoring with the identity map of ω_{U_i} , the map (2.4.8) induces naturally an $\mathcal{O}_{U_i}$ -module isomorphism

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i) : \mathcal{V}_C|_{U_i} \otimes \omega_{U_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{U_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}).$$

Let $(\eta_i)_* : \omega_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\cong} \omega_{\eta_i(U_i)}$ be the pushforward of differentials, i.e. $(\eta_i)_* = (\eta_i^{-1})^*$. It can be extended by linearity to $(\eta_i)_* : \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{U_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\eta_i(U_i)}(\bullet 0)$. Let

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\eta_i) : \mathcal{V}_C|_{U_i} \otimes \omega_{U_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\eta_i(U_i)}(\bullet 0) \\ \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\eta_i) &= (\eta_i)_* \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i). \end{aligned} \tag{3.1.1}$$

In the case that U_i and $\eta_i(U_i)$ are identified by η_i , we have $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i) = \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)$. Let z be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. If v is a section of $\mathcal{V}_C|_{U_i} \otimes \omega_{U_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ defined near x_i , we define a linear action of v on $\mathbb{W}_i$ such that if $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i$, then

$$\boxed{v \cdot w_i = \text{Res}_{z=0} Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)v, z)w_i} \tag{3.1.2}$$

Define a linear action of $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ on $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ as follows. If $v \in H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$, the action of v on any $w_{\bullet}$ is

$$v \cdot w_{\bullet} = \sum_{i=1}^N w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes (v|_{U_i}) \cdot w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N. \quad (3.1.3)$$

We now define a **space of covacua**

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \frac{\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}}{H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}} \quad (3.1.4)$$

whose dual vector space is denoted by $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ and called a **space of conformal blocks** or **space of vacua**.

A conformal block $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is understood as a chiral correlation function in physics. According to the above definition, ϕ as a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ should vanish on the subspace $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. Such condition is similar to the Jacobi identity for VOAs. We now interpret this condition in a similar fashion as Theorem 2.1.2.

For each $\phi \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^*$ and x_i , if $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we define

$$\imath\phi_{x_i}(w_{\bullet}) \in \mathbb{V}^*[[z^{\pm 1}]]$$

whose evaluation on each $v \in \mathbb{V}$, written as $\imath\phi_{x_i}(v, w_{\bullet})$, equals

$$\imath\phi_{x_i}(v, w_{\bullet}) = \phi(w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z)w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N). \quad (3.1.5)$$

By the lower truncation property, the above expression is an element of $\mathbb{C}((z))$. Also, the above expression makes sense when v is a section of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\eta_i(U_i)}$ defined near $z = 0$. By linearity, we can define $\imath\phi_{x_i}(v, w)$ for any $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. The following theorem is also true when C is nodal; however, we will only be interested in the smooth case. We understand

$$C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} = C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N\}.$$

Theorem 3.1.2. *Assume that C is smooth. Let $\phi \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^*$. Then the following are equivalent.*

- (a) ϕ is an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.
- (b) For each $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, there exists a (necessarily unique) element

$$\imath\phi(w) \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_C^*) \quad (3.1.6)$$

such that for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, if we identify $U_i \simeq \eta_i(U_i)$ via η_i and identify $\mathcal{V}_C|_{U_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_i}$ via $\mathcal{U}_i(\eta_i)$, then the evaluation of $\imath\phi(w)$ with any $v \in \mathcal{V}_C(U_i)$ (restricted to $U_i - x_i$), written as $\imath\phi(v, w)$, is

$$\imath\phi(v, w) = \imath\phi_{x_i}(v, w). \quad (3.1.7)$$

Proof. Choose any $v \in H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$. Assume $w = w_{\bullet} = w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N$. Then

$$\sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi_{x_i}(v, w_{\bullet}) = \phi(v \cdot w_{\bullet}). \quad (3.1.8)$$

Suppose that (b) is true. Then $\wr \phi(v, w_{\bullet})$ is an element of $H^0(C, \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$, and the left hand side of the above expression equals $\sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{x_i} \wr \phi(v, w_{\bullet})$, which, by residue theorem, equals 0. Thus ϕ vanishes on $v \cdot w_{\bullet}$. This proves (a).

We now assume (a). Choose any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and restrict $\wr \phi_{x_i}(w_{\bullet})$ to $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$ (or $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_i}$ when considering non-constant sections), which gives

$$\wr \phi_{x_i}^{\leq n}(w_{\bullet}) \in (\mathbb{V}^{\leq n})^*((z)).$$

Then for any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ and $v \in H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$, since ϕ vanishes on $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we have $\sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi_{x_i}(v, w_{\bullet})$ equals 0 by (3.1.8). Thus, by strong residue theorem, there exists

$$\wr \phi^{\leq n}(w_{\bullet}) \in H^0(C, (\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n})^* \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$$

whose series expansion near each x_i is $\wr \phi_{x_i}^{\leq n}$. Equivalently, (3.1.7) holds for any i and any $v \in \mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}(U_i)$. It is clear that $\wr \phi^{\leq n'}(w_{\bullet})$ restricts to $\wr \phi^{\leq n}(w_{\bullet})$ when $n' \geq n$. One can thus define $\wr \phi(w_{\bullet})$ to be the projective limit of $\wr \phi^{\leq n}(w_{\bullet})$ over n . $\square$

Our next goal is to give a coordinate-free definition of conformal blocks. Let $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ be an N -pointed complex curve, and let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. Define a vector space $\mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ isomorphic to $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ as follows. $\mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is a (infinite rank) vector bundle on the 0-dimensional manifold $\{C\}$ (consider as the base manifold of the family $C \rightarrow \{C\}$). For any choice of local coordinates $\eta_{\bullet} = (\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively, we have a trivialization

$$\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}) : \mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}. \quad (3.1.9)$$

such that if $\mu_{\bullet}$ is another set of local coordinates, then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet})\mathcal{U}(\mu_{\bullet})^{-1} &= \mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet} \circ \mu_{\bullet}^{-1}) \\ &:= \mathcal{U}(\eta_1 \circ \mu_1^{-1}) \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_2 \circ \mu_2^{-1}) \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_N \circ \mu_N^{-1}). \end{aligned} \quad (3.1.10)$$

If $v \in H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ and $w \in \mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, we set

$$v \cdot w = \mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet})^{-1} \cdot v \cdot \mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}) \cdot w, \quad (3.1.11)$$

where the action of v on $\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet})w$ (which depends on $\eta_{\bullet}$) is defined by (3.1.2) and (3.1.3).

Lemma 3.1.3. *The definition of $v \cdot w$ in (3.1.11) is independent of the choice of $\eta_\bullet$.*

Proof. We prove this lemma for the case $N = 1$. The general cases can be proved in a similar way. Choose local coordinates η, μ at $x = x_1$ defined on a neighborhood U . We identify U with $\mu(U)$ via μ . So μ is identified with the standard coordinate $1_{\mathbb{C}}$ of $\mathbb{C}$, and $\eta \in \mathbb{G}$. (We will denote by z the standard complex variable of $\mathbb{C}$.) Also, identify $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W})$ (where $\mathbb{W} = \mathbb{W}_1 = \mathbb{W}_\bullet$) with $\mathbb{W}$ via $\mathcal{U}(\mu)$. So $\mathcal{U}(\mu) = \mathcal{U}(1_{\mathbb{C}}) = 1$. Choose any $w \in \mathbb{W}$, and assume that v is of the form

$$\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\mu)v = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)v = u(z)dz$$

where $u = u(z) \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}(\bullet 0)(U)$. Then, by (2.4.9), we have

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)v = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|1_{\mathbb{C}}))u(z)dz = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|1_{\mathbb{C}})_z)u(z)dz.$$

By (3.1.1), we have

$$\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta)v = \eta_* (\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|1_{\mathbb{C}})_z)u(z)dz) = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|1_{\mathbb{C}})_{\eta^{-1}(z)}) \cdot u(\eta^{-1}(z)) \cdot d(\eta^{-1}(z)).$$

We calculate that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}(\eta)^{-1} \cdot v \cdot \mathcal{U}(\eta) \cdot w &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \mathcal{U}(\eta)^{-1} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta)v, z) \mathcal{U}(\eta)w \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \mathcal{U}(\eta)^{-1} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|1_{\mathbb{C}})_{\eta^{-1}(z)}) \cdot u(\eta^{-1}(z)), z) \mathcal{U}(\eta)w \cdot d(\eta^{-1}(z)), \end{aligned}$$

which by Theorem 2.4.1 equals

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{Res}_{z=0} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u(\eta^{-1}(z)), \eta^{-1}(z))w \cdot d(\eta^{-1}(z)) \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u(z), z)w \cdot dz = \mathcal{U}(\mu)^{-1} \cdot v \cdot \mathcal{U}(\mu) \cdot w. \end{aligned}$$

The proof is complete. □

Thus, we have a coordinate-independent linear action of $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}}))$ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Then the space of conformal blocks $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is the dual space of the space of covacua

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)}{H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)}. \quad (3.1.12)$$

Remark 3.1.4. We remark that Theorem 3.1.2 still holds in this general setting. Indeed, by Theorem 2.4.1, for each $w \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ one can define $\imath\phi_{x_i}(w)$ whose expression is covariant under the change of local coordinates. Then ϕ is a conformal block if and only if for each w , all these $\imath\phi_{x_i}(w)$ can be extended to a (necessarily unique) $\imath\phi(w)$ which is independent of the choice of local coordinates.

Example 3.1.5. Let $C = \mathbb{P}^1$. Let ζ be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C} = \mathbb{P}^1 - \{\infty\}$, and let $\varpi = \zeta^{-1}$ be a coordinate of ∞ defined on $\mathbb{P}^1 - \{0\}$. Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\mathbb{P}^1; 0, \infty; \zeta, \varpi)$. So the divisor $S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ is $0 + \infty$, and hence $\mathbb{P}^1 - S_{\mathfrak{X}} = \mathbb{C} - \{0\} = \mathbb{C}^\times$. Choose V -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}_2$ associated to $0, \infty$ respectively. Let $\mathbb{W}_\bullet = \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{W}_2$. We shall show that there is an isomorphism $\text{Hom}_V(\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}'_2) \simeq \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

Define a linear map $\text{Hom}_V(\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}'_2) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ as follows. If $T \in \text{Hom}_V(\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{W}'_2)$, then the corresponding conformal block ϕ_T , as a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$, is defined by

$$\phi_T(w_\bullet) = \langle Tw_1, w_2 \rangle \quad (3.1.13)$$

for each $w_\bullet := w_1 \otimes w_2 \in \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{W}_2$. We now verify that ϕ_T is a conformal block by verifying (b) of Theorem 3.1.2. $\mathcal{V}_{\mathbb{P}^1}|\mathbb{C}^\times$ is generated by all $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v$ where $v \in \mathbb{V}$. Moreover, it is easy to define $\imath\phi_T(w_\bullet) \in H^0(\mathbb{C}^\times, \mathcal{V}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^*)$ such that for any v ,

$$\imath\phi_T(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) = \langle TY_{\mathbb{W}_1}(v, \zeta)w_1, w_2 \rangle,$$

considering $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v$ as a section on $\mathbb{C}^\times$. The series expansion of $\imath\phi_T(w_\bullet)$ near 0 is clearly $\imath\phi_{T,0}(w_\bullet)$. Near ∞ , we have

$$\begin{aligned} \imath\phi_{T,\infty}(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) &= \phi_{T,\infty}(w_1 \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v, \varpi)w_2) \\ &= \langle Tw_1, Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v, \varpi)w_2 \rangle = \langle Tw_1, Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\varpi|\zeta))v, \zeta^{-1})w_2 \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

According to (the proof of) Lemma 2.5.1 (note that we have $\xi = \zeta$ and $q = \xi\varpi = 1$), we have

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\varpi|\zeta)) = \mathcal{U}(\gamma_\zeta),$$

where we recall by (2.3.15) that $\mathcal{U}(\gamma_\zeta) = e^{\zeta L_1}(-\zeta^{-2})^{L_0}$ when acting on V . Thus, by (2.3.16) and the above calculation, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \imath\phi_{T,\infty}(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\zeta)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) &= \langle Tw_1, Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(\mathcal{U}(\gamma_\zeta)v, \zeta^{-1})w_2 \rangle \\ &= \langle Tw_1, Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(v, \zeta)^t w_2 \rangle = \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(v, \zeta)Tw_1, w_2 \rangle = \langle TY_{\mathbb{W}_1}(v, \zeta)w_1, w_2 \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the series expansion of $\imath\phi_T(w_\bullet)$ near ∞ is $\imath\phi_{T,\infty}(w_\bullet)$. So ϕ_T is a conformal block.

It is obvious that the map $T \mapsto \phi_T$ is injective. To show the surjectivity, we choose any conformal block ϕ . Define a linear map $T : W_1 \rightarrow W_2^*$ satisfying $\phi(w_\bullet) = \langle Tw_1, w_2 \rangle$ for any w_1, w_2 . Then for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$, by the above calculation, we see that $\langle TY_{\mathbb{W}_1}(v, \zeta)w_1, w_2 \rangle$ and $\langle Tw_1, Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(v, \zeta)^t w_2 \rangle$ (which are elements of $\mathbb{C}((\zeta))$ and $\mathbb{C}((\zeta^{-1}))$ respectively) are expansions near $\zeta = 0$ and $\zeta^{-1} = 0$ of the same function in $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(\bullet 0 + \bullet \infty))$. Thus, they are equal to a polynomial of ζ . Take v to be the conformal vector c . Then one sees that T intertwines the actions of L_0 . This shows that T has image in $\mathbb{W}'_2$, since, in particular, T maps L_0 -homogeneous vectors of $\mathbb{W}_1$ to those of $\mathbb{W}'_2$ with the same weights. It is now obvious that T intertwines the actions of $\mathbb{V}$, and that $\phi = \phi_T$.

Example 3.1.6. Choose any $z \in \mathbb{C}^\times$. Let again ζ be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. Then $\zeta, \zeta - z, \zeta^{-1}$ are local coordinates of $0, z, \infty$ respectively. Set $\mathfrak{X} = (\mathbb{P}^1; 0, z, \infty; \zeta, \zeta - z, \zeta^{-1})$. Choose any $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, and set $\mathbb{W}_\bullet = \mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}'$. Then the vertex operator $Y_{\mathbb{W}}$ can be viewed as an element ϕ of $\mathcal{T}^*\mathfrak{X}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ by sending each $w_\bullet = w \otimes v \otimes w' \in \mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}'$ to the scalar

$$\phi(w_\bullet) = \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w, w' \rangle.$$

One can define $\imath\phi(w_\bullet) \in H^0(\mathbb{C} - \{z\}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^*)$ such that for any $u \in \mathbb{V}$, the section $\mathcal{U}_\rho(\zeta)^{-1}u$ on $\mathbb{C} - \{z\}$ is sent to the function f in Theorem 2.1.2. Using the argument in the previous example, it is not hard to check that $\imath\phi_0(w_\bullet), \imath\phi_z(w_\bullet), \imath\phi_\infty(w_\bullet)$ are the series expansions of $\imath\phi(w_\bullet)$ near $0, z, \infty$ respectively. This proves that ϕ is a conformal block.

3.2 Sheaves of conformal blocks

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates. Let z be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))$ be the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module associating to each open $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ the algebra $\mathcal{O}(V)((z))$. If $\mathbb{W}$ is a $\mathbb{V}$ -module, we have a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))$ -modules

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{\mathbb{W}} : (\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}} (\mathbb{W} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}) &\rightarrow \mathbb{W} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z)), \\ v \otimes w &\mapsto Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w \end{aligned} \quad (3.2.1)$$

where $v = v \otimes 1, w = w \otimes 1$ are constant sections. Note a section of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{B}}$ on a neighborhood of $\{0\} \times V$ (where V is an open subset of $\mathcal{B}$) can be regarded as an element of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(V)((z))$ by taking series expansion.

If $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, we set $\mathbb{W}_\bullet = \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$ as usual, and define

$$\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}. \quad (3.2.2)$$

Choose mutually disjoint neighborhoods $U_1, \dots, U_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively. For each i we have

$$\mathcal{U}_\eta(\eta_i) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{U_i},$$

and the pushforward

$$(\eta_i, \pi)_* : \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\cong} \omega_{(\eta_i, \pi)(U_i)/\mathcal{B}}$$

equaling $((\eta_i, \pi)^{-1})^*$, which, by tensoring with $1_{\mathbb{V}}$, gives rise to (identifying $\mathcal{B}$ with $\{0\} \times \mathcal{B}$)

$$(\eta_i, \pi)_* : \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{(\eta_i, \pi)(U_i)/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet \mathcal{B}).$$

Define

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_i) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{U_i} &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{(\eta_i, \pi)(U_i)/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet \mathcal{B}), \\ \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_i) &= (\eta_i, \pi)_* \cdot \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i).\end{aligned}\quad (3.2.3)$$

If V is an open subset of $\mathcal{B}$, and v is a section of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{U_i}$ defined near $\varsigma_i(V)$, then $\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_i)v$, which is a section defined near $\{0\} \times V$, can be viewed (by taking series expansion) as an element of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(V)((z))dz$. If $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(V)$, we set

$$v \cdot w_i = \text{Res}_{z=0} Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_i)v, z)w_i. \quad (3.2.4)$$

One can now define an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -linear action of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ as follows. If $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ is open, for any v in $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V) = (\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\pi^{-1}(V))$ and any $w \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(V)$, we set

$$v \cdot w_\bullet = \sum_{i=1}^N w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes (v|_{U_i \cap \pi^{-1}(V)}) \cdot w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N. \quad (3.2.5)$$

Then for each $b \in V$, the value $(v \cdot w_\bullet)(b)$ (which is a vector inside the fiber $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_b \simeq \mathbb{W}_\bullet$) equals

$$(v \cdot w_\bullet)(b) = (v|_{\mathcal{C}_b}) \cdot w_\bullet(b) \quad (3.2.6)$$

where $w_\bullet(b) = w_1(b) \otimes w_2(b) \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N(b)$, and $v|_{\mathcal{C}_b}$, the restriction of v to the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$, is in $\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))$. The action on the right hand side of (3.2.6) is defined by (3.1.2) and (3.1.3).

Define a **sheaf of covacua**

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)}{\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)} \quad (3.2.7)$$

whose dual sheaf is denoted by $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and called a **sheaf of conformal blocks** or **sheaf of vacua**. $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is the sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules associated to the presheaf whose sections on any open $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ are (linear combinations of) those in $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(V) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(V)$.

For each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, we let $\mathfrak{X}_b$ be the restriction of $\mathfrak{X}$ to $\mathcal{C}_b = \pi^{-1}(b)$, i.e.

$$\mathfrak{X}_b = (\mathcal{C}_b; \varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b); \eta_1|_{U_1 \cap \mathcal{C}_b}, \dots, \eta_N|_{U_N \cap \mathcal{C}_b}).$$

We show that each fiber of the sheaf $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is isomorphic to the space of covacua $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Note the obvious $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B},b}$ -module isomorphism of stalks

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)_b \simeq \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)_b}{\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)_b}. \quad (3.2.8)$$

Recall that $\mathfrak{m}_b$ is the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B},b}$.

Theorem 3.2.1. *For any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the evaluation map at b :*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b = \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B},b} \rightarrow \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}, \quad w \mapsto w(b) \quad (3.2.9)$$

descends to an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_b = \frac{\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b}{\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b} \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}). \quad (3.2.10)$$

Proof. By (3.2.8), the fiber $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_b$ equals $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b$ modulo the subspace spanned by $\mathfrak{m}_b \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b$ and $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b$. The first one is sent by the map (3.2.9) to 0, and the second one into $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ according to the relation (3.2.6). Thus the linear map (3.2.10) is well-defined. It is clearly surjective. To show that (3.2.10) is injective, it suffices to show that the map (3.2.9) sends $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})_b$ onto $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b))) \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. This follows from Corollary 2.5.8. $\square$

Remark 3.2.2. For any open subset $V \subset \mathcal{B}$, an element $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V)$ is an homomorphism $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_V \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_V$ vanishing on $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(W) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(W)$ for any open subset $W \subset V$. By (3.2.6), it is clear that this vanishing requirement $\Leftrightarrow$ for any $b \in V$, the fiber

$$\phi(b) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_b \simeq \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}|_b \simeq \mathbb{C}$$

vanishes on $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}_b})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. By Corollary 2.5.8, we also have $\Rightarrow$. This proves:

Proposition 3.2.3. *Let $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ be open, and let $\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_V \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_V$ be a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_V$ -modules. Then ϕ is a conformal block if and only if its restriction to each fiber is a conformal block. More precisely, $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V)$ if and only if $\phi(b) \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ for any $b \in V$.*

We now define the sheaves of covacua and conformal blocks for any family $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ of N -pointed complex curves whose local coordinates are not specified. If $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ is open, then $\mathfrak{X}_V$ denotes the subfamily

$$\mathfrak{X}_V = (\pi : \mathcal{C}_V = \pi^{-1}(V) \rightarrow V; \varsigma_1|_V, \dots, \varsigma_N|_V). \quad (3.2.11)$$

Define $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ to be an infinite rank locally free sheaf on $\mathcal{B}$ as follows. For any connected open subset $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ together with local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ of the family $\pi : \mathcal{C}_V \rightarrow V$ defined near $\varsigma_1(V), \dots, \varsigma_N(V)$ respectively, we have a trivialization

$$\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}) \equiv \mathcal{U}(\eta_1) \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_N) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_V \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V \quad (3.2.12)$$

such that if $\mu_\bullet$ is another set of local coordinates, then

$$\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet)^{-1} : \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$$

is defined such that for any constant section $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet)^{-1}w_\bullet$, as a $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$ -valued holomorphic function, satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet)^{-1}w_\bullet \right)(b) &\equiv \left(\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet|\mu_\bullet)w_\bullet \right)(b) \\ &= \mathcal{U}((\eta_1|\mu_1)_b)w_1 \otimes \mathcal{U}((\eta_2|\mu_2)_b)w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathcal{U}((\eta_N|\mu_N)_b)w_N \end{aligned} \quad (3.2.13)$$

for any $b \in V$. Here, for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, $(\eta_i|\mu_i)_b$ is the element in $\mathbb{G}$ satisfying

$$(\eta_i|\mu_i)_b(z) = \eta_i \circ (\mu_i, \pi)^{-1}(z, b). \quad (3.2.14)$$

If we compare the transition functions (3.1.10) and (3.2.13), we see that there is a natural and coordinate-independent isomorphism of vector spaces

$$\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_b \simeq \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$$

where $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is defined near (3.1.9). We shall identify these two spaces in the following.

The action of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is defined fiberwisely by the action of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(b) = H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}(b)))$ (recall again Corollary 2.5.8) on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. By (3.2.6), it is clear that if we choose a set of local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$ near $\varsigma_1(V), \dots, \varsigma_N(V)$ as above, and if we identify $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_V \simeq \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$ via $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)$, then this action is described by (3.2.4) and (3.2.5).

The **sheaf of covacua** $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is defined still by (3.2.7), and the **sheaf of conformal blocks** $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is its dual sheaf.

Proposition 3.2.4. *Assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is connected, and let $\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ be a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules. Suppose that V is a non-empty open subset of $\mathcal{B}$, and the restriction $\phi|_V : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_V \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_V$ is an element in $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(V)$. Then $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$.*

Proof. We first assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is small enough such that $\mathfrak{X}$ can be equipped with N local coordinates, and that the connect manifold $\mathcal{B}$ is biholomorphic to a polydisc which in particular is Stein. Then for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the restriction of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B}) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$ to the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}_b} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ by Corollary 2.5.8. Thus, ϕ is a conformal block if and only if its evaluation with any element of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B}) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$ (which is a holomorphic function on $\mathcal{B}$) is zero. By our assumption, such holomorphic function vanishes on V . Thus it is zero on $\mathcal{B}$.

In general, we let A be the set of all $b \in \mathcal{B}$ such that b has a neighborhood W such that the restriction $\phi|_W$ is a conformal block. Then A is open and (by assumption) non-empty. For any $b \in \mathcal{B} - A$, let W be a connected neighborhood of b small enough as in the first paragraph. Then $\phi|_W$ is a conformal block if W has a non-zero open subset V such that $\phi|_V$ is a conformal block. Therefore W must be disjoint from A . This shows that $\mathcal{B} - A$ is open. Thus $\mathcal{B} = A$. $\square$

Next, we generalize Theorem 3.1.2 to sheaves of conformal blocks. Assume that $\mathfrak{X}$ has local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$. Let $\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ be a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules. Then for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, we have an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))$ -module homomorphism

$$\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})} : (\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}} (\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))$$

such that for each $v \in \mathbb{V}, w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, considered as constant sections on $\mathcal{B}$ of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}((z))$ and $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ respectively, $v \otimes w_{\bullet}$ is sent to

$$\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}(v \otimes w_{\bullet}) \equiv \imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}(v, w_{\bullet}) = \phi(w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \dots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z)w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_N). \quad (3.2.15)$$

For any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, for the fiber map $\phi(b) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ we can define $\imath\phi(b)_{\varsigma_i(b)}$ as in Section 3.1. Then it is clear that the following elements in $\mathbb{C}((z))$ are equal:

$$\imath\phi(b)_{\varsigma_i(b)}(v, w_{\bullet}) = (\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}(v, w_{\bullet}))(b). \quad (3.2.16)$$

Shortly speaking, the restriction of $\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}$ to each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ equals $\imath\phi(b)_{\varsigma_i(b)}$.

For any (non-necessarily open) subset $E \subset \mathcal{C}$, we set

$$E - S_{\mathfrak{X}} = E - \bigcup_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B}). \quad (3.2.17)$$

Choose mutually disjoint neighborhoods $U_1, \dots, U_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively. Note that $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$ and $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_{\mathcal{C}-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}$ are $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ modules realized by pulling back $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ to $\mathcal{C}$. The following theorem is clearly true if $\mathcal{B}$ is replaced by an open subset V and $\mathfrak{X}$ by the subfamily $\mathfrak{X}_V$.

Theorem 3.2.5. *Assume that $\mathfrak{X}$ is a smooth family. Let $\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ be a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules. Then the following are equivalent.*

- (a) ϕ is an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$.
- (b) For each open $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ and $w \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V) \simeq \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(V)$, there is a (necessarily unique) element

$$\imath\phi(w) \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_V - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*)$$

satisfying that for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, if we identify $U_i \simeq (\eta_i, \pi)(U_i)$ via (η_i, π) and identify $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_{U_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_i}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\eta_i}$, then the evaluation of $\imath\phi(w)$ with any $v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(U_i \cap \mathcal{C}_V)$ (restricted to $U_i \cap \mathcal{C}_V - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$) is

$$\imath\phi(v, w) = \imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}(v, w). \quad (3.2.18)$$

Note that $v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(U_i \cap \mathcal{C}_V)$ can be regarded as an element of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(V)((z))$.

Proof. Suppose that (b) holds. Then by (3.2.16), for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and any section w of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ defined near b , the restriction $\imath\phi(w)|_{\mathcal{C}_b - S_{\mathfrak{X}}} = \imath\phi(w)|_{\mathcal{C}_b - S_{\mathfrak{X}_b}}$, which is an element in $H^0(\mathcal{C}_b - S_{\mathfrak{X}_b}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}^*)$, has series expansion $\imath\phi(b)_{\varsigma_i(b)}$ near each $\varsigma_i(b)$. Thus, by Theorem 3.1.2, $\phi(b)$ is a conformal block on the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$. Since this is true for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, by Proposition 3.2.3, ϕ is a conformal block on the family $\mathfrak{X}$. This proves (a).

Now assume (a). Choose open $V \subset \mathcal{B}$ and $w \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V)$. For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the restriction of $\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}(w)$ to $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$ gives a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_V$ -modules

$$s_i := \imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}^{\leq n}(w) : \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_V((z)).$$

which can also be considered as

$$s_i \in ((\mathbb{V}^{\leq n})^* \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(V))((z)).$$

Let $\mathcal{C} = (\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n})^*|_{\mathcal{C}_V}$. By the fact due to Proposition 3.2.3 that $\phi(b)$ is a conformal block on $\mathcal{C}_b$ for each $b \in V$, it is easy to see that $s_1, \dots, s_N$ satisfy (b) of Theorem 1.4.1. Thus they also satisfy (a) of that theorem, namely, that $s_1, \dots, s_N$ can be extended to an element

$$s := \imath\phi^{\leq n}(w) \in H^0(\mathcal{C}_V, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_{\mathcal{C}_V}),$$

which can also be regarded as in $H^0(\mathcal{C}_V - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*|_{\mathcal{C}_V})$. It is clear that $\imath\phi^{\leq n'}(w)$ restricts to $\imath\phi^{\leq n}(w)$ when $n' \geq n$. Thus $\imath\phi(w)$, the projective limit over $n \in \mathbb{N}$ of $\imath\phi^{\leq n}(w)$, satisfies (3.2.18). This proves (b). $\square$

Remark 3.2.6. In the case that local coordinates are not assigned to the smooth family $\mathfrak{X}$, one can still define $\imath\phi$ for each $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$. Indeed, for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, the restriction of $\imath\phi_{\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})}$ to each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is independent of the choice of local coordinates by (the proof of) Lemma 3.1.3. So is $\imath\phi$. Thus, one can define $\imath\phi$ locally, and glue them together to obtain the global section.

3.3 Sewing conformal blocks

Formal conformal blocks

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates obtained via sewing the following smooth family

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \varsigma'_1, \dots, \varsigma'_M; \varsigma''_1, \dots, \varsigma''_M; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi_1, \dots, \xi_M; \varpi_1, \dots, \varpi_M).$$

(See Section 1.6.) As suggested by the notations, we require as in Remark 1.6.1 that the N -points $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N$ and the local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ of $\mathfrak{X}$ are constant with respect to sewing. In this section, *we only assume that each connected component*

of each fiber $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}_b$ contains at least one of the $N + 2M$ marked points of $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}_b$. This is slightly weaker than the assumption in Rem. 1.6.1. Choose $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$, and $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ whose contragredient modules are $\mathbb{M}'_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}'_M$, which are associated to $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N, \varsigma'_1, \dots, \varsigma'_M, \varsigma''_1, \dots, \varsigma''_M$ respectively.

To simplify discussions, we assume throughout this section that $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is Stein. This assumption allows us to work with modules instead of sheaves of modules. Recall that we have

$$\mathcal{D}_{r, \rho_\bullet} = \mathcal{D}_{r_1 \rho_1} \times \dots \times \mathcal{D}_{r_M \rho_M}, \quad \mathcal{B} = \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r, \rho_\bullet}.$$

Then $\mathcal{B}$ is also Stein. We have the identification $\mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \simeq \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ realized by $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)$. By taking series expansions, $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ can be regarded as a subalgebra of

$$\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_\bullet]] = \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_1, q_2, \dots, q_M]],$$

whose elements are formal power series of $q_1, \dots, q_M$ whose coefficients are in $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. In particular, $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_\bullet]]$ is an $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -module. Choose a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -modules

$$\phi : \mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B}) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_\bullet]]. \quad (3.3.1)$$

We say that ϕ is a **formal conformal block** if ϕ vanishes on $\pi_* (\mathscr{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B}) \cdot \mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$. We say that ϕ **converges absolutely and locally uniformly (a.l.u.)** if the image of ϕ is in $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$. This name is explained below.

Remark 3.3.1. Write

$$q_\bullet^{n_\bullet} = q_1^{n_1} q_2^{n_2} \dots q_M^{n_M}$$

for any $n_\bullet = (n_1, n_2, \dots, n_M) \in \mathbb{N}^M$. For each $w \in \mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$, we have the series expansion

$$\phi(w) = \sum_{n_\bullet \in \mathbb{N}^M} \phi(w)_{n_\bullet} \cdot q_\bullet^{n_\bullet}$$

where each $\phi(w)_{n_\bullet}$ is a holomorphic function on $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. Then it is clear that ϕ converges a.l.u. on $\mathcal{B}$ if and only if for any w (which is sufficient to be constant) and any compact subsets $K \subset \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ and $Q \subset \mathcal{D}_{r, \rho_\bullet}$, there exists $C > 0$ such that

$$\sum_{n_\bullet \in \mathbb{N}^M} |\phi(w)_{n_\bullet}(b)| \cdot |q_\bullet^{n_\bullet}| \leq C \quad (3.3.2)$$

for any $b \in K$ and $q_\bullet = (q_1, \dots, q_M)$ in Q .

If ϕ converges a.l.u. on $\mathcal{B}$, one can regard ϕ as a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules

$$\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$$

whose values at the global sections of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ are given by (3.3.1).

Proposition 3.3.2. *Let ϕ in (3.3.1) be a formal conformal block, and assume that ϕ converges a.l.u..*

1. *If for every $b \in \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$, each connected component of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}_b$ contains at least one $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$ (cf. Rem. 1.6.1), then ϕ is a conformal block, i.e. $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$.*
2. *If for every $b \in \mathcal{B} - \Delta = \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}, \rho_{\bullet}}^{\times}$, each connected component of $\mathcal{C}_b$ contains at least one of $\varsigma_1(b), \dots, \varsigma_N(b)$, then ϕ is a conformal block on $\mathcal{B} - \Delta$.*

Proof. Case 1 follows easily from Corollary 2.5.8, Proposition 3.2.3, and our assumption that $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ (and hence $\mathcal{B}$) is Stein.

In case 2, note that Proposition 3.2.3 and Theorem 2.5.6 apply to the restriction $\mathfrak{X}_{\mathcal{B}-\Delta}$. So it suffices to prove for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ that for sufficiently large $k \in \mathbb{N}$, the elements of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B})$ generate the stalk $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))_b$. This follows from Cartan's theorem A and that $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ is coherent (by Grauert's direct image theorem). $\square$

Sewing conformal blocks

Let $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{\bullet}$ be

$$\mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N \otimes \mathbb{M}_1 \otimes \mathbb{M}'_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{M}_M \otimes \mathbb{M}'_M. \quad (3.3.3)$$

We have switched the orders and put each $\mathbb{M}_j$ and its contragredient module $\mathbb{M}'_j$ together, which are associated to $\varsigma'_j(\mathcal{B})$ and $\varsigma''_j(\mathcal{B})$ respectively. Our goal is to define a formal conformal block from each element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{\bullet})$. Notice that for each $j = 1, \dots, M$, $(\mathbb{M}'_j \otimes \mathbb{M}_j)^*$ can be regarded as the algebraic completion of $\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j$. Define

$$\blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft \in (\mathbb{M}'_j \otimes \mathbb{M}_j)^*$$

such that for any $m' \in \mathbb{M}'_j, m \in \mathbb{M}_j$,

$$\langle \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft, m' \otimes m \rangle = \langle m', m \rangle.$$

Let $A \in \text{End}(\mathbb{M}_j)$ whose transpose $A^t \in \text{End}(\mathbb{M}'_j)$ exists, i.e.,

$$\langle Am, m' \rangle = \langle m, A^t m' \rangle \quad (3.3.4)$$

for any $m' \in \mathbb{M}'_j, m \in \mathbb{M}_j$. Then we have an element

$$A \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft \equiv \triangleright \otimes_j A^t \blacktriangleleft \in (\mathbb{M}'_j \otimes \mathbb{M}_j)^* \quad (3.3.5)$$

whose value at each $m' \otimes m$ is (3.3.4).

More explicitly, for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ we choose a basis $\{m(n, a)\}_a$ of the finite dimensional vector space $\mathbb{M}_j(n)$ (which we recall is the n -eigenspace of $\tilde{L}_0$; recall also Convention 2.2.6). Its dual basis $\{\check{m}(n, a)\}_a$ is a basis of $\mathbb{M}'_j(n) = \mathbb{M}_j(n)^*$ satisfying $\langle m(n, a), \check{m}(n, b) \rangle = \delta_{a,b}$. Then we have

$$\triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \sum_a m(n, a) \otimes \check{m}(n, a),$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} A \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft &= \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \sum_a A \cdot m(n, a) \otimes \check{m}(n, a) \\ &= \triangleright \otimes_j A^t \blacktriangleleft = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \sum_a m(n, a) \otimes A^t \cdot \check{m}(n, a). \end{aligned}$$

Let $P(n)$ be the projection of $\mathbb{M}_j$ onto $\mathbb{M}_j(n)$. Its transpose, which is the projection of $\mathbb{M}'_j$ onto $\mathbb{W}'_j(n)$, is also denoted by $P(n)$. Then we clearly have

$$P(n) \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft = \triangleright \otimes_j P(n) \blacktriangleleft = \sum_a m(n, a) \otimes \check{m}(n, a) \in \mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j.$$

Recall $\tilde{L}_0^t = \tilde{L}_0$. Define

$$q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{N}} P(k) q_j^k \in \text{End}(\mathbb{M}_j)[[q_j]]. \quad (3.3.6)$$

Then we have

$$q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft = \triangleright \otimes_j q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleleft \in (\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[q_j]]. \quad (3.3.7)$$

For any $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}'_\bullet)(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$, we define its (normalized) **sewing** $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ which is an $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -module homomorphism

$$\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi : \mathcal{W}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B}) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_\bullet]],$$

and the (standard) **sewing**

$$\mathcal{S}\psi : \mathcal{W}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B}) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})\{q_\bullet\},$$

as follows. Regard ψ as an $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ -module homomorphism $\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}'_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ is defined such that for any constant section $w \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$,

$$\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi(w) = \psi\left(w \otimes (q_1^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes (q_M^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft)\right). \quad (3.3.8)$$

$\mathcal{S}\psi$ is defined similarly, except that the normalized energy operator $\tilde{L}_0$ is replaced by the standard one L_0 . When $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ are irreducible, $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\phi$ differs from $\mathcal{S}\phi$ by a factor $q_1^{\lambda_1} \dots q_M^{\lambda_M}$ for some $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_M \in \mathbb{C}$. Our goal is to show that $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ is a formal conformal block. In the case that $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ are semisimple (which is sufficient for our purpose), this will show that $\mathcal{S}\phi$ is also a formal conformal block in a suitable sense. We begin our proof with the following observation, in which we have omitted the subscript j of ξ, ϖ, q for simplicity.

Lemma 3.3.3. *Let R be any unital commutative $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra. (For instance, $R = \mathcal{O}(X)$ where X is a complex manifold.) For any $u \in \mathbb{V}$ and $f \in R[[\xi, \varpi]]$, the following two elements in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)[[q]]$ (where the tensor products are over $\mathbb{C}$) are equal:*

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Res}_{\xi=0} Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft \cdot f(\xi, q/\xi) \frac{d\xi}{\xi} \\ &= \text{Res}_{\varpi=0} q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}(\varpi^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) u, \varpi) \blacktriangleleft \cdot f(q/\varpi, \varpi) \frac{d\varpi}{\varpi}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.3.9)$$

Remark 3.3.4. We explain the meaning of the left hand side; the other side can be understood in a similar way. As $q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft$ is an element of $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[q]]$, $Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft$ is an element of $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)((\xi))[[q]]$, i.e. it is a formal power series of q whose coefficients are in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)((\xi))$. (Note that one cannot switch the order of $((\xi))$ and $[[q]]$.) Identify $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)((\xi))[[q]] \simeq (\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes 1)((\xi))[[q]]$, which is a subspace of the $R((\xi))[[q]]$ -module $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)((\xi))[[q]]$. On the other hand, write $f(\xi, \varpi) = \sum_{m,n \in \mathbb{N}} f_{m,n} \xi^m \varpi^n$ where each $f_{m,n}$ is in R . Then

$$f(\xi, q/\xi) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \sum_{k \geq -n} f_{n+k,n} \xi^k q^n,$$

which shows $f(\xi, q/\xi) \in R((\xi))[[q]]$. Thus, the term in the residue on the left hand side is an element in

$$(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)((\xi))[[q]] d\xi,$$

whose residue is in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)[[q]]$.

Proof of Lemma 3.3.3. Consider $Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0}$ as an element of $\text{End}(\mathbb{M}_j)[[\xi^{\pm 1}, q]]$. Since $\tilde{L}_0^t = \tilde{L}_0$, we have the following relations of elements of $\text{End}(\mathbb{M}'_j)[[\xi^{\pm 1}, q^{\pm 1}]]$:

$$\begin{aligned} & (Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0})^t = q^{\tilde{L}_0} (Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi))^t \stackrel{(2.3.16)}{=} q^{\tilde{L}_0} Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}(\mathcal{U}(\gamma_\xi) \xi^{L_0} u, \xi^{-1}) \\ & \stackrel{(2.3.17)}{=} q^{\tilde{L}_0} Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}(\xi^{-L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) u, \xi^{-1}) \stackrel{(2.4.6)}{=} Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}((q/\xi)^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) u, q/\xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0}. \end{aligned}$$

(Note that due to the appearance of q/ξ in the vertex operator, it was not known a priori that the right hand side contains no negative powers of q .) Thus, by (3.3.5), we have the following equations of elements in $(\mathbb{M}'_j \otimes \mathbb{M}_j)^*[[\xi^{\pm 1}, q^{\pm 1}]]$:

$$Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft = \blacktriangleright \otimes_j (Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0})^t \blacktriangleleft$$

$$= \blacktriangleright \otimes_j Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}((q/\xi)^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)u, q/\xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleleft = q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}((q/\xi)^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)u, q/\xi) \blacktriangleleft. \quad (3.3.10)$$

Since for each n , $P(n) \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft$ is in $\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j$, (3.3.10) is actually an element in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[\xi^{\pm 1}, q^{\pm 1}]]$.

Let

$$A(\xi, q) = Y_{\mathbb{M}_j}(\xi^{L_0} u, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft, \\ B(\varpi, q) = q^{\tilde{L}_0} \blacktriangleright \otimes_j Y_{\mathbb{M}'_j}(\varpi^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)u, \varpi) \blacktriangleleft,$$

considered as elements of $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[\xi^{\pm 1}, q^{\pm 1}]]$ and $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[\varpi^{\pm 1}, q^{\pm 1}]]$ respectively. Then (3.3.10) says $A(\xi, q) = B(q/\xi, q)$. Let $C(\xi, \varpi) \in (\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[\xi^{\pm 1}, \varpi^{\pm 1}]]$ be $A(\xi, \xi\varpi)$, which also equals $B(\varpi, \xi\varpi)$. Since $A(\xi, q)$ contains only non-negative powers of q , so does $A(\xi, \xi\varpi)$ for ϖ . Similarly, since $B(\varpi, q)$ contains only non-negative powers of q , so does $B(\varpi, \xi\varpi)$ for ξ . Therefore $C(\xi, \varpi)$ is an element in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j)[[\xi, \varpi]]$, where the latter can be identified with the subspace $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes 1)[[\xi, \varpi]]$ of the $R[[\xi, \varpi]]$ -module $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)[[\xi, \varpi]]$. Thus $D(\xi, \varpi) := f(\xi, \varpi)C(\xi, \varpi)$ is well-defined as an element in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes R)[[\xi, \varpi]]$. It is easy to check that

$$\text{Res}_{\xi=0} \left(D(\xi, q/\xi) \frac{d\xi}{\xi} \right) = \text{Res}_{\varpi=0} \left(D(q/\varpi, \varpi) \frac{d\varpi}{\varpi} \right).$$

(Indeed, they both equal $\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} D_{n,n} q^n$ if we write $D(\xi, \varpi) = \sum_{m,n \in \mathbb{N}} D_{m,n} \xi^m \varpi^n$.) This proves (3.3.9). $\square$

Theorem 3.3.5. *Let $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{\bullet})(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. Then $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ is a formal conformal block.*

Proof. Step 1. Note that we have $S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ and $S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) + \sum_{j=1}^M (\varsigma'_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) + \varsigma''_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}))$. Choose any v in $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}))(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) = (\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}))(\mathcal{C})$. In this first step, we would like to construct a formal power series expansion

$$v = \sum_{n_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{N}^M} v_{n_{\bullet}} q_{\bullet}^{n_{\bullet}} \quad (3.3.11)$$

where each $v_{n_{\bullet}}$ is in $(\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}))(\tilde{\mathcal{C}})$.

First, choose any precompact open subset $\tilde{U}$ of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$ disjoint from the double points $\varsigma'_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ and $\varsigma''_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ for all $1 \leq j \leq M$. Then for each j one can find small enough positive numbers $\epsilon_j < r_j, \lambda_j < \rho_j$ such that $\tilde{U} \times \mathcal{D}_{\epsilon_{\bullet}\lambda_{\bullet}}$ is an open subset of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}\rho_{\bullet}} - \bigcup_j F'_j - \bigcup_j F''_j$ in (1.6.9), and hence an open subset of $\mathcal{C}$. Moreover, by (1.6.14), the projection $\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ equals $\tilde{\pi} \times 1 : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}\rho_{\bullet}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}\rho_{\bullet}}$ when restricted to $\tilde{U} \times \mathcal{D}_{\epsilon_{\bullet}\lambda_{\bullet}}$. It follows that the section $v|_{\tilde{U} \times \mathcal{D}_{\epsilon_{\bullet}\lambda_{\bullet}}}$ of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})$ can be

regarded as a section of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet} / \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})$, which, by taking power series expansions at $q_\bullet = 0$, is in turn an element of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})(\tilde{U})[[q_\bullet]]$. The coefficient before $q_\bullet^{n_\bullet}$ defines $v_{n_\bullet}|_{\tilde{U}}$. This defines the section $v_{n_\bullet}$ of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})$ on $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} - \bigcup_{j=1}^M (\zeta'_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) \cup \zeta''_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}))$ satisfying (3.3.11).

We now show that $v_{n_\bullet}$ has poles of orders at most $n_j + 1$ at $\zeta'_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ and $\zeta''_j(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. This will imply that $v_{n_\bullet}$ extends to a section of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})$ on $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$. Let $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j = \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet, \rho_\bullet \setminus j} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$, and choose open sets W_j, W'_j, W''_j as in the paragraph containing equation (2.5.10). Define coordinates ξ_j, ϖ_j, q_j as in the beginning of Section 1.6. Then, by (2.5.11) and (1.6.24), $v|_{W_j - \Sigma}$ is a sum of those whose restrictions to W'_j, W''_j under the trivializations $\mathcal{U}_\rho(\xi_j), \mathcal{U}_\rho(\varpi_j)$ are

$$f(\xi_j, q_j/\xi_j, \cdot) \xi_j^{L_0} u \cdot \frac{d\xi_j}{\xi_j} \quad \text{resp.} \quad -f(q_j/\varpi_j, \varpi, \cdot) \varpi_j^{L_0} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) u \cdot \frac{d\varpi_j}{\varpi_j} \quad (3.3.12)$$

where $u \in \mathbb{V}$ and $f = f(\xi_j, \varpi_j, \cdot) \in \mathcal{O}(W_j)$, and the coordinates of $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j$ are suppressed as the dot. In the above two terms, if we take power series expansions of $q_\bullet$, then it is obvious that the coefficients before $q_\bullet^{n_\bullet}$ have poles of orders at most $n_j + 1$ at $\xi_j = 0$ and $\varpi_j = 0$ respectively. This proves the claim.

Step 2. By (2.5.10), we can regard $f(\xi_j, \varpi_j, \cdot)$ as an element of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_j)[[\xi_j, \varpi_j]]$, which in turn is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_{\bullet \setminus j}, \xi_j, \varpi_j]]$. Thus, by Lemma 3.3.3 (applied to $R = \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_{\bullet \setminus j}]]$) and the fact that $v|_{W_j - \Sigma}$ is a (finite) sum of those of the form (3.3.12), we have the following equation of elements in $(\mathbb{M}_j \otimes \mathbb{M}'_j \otimes \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}))[[q_\bullet]]$:

$$\sum_{n_\bullet \in \mathbb{N}^M} (v_{n_\bullet} \cdot q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft + q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_j v_{n_\bullet} \cdot \blacktriangleleft) q_\bullet^{n_\bullet} = 0 \quad (3.3.13)$$

where the actions of $v_{n_\bullet}$ on $\mathbb{M}_j$ and $\mathbb{M}'_j$ are defined by (3.2.4) using the local coordinates ξ_j, ϖ_j of $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$. On the other hand, since ψ is conformal block, for each $n_\bullet$, the element $A_{n_\bullet} \in \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ defined by

$$\begin{aligned} A_{n_\bullet} := & \psi \left(v_{n_\bullet} \cdot w \otimes (q_1^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes (q_M^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft) \right) \\ & + \sum_{j=1}^M \psi \left(w \otimes (q_1^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes v_{n_\bullet} \cdot q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_j \blacktriangleleft \otimes \cdots \otimes (q_M^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft) \right) \\ & + \sum_{j=1}^M \psi \left(w \otimes (q_1^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes q_j^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_j v_{n_\bullet} \cdot \blacktriangleleft \otimes \cdots \otimes (q_M^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft) \right) \end{aligned}$$

equals 0. Here, similarly, the action of $v_{n_\bullet}$ on w is defined by (3.2.4) and (3.2.5) using the local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$. By (3.3.13), we have

$$0 = \sum_{n_\bullet \in \mathbb{N}^M} A_{n_\bullet} q_\bullet^{n_\bullet} = \sum_{n_\bullet \in \mathbb{N}^M} \psi \left(v_{n_\bullet} \cdot w \otimes (q_1^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes (q_M^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft) \right) q_\bullet^{n_\bullet},$$

which is exactly $\tilde{S}\psi(v \cdot w)$. This finishes the proof that $\tilde{S}\psi$ is a formal conformal block. $\square$

3.4 Propagation of conformal blocks

$\imath\phi$ as a conformal block

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ be an N -pointed compact Riemann surface. Recall the divisor $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + \dots + x_N$. As in previous sections, we write $C - \{x_1, \dots, x_N\}$ as $C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ for brevity. Then the projection onto the second component $C \times (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is the family over $C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ with constant fiber C . We understand each x_i as the constant section $x_i : C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} \rightarrow C \times (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})$, i.e., its value at each $y \in C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ is (x_i, y) . Let

$$\iota : C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} \rightarrow C \times (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})$$

be the diagonal map, i.e., sending each y to (y, y) . We thus have a family of $(N+1)$ -pointed curve

$$\imath\mathfrak{X} = (C \times (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow (C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}); \iota, x_1, \dots, x_N). \quad (3.4.1)$$

Let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules associated to the N points of $\mathfrak{X}$. Choose $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Our first goal in this section is to show that the $\imath\phi$ in (3.1.6) can be identified naturally with an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\imath\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})$.

We make the identification of $\mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}$ -modules

$$\mathcal{W}_{\imath\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \simeq \mathcal{V}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \quad (3.4.2)$$

as follows. Choose any open subset $V \subset C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ and a univalent map $\mu : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, and choose local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ respectively. Then we have a local coordinate $\varrho(\mu)$ of $\iota(V)$ defined on $V \times V$ to be

$$\varrho(\mu)_y(x) \equiv \varrho(\mu)(x, y) = \mu(x) - \mu(y) \quad (3.4.3)$$

for any $x, y \in V$. One can also regard each η_i as the local coordinate of $x_i(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ constant over the base $C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$. Write $(\varrho(\mu), \eta_{\bullet}) = (\varrho(\mu), \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$. We then have trivialization

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu), \eta_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{W}_{\imath\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_V \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$$

as in (3.2.12). On the other hand, we have $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu) : \mathcal{V}_C|_V \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$ and $\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ as in (2.4.8) and (3.1.9), which give

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu) \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{V}_C|_V \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V.$$

Then the isomorphism (3.4.2) on V is given by

$$(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu) \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet))^{-1} \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu), \eta_\bullet) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_V \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathcal{V}_C|_V \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet). \quad (3.4.4)$$

We identify the above two sheaves of modules via the above map, so that we also have identification

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu), \eta_\bullet) = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu) \otimes \mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet). \quad (3.4.5)$$

Using (2.4.9), (3.1.10), and (3.2.13), it is not hard to see that this isomorphism is independent of the choice of μ and $\eta_\bullet$. Thus (3.4.2) can be defined globally.

Recall from (3.1.6) and Remark 3.1.4 that for each $w \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, $\imath\phi(w)$ is an element of $H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_C^*) = \mathcal{V}_C^*(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}) = \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}}(\mathcal{V}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}, \mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}})$ whose evaluation $\imath\phi(v, w_\bullet)$ with any $v \in \mathcal{V}_C(V)$ (where $V \subset C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ is open) is also written as $\imath\phi(v \otimes w_\bullet)$. This notation suggests that we regard $\imath\phi$ as an element of $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}}(\mathcal{V}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet), \mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}})$, which, through the isomorphism (3.4.2), becomes a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}$ -modules

$$\imath\phi : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_\bullet) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}.$$

We would like to show that $\imath\phi$ is a conformal block.

Theorem 3.4.1 (Propagation of conformal blocks). *For any $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, $\imath\phi$ is an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that C is connected. Then so is the base manifold $C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ of the family $\mathfrak{X}$. Choose any of $x_1, \dots, x_N$, say x_1 . Choose local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$ of $x_\bullet$ such that η_1 is defined on a neighborhood $V \ni x_1$. Assume that under the coordinate η_1 , V is an open disc centered at x_1 with radius $r > 0$. Identify $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ with $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$ via the trivialization $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)$ (which means we set $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet) = 1$). By Proposition 3.2.4, it suffices to prove that the restriction of $\imath\phi$ to $V - \{x_1\}$ is a conformal block. Identify V with an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$ via η_1 , which makes η_1 equal to the standard coordinate z of $\mathbb{C}$. We also have $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_1) = \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_1)$. Choose any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$ and $v \in \mathbb{V}$. By the fact that $\imath\phi$ equals $\imath\phi_{x_1}$ (defined by (3.1.5)) near x_1 , we have

$$\begin{aligned} & \imath\phi(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta_1), \eta_\bullet)^{-1}(v \otimes w_\bullet)) \stackrel{(3.4.5)}{=} \imath\phi(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_1)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) \\ &= \phi(Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(v, z)w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) \\ &\stackrel{(2.4.6)}{=} \phi(z^{\tilde{L}_0}Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(z^{-L_0}v, 1)z^{-\tilde{L}_0}w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N). \end{aligned} \quad (3.4.6)$$

Define

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{Y}} = (\mathbb{P}^1 \sqcup C; 0, 1, x_2, \dots, x_N; \infty; x_1; z, z-1, \eta_2, \dots, \eta_N; z^{-1}; \eta_1).$$

Its sewing (near $\infty \in \mathbb{P}^1, x_1 \in C$ controlled by $|z^{-1}| < 1, |\eta_1| < r$) gives a family $\mathfrak{Y}$ with base manifold the open disc $\mathcal{D}_r$ with radius r (which is equivalent to V). Associate $\mathbb{W}_1, \mathbb{V}, \mathbb{W}_2, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ to $0, 1, x_2, \dots, x_N$ and $\mathbb{W}'_1, \mathbb{W}_1$ to ∞, x_1 respectively. Let ψ be a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_2 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N \otimes \mathbb{W}'_1 \otimes \mathbb{W}_1$, for which we switch the order to $\mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{W}_2 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N \otimes \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}'_1$ (where the order of two $\mathbb{W}_1$ are also switched), is defined by $\phi \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet^*$ (a linear functional on the first N components) tensor the conformal block on $(\mathbb{P}; 0, 1, \infty)$ (which is a linear functional on the last three components) defined as in example 3.1.6. Then the sewing $\tilde{S}\psi$ (which is a formal conformal block by Theorem 3.3.5), evaluated with the constant section $v \otimes w_\bullet$ (under the local coordinates $z, z-1, \eta_2, \dots, \eta_N$ constant with respect to sewing), is

$$\phi(q^{\tilde{L}_0} Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(v, 1) w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N) \quad (\in \mathbb{C}[[q]]).$$

This expression is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r^\times)$ (and hence of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r)$) since (3.4.6) is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_r^\times)$. If we scale the local coordinates of $0, 1 \in \mathbb{P}^1$ by q^{-1} , then the above expression becomes (3.4.6) (with z replaced by q), and the restriction $\mathfrak{Y}_{\mathcal{D}_r^\times}$ of $\mathfrak{Y}$ to the punctured disc $\mathcal{D}_r^\times$, including the sections and the local coordinates, is exactly $\mathfrak{X}|_{V-\{x_1\}}$. This shows that, after scaling the coordinates, $\tilde{S}\psi$ becomes exactly $\mathfrak{I}\phi$. So $\tilde{S}\psi$ converges a.l.u.. By Proposition 3.3.2-2, $\tilde{S}\psi$ is an actual conformal block associated to the restricted family $\mathfrak{Y}_{\mathcal{D}_r^\times}$. So $\mathfrak{I}\phi|_{V-\{x_1\}}$ is a conformal block associated to $\mathfrak{X}|_{V-\{x_1\}}$. This finishes the proof. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.2. *For each $y \in C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$, if we set $\mathfrak{X}_y = (C; y, x_1, \dots, x_N)$, then the value of $\mathfrak{I}\phi$ at y , written as $\mathfrak{I}\phi|_y$, is an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_y}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.*

Remark 3.4.3. We describe the explicit form of $\mathfrak{I}\phi|_y$ as an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_y}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Choose local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$ at $x_\bullet$. Choose a univalent map μ defined on a neighborhood V of y . Then, $\varrho(\mu)_y$ (defined in (3.4.3)) is a local coordinate at y . Identify $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet) : \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. Then for any $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$,

$$\mathfrak{I}\phi|_y(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu)_y)^{-1}v \otimes w_\bullet) = \mathfrak{I}\phi(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1}v, w_\bullet)|_y, \quad (3.4.7)$$

where we recall that $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1}v$ is in $\mathcal{V}_C(V)$.

Note that Theorem 3.4.1 is stronger than Corollary 3.4.2, in that it says also that $\mathfrak{I}\phi|_y$ varies holomorphically over y .

Double propagation

We now want to propagate the conformal block $\mathfrak{I}\phi$. For any two sets A, B , we set

$$\text{Conf}(A, B) = \{(a, b) \in A \times B : a \neq b\}, \quad \text{Conf}_2(A) = \text{Conf}(A, A). \quad (3.4.8)$$

Fix trivialization $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \simeq \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ via $\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet})$. Let $V \subset C - S_{\mathfrak{x}}$ be open. For each $v \in \mathcal{V}_C(V)$ and $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, $v \otimes w_{\bullet}$ can be regarded as an element of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V)$ by (3.4.4). Therefore, by Theorem 3.2.5, we have $\wr \wr \phi(v \otimes w_{\bullet})$, written as $\wr \wr \phi(v, w_{\bullet})$ in the following, sending each $u \in \mathcal{V}_C(U)$ (where U is an open subset of $C - S_{\mathfrak{x}}$ disjoint from V) to an element $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet}) \in \mathcal{O}(U \times V)$. (To apply Theorem 3.2.5, we extend u to an element of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{x}}(U \times V)$ constantly over V .) This map is compatible with the restrictions to subsets of U and of V . Using this compatibility, for any (non-necessarily disjoint) open subsets $U, V \subset C$, $\wr \wr \phi(w_{\bullet})$ can be extended to a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}(U)$ - $\mathcal{O}(V)$ bimodules

$$\wr \wr \phi(w_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{V}_C(U) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{V}_C(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_2(C-S_{\mathfrak{x}})}(\text{Conf}(U - S_{\mathfrak{x}}, V - S_{\mathfrak{x}})) \quad (3.4.9)$$

compatible with the restrictions to subsets of U and V , such that for any $u \in \mathcal{V}_C(U)$, $v \in \mathcal{V}_C(V)$ and open subsets $U_0 \subset U$, $V_0 \subset V$ satisfying $U_0 \cap V_0 = \emptyset$, $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})|_{U_0 \times V_0}$ is the element $\wr \wr \phi(u|_{U_0 - S_{\mathfrak{x}}}, v|_{V_0 - S_{\mathfrak{x}}}, w_{\bullet})$ describe above (which is in $\mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_2(C-S_{\mathfrak{x}})}((U_0 - S_{\mathfrak{x}}) \times (V_0 - S_{\mathfrak{x}}))$). For brevity, such compatibility is summarized by saying that $\wr \wr \phi(w_{\bullet})$ is a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C \boxtimes \mathcal{O}_C$ -modules

$$\wr \wr \phi(w_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{V}_C \boxtimes \mathcal{V}_C \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_2(C-S_{\mathfrak{x}})} \quad (3.4.10)$$

Similar to this description, we can regard $\wr \phi(w_{\bullet})$ as a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C$ -modules

$$\wr \phi(w_{\bullet}) : \mathcal{V}_C \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{x}}} \quad (3.4.11)$$

whose value at each $v \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ is equal to the one at $v|_{V-S_{\mathfrak{x}}}$.

The next theorem is just the restatement of the description of $\wr \phi$ in Theorem 3.1.2. We assume that for each $i = 1, \dots, N$, η_i is defined on W_i , and that $W_i \cap W_j = \emptyset$ if $i \neq j$. Let z be the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$.

Theorem 3.4.4. *Choose any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. Choose $V \subset W_i$ an open disc centered at x_i (under the coordinate η_i), identify V with a neighborhood of $0 \in \mathbb{C}$ via η_i , and identify $\mathcal{V}_V \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$ via the trivialization $\mathcal{U}_{\rho}(\eta_i) = \mathcal{V}_{\rho}(\eta_i)$. Choose $v \in \mathcal{V}_C(V)$, and choose $y \in V - S_{\mathfrak{x}} = V - \{x_i\}$. Then*

$$\wr \phi(v, w_{\bullet})|_y = \phi(w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z)w_j \otimes \dots \otimes w_N)|_{z=\eta_i(y)}. \quad (3.4.12)$$

Moreover, we have

$$\wr \phi(1, w_{\bullet})|_y = \phi(w_{\bullet}). \quad (3.4.13)$$

In this theorem, $1 \in \mathcal{V}_C(C)$ is the vacuum section defined in Remark 2.5.3. Since $Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(1, z) = 1_{\mathbb{W}_i}$, (3.4.13) is clearly true when y is in a neighborhood of $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Thus (3.4.13) is true for any $y \in C$.

We now generalize this theorem to $\wr \wr \phi$.

Theorem 3.4.5. Choose any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. Choose any U, V open subsets of C with $\eta : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \mu : V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ univalent maps, identify $\mathcal{V}_U \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_U, \mathcal{V}_V \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_V$ via trivializations $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta) = \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta), \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu) = \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\mu)$ respectively. Choose u, v in $\mathcal{V}_C(U), \mathcal{V}_C(V)$ respectively, and choose $x \in U - S_{\mathfrak{x}}, y \in V - S_{\mathfrak{x}}$ satisfying $x \neq y$. Then the following are true.

- (1) If U is an open disc in W_i centered at x_i (under the coordinate η_i) and does not contain y , and if $\eta = \eta_i$. Then

$$\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)|_{x,y} = \wr \phi(v, w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(u, z)w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N)|_y \Big|_{z=\eta_i(x)} \quad (3.4.14)$$

where the series of z on the right hand side converges absolutely, and we regard $u \in \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}[[z]]$ by taking Taylor series expansion of the variable η_i at x_i .

- (2) If $U = V$ and do not contain $x_1, \dots, x_N$, if $\eta = \mu$, and if U contains the closed disc with center y and radius $|\eta(x) - \eta(y)|$ (under the coordinate η), then

$$\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)|_{x,y} = \wr \phi(Y(u, z)v, w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N)|_y \Big|_{z=\eta(x)-\eta(y)} \quad (3.4.15)$$

where the series of z on the right hand side converges absolutely, and we regard $u \in \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}[[z]]$ by taking Taylor series expansion of the variable $\eta - \eta(y)$ at y .

- (3) We have

$$\wr \wr \phi(1, v, w_\bullet) = \wr \phi(v, w_\bullet). \quad (3.4.16)$$

- (4) We have

$$\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)|_{x,y} = \wr \wr \phi(v, u, w_\bullet)|_{y,x}. \quad (3.4.17)$$

Proof. It is easy to see that

$$\wr \wr \phi_{x,y} = \wr (\wr \phi|_y)|_x. \quad (3.4.18)$$

Thus (1) (2) (3) follow directly from Theorem 3.4.4 and relation (3.4.13) (with ϕ replaced by $\wr \phi|_y$). We now prove (4). It suffices to assume that C is connected.

Assume first of all that $N > 1$. Let U and V be open discs in W_1, W_2 centered at x_1, x_2 and identified with open subsets of $\mathbb{C}$ via η_1, η_2 respectively. (Note that under this identification, we have $x_1 = 0$ and $x_2 = 0$.) Let ζ be also the standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. Then from (1) and Theorem 3.4.4, $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)|_{x,y}$ equals the evaluation of

$$g(z, \zeta) := \phi(Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(u, z)w_1 \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_2}(v, \zeta)w_2 \otimes w_3 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) \quad (3.4.19)$$

(which is an element of $\mathbb{C}((z, \zeta))$) first at $\zeta = \eta_2(y)$ and then at $z = \eta_1(x)$. By varying x and y , $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)$ is clearly a two-variable holomorphic function $f(z, \zeta)$

on $(U - \{0\}) \times (V - \{0\})$. Thus, we have for any $z_0 \in U - \{0\}, \zeta_0 \in V - \{0\}$ that $f(z, \zeta)|_{\zeta=\zeta_0}|_{z=z_0} = g(z, \zeta)|_{\zeta=\zeta_0}|_{z=z_0}$.

By taking Laurant series expansions, we may regard $f(z, \zeta)$ as an element of $\mathbb{C}[[z^{\pm 1}, \zeta^{\pm 1}]]$. By applying $\text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \text{Res}_{z=0}(\cdots) z^m \zeta^n dz d\zeta$ to f and g for any $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$ (note the order of the two residues), we see that $f(z, \zeta)$ and $g(z, \zeta)$ can be regarded as identical elements of $\mathbb{C}[[z^{\pm 1}, \zeta^{\pm 1}]]$. Since g is in $\mathbb{C}((z, \zeta))$, so is f . Since the double series $f(z, \zeta)$ converges absolutely when $z \in U - \{0\}$ and $\zeta \in V - \{0\}$, so does $g(z, \zeta)$. Therefore, the evaluations of (3.4.19) at $\zeta = \eta_2(y)$ and at $z = \eta_1(x)$ commute. This proves (4) for the above chosen U, V . By analytic continuation, one may use the argument in the proof of Proposition 3.2.4 to show (4) when U is as above and V is any open subset of C . Another application of this argument proves (4) for any open $U, V \subset C$.

Finally, we assume that $N = 1$. Then, by (3.4.13), ϕ is the restriction of a conformal block ψ on C with two marked points. Since (4) is true for ψ , it holds also for ϕ . $\square$

Multiple propagations

Although single and double propagations are sufficient for proving the main results of this monograph, it would be interesting to generalize them to multiple propagation.

Choose $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and define

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Conf}(A_1, \dots, A_n) &= \{(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in A_1 \times \cdots \times A_n : a_i \neq a_j \text{ for any } 1 \leq i < j \leq n\}, \\ \text{Conf}_n(A) &= \text{Conf}(A, A, \dots, A). \end{aligned}$$

One can apply the propagation n -times to obtain, for each $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C^{\boxtimes n}$ -modules

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_C^{\boxtimes n} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})}, \quad (3.4.20)$$

which means that for any open subsets $U_1, \dots, U_n$ of C , we have an $\mathcal{O}(U_1) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \cdots \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(U_n)$ -module homomorphism

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_C(U_1) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \cdots \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{V}_C(U_n) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}})}(\text{Conf}(U_1 - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \dots, U_n - S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$$

compatible with respect to restrictions. We have the following generalization of Theorem 3.4.5. Recall again that $W_1, \dots, W_N$ are mutually disjoint neighborhoods of $x_1, \dots, x_N$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively.

Theorem 3.4.6. *Choose any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. For each $1 \leq k \leq n$, choose an open subset U_k of C equipped with a univalent map $\mu_k : U_k \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, identify $\mathcal{V}_{U_k} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{U_k}$ via trivialization $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu_k) = \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\mu_k)$, choose $v_k \in \mathcal{V}_C(U_k) = \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(U_k)$, and choose $y_k \in U_k - S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ satisfying $y_j \neq y_k$ for any $1 \leq j < k \leq n$. Then the following are true.*

- (1) If U_1 is an open disc of W_i centered at x_i (under the coordinate η_i) and does not contain $y_2, \dots, y_n$, and if $\mu_1 = \eta_i$, then

$$\begin{aligned} & \imath^n \phi(v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet) \Big|_{y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n} \\ &= \imath^{n-1} \phi(v_2, \dots, v_n, w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v_1, z) w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_N) \Big|_{y_2, \dots, y_n} \Big|_{z=\eta_i(y_1)} \end{aligned} \quad (3.4.21)$$

where the series of z on the right hand side converges absolutely, and v_1 is considered as an element of $\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}((z))$ by taking Taylor series expansion with respect to the variable η_j at x_j .

- (2) If $U_1 = U_2$ and do not contain $x_1, \dots, x_N, y_3, \dots, y_n$, if $\mu_1 = \mu_2$, and if U_2 contains the closed disc with center y_2 and radius $|\mu_2(y_1) - \mu_2(y_2)|$ (under the coordinate μ_2), then

$$\begin{aligned} & \imath^n \phi(v_1, v_2, v_3, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet) \Big|_{y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n} \\ &= \imath^{n-1} \phi(Y(v_1, z) v_2, v_3, \dots, v_n, w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N) \Big|_{y_2, \dots, y_n} \Big|_{z=\mu_2(y_1) - \mu_2(y_2)} \end{aligned} \quad (3.4.22)$$

where the series of z on the right hand side converges absolutely, and v_1 is considered as an element of $\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}((z))$ by taking Taylor series expansion with respect to the variable $\mu_2 - \mu_2(y_2)$ at y_2 .

- (3) We have

$$\imath^n \phi(\mathbf{1}, v_2, v_3, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet) = \imath^{n-1} \phi(v_2, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet). \quad (3.4.23)$$

- (4) For any permutation σ of the set $\{1, 2, \dots, n\}$, we have

$$\imath^n \phi(v_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma(n)}, w_\bullet) \Big|_{y_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, y_{\sigma(n)}} = \imath^n \phi(v_1, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet) \Big|_{y_1, \dots, y_n}. \quad (3.4.24)$$

Proof. (1) (2) (3) follow from

$$\imath^n \phi \Big|_{y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n} = \imath(\imath^{n-1} \phi \Big|_{y_2, \dots, y_n}) \Big|_{y_1}. \quad (3.4.25)$$

If σ fixes $3, \dots, n$ and exchanges $1, 2$, then (4) follows from Theorem 3.4.5-(4). If $1 \leq k < n$ and σ exchanges $k, k+1$ and fixes the others, then the first two components of $\imath^{n-k+1} \phi$ are exchangeable. Thus, by propagating $\imath^{n-k+1} \phi$ for $k-1$ times, we see that the k -th and the $(k+1)$ -th components of $\imath^n \phi$ are exchangeable. This proves (4) in general. $\square$

3.5 A commutator formula

The results of this section will be used in Section 3.6 to define a logarithmic connection on sheaves of conformal blocks.

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces. We are going to define a sheaf action $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \curvearrowright \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ which is $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -linear on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ and $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -linear on $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$. In other words, we shall define a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules

$$\mathbf{L} : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \underline{\text{End}}_{\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}}(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})).$$

Thus, for any open subset $W \subset \mathcal{C}$, any element of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$ gives an element of $\text{End}_{\mathcal{O}_W}(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})|_W)$.

Choose open $W \subset \mathcal{C}$ together with $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(W)$ univalent on each fiber. We assume that W is small enough such that $\pi(W)$ has coordinates $\tau_{\bullet} = (\tau_1, \tau_2, \dots)$. Write also $\tau_{\bullet} \circ \pi$ as $\tau_{\bullet}$ for simplicity. Identify W with an open subset of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ via $(\eta, \tau_{\bullet})$, and identify

$$\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_W \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_W, \quad \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_W \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_W$$

via the trivialization $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta) = \mathcal{V}_{\varrho}(\eta)$. Let z be the standard coordinates of $\mathbb{C}$ (which is identified with η). Then for any $udz = u(z, \tau_{\bullet})dz$ in $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$, open subset $U \subset W$, and $v = v(z, \tau_{\bullet})$ in $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_W(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(U)$, we define the action of udz on v , written as $\mathbf{L}_{udz}v = (\mathbf{L}_{udz}v)(z, \tau_{\bullet})$, to be

$$\mathbf{L}_{udz} v = \text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} Y(u(\zeta, \tau_{\bullet}), \zeta - z)v(z, \tau_{\bullet})d\zeta \quad (3.5.1)$$

where ζ is another distinct standard complex variable of $\mathbb{C}$. Note that u, v are $\mathbb{V}$ -valued meromorphic functions on W with possible poles at $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$. That $\mathbf{L}_{udz}v$ has finite poles at $S_{\mathfrak{X}}$ follows from the easy calculation

$$\mathbf{L}_{udz} v = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{1}{n!} Y(\partial_z^n u(z, \tau_{\bullet}))_n v(z, \tau_{\bullet}) \quad (3.5.2)$$

where the sum is finite by the lower truncation property.

Similar to (3.2.4), the definition of this action is independent of the choice of η thanks to Theorem 2.4.1. Thus, it can be extended to $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \curvearrowright \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$. (We will not this fact; in Section 3.6, we shall only use the local expression of $\mathbf{L}$ as in (3.5.2).) By tensoring with the identity map of $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$, we get a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules

$$\mathbf{L} : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \underline{\text{End}}_{\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}}(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$$

whose local expression under η is

$$\mathbf{L}_{udz} v dz = \left(\text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} Y(u(\zeta, \tau_{\bullet}), \zeta - z)v(z, \tau_{\bullet})d\zeta \right) dz$$

$$= \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{1}{n!} Y(\partial_z^n u(z, \tau_\bullet))_n v(z, \tau_\bullet) dz. \quad (3.5.3)$$

Now, we assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is small enough such that we have a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$. Let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules associated to the N -points. Let now W be a neighborhood of $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ on which η_i is defined, set $\eta = \eta_i$, and take the identifications mentioned above. Recall that by (3.2.4), for each $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ and $vdz \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$,

$$vdz \cdot w_i = \text{Res}_{z=0} Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z) w_i dz.$$

The following is the main result of this section.

Proposition 3.5.1. *For any $udz, vdz \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$ and $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$,*

$$udz \cdot vdz \cdot w_i - vdz \cdot udz \cdot w_i = (\mathbf{L}_{udz} vdz) \cdot w_i.$$

Note that the same identity holds when w_i is replaced by any $w \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$.

Proof. We write w_i as w for simplicity. Since the actions of udz, vdz and the definition of $\mathbf{L}$ can be defined fiberwisely, it suffices to assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is a single point. We thus suppress the symbol $\tau_\bullet$. Note that W is identified with $\eta(W)$ under η . We assume that $W = \eta(W)$ is an open disc. Choose any $w' \in \mathbb{W}'_i$. Then there exists a holomorphic function $f = f(z, \zeta)$ on $\text{Conf}_2(W - \{0\})$ (recall (3.4.8)) such that for each fixed z , the series expansion (with respect to the variable ζ) near 0, z are respectively

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha_z(\zeta) &= \langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(u, \zeta) w \rangle && \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta)), \\ \gamma_z(\zeta - z) &= \langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, z) w \rangle && \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta - z)), \end{aligned}$$

and that for each fixed ζ , the series expansion with respect to z at 0 is

$$\beta_\zeta(z) = \langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(u, \zeta) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z) w \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((z)).$$

Indeed, let ϕ be the conformal block on $(\mathbb{P}^1; 0, \infty)$ defined in example 3.1.6. Then $f = \text{res} \phi(u, v, w \otimes w')$. That its series expansions are described as above follows from theorems 3.4.4 and 3.4.5.

Choose circles $C_1, C_2, C_3 \subset W$ centered at 0 with radii r_1, r_2, r_3 respectively satisfying $r_1 < r_2 < r_3$. For each $z \in C_2$, choose a circle $C(z)$ centered at z whose radius is less than $r_2 - r_1$ and $r_3 - r_2$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \langle w', vdz \cdot udz \cdot w \rangle &= \text{Res}_{z=0} (\text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \alpha_z(\zeta) d\zeta) dz = \text{Res}_{z=0} (\text{Res}_{\zeta=0} f(z, \zeta) d\zeta) dz \\ &= \oint_{C_2} \left(\oint_{C_1} f(z, \zeta) d\zeta \right) dz. \end{aligned} \quad (3.5.4)$$

Similarly,

$$\langle w', u dz \cdot v dz \cdot w \rangle = \oint_{C_3} \left(\oint_{C_2} f(z, \zeta) dz \right) d\zeta = \oint_{C_2} \left(\oint_{C_3} f(z, \zeta) d\zeta \right) dz. \quad (3.5.5)$$

Note that in the last equation, the two contour integrals are interchangeable since f is holomorphic and in particular continuous on $\text{Conf}_2(W - \{0\})$. Also,

$$\begin{aligned} \langle w', (\mathbf{L}_{u dz} v dz) \cdot w_i \rangle &= \text{Res}_{z=0} (\text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} \gamma_z(\zeta - z) d\zeta) dz \\ &= \oint_{C_2} \left(\oint_{C(z)} f(z, \zeta) d\zeta \right) dz, \end{aligned}$$

which, by Cauchy integral theorem (applied to the function $\zeta \mapsto f(z, \zeta)$ for each fixed z), equals the difference of (3.5.5) and (3.5.4). This finishes the proof. $\square$

The following useful observation will be used in constructing connections on sheaves of conformal blocks.

Lemma 3.5.2. *For any $v dz \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$ and $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$,*

$$((\partial_z v) dz) \cdot w_i + ((L_{-1} v) dz) \cdot w_i = 0.$$

Proof. Recall that when v is a constant section, we have the L_{-1} -derivative property (2.2.4). Since we do not assume here that v is constant, we have

$$\partial_z Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z) = Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\partial_z v, z) + Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(L_{-1} v, z).$$

Thus, the left hand side of the equation we want to prove equals

$$\text{Res}_{z=0} \partial_z (Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, z) w_i) dz.$$

This residue must be 0 since the series expansion of $\partial_z(\dots)$ with respect to z does not contain z^{-1} . $\square$

3.6 The logarithmic connections

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ be a family of complex curves. If $\mathcal{E}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module, then a **logarithmic connection** ∇ on $\mathcal{E}$ associates to each open subset $U \subset \mathcal{B}$ a bilinear map

$$\nabla : \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(U) \times \mathcal{E}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}(U), \quad (\eta, s) \mapsto \nabla_{\eta} s$$

satisfying conditions (a) and (b) of Definition 1.8.3, namely,

- (a) If V is an open subset of U , then $\nabla_{\eta|_V} s|_V = (\nabla_{\eta} s)|_V$.
- (b) If $f \in \mathcal{O}_B(U)$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\nabla_{f\eta} s &= f \nabla_{\eta} s, \\ \nabla_{\eta}(fs) &= \eta(f)s + f \nabla_{\eta} s.\end{aligned}$$

Thus, ∇ is a connection if $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of compact Riemann surfaces (equivalently, $\Delta = \emptyset$).

Given a logarithmic connection ∇ on $\mathcal{E}$, one can define on the dual sheaf $\mathcal{E}^*$ the dual connection (also denoted by ∇) as follows. Choose any open $U \subset \mathcal{B}$, $\eta \in \Theta_B(-\log \Delta)(U)$, and $\sigma \in \mathcal{E}^*(U) = \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}|_U, \mathcal{O}_U)$, then $\nabla_{\eta}\sigma$, which is an element of $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_U}(\mathcal{E}|_U, \mathcal{O}_U)$, is defined such that for any open subset $V \subset U$ and $s \in \mathcal{E}(V)$,

$$\langle \nabla_{\eta}\sigma, s \rangle = \eta\langle \sigma, s \rangle - \langle \sigma, \nabla_{\eta}s \rangle. \quad (3.6.1)$$

We now assume that $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed complex curves $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ equipped with $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$. Our goal of this section is to define locally a logarithmic connection ∇ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ near each point of $\mathcal{B}$. Since our task is local, we assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is small enough such that the following hold.

- (i) $\mathfrak{X}$ is either smooth or is obtained by sewing a smooth family.
- (ii) If $\mathfrak{X}$ is smooth, then $\mathcal{B}$ is biholomorphic to a Stein open subset of a complex coordinate space $\mathbb{C}^m$ ($m \in \mathbb{N}$); if $\mathfrak{X}$ is obtained by sewing a smooth family $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$, then $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is biholomorphic to a Stein open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$.
- (iii) We can equip $\varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N$ with local coordinates:

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N).$$

Note that condition (ii) implies that $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein. (If $\mathfrak{X}$ is obtained by sewing $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$, then $\mathcal{B}$ is a product of the Stein manifold $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ and some open discs, which is therefore Stein.) Recall the description of $\Theta_B(-\log \Delta)$ near (1.6.17), which shows that, due to condition (ii), $\Theta_B(-\log \Delta)$ is a free $\mathcal{O}_B$ -module, i.e., it is generated freely by finitely many global sections $\eta_1, \eta_2, \dots \in \Theta_B(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$.

We shall construct a (global) logarithmic connection ∇ over $\mathcal{B}$ whenever the above three conditions are satisfied. For that purpose, we shall define, for each $\eta \in \{\eta_1, \eta_2, \dots\}$, a sheaf map (not a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_B$ -modules !)

$$\nabla_{\eta} : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$$

satisfying that for any open $U \subset \mathcal{B}$, $w \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(U)$, and $f \in \mathcal{O}(U)$,

$$\nabla_{\eta}(fw) = \eta(f)w + f \nabla_{\eta}w.$$

(Indeed, we will do this for any $\eta \in \Theta_B(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$.) Then the **differential operators** $\nabla_{\eta_1}, \nabla_{\eta_2}, \dots$ extend to a logarithmic connection ∇ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, whose dual connection is the one ∇ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.

Defining ∇ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$

We now fix $\eta \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$. Recall that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is the quotient of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathcal{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ (identified via $\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet})$) by the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -submodule $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Our plan is to define the action of ∇_{η} on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, and then to show that ∇_{η} preserves that submodule.

Choose any $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then, due to (1.6.22), we have a short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \xrightarrow{d\pi} (\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow 0.$$

where $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is short for $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta})(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$. By Theorem 1.5.7, there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $k \geq k_0$ and $b \in \mathcal{B}$, we have $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0$. Thus, when $k \geq k_0$, we have $R^1 \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) = 0$ due to Grauert's Theorem 1.6.2. Therefore, if we apply (1.3.1) to the above short exact sequence, we get an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \xrightarrow{d\pi} \pi_*(\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(kS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow 0.$$

Consider this as a short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules. Since $\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})$ is coherent by Grauert direct image theorem (indeed it is locally free by Theorem 1.6.2), and since $\mathcal{B}$ is assumed to be Stein, we have $H^1(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0$ by Cartan's theorem B. Therefore, we have an exact sequence of vector spaces $0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \xrightarrow{d\pi} H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow 0$. To simplify notations, we take the direct limit over all $k \geq k_0$ to obtain an exact sequence

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) &\rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \\ &\xrightarrow{d\pi} H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow 0. \end{aligned} \quad (3.6.2)$$

Choose any $\eta \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$. Then, its pull back $\pi^* \eta$ is in $\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{C})$ (recall (1.3.2)), which can be viewed as an element of $\pi_*(\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(\mathcal{B})$ and hence of $\pi_*(\pi^* \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta))(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{B})$. Since the $d\pi$ in the above exact sequence is a surjective, there exists a **lift** $\tilde{\eta}$ of η , i.e., an element $\tilde{\eta}$ satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{\eta} &\in \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C}), \\ d\pi(\tilde{\eta}) &= \pi^* \eta. \end{aligned} \quad (3.6.3)$$

(Recall that $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C})$ equals $\pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{B})$.)

We are going to use $\tilde{\eta}$ to define ∇_{η} . Let $\tau_{\bullet} = (\tau_1, \tau_2, \dots)$ be coordinates of $\pi(\mathcal{B})$. For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, choose a neighborhood W_i of $\zeta_i(\mathcal{B})$ on which η_i is defined, such that $W_i \cap W_j = \emptyset$ when $i \neq j$. Write $\tau_{\bullet} \circ \pi$ also as $\tau_{\bullet}$ for simplicity, so that

$(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$ is a coordinate of W_i . Identify W_i with its image via $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$, so that η_i is identified with the standard coordinate z of $\mathbb{C}$. Write

$$\eta = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j}. \quad (3.6.4)$$

Then by (1.6.18) and (3.6.3), when restricted to W_i , $\tilde{\eta}$ can be written as

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{W_i} = h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) \partial_z + \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} \quad (3.6.5)$$

where, due to the divisor $\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}$, $z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet)$ is a holomorphic function on W_i for some $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Recall that $\mathbf{c}$ is the conformal vector of $\mathbb{V}$. We set

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}) &\in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W_1 \cup \dots \cup W_N) \\ \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta})|_{W_i} &= h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) \mathbf{c} \, dz. \end{aligned} \quad (3.6.6)$$

Now, for any open subset $U \subset \mathcal{B}$ and any $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(U)$, we define

$$\boxed{\nabla_{\eta} w_i = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} w_i - \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}) \cdot w_i} \quad (3.6.7)$$

For any $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(U)$, we set

$$\nabla_{\eta} w_\bullet = \sum_{i=1}^N w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_i \otimes \dots \otimes \nabla_{\eta} w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_N. \quad (3.6.8)$$

This finishes the definition of ∇_{η} .

Remark 3.6.1. It is easy to check that the definition of ∇_{η} is independent of the choice of the coordinate $\tau_\bullet$ of $\mathcal{B}$. Thus, if we assume in (ii) just that $\mathcal{B}$ is a Stein manifold, then one still has a well defined ∇_{η} whose local expression is given by (3.6.7) and (3.6.8) when choosing a coordinate $\tau_\bullet$ for a small enough open subset of $\mathcal{B}$. The requirement that $\mathcal{B}$ is also biholomorphic to an open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$ is used to define ∇ , for which the freeness of $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$ is needed.

Remark 3.6.2. As mentioned before, we define ∇ by first defining $\nabla_{\eta_1}, \nabla_{\eta_2}, \dots$ where $\eta_1, \eta_2, \dots$ generate freely $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$, and then extending it $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -linearly to a logarithmic connection over $\mathcal{B}$. $\nabla_{\eta_1}, \nabla_{\eta_2}, \dots$ are defined by formula (3.6.7) using the lifts $\tilde{\eta}_1, \tilde{\eta}_2, \dots$. Then for any section η of $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)$, the operator ∇_{η} can also be defined by (3.6.7) by choosing the lift $\tilde{\eta}$ in the following way: choose unique sections $f_1, f_2, \dots$ of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ such that $\eta = f_1 \eta_1 + f_2 \eta_2 + \dots$. Then $\tilde{\eta} = (f_1 \circ \pi) \tilde{\eta}_1 + (f_2 \circ \pi) \tilde{\eta}_2 + \dots$.

Remark 3.6.3. One can write down the explicit formula of $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}) \cdot w_i$. Write

$$h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet) z^k, \quad (3.6.9)$$

noting that $\hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet)$ vanishes when k is sufficiently small. Then, using $Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c})_k = L_{k-1}$, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}) \cdot w_i &= \text{Res}_{z=0} h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, z) w_i dz = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet) \text{Res}_{z=0} z^k Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, z) w_i dz \\ &= \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c})_k w_i = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} w_i. \end{aligned} \quad (3.6.10)$$

We conclude:

$$\nabla_{\tilde{\eta}} w_i = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} w_i - \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}_i(k, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} w_i. \quad (3.6.11)$$

Remark 3.6.4. We give a heuristic explanation of our definition of $\nabla_{\tilde{\eta}}$. Assume that $\mathfrak{X}$ is a smooth family. For brevity, we also assume $N = i = 1$, and write $\mathbb{W}_i = \mathbb{W}$, $w_i = w$, $\varsigma_i = \varsigma$, $\eta_i = \eta$. Let $\zeta \mapsto \varphi_\zeta^\eta$ and $\zeta \mapsto \varphi_\zeta^{\tilde{\eta}}$ be the (complex) one-parameter flows (in $\mathcal{C}$ and in $\mathcal{B}$) integrated from the vector fields η and $\tilde{\eta}$ respectively. Fix $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and set $b(\zeta) = \varphi_\zeta^\eta(b)$. Choose a closed disc $D(b)$ in the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ centered at $\varsigma(b)$. Then we have an equivalence of open Riemann surfaces

$$\varphi_\zeta^{\tilde{\eta}} : \mathcal{C}_b - D(b) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{C}_{b(\zeta)} - D(b(\zeta))$$

where $D(b(\zeta))$ is a closed disc inside $\mathcal{C}_b$. Now, η gives local coordinates of $\mathcal{C}_b - D(b)$ and $\mathcal{C}_{b(\zeta)} - D(b(\zeta))$ near the circles $\partial D(b)$ and $\partial(D(b(\zeta)))$ respectively. Pull back the coordinate η near $\partial(D(b(\zeta)))$ to one near $\partial D(b)$ through the biholomorphic map $\varphi_\zeta^{\tilde{\eta}}$, and call this new coordinate η_ζ . Then, we have two local coordinates of $\mathcal{C}_b - D(b)$: they are η, η_ζ , both defined near $\partial D(b)$.

Now, we shall find the condition of w to be a parallel section in the direction of η . Then $w(b)$ in the η coordinate should be equal to $w(b(\zeta))$ in the η_ζ coordinate. So one should expect the following identity of elements in $\mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W})$:

$$\mathcal{U}(\eta)^{-1} w(b) = \mathcal{U}(\eta_\zeta)^{-1} w(b(\zeta)).$$

Here, $\mathcal{U}(\eta)$ and $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\zeta)$ are the trivializations of the vector space $\mathscr{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W})$ induced by the local coordinates η, η_ζ near the circles. (We have defined such trivializations in the paragraphs near (3.1.9) when the local coordinates are defined near (neighborhoods of) points. It is reasonable to expect that they can be generalized, at least formally, to those defined near circles.) Thus, formally, we have

$$w(b(\zeta)) = \mathcal{U}(\eta_\zeta \circ \eta^{-1}) w(b).$$

We now want to take the derivative of this equation. Set $h = h_i, \hat{h} = \hat{h}_i$. Then $\partial_\zeta(\eta_\zeta \circ \eta^{-1})|_{\zeta=0}$, the derivative at $\zeta = 0$ of the transformation $\eta_\zeta \circ \eta^{-1}$, should equal the vector field $h(z, \tau_\bullet)\partial_z$ at $\tau_\bullet = b$ due to (3.6.5). Thus, the derivative of $\mathcal{U}(\eta_\zeta \circ \eta^{-1})$ at $\tau_\bullet = b$ should equal the action of the vector field $h(z, b)\partial_z = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}(k, b)z^k\partial_z$ on $\mathbb{W}$, which, by the correspondence $z^k\partial_z \leftrightarrow L_{k-1}$ (see (2.3.1))¹, should be $\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}(k, b)L_{k-1}$. So

$$\partial_\zeta w(b(\zeta))\Big|_{\zeta=0} = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \hat{h}(k, b)L_{k-1}w(b).$$

By (3.6.11), this is equivalent to $\nabla_\eta w_i = 0$ at b .

Defining ∇ on $\mathcal{I}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$

Assume as before that $\mathcal{B}$ satisfies conditions (i)-(iii).

Theorem 3.6.5. *The logarithmic connection ∇ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ descends to one on $\mathcal{I}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.*

To prove this theorem, we need to show that ∇_η descends to one on $\mathcal{I}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. This means that we need to check that ∇_η preserves the $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -submodule $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

Proof. Choose any open subset $U \subset \mathcal{B}$. Choose any $w_i \in \mathbb{W}_i \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(U)$ for each $1 \leq i \leq N$ and set $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N$ which is in $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(U) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(U)$. Choose $v \in \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(U)$. So $v \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C}_U)$. (Recall that by our notation, $\mathcal{C}_U = \pi^{-1}(U)$.) We shall show that $[\nabla_\eta, v] = \mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\eta}}v$, i.e.,

$$\nabla_\eta(v \cdot w_i) = v \cdot \nabla_\eta w_i + \mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\eta}}v \cdot w_i. \quad (3.6.12)$$

Then the same relation holds with w_i replaced by $w_\bullet$, which will finish the proof of the theorem. (Note that $\mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\eta}}$ is defined as in Section 2.6, and that $\mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\eta}}v$ is also in $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C}_U)$.) Since both sides of (3.6.12) are $\mathbb{W}_i$ -valued holomorphic functions on U , to prove this relation on U , it suffices to verify it on $U - \Delta$. Therefore, we assume in the following that $\Delta = \emptyset$ and $\mathcal{B} = U$. So $\mathfrak{X}$ is a smooth family.

Recall that η_i is defined on W_i , and that we have identified W_i with $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)(W_i)$ and hence η_i with the standard coordinate z . Since, in (3.6.12), v is acting on $\mathbb{W}_i$, we use $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) = \mathcal{V}_\varrho(\eta_i)$ to identify $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}|_{W_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i}$ and hence $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}|_{W_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i} dz$. Then the section $v|_{W_i} \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W_i)$ can be written as $v = u dz$ where $u = u(z, \tau_\bullet) \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W_i)$.

We now use (3.6.7) to calculate that

$$\nabla_\eta(v \cdot w_i) = \nabla_\eta(udz \cdot w_i) = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j}(udz \cdot w_i) - \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}) \cdot u dz \cdot w_i,$$

¹Here, unlike in Section 2.3, the action of $z\partial_z$ is L_0 but not $\tilde{L}_0$.

which, by Proposition 3.5.1, equals

$$\begin{aligned} & \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) u dz \cdot \partial_{\tau_j} w_i - u dz \cdot \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}) \cdot w_i + \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) ((\partial_{\tau_j} u) dz \cdot w_i) - (\mathbf{L}_{\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})} u dz) \cdot w_i \\ &= v \cdot \nabla_{\mathfrak{h}} w_i + \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) ((\partial_{\tau_j} u) dz \cdot w_i) - (\mathbf{L}_{\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})} u dz) \cdot w_i. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, one can finish proving (3.6.12) by showing

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}} u dz \cdot w_i = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) ((\partial_{\tau_j} u) dz \cdot w_i) - (\mathbf{L}_{\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})} u dz) \cdot w_i.$$

By Lemma 3.5.2, the above equation follows if we can show

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}} u dz = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) (\partial_{\tau_j} u) dz - \mathbf{L}_{\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})} u dz + (\partial_z + L_{-1})(\cdots) dz. \quad (3.6.13)$$

By (3.6.6) and (3.5.3), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{L}_{\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})} u dz &= \sum_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) Y(\mathbf{c})_k u(z, \tau_\bullet) dz \\ &= \sum_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} u(z, \tau_\bullet). \end{aligned}$$

By Theorem 2.6.2 and also Remark 2.6.3 (which explains the appearance of $\partial_z h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) u dz$ below), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}} u dz &= h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) \partial_z u dz + \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} u dz - \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} u dz + \partial_z h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) u dz \\ &= \partial_z (h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) u) dz + \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} u dz - \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} u dz + h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) L_{-1} u dz \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} u dz - \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{1}{k!} \partial_z^k h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) L_{k-1} u dz + (\partial_z + L_{-1})(h_i(z, \tau_\bullet) u) dz. \end{aligned}$$

This proves (3.6.13). □

Projective uniqueness of ∇

We shall show that the definition of $\nabla_{\mathfrak{h}}$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is independent, up to $\mathcal{O}_B$ -scalar multiples, of the choice of the lift $\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}$.

Proposition 3.6.6. Suppose that $\eta \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$ has two lifts $\tilde{\eta}, \tilde{\eta}' \in \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_{\Delta} + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C})$ which together with $\eta_{\bullet}$ define $\nabla_{\eta}, \nabla'_{\eta}$ respectively. Then there exists $f \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ such that

$$\nabla_{\eta}s - \nabla'_{\eta}s = -fs$$

for any section s of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Consequently, for any section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, we have

$$\nabla_{\eta}\phi - \nabla'_{\eta}\phi = f\phi. \quad (3.6.14)$$

Remark 3.6.7. A different proof of this proposition will be given in Section 4.2, and we will see that $f = \#(\tilde{\eta} - \tilde{\eta}')$ which is calculated by (4.2.4).

Proof. Set $\tilde{0} = \tilde{\eta} - \tilde{\eta}'$ and $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0}) = \mathfrak{v}(\tilde{\eta}) - \mathfrak{v}(\tilde{\eta}')$. Then $d\pi(\tilde{0}) = 0$, i.e., $\tilde{0}$ is a lift of the zero tangent field of $\mathcal{B}$. Hence, by the exact sequence (3.6.2), we have

$$\tilde{0} \in \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{B}).$$

Let $W = W_1 \cup \cdots \cup W_N$. Then $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})$ is an element of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$. We shall show that the action of $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})$ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ (defined by acting on each component as in (3.2.5)) descends to an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -scalar multiplication on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.

On each W_i and under the previously mentioned trivializations, $\tilde{0}$ and $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})$ can be written as

$$\tilde{0}|_{W_i} = a_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})\partial_z, \quad \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})|_{W_i} = a_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})\mathbf{c} \, dz.$$

So

$$\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0}) \in \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W).$$

By Theorem 1.5.7, there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and $k \geq k_0$, we have $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0$. Thus, as argued for (3.6.2), by constructing long exact sequences twice and using the fact that $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein, we see that the short exact sequence (2.5.16) gives rise to an exact sequence of vector spaces

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))) \xrightarrow{\lambda} H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow 0. \quad (3.6.15)$$

Since λ is surjective, there is an element $u \in \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B}) = \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C})$ such that $\lambda(u) = \tilde{0}$. By (2.5.17) (note the identification that $\eta = z$), on W_i we can express u by

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)u|_{W_i} = a_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})\mathbf{c} \, dz + b_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})\mathbf{1} \, dz.$$

Hence

$$\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})|_{W_i} - u|_{W_i} = -b_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})\mathbf{1} \, dz.$$

Set $f(\tau_{\bullet}) = -\sum_i \text{Res}_{z=0} b_i(z, \tau_{\bullet})dz$. Then $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0}) - u|_W$ acts as $f \cdot \mathbf{1}$ on $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ and hence on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. By the definition of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ as a quotient of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, u acts trivially on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. So $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})$ acts as $f \cdot \mathbf{1}$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. $\square$

3.7 Local freeness

We say that the VOA $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -**cofinite** if the subspace of $\mathbb{V}$ spanned by $C_2(\mathbb{V}) := \{Y(u)_{-2}v : u, v \in \mathbb{V}\}$ has finite codimension. The following important result is due to Buhl.

Theorem 3.7.1 (Cf. [Buh102] Thm. 1). *Assume $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite. Then there exist $Q \in \mathbb{N}$ and a finite set $\mathbb{E}$ of homogeneous vectors of $\mathbb{V}$ satisfying the following condition: For any weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ generated by a vector w_0 , there exists $L \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\mathbb{W}$ is spanned by elements of the form*

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v_k)_{-n_k} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v_{k-1})_{-n_{k-1}} \cdots Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v_1)_{-n_1} w_0 \quad (3.7.1)$$

where $n_k \geq n_{k-1} \geq \cdots \geq n_1 > -L$ and $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_k \in \mathbb{E}$. In addition, for any $1 \leq j \leq k$, if $n_j > 0$ then $n_j > n_{j-1}$; if $n_j \leq 0$ then $n_j = n_i$ for at most Q different i .

We will fix this $\mathbb{E}$ in this section.

Corollary 3.7.2. *Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite. Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a finitely generated admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Then for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, there exists $\nu(n) \in \mathbb{N}$ such that any $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vector $w \in \mathbb{W}$ whose weight $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) > \nu(n)$ is a sum of vectors in $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{-l} \mathbb{W}(\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) - \text{wt}(v) - l + 1)$ where $v \in \mathbb{E}$ and $l > n$.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that $\mathbb{W}$ is generated by a single $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vector w_0 . Let T be the set of all vectors of the form (3.7.1) where $n_k \leq n$. Then, by the above theorem, T is a finite subset of $\mathbb{W}$. Set $\nu(n) = \max\{\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1) : w_1 \in T\}$. If $w \in \mathbb{W}$ is $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous with weight $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) > \nu(n)$, then we can also write w as a sum of $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vectors of the form (3.7.1), but now the n_k must be greater than ν since such vector is not in T . This proves that w is a sum of $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vectors of the form $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{-l} w_2$ where $v \in \mathbb{E}$, $l > n$, and $w_2 \in \mathbb{W}$ is $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous. The same is true if $\mathbb{W}$ is assumed finitely generated. By (2.2.6), we have $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_2) = \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) - \text{wt}(v) - l + 1$. $\square$

Recall the definition of sheaf of conformal blocks $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})/\mathcal{N}$ where $\mathcal{N} = \pi_* (\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. For any section σ of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, its equivalence class (considered as a section of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$) is written as $[\sigma]$.

Theorem 3.7.3. *Let $\mathbb{V}$ be C_2 -cofinite, let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be finitely generated $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, and let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates. Assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is a Stein manifold. Then there exist finitely many elements $s_1, s_2, \dots$ of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$ such that for any element $\sigma \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$, its equivalence class $[\sigma]$ in $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(\mathcal{B})$ is an $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -linear combination of $[s_1], [s_2], \dots$.*

Proof. Since local coordinates are chosen, we identify $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ with $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$. Let $E = \max\{\text{wt}(v) : v \in \mathbb{E}\}$. By our assumption on $\mathfrak{X}$ and $\mathcal{B}$, and by Theorem 2.4.3, there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}(kS_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0 \quad (3.7.2)$$

for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ and $k \geq k_0$. We fix an arbitrary $k \in \mathbb{N}$ satisfying $k \geq E + k_0$.

Introduce a weight $\widetilde{\text{wt}}$ on $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ such that $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_{\bullet}) = \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1) + \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_2) + \cdots + \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_N)$ when $w_1, \dots, w_N$ are $\widetilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq n}$ (resp. $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}(n)$) denotes the subspace spanned by all $\widetilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous homogeneous vectors $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ satisfying $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) \leq n$ (resp. $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) = n$). Note that $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq N\nu(k)}$ is finite dimensional. We shall prove the claim of our theorem by choosing $s_1, s_2, \dots$ to be a basis of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq N\nu(k)}$. By induction, it suffices to show that for any $n > N\nu(k)$, any vector of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}(n)$ (considered as constant sections of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$) is a (finite) sum of elements of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq n-1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \bmod \mathcal{N}(\mathcal{B})$.

Choose any $w_{\bullet} = w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}(n)$ such that $w_1, \dots, w_N$ are $\widetilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous. Then one of $w_1, \dots, w_N$ must have $\widetilde{L}_0$ -weight greater than $\nu(k)$. Assume, without loss of generality, that $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1) > \nu(k)$. Then, by Corollary 3.7.2, w_1 is a sum of non-zero $\widetilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vectors of the form $Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(u)_{-l}w_1^{\circ}$ where $u \in \mathbb{E}$, $l > k$, $w_1^{\circ} \in \mathbb{W}_1$, and $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1^{\circ}) = \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1) - \text{wt}(u) - l + 1$. Thus $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1) - \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_1^{\circ}) \geq l - 1 \geq k \geq E + k_0$.

It suffices to show that each $Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(u)_{-l}w_1^{\circ} \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N$ is a sum of elements of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq n-1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B}) \bmod \mathcal{N}(\mathcal{B})$. Thus, we assume for simplicity that $w_1 = Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(u)_{-l}w_1^{\circ}$. Then

$$w_{\bullet} = Y_{\mathbb{W}_1}(u)_{-l}w_1^{\circ} \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N.$$

Set also

$$w_{\bullet}^{\circ} = w_1^{\circ} \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N.$$

Then $n - \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_{\bullet}^{\circ}) = \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_{\bullet}) - \widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_{\bullet}^{\circ}) \geq E + k_0$. Thus

$$\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w_{\bullet}^{\circ}) \leq n - E - k_0. \quad (3.7.3)$$

Consider the short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(k_0S_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(lS_{\mathfrak{X}}) \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0$$

where $\mathcal{G}$ is the quotient of the previous two sheaves. By (3.7.2) and Grauert's Theorem 1.6.2, we see that $R^1\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(k_0S_{\mathfrak{X}})) = 0$, and $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(k_0S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ is locally free. Thus, we may apply (1.3.1) to obtain an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(k_0S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(lS_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow \pi_*\mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0.$$

Since $\mathcal{B}$ is assumed to be a Stein manifold, by Cartan's theorem B, we know $H^1(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(k_0 S_{\mathfrak{X}}))) = 0$. Thus, there is an exact sequence

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(k_0 S_{\mathfrak{X}}))) &\rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(l S_{\mathfrak{X}}))) \\ &\rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow 0. \end{aligned} \quad (3.7.4)$$

Note that $H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \mathcal{G})$ is exactly $\mathcal{G}(\mathcal{C})$. Choose mutually disjoint neighborhoods $W_1, \dots, W_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ respectively. For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, identify $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}|_{W_i}$ with $\mathbb{V}^{\leq E} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}|_{W_i}$ via $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i)$, and identify η_i with the standard coordinate z by identifying W_i with $(\eta_i, \pi)(W_i)$. Define an element $v \in \mathcal{G}(\mathcal{C})$ as follows. $v|_{W_1}$ is the equivalence class represented by $uz^{-l}dz$, and $v|_{\mathcal{C}-\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B})} = 0$. Since the second map in the above exact sequence is surjective, v lifts to an element $\hat{v}$ of $H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(l S_{\mathfrak{X}})))$, i.e., of $(\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq E} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(l S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{C})$. Moreover, by the definition of $\mathcal{G}$ as a quotient, for each $1 \leq i \leq N$ we have an element v_i of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq E} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_C(k_0 S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W_i)$ (and hence of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq E} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i}(k_0 \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B}))(W_i)$) such that

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{v}|_{W_1} &= uz^{-l}dz + v_1 dz, \\ \hat{v}|_{W_i} &= v_i dz \quad (2 \leq i \leq N). \end{aligned}$$

Notice that $\text{Res}_{z=0} Y(\cdot, z)z^n dz = Y(\cdot)_n$. It follows that the element $\hat{v} \cdot w_\bullet^\circ$, which is clearly in $\mathcal{N}(\mathcal{B})$, equals $w_\bullet + w_\Delta$ where

$$w_\Delta = (v_1 dz) \cdot w_1^\circ \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N + \sum_{i=2}^N w_1^\circ \otimes w_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes (v_i dz) \cdot w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N.$$

Thus $[w_\bullet] = -[w_\Delta]$. For each $1 \leq i \leq N$, v_i has pole at $z = 0$ with order at most k_0 . Thus, by (2.2.6), the action of $v_i dz$ on $\mathbb{W}_i$ increases the $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight by at most $E + k_0 - 1$. It follows from (3.7.3) that $w_\Delta \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet^{\leq n-1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$. The proof is complete. $\square$

Theorem 3.7.4. *Let $\mathbb{V}$ be C_2 -cofinite, let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be finitely generated $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, and let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces. Then $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and (hence) $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ are locally free.*

Proof. We have seen that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ admits a connection near any point of $\mathcal{B}$. Thus, to prove the local freeness, it suffices to verify that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ satisfies the two conditions of Theorem 1.8.5. Assume that $\mathcal{B}$ is a Stein manifold, and $\mathfrak{X}$ is equipped with local coordinates. Consider $A = \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{C/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B})$ as a vector space. Then $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ and $\mathcal{F} = A \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ are clearly locally free with infinite rank. Define a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -modules $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ such that for each $v \in A$, $w \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, $U \subset \mathcal{B}$ being open, and $f \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}(U)$,

$$\varphi : (v, w, f) \mapsto f \cdot (v \cdot w)|_U.$$

Then both $\varphi(\mathcal{F})$ and $\mathcal{N}$ are $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -submodules of $\mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. It is clear that $\varphi(\mathcal{F}(U)) \subset \mathcal{N}(U)$ and hence $\varphi(\mathcal{F})(U) \subset \mathcal{N}(U)$. By Corollary 2.5.8, we have $\varphi(\mathcal{F})_b = \mathcal{N}_b$ for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$. Thus $\varphi(\mathcal{F}) = \mathcal{N}(U)$. Thus $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \text{coker}(\varphi)$, which verifies condition (a) of Theorem 1.8.5. By Theorem 3.7.3, $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ satisfies condition (b). $\square$

Corollary 3.7.5. *In the setting of Theorem 3.7.4, the dimension function*

$$b \in \mathcal{B} \mapsto \dim_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$$

is finite and constant on each connected component of $\mathcal{B}$.

Proof. This follows from theorems 3.7.4 and 3.2.1. $\square$

Remark 3.7.6. For each $g \in \mathbb{N}$ and $N \in \mathbb{Z}_{+}$, one has a universal family $\mathfrak{X}$ of N -pointed connected compact Riemann surfaces with genus g , where $\mathcal{B}$ is the Teichmüller space $\mathcal{T}_{g,N}$ of all such curves, and any such curve is biholomorphic to one of the fibers of $\mathfrak{X}$. Since $\mathcal{T}_{g,N}$ is well known to be connected, it follows that the dimensions of the spaces of conformal blocks are finite and depend only on $\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}, g, N$ but not on the complex structures of the Riemann surfaces.

Chapter 4

Sewing and factorization

4.1 Projective structures

Schwarzian derivatives and projective structures

Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ be a family of compact Riemann surfaces. Let us calculate the transition functions of $\mathcal{V}ir_c$ (which is a subsheaf of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}$). Choose an open subset $U \subset \mathcal{C}$ and holomorphic functions $\eta, \mu : U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ univalent on each fiber. If $f \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ and $\partial_{\eta}f$ is nowhere zero, we define the **Schwarzian derivative** of f over η to be

$$S_{\eta}f = \frac{\partial_{\eta}^3 f}{\partial_{\eta}f} - \frac{3}{2} \left(\frac{\partial_{\eta}^2 f}{\partial_{\eta}f} \right)^2 \quad (4.1.1)$$

where the partial derivative ∂_{η} is defined with respect to (η, π) , i.e., it is annihilated by $d\pi$ and restricts to $d/d\eta$ on each fiber. Similarly, one can define $S_{\mu}f$. The change of variable formula is easy to calculate:

$$S_{\mu}f = (\partial_{\mu}\eta)^2 S_{\eta}f + S_{\mu}\eta. \quad (4.1.2)$$

Take $f = \mu$ and notice $S_{\mu}\mu = 0$, we have

$$S_{\mu}\eta = -(\partial_{\mu}\eta)^2 S_{\eta}\mu. \quad (4.1.3)$$

Assuming f is also univalent on each fiber, we obtain the cocycle relation.

$$S_{\mu}\eta \cdot d\mu^2 = -S_{\eta}\mu \cdot d\eta^2, \quad S_{\mu}f \cdot d\mu^2 + S_{\eta}f \cdot d\eta^2 + S_{\eta}\mu \cdot d\eta^2 = 0. \quad (4.1.4)$$

By (2.5.7), the transition function from μ to η is given by $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta)\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\mu)^{-1} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))$. The vacuum vector $\mathbf{1}$ is clearly fixed by the transition function. So we just need to calculate $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))\mathbf{c}$. By Remark 2.1.3 and formula (2.3.9), if $\rho = \rho(z) \in \mathbb{G}$, then $\mathcal{U}(\rho)\mathbf{c} = \rho'(0)^{L_0} e^{c_2 L_2} \mathbf{c} = \rho'(0)^{L_0} (\mathbf{c} + \frac{c}{2} c_2 \mathbf{1}) = \rho'(0)^2 \mathbf{c} + \frac{c}{2} c_2 \mathbf{1}$

where c is the central charge, and c_2 , which is given by (2.3.10), is $\frac{1}{6}\mathbf{S}_z\rho(0)$. Replace ρ by $\varrho(\eta|\mu) : U \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$. Then $\rho^{(n)}(0)$ should be replaced by $\partial_\mu^n \eta$. Thus the transition function $\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))$ is described by

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))\mathbf{1} = \mathbf{1}, \quad \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta|\mu))\mathbf{c} = (\partial_\mu \eta)^2 \mathbf{c} + \frac{c}{12} \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta \cdot \mathbf{1}. \quad (4.1.5)$$

We collect some useful properties of the Schwarzian derivatives.

Proposition 4.1.1. *The following are true.*

- (1) *If the restriction of η to each fiber $U_b = U \cap \pi^{-1}(b)$ (where $b \in \mathcal{B}$) is a Möbius transformation of μ , i.e., of the form $\frac{a\mu+b}{c\mu+d}$ where $ad - bc \neq 0$, then $\mathbf{S}_\mu \eta = 0$.*
- (2) *Let $Q \in \mathcal{O}(U)$. Then, for each $x \in U$, one can find a neighborhood $V \subset U$ of x and a function $f \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ univalent on each fiber $V_b = V \cap \pi^{-1}(b)$, such that $\mathbf{S}_\eta f = Q$.*
- (3) *If $f, g \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ are univalent on each fiber, then $\mathbf{S}_\eta f = \mathbf{S}_\eta g$ if and only if $\mathbf{S}_f g = 0$.*
- (4) *If $f, Q \in \mathcal{O}(U)$, f is univalent on each fiber, and $\mathbf{S}_\mu f = Q$, then*

$$\mathbf{S}_\eta f = (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-2} (Q - \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta). \quad (4.1.6)$$

We remark that the converse of (1) is also true: If f is univalent on each fiber, and if $\mathbf{S}_\eta f = 0$, then the restriction of f to each fiber is a Möbius transformation of η .

Proof. (1) can be verified directly. To prove (2), we identify U with an open subset of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ via (η, π) . So η is identified with the standard coordinate z . We choose a neighborhood $V \subset U$ of x of the form $\mathcal{D} \times W$ where $W \subset \mathcal{B}$ is open, and $\mathcal{D}$ is an open disc centered at point $p = \eta(x) \in \mathbb{C}$. Consider the differential equation

$$\partial_z^2 h + Qh/2 = 0$$

which can be transformed to an $\mathbb{C}^2$ -valued 1-st order differential equation

$$\partial_z \begin{pmatrix} \alpha \\ \beta \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -Q/2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \alpha \\ \beta \end{pmatrix}$$

where α, β and h are related by $\alpha = h, \beta = \partial_z h$. By Theorem 1.7.1, there exist solutions $h_1, h_2 \in \mathcal{O}(V)$ satisfying the initial conditions $h_1(\cdot, p) = 1, \partial_z h_1(\cdot, p) = 0$ and $h_2(\cdot, p) = 0, \partial_z h_2(\cdot, p) = 1$. It is easy to check that $f := h_2/h_1$ satisfies $\mathbf{S}_z f = Q$, and is defined and satisfies $\partial_z f \neq 0$ near $\{p\} \times W$.

(3) follows from (4.1.2), which says $\mathbf{S}_\eta g = (\partial_\eta f)^2 \mathbf{S}_f g + \mathbf{S}_\eta f$. (4) follows from (4.1.2) and (4.1.3). □

Definition 4.1.2. An open cover $(U_\alpha, \eta_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}}$ of $\mathcal{C}$, where each open set U_α is equipped with a function $\eta_\alpha \in \mathcal{O}(U_\alpha)$ holomorphic on each fiber, is called a (family of) **projective chart** of $\mathfrak{X}$, if for any $\alpha, \beta \in \mathfrak{A}$, we have $S_{\eta_\beta} \eta_\alpha = 0$ on $U_\alpha \cap U_\beta$. Two projective charts are called equivalent if their union is a projective chart. An equivalence class of projective charts is called a **projective structure**. Equivalently, a projective structure is a maximal projective chart.

Suppose that $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ is a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates. We say that the local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ **admit a projective structure** if, by choosing mutually disjoint neighborhoods $W_1, \dots, W_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively, there is a projective chart of $\mathfrak{X}$ which contains $(W_1, \eta_1), \dots, (W_N, \eta_N)$.

Remark 4.1.3. Let $\mathfrak{P}$ be a projective chart on $\mathfrak{X}$. Choose an open subset $W \subset \mathcal{C}$ and a fiberwisely univalent $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(W)$. One can define an element

$$S_\eta \mathfrak{P} \in \mathcal{O}(W)$$

as follows. Choose any $(U, \mu) \in \mathfrak{P}$. Then $S_\eta \mathfrak{P} = S_\eta \mu$ on $W \cap U$. To check that $S_\eta \mathfrak{P}$ is well defined, suppose there is another $(V, \zeta) \in \mathfrak{P}$. Then $S_\mu \zeta = 0$ on $U \cap V$. Thus $S_\eta \mu = S_\eta \zeta$ on $U \cap V \cap W$ by Proposition 4.1.1.

Existence and classification of projective structures

In what follows we assume for simplicity that each fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ of the family $\mathfrak{X}$ is connected. We also assume that c is a non-zero central charge. Recall the exact sequence (2.5.15), and tensor it by the identity map of $\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}$. We obtain a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2} \xrightarrow{\lambda} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow 0, \quad (4.1.7)$$

which induces a long one

$$0 \rightarrow \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}) \rightarrow \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}) \xrightarrow{\lambda} \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\delta} R^1 \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}). \quad (4.1.8)$$

Here, we have used the obvious equivalence $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\cong} \pi_* \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}, f \mapsto f \circ \pi$. We thus obtain a linear map

$$\lambda : H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}). \quad (4.1.9)$$

Consider $1 \in H^0(\mathcal{B}, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}})$, i.e. the constant function on $\mathcal{B}$ with value 1.

Theorem 4.1.4. *There is a one to one correspondence between the subset $\lambda^{-1}(1)$ of $H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}))$ and the projective structures of $\mathfrak{X}$.*

Proof. First of all, observe that by (2.5.17), for any open $U \subset \mathcal{C}$ and $\mu \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ univalent on each fiber, we have

$$\lambda : \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\mu^2 \mapsto 1, \quad \mathbf{1} \, d\mu^2 \mapsto 0$$

where $\mathbf{1}$ is the vacuum section. If $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ is also univalent on each fiber, then by (4.1.5) and $d\mu = (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-1} d\eta$, we have

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\mu^2 = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\eta^2 + \frac{c}{12} (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-2} \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta \cdot \mathbf{1} \, d\eta^2. \quad (4.1.10)$$

Choose any $\nu \in \lambda^{-1}(1)$. The corresponding projective chart $\mathfrak{P}$ is defined as follows. For any $x \in \mathcal{C}$, we choose a neighborhood U of x and $\mu \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ univalent on each fiber $U \cap \pi^{-1}(b)$. Since ν is an element of $\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}(\mathcal{C})$ sent by λ to 1, we have

$$\nu|_U = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\mu^2 - \frac{c}{12} Q \cdot \mathbf{1} \, d\mu^2 \quad (4.1.11)$$

for some $Q \in \mathcal{O}(U)$. By Proposition 4.1.1, we may find an open subset $U_x \subset U$ containing x so that there exists $f_x \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ which is univalent on each fiber and satisfies $\mathbf{S}_\mu f_x = Q$. We claim that $\mathfrak{P} := \{(U_x, f_x)\}_{x \in \mathcal{C}}$ is a projective chart. Let $y \in \mathcal{C}$, and let (U_y, f_y) be obtained in the same way through a function $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U_y)$ univalent on each fiber. Let $V = U_x \cap U_y$. Then, by (4.1.10), we have

$$\nu|_V = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\eta^2 - \frac{c}{12} (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-2} (Q - \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta) \cdot \mathbf{1} \, d\eta^2.$$

Thus, we have $\mathbf{S}_\eta f_y|_V = (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-2} (Q - \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta)$. On the other hand, by (4.1.6), we also have $\mathbf{S}_\eta f_x|_V = (\partial_\mu \eta)^{-2} (Q - \mathbf{S}_\mu \eta)$. So $\mathbf{S}_\eta f_x|_V = \mathbf{S}_\eta f_y|_V$. This implies, by Proposition 4.1.1, that $\mathbf{S}_{f_x} f_y = 0$ on V . Thus $\mathfrak{P}$ is projective. By maximizing $\mathfrak{P}$, we obtain the projective structure.

If $\nu' \neq \nu$ defines another projective chart $\mathfrak{P}' = \{U'_x, f'_x\}$, then for the corresponding Q' defined similarly by (4.1.11) on U'_x , we have $\mathbf{S}_\mu f'_x = Q'$. Since $\nu' \neq \nu$, we may find x such that $Q \neq Q'$. Thus, on $U_x \cap U'_x$ we have $\mathbf{S}_\mu f_x \neq \mathbf{S}_\mu f'_x$. Hence $\mathbf{S}_{f_x} f'_x \neq 0$ by Proposition 4.1.1. So $\{U'_x, f'_x\}$ is not equivalent to $\{U_x, f_x\}$. Thus, the map $\nu \mapsto \mathfrak{P}$ is injective.

Finally, we show that this map is also surjective. Choose projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$. If (U, μ) and (U, η) belongs to this projective structure, then the transition function (4.1.10) becomes $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\mu^2 = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\eta^2$. By this formula, it is clear that one can find ν such that $\lambda(\nu) = 1$, and that on each (U, μ) belonging to the projective structure, we have $\nu|_U = \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu)^{-1} \mathbf{c} \, d\mu^2$. Namely, the Q for $\nu|_U$ is zero. It is obvious that the ν corresponds to $\mathfrak{P}$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.5. *The sheaf map $\delta : \mathcal{O}_\mathcal{B} \rightarrow R^1 \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ in (4.1.8) is zero. Consequently, we have a long exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})) \xrightarrow{\lambda} H^0(\mathcal{B}, \mathcal{O}_\mathcal{B}) \rightarrow H^1(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})). \quad (4.1.12)$$

As we will see in the proof, $\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module.

Proof. Recall that by Ehresmann's theorem, the (assumed connected) fibers of $\mathfrak{X}$ are diffeomorphic. We let g be the genus. If $g > 1$, then for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, we have $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes 2}) = 0$ by Corollary 1.2.6. Thus, by Grauert's Theorem 1.3.1, $\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ is locally free, and $R^1\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2}) = 0$, which shows $\delta = 0$.

We now treat the case $g = 0, 1$. Assume first of all that $\mathcal{B}$ is a single point. Then $\mathfrak{X}$ admits a projective structure. Indeed, when $g = 0$, $\mathfrak{X}$ is equivalent to $\mathbb{P}^1$, which obviously admits a projective structure (e.g. $\{(\mathbb{P}^1 - \{\infty\}, z), (\mathbb{P}^1 - \{0\}, 1/z)\}$). If $g = 1$, then it is well known that $\mathfrak{X}$ is equivalent to $\mathbb{C}/\Lambda$ where Λ is a real rank 2 lattice in $\mathbb{C}$ generated by 1 and τ in the upper half plane. (See e.g. [Hain08].) A projective structure on $\mathbb{C}$ preserved by Λ clearly exists, which descends to one of $\mathfrak{X}$. Thus, by Theorem 4.1.4, $\lambda^{-1}(1)$ is nonempty. Therefore, by the exactness of (4.1.8), $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}} \simeq \mathbb{C}$ is in the kernel of δ , which shows $\delta = 0$.

We now treat the general case where $\mathcal{B}$ a complex manifold. Since $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ (as an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module) is generated by the global section 1, it suffices to prove $\delta(1) = 0$. We first claim that $R^1\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ is locally free. Indeed, when $g = 1$, we have $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}_b}$ by the lattice realization. Thus, by Serre duality, we have $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes 2}) \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}_b}) \simeq H^0(\mathcal{C}_b, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}_b})$, which has constant (over $b \in \mathcal{B}$) dimension 1. Thus $R^1\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ (and also $\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$) is locally free (of rank 1) by Grauert's Theorem 1.3.1. When $g = 0$, the same is true since all fibers are equivalent to $\mathbb{P}^1$. Moreover, Grauert's theorem tells us that the fiber of $R^1\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ at b is naturally equivalent to $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes 2})$. Thus, it suffices to show that for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, the restriction of $\delta(1)$ to the fiber $\mathcal{C}_b$ is the zero element of $H^1(\mathcal{C}_b, \omega_{\mathcal{C}_b}^{\otimes 2})$. This follows from the previous paragraph. $\square$

Theorem 4.1.6. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$ be a family of compact Riemann surfaces. Suppose that $\mathcal{B}$ is a Stein manifold. Then there is a projective chart on $\mathfrak{X}$.*

Proof. Since $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein and $\pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})$ is locally free, we have $H^1(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}^{\otimes 2})) = 0$ by Cartan's theorem B. Therefore, the map λ in (4.1.12) is surjective. Thus, a projective structure exists by Theorem 4.1.4. $\square$

Corollary 4.1.7. *Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces. Then for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$, there is a neighborhood $V \ni b$ such that the restricted family $\mathfrak{X}_V$ can be equipped with local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ which admit a projective structure.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein. Thus we can choose a projective chart $\{(U_\alpha, \mu_\alpha)\}_{\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}}$ of $\mathfrak{X}$. Choose $b \in \mathcal{B}$. Then one may shrink $\mathcal{B}$ such that b is still in $\mathcal{B}$, and that for any $1 \leq i \leq N$, we can find $\alpha \in \mathfrak{A}$ such that U_α contains $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. Set $\eta_i = \mu_\alpha - \mu_\alpha \circ \varsigma_i \circ \pi$, defined near $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. It is clear that $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are compatible with the chosen projective chart. $\square$

4.2 Actions of $\pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$

In this section, we fix $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$ to be a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates. We assume for simplicity that $\mathcal{B}$ is a Stein manifold with coordinates $\tau_\bullet = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_N)$. Let $\mathbb{V}$ be a VOA with central charge c , and let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. By definition, $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ and hence its subsheaf $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ act trivially on the sheaf of covacua $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

Recall the exact sequence (3.6.15)

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*(\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))) \xrightarrow{\lambda} H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \rightarrow 0.$$

We shall define an action of $H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, which turns out to be an $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -scalar multiplication. Such definition already appears in the proof of Theorem 3.6.6, where the action of $\tilde{0} \in H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ is f . Our goal in this section is to express f in terms of a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$.

Choose mutually disjoint neighborhoods $W_1, \dots, W_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively. Write each $\tau_j \circ \pi$ as τ_j for short, so that $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$ is a coordinate of W_i . Set $W = W_1 \cup \dots \cup W_N$. Choose any $\theta \in H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_*\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$, which, in each W_i , is expressed as

$$\theta|_{W_i} = a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i}. \quad (4.2.1)$$

As in (3.6.6), we define $\mathbf{v}(\theta) \in \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$ such that

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \mathbf{v}(\theta)|_{W_i} = a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \mathbf{c} d\eta_i. \quad (4.2.2)$$

The action of θ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is defined to be the action of $\mathbf{v}(\theta)$, namely, is determined by

$$\mathbf{v}(\theta) \cdot w_\bullet = \sum_{i=1}^N w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbf{v}(\theta) \cdot w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_N \quad (4.2.3)$$

for any $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. (Recall (3.2.4).) Such definition depends on the choice of local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$.

Lemma 4.2.1. *Assume $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ admit a projective structure. Then the action of θ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is zero.*

Proof. Assume that $(W_1, \eta_1), \dots, (W_N, \eta_N)$ belong to a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$. Then, by (4.1.5), the transition function for $\mathbf{c} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ between two projective coordinates is the same as that for $\Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$, namely, when $S_\mu \eta = 0$, ∂_μ changes to $\partial_\mu \eta \cdot \partial_\eta$, and $\mathbf{c} d\mu$ changes to $\partial_\mu \eta \cdot \mathbf{c} d\eta$, sharing the same transition function $\partial_\mu \eta$. Thus, as θ is over $\mathcal{C}$, $\mathbf{v}(\theta)$ can be extended to a section of $\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})$ on $\mathcal{C}$. In particular, $\mathbf{v}(\theta)$ is in $(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{C}) = \pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B})$. Thus, $\mathbf{v}(\theta)$ acts trivially on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. $\square$

Corollary 4.2.2. *In Proposition 3.6.6, if $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ admit a projective structure outside $\mathcal{C}_\Delta$ (the union of all the nodal fibers), then the definition of the logarithmic connection ∇ is independent of the lifts, i.e., we have $\nabla_\eta = \nabla'_\eta$.*

Thus, the projectiveness of ∇ is controlled by the projective structures of $\mathfrak{X}$.

Proof. In the proof of Proposition 3.6.6, we need to show that $f = 0$. It suffices to prove this outside the discriminant locus Δ . Thus, we may assume $\Delta = \emptyset$ and hence $\mathfrak{X}$ is a smooth family. We know that the action of $\mathfrak{v}(\tilde{0})$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is the multiplication by f . By Lemma 4.2.1, the action is trivial. Thus $f = 0$. $\square$

Proposition 4.2.3. *Suppose that $\mathfrak{X}$ has a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$. Choose $\theta \in H^0(\mathcal{B}, \pi_* \Theta_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ whose local expression is given by (4.2.1). Then the action of $\mathfrak{v}(\theta)$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ (defined by the local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$) is the $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -scalar multiplication by*

$$\#(\theta) := \frac{c}{12} \sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} \cdot a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) d\eta_i. \quad (4.2.4)$$

Note that each $\mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}$ (defined in Remark 4.1.3) is an element of $\mathcal{O}(W_i)$. Also, the residue $\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0}$ is taken with respect to the coordinate $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$.

Proof. It suffices to prove that the claim is locally true. Thus, we may shrink $\mathcal{B}$ and $W_1, \dots, W_N$ such that for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, there exists a coordinate $\mu_i \in \mathcal{O}(W_i)$ at $\varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$ such that $(W_i, \mu_i) \in \mathfrak{P}$. Then

$$\theta|_{W_i} = a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot (\partial_{\mu_i} \eta_i)^{-1} \partial_{\mu_i}.$$

Our strategy is to compare the action of $\mathfrak{v}(\theta)$ defined by the coordinates $\mu_\bullet$ (which is trivial by Lemma 4.2.1) with $\tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)$ defined by $\eta_\bullet$. Set $\tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta) \in \mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(W)$ such that $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu_i) \tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)|_{W_i} = a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot (\partial_{\mu_i} \eta_i)^{-1} \mathbf{c} d\mu_i$. Then

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu_i) \tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)|_{W_i} = a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot (\partial_{\mu_i} \eta_i)^{-2} \mathbf{c} d\eta_i.$$

By Lemma 4.2.1, the action of $\tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is zero. Notice that the action of $\tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)$ is independent of the choice of local coordinates. (See Lemma 3.1.3 and the paragraphs before Proposition 3.2.4.) By (4.1.5), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)|_{W_i} &= \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\eta_i)|_{\mu_i}) \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\mu_i) \tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)|_{W_i} \\ &= a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + \frac{c}{12} a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot (\partial_{\mu_i} \eta_i)^{-2} \mathbf{S}_{\mu_i} \eta_i \cdot \mathbf{1} d\eta_i \end{aligned}$$

By (4.2.2) and (4.1.3), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)|_{W_i} &= \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \mathfrak{v}(\theta)|_{W_i} - \frac{c}{12} a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mu_i \cdot \mathbf{1} d\eta_i \\ &= \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i) \mathfrak{v}(\theta)|_{W_i} - \frac{c}{12} a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} \cdot \mathbf{1} d\eta_i. \end{aligned}$$

Since the action of $\tilde{\mathfrak{v}}(\theta)$ is zero, the action of $\mathfrak{v}(\theta)$ equals the sum over i of the actions of $\frac{c}{12} a_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} \cdot \mathbf{1} d\eta_i$, which is exactly the scalar multiplication by (4.2.4). $\square$

4.3 Convergence of sewing

In this section, we assume the setting of Section 3.3. In particular, $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed complex curves with local coordinates obtained by sewing the smooth family

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \rightarrow \tilde{\mathcal{B}}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \varsigma'_1, \dots, \varsigma'_M; \varsigma''_1, \dots, \varsigma''_M; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi_1, \dots, \xi_M; \varpi_1, \dots, \varpi_M),$$

to which the $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N, \mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}'_M$, and their contragredient modules $\mathbb{M}'_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}'_M$ are associated. Also, we assume throughout this section that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite, $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are finitely generated $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, and $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ (and hence their contragredient modules) are semi-simple, i.e., they are finite direct sums of irreducible modules.

For each $n \in \mathbb{C}$, let P_n be the projection of each $\mathbb{V}$ -module onto its L_0 -weight n subspace. Recall the notation $q_{\bullet}^{n_{\bullet}} = q_1^{n_1} \cdots q_M^{n_M}$. Given $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{\bullet})(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$, we say that $\mathcal{S}\psi$ **converges absolutely and locally uniformly (a.l.u.)** if $\mathcal{S}\psi$ converges in the sense of Remark 3.3.1, i.e., if for any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ and any compact subsets $K \subset \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ and $Q \subset \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}, \rho_{\bullet}}^{\times}$, there exists $C > 0$ such that

$$\sum_{n_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{C}^M} \left| \psi \left(w_{\bullet} \otimes (P_{n_1} \blacktriangleright \otimes_1 \blacktriangleleft) \otimes \cdots \otimes (P_{n_M} \blacktriangleright \otimes_M \blacktriangleleft) \right) (b) \right| \cdot |q_{\bullet}^{n_{\bullet}}| \leq C$$

for any $b \in K$ and $q_{\bullet} = (q_1, \dots, q_M) \in Q$. When $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ are irreducible (i.e. simple), since L_0 and $\tilde{L}_0$ differ by a scalar multiplication, we have $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi = q_{\bullet}^{\lambda_{\bullet}} \mathcal{S}\psi$ where $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_M$ are constants. Thus $\mathcal{S}\psi$ converges a.l.u. if and only if $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ does. The same is true when $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ are semisimple. Recall also that $\mathcal{S}\psi$ is a formal conformal block.

As in the proof of Theorem 3.7.3, for each $k \in \mathbb{N}$, $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq k}$ (resp. $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}(k)$) denotes the (finite dimensional) subspace spanned by all $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous homogeneous vectors $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ satisfying $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) \leq k$ (resp. $\widetilde{\text{wt}}(w) = k$). This gives a filtration (resp. grading) of $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. We define

$$\mathcal{S}\psi^{\leq k} \in (\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq k})^* \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})\{q_{\bullet}\}$$

whose evaluation with each $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq k}$ is $\mathcal{S}\psi(w)$. Clearly, the a.l.u. convergence of $\mathcal{S}\psi$ holds if and only if $\mathcal{S}\psi^{\leq k} \in (\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq k})^* \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B} - \Delta)$ for any large enough k . Recall $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{D}_{r_{\bullet}, \rho_{\bullet}} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$.

Theorem 4.3.1. *Assume that $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ (and hence $\mathcal{B}$) is a Stein manifold. Then there exists $k_0 \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ such that for any $k \geq k_0$, there exist*

$$A_1, \dots, A_M \in \text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}((\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^{\leq k})^*) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$$

not depending on $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$, such that for any $1 \leq j \leq M$,

$$q_j \partial_{q_j} (\mathcal{S}\psi^{\leq k}) = A_j \cdot \mathcal{S}\psi^{\leq k}. \quad (4.3.1)$$

For simplicity, we shall prove this theorem for $M = 1$. For general M the idea of the proof is the same. We set $q = q_1 = q_\bullet$, $\mathbb{M} = \mathbb{M}_1 = \mathbb{M}_\bullet$, etc.. In this case, we have $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ and $\Delta = \{0\} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. We assume that $\mathbb{M}$ and hence $\mathbb{M}'$ are irreducible, so that $\tilde{L}_0$ and L_0 are equal up to a constant. Recall the assumptions of U', U'' in Section 1.6: U' (resp. U'') is a neighborhood of $\varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ (resp. $\varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$) such that

$$(\xi, \tilde{\pi}) : U' \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_r \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \quad \text{resp.} \quad (\varpi, \tilde{\pi}) : U'' \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$$

is a biholomorphic map. Recall $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = \sum_i \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})$. We set $S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \varsigma_i(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) + \varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) + \varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ to be a divisor of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$. Let

$$\Gamma = \varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}) \cup \varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}).$$

Our first step is to show that ψ is a formal parallel section in the direction of q . Define $\eta \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(-\log \Delta)(\mathcal{B})$ to be $\eta = q\partial_q$, regarded as constant over $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. Choose $\tilde{\eta} \in \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C})$ satisfying $d\pi(\tilde{\eta}) = q\partial_q$ as in (3.6.3). We shall take the series expansion of the vertical part of $\tilde{\eta}$.

For any open precompact subset $\tilde{V} \subset \tilde{\mathcal{C}} - \Gamma$ and an $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(\tilde{V})$ univalent on each fiber, choose an open subdisc $\mathcal{D} \subset \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ centered at 0 with standard coordinate q , and assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is small enough such that $\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V} \simeq \tilde{V} \times \mathcal{D}$ can be regarded as an open subset of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}} \times \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} - F'_1 - F''_1$ (recall (1.6.9)) and hence of $\mathcal{C}$. Consider η also as an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V})$ which is constant over $\mathcal{D}$. Thus $\partial_q \eta = 0$. Then there exists $h \in \mathcal{O}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V})$ such that

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V}} = h\partial_\eta + q\partial_q. \quad (4.3.2)$$

Write $h = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} h_n q^n$ where $h_n \in \mathcal{O}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}(\tilde{V}))$. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, set an element $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp \in \Theta_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})(\tilde{V})$ by

$$\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp|_{\tilde{V}} = h_n \partial_\eta. \quad (4.3.3)$$

Lemma 4.3.2. *The locally defined $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp$ is independent of the choice of η , and hence can be extended to an element of $\Theta_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})(\tilde{\mathcal{C}} - \Gamma)$*

Proof. Suppose we have another $\mu \in \mathcal{O}(\tilde{V})$ univalent on each fiber, which is extended constantly to $\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V}$. Then $\partial_q \mu = 0$ and hence $\tilde{\eta}|_{\mathcal{D} \times \tilde{V}} = h \cdot \partial_\eta \mu \cdot \partial_\mu + q\partial_q$. Note that $\partial_\eta \mu$ is constant over q . Thus, if we define $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp|_{\tilde{V}}$ using μ , then $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp|_{\tilde{V}} = h_n \cdot \partial_\eta \mu \cdot \partial_\mu$, which agrees with (4.3.3). $\square$

We shall show that $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp$ has poles of finite orders at Γ . For that purpose, we need to describe explicitly $\tilde{\eta}$ near the critical locus Σ . Let us first recall the geometry

of $\mathfrak{X}$ near Σ . By the paragraph containing (2.5.10), any $x' \in \Sigma$ is contained in a neighborhood W of the form

$$\begin{aligned} W &= \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}, \\ W \cap \Sigma &\simeq (0, 0) \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}, \\ \pi : W &= \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\pi_{r,\rho} \times 1} \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}} = \mathcal{B}, \end{aligned}$$

where $\pi_{r,\rho} : \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ is the multiplication map. As usual, we let ξ, ϖ be respectively the standard coordinates of $\mathcal{D}_r, \mathcal{D}_\rho$. Then (ξ, ϖ) is a coordinate of $\mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho$. Set $q = \pi_{r,\rho} = \xi\varpi$.

In the following, we let $\tau_\bullet$ be any biholomorphic map from $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ to an open subset of a complex manifold. If $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is small enough, then $\tau_\bullet$ can be a set of coordinates of $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. The purpose of introducing $\tau_\bullet$ is only to indicate the dependence of certain functions on the points of $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. Thus, $(\xi, q, \tau_\bullet)$ and $(\varpi, q, \tau_\bullet)$ are respectively biholomorphic maps of

$$W' = \mathcal{D}_r^\times \times \mathcal{D}_\rho \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}, \quad W'' = \mathcal{D}_r \times \mathcal{D}_\rho^\times \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$$

to complex manifolds. By (1.6.20), we can find $a, b \in \mathcal{O}((\xi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet)(W))$ such that

$$\tilde{\eta}|_W = a(\xi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet)\xi\partial_\xi + b(\xi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet)\varpi\partial_\varpi.$$

Since $d\pi(\xi\partial_\xi) = d\pi(\varpi\partial_\varpi) = q\partial_q$ by (1.6.21), we must have

$$a + b = 1. \tag{4.3.4}$$

This relation, together with (1.6.2), shows that under the coordinates $(\xi, q, \tau_\bullet)$ and $(\varpi, q, \tau_\bullet)$ respectively,

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{W'} = a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet)\xi\partial_\xi + q\partial_q, \quad \tilde{\eta}|_{W''} = b(q/\varpi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet)\varpi\partial_\varpi + q\partial_q. \tag{4.3.5}$$

Lemma 4.3.3. *For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp$ has poles of orders at most $n - 1$ at $\varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ and $\varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. Consequently, $\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp$ is an element of $\Theta_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet, S_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}})(\tilde{\mathcal{C}})$.*

Proof. Let us write

$$a(\xi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet) = \sum_{m,n \in \mathbb{N}} a_{m,n}(\tau_\bullet)\xi^m\varpi^n, \quad b(\xi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet) = \sum_{m,n \in \mathbb{N}} b_{m,n}(\tau_\bullet)\xi^m\varpi^n$$

where $a_{m,n}, b_{m,n} \in \mathcal{O}(\tau_\bullet(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}))$. Then

$$a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet) = \sum_{n \geq 0, l \geq -n} a_{l+n,n}(\tau_\bullet)\xi^l q^n, \quad b(q/\varpi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet) = \sum_{m \geq 0, l \geq -m} b_{m,l+m}(\tau_\bullet)\varpi^l q^m. \tag{4.3.6}$$

Combine these two relations with (4.3.3) and (4.3.5), and take the coefficients before q^n . We obtain

$$\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp \Big|_{U' - \varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})} = \sum_{l \geq -n} a_{l+n,n}(\tau_\bullet) \xi^{l+1} \partial_\xi, \quad \tilde{\eta}_n^\perp \Big|_{U'' - \varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})} = \sum_{l \geq -n} b_{n,l+n}(\tau_\bullet) \varpi^{l+1} \partial_\varpi, \quad (4.3.7)$$

which finishes the proof. $\square$

One can then let $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp)$ be a section of $\mathcal{V}ir_c \otimes \omega_{\tilde{\mathcal{C}}/\tilde{\mathcal{B}}}(\bullet S_{\tilde{\mathcal{X}}})$ defined on $U' \cup U''$ (near $\varsigma'(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \varsigma''(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$) and near $\varsigma_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ as in (4.2.2). Note that $\mathcal{V}ir_c$ is defined over $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$. Also, $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp)$ depends on the local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N, \xi, \varpi$. Recall the correspondence $\partial_\xi \mapsto c d\xi, \partial_\varpi \mapsto c d\varpi$. We calculate the actions of $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp)$ on $\mathbb{M}$ and on $\mathbb{M}'$ to be respectively

$$\text{Res}_{\xi=0} \sum_{l \geq -n} a_{l+n,n} Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\mathbf{c}, \xi) \xi^{l+1} d\xi, \quad \text{Res}_{\varpi=0} \sum_{l \geq -n} b_{n,l+n} Y_{\mathbb{M}'}(\mathbf{c}, \varpi) \varpi^{l+1} d\varpi. \quad (4.3.8)$$

In the following proofs, we will suppress the symbol $\tau_\bullet$ when necessary.

Lemma 4.3.4. *The following equation of elements of $(\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')[[q]]$ is true.*

$$L_0 q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \triangleleft = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp) q^{n+\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \triangleleft + \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} q^{n+\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp) \triangleleft \quad (4.3.9)$$

Note that as $\mathbb{M}$ is assumed to be irreducible, the equation still holds if $\tilde{L}_0$ is replaced by L_0 .

Proof. It is obvious that $\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)\mathbf{c} = \mathbf{c}, \xi^{L_0}\mathbf{c} = \xi^2\mathbf{c}, \varpi^{L_0}\mathbf{c} = \varpi^2\mathbf{c}$. Notice Remark 3.3.4. We have

$$\begin{aligned} & Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\xi^{L_0}\mathbf{c}, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \triangleleft \cdot a(\xi, q/\xi) \frac{d\xi}{\xi} \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} \sum_{l \geq -n} Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\mathbf{c}, \xi) q^{n+\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \triangleleft \cdot a_{l+n,n} \xi^{l+1} d\xi \end{aligned}$$

as elements of $(\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}' \otimes \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}))((\xi))[[q]] d\xi$. Take $\text{Res}_{\xi=0}$ and notice (4.3.8). Then, the above expression becomes the first summand on the right hand side of (4.3.9). A similar thing could be said about the second summand. Thus, the right hand side of (4.3.9) equals

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Res}_{\xi=0} Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\xi^{L_0}\mathbf{c}, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \triangleleft \cdot a(\xi, q/\xi) \frac{d\xi}{\xi} \\ &+ \text{Res}_{\varpi=0} q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes Y_{\mathbb{M}'}(\varpi^{L_0}\mathcal{U}(\gamma_1)\mathbf{c}, \varpi) \triangleleft \cdot b(q/\varpi, \varpi) \frac{d\varpi}{\varpi}. \end{aligned}$$

By Lemma 3.3.3 and that $a + b = 1$, it equals

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Res}_{\xi=0} Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\xi^{L_0} \mathbf{c}, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft \cdot \frac{d\xi}{\xi} &= \text{Res}_{\xi=0} Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\mathbf{c}, \xi) q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft \cdot \xi d\xi \\ &= Y_{\mathbb{M}}(\mathbf{c})_1 q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft = L_0 q^{\tilde{L}_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft. \end{aligned}$$

□

Lemma 4.3.5. *For any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we have the following relation of elements of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})\{q\}$.*

$$q\partial_q \mathcal{S}\psi(w_{\bullet}) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \psi(w_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) q^{n+L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft) + \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \psi(w_{\bullet} \otimes q^{n+L_0} \triangleright \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) \blacktriangleleft).$$

Proof. We have

$$q\partial_q \mathcal{S}\psi(w_{\bullet}) = q\partial_q \psi(w_{\bullet} \otimes q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft) = \psi(w_{\bullet} \otimes L_0 q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft).$$

By the Lemma 4.3.4 (with $\tilde{L}_0$ replaced by L_0), the desired equation is proved. □

As usual, we let $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})w_{\bullet}$ denote $\sum_i w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N$. Recall $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. For any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, one can define $\nabla_{q\partial_q} w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ using (3.6.7) and (3.6.8), which equals $\nabla_{q\partial_q} w_{\bullet} = -\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})w_{\bullet}$. The action of $\mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}})$ clearly equals that of $\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} q^n \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})$. Thus, we obtain

$$\nabla_{q\partial_q} w_{\bullet} = - \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} q^n \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})w_{\bullet}. \quad (4.3.10)$$

In particular, the series on the right hand side converges absolutely.

The following lemma claims that up to a formal projective term, $\mathcal{S}\psi$ is parallel in the direction of $q\partial_q$, where the connection is defined by the chosen lift $\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}$. Recall that $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is Stein. Thus, we can choose a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$ on $\tilde{\mathcal{X}}$, which exists due to Theorem 4.1.6.

Proposition 4.3.6. *There exists $\#(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) \in \mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, such that for any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, we have the following equation of elements of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})\{q\}$:*

$$q\partial_q \mathcal{S}\psi(w_{\bullet}) = \mathcal{S}\psi(\nabla_{q\partial_q} w_{\bullet}) + \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \#(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) q^n \cdot \mathcal{S}\psi(w_{\bullet}).$$

Proof. $\#(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})$ is defined by Proposition 4.2.3. Moreover, by that proposition, we have

$$\begin{aligned} w_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft + w_{\bullet} \otimes q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) \blacktriangleleft + \mathbf{v}(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp})w_{\bullet} \otimes q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft \\ = \#(\tilde{\mathfrak{h}}_n^{\perp}) \cdot w_{\bullet} \otimes q^{L_0} \triangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft. \end{aligned}$$

By Lemma 4.3.5 and relation (4.3.10), it is easy to prove the desired equation. □

We still need one more result before we can prove Theorem 4.3.1: the projective term $\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \#(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp) q^n$ converges absolutely.

Proposition 4.3.7. $\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \#(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp) q^n$ is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}) = \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$.

Proof. Let $\tilde{V}_1, \dots, \tilde{V}_N$ be mutually disjoint neighborhoods of $\varsigma_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined. Assume that they are disjoint from U', U'' . Then $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{V}_1, \dots, \mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{V}_N$ are neighborhoods of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$. Write $\tau_\bullet \circ \pi$ also as $\tau_\bullet$ for simplicity. Recall (4.3.2). We may write

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{V}_i} = h_i(q, \eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i} + q \partial_q$$

where $h_i(q, \eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{C}}(\bullet S_{\mathcal{X}})(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{V}_i)$. Write $h_i = \sum_n h_{i,n} q^n$. Then by (4.3.3),

$$\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp|_{\tilde{V}_i} = h_{i,n}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i}. \quad (4.3.11)$$

Combine (4.3.7) and (4.3.11), and apply Proposition 4.2.3 to the family $\tilde{\mathcal{X}}$. We obtain

$$\#(\tilde{\eta}_n^\perp) = \frac{c}{12} (A_n + B_n + \sum_{i=1}^N C_{i,n})$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} A_n &= \sum_{l \geq -n} \text{Res}_{\xi=0} \mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P} \cdot a_{l+n,n}(\tau_\bullet) \xi^{l+1} d\xi, \\ B_n &= \sum_{l \geq -n} \text{Res}_{\varpi=0} \mathbf{S}_\varpi \mathfrak{P} \cdot b_{n,l+n}(\tau_\bullet) \varpi^{l+1} d\varpi, \\ C_{i,n} &= \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} \cdot h_{i,n}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) d\eta_i. \end{aligned}$$

Notice that $\mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} = \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$, $\mathbf{S}_\varpi \mathfrak{P} = \mathbf{S}_\varpi \mathfrak{P}(\varpi, \tau_\bullet)$, $\mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P} = \mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P}(\xi, \tau_\bullet)$ are holomorphic functions on $\tilde{V}_i, U', U''$ which are identified with their images under $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet), (\xi, \tau_\bullet), (\varpi, \tau_\bullet)$ respectively.

We have

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} A_n q^n = \sum_{n \geq 0} \sum_{l \geq -n} \text{Res}_{\xi=0} \mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P} \cdot a_{l+n,n}(\tau_\bullet) \xi^{l+1} q^n d\xi. \quad (4.3.12)$$

We claim that (4.3.12) is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. Note that $a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet)$ is defined when $|q|/\rho < |\xi| < r$. Choose any $\epsilon \in (0, r\rho)$. Choose a circle γ' surrounding $\mathcal{D}_{\epsilon/\rho}$ and inside $\mathcal{D}_r$. Then, when ξ is on γ , $a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet)$ can be defined whenever $|q| < \epsilon$. Thus,

$$A := \frac{1}{2i\pi} \oint_{\gamma'} \mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P}(\xi, \tau_\bullet) \cdot a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet) \xi d\xi$$

is a holomorphic function defined whenever $|q| < \epsilon$. Recall the first equation of (4.3.6), and note that the series converges absolutely and uniformly when $\xi \in \gamma'$ and $|q| \leq \epsilon$, by the double Laurent series expansion of $a(\xi, q/\xi, \tau_\bullet)$. Therefore, the above contour integral equals

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} \sum_{l \geq -n} \oint_{\gamma'} \frac{1}{2i\pi} \mathbf{S}_\xi \mathfrak{P}(\xi, \tau_\bullet) \cdot a_{l+n,n}(\tau_\bullet) \xi^{l+1} q^n d\xi,$$

which clearly equals (4.3.12) as an element of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q]]$. Thus (4.3.12) is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ whenever $\epsilon < r\rho$, and hence when $\epsilon = r\rho$.

A similar argument shows $\sum B_n q^n$ converges a.l.u. to

$$B := \frac{1}{2i\pi} \oint_{\gamma''} \mathbf{S}_\varpi \mathfrak{P}(\varpi, \tau_\bullet) \cdot b(q/\varpi, \varpi, \tau_\bullet) \varpi d\varpi$$

where γ'' is any circle in $\mathcal{D}_\rho$ surrounding 0. Finally, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} C_i &:= \sum_{n \geq 0} C_{i,n} q^n = \sum_{n \geq 0} \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot h_{i,n}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) q^n d\eta_i \\ &= \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot h_i(q, \eta_i, \tau_\bullet) d\eta_i \end{aligned}$$

which is clearly inside $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. The proof is now complete. We summarize that the projective term equals

$$\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \#(\tilde{\mathfrak{H}}_n^\perp) q^n = \frac{c}{12} (A + B + \sum_{i=1}^N C_i). \quad (4.3.13)$$

□

Proof of Theorem 4.3.1. We choose k_0 such that the $s_1, s_2, \dots$ found in Theorem 3.7.3 are in $\mathbb{W}_\bullet^{\leq k_0} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$. We may assume $s_1, s_2, \dots$ form a basis of $\mathbb{W}_\bullet^{\leq k_0}$, regarded as constant sections of $\mathbb{W}_\bullet^{\leq k_0} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$. Fix any $k \geq k_0$, and extend $s_1, s_2, \dots$ to a basis of $\mathbb{W}_\bullet^{\leq k}$.

By propositions 4.3.6 and 4.3.7, for each s_i of $s_1, s_2, \dots$, we have the following equation of elements of $\mathcal{O}(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})\{q\}$:

$$q\partial_q \mathcal{S}\psi(s_i) = \mathcal{S}\psi(\nabla_{q\partial_q} s_i) + g\mathcal{S}\psi(s_i)$$

where $g \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r\rho} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}) = \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ equals (4.3.13) and is hence independent of $s_1, s_2, \dots$. By Theorem 3.7.3, we can find $f_{i,j} \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ such that $\nabla_{q\partial_q} s_i$ equals $\sum_j f_{i,j} s_j$ mod sections of $\pi_*(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. (Indeed, the proof of that theorem shows that the relation holds mod a sum of elements of the form

$\hat{v} \cdot w_\bullet^\circ \in \pi_* (\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}} \otimes \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))(\mathcal{B}) \cdot \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$. Since, by Theorem 3.3.5, $\mathcal{S}\psi$ is a formal conformal block, we must have

$$q\partial_q \mathcal{S}\psi(s_i) = \sum_j f_{i,j} \mathcal{S}\psi(s_j) + g \mathcal{S}\psi(s_i).$$

The proof is completed by setting the matrix-valued function $A_1 = A$ to be $(f_{i,j} + g\delta_{i,j})_{i,j}$. $\square$

Theorem 4.3.8. *Choose $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}'_\bullet)(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. Then $\mathcal{S}\psi$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ converge a.l.u..*

We are not assuming $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ to be Stein.

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M$ are irreducible. Then $\mathcal{S}\psi$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$ differ by $q^\lambda \bullet$ for some $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_M \in \mathbb{C}$.

When $M = 1$, the a.l.u. convergence follows directly from theorems 4.3.1 and 1.7.2. The general case can be proved by induction. For simplicity, we assume $M = 2$ and explain the idea. According to the base case, for any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, we know that $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi(w_\bullet)(q_1, q_2, \tau_\bullet)$ is an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r_1\rho_1} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})[[q_2]]$. Also, by the base case (applied to the smooth family over $\mathcal{D}_{r_1\rho_1}^\times \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$), we know that $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi(w_\bullet)(q_1, q_2, \tau_\bullet)$ converges a.l.u. to an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_{r_1\rho_1}^\times \times \mathcal{D}_{r_2\rho_2} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}})$. This finishes the proof. $\square$

Recall that the logarithmic connection on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is dual to the one on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. From propositions 4.3.6 and 4.3.7 and their proofs, we have:

Theorem 4.3.9. *Assume $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is Stein. For each $1 \leq k \leq M$, define $\nabla_{q_k\partial_{q_k}}$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and hence on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ using $\eta_\bullet$ and a lift $\tilde{\eta}$ of $q_k\partial_{q_k}$ as in Section 3.6. Then there exists a projective term $f_k \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ such that*

$$\nabla_{q_k\partial_{q_k}} \mathcal{S}\psi = f_k \cdot \mathcal{S}\psi.$$

Recall $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet\rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}$. When $M = 1$, the projective term f_1 is (4.3.13). In the following remark, we give the formula of f_k for a general M .

Remark 4.3.10. Let $\tilde{\eta} \in \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(-\log \mathcal{C}_\Delta + \bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})(\mathcal{C})$ be a lift of $\eta = q_k\partial_{q_k}$. Choose neighborhoods $U'_1, \dots, U'_M, U''_1, \dots, U''_M$ of $\varsigma'_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma'_M(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \varsigma''_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma''_M(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ as in (1.6.6). Choose $\tilde{V}_1, \dots, \tilde{V}_N$ to be neighborhoods of $\varsigma_1(\tilde{\mathcal{B}}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\tilde{\mathcal{B}})$ as in the proof of Proposition 4.3.7. Assume that they are disjoint from $U'_1, \dots, U'_M, U''_1, \dots, U''_M$. Then $\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet\rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{V}_1, \dots, \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet\rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{V}_N$ are neighborhoods of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ in $\mathcal{C}$. For each $1 \leq i \leq N, 1 \leq j \leq M$, write

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{\mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet\rho_\bullet} \times \tilde{V}_i} = h_i(q_\bullet, \eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i} + q_k \partial_{q_k},$$

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{\mathcal{D}_{r_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j} \times \mathcal{D}_{r_\bullet\rho_\bullet} \setminus \mathcal{V} \times \tilde{\mathcal{B}}} = a_j(\xi_j, \varpi_j, q_{\bullet \setminus j}, \tau_\bullet) \xi_j \partial_{\xi_j} + b_j(\xi_j, \varpi_j, q_{\bullet \setminus j}, \tau_\bullet) \varpi_j \partial_{\varpi_j} + (1 - \delta_{j,k}) q_k \partial_{q_k}.$$

where h_i, a_j, b_j are holomorphic functions on suitable domains, and

$$a_j + b_j = \delta_{j,k}.$$

Choose a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$ of $\mathfrak{X}$. Then $S_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} = S_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$, $S_{\xi_j} \mathfrak{P} = S_{\xi_j} \mathfrak{P}(\xi_j, \tau_\bullet)$, $S_{\varpi_j} \mathfrak{P} = S_{\varpi_j} \mathfrak{P}(\varpi_j, \tau_\bullet)$ are holomorphic functions on $\tilde{V}_i, U'_j, U''_j$ which are identified with their images under $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet), (\xi_j, \tau_\bullet), (\varpi_j, \tau_\bullet)$ respectively. Choose circles $\gamma'_j \subset \mathcal{D}_{r_j}$ and $\gamma''_j \subset \mathcal{D}_{\rho_j}$ surrounding 0. Then the projective term f_k in Theorem 4.3.9 equals

$$f_k = \frac{c}{12} \cdot \left(\sum_{1 \leq j \leq M} A_j + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq M} B_j + \sum_{1 \leq i \leq N} C_i \right),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} A_j &= \oint_{\gamma'_j} S_{\xi_j} \mathfrak{P}(\xi_j, \tau_\bullet) \cdot a_j(\xi_j, q_j/\xi_j, q_{\bullet \setminus j}, \tau_\bullet) \cdot \xi_j d\xi_j, \\ B_j &= \oint_{\gamma''_j} S_{\varpi_j} \mathfrak{P}(\varpi_j, \tau_\bullet) \cdot b_j(q_j/\varpi_j, \varpi_j, q_{\bullet \setminus j}, \tau_\bullet) \cdot \varpi_j d\varpi_j, \\ C_i &= \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} S_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P}(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot h_i(q_\bullet, \eta_i, \tau_\bullet) d\eta_i. \end{aligned}$$

4.4 Linear independence of sewing

We continue the study of sewing, but assume that $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ is a single compact Riemann surface, and $M = 1$, i.e.,

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{\mathcal{C}}; x_1, \dots, x_N; x'; x''; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi; \varpi).$$

The main result of this section can be generalized, by induction, to any $M \in \mathbb{Z}_+$. As usual, we assume that each connected component of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$ contains at least one of $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a finite set of mutually inequivalent irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. Choose open discs $W' \simeq \mathcal{D}_r, W'' \simeq \mathcal{D}_\rho$ (with respect to the local coordinates ξ, ϖ) around x', x'' which do not contain $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Assume $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are finitely-generated $\mathbb{V}$ -modules associated to $x_1, \dots, x_N$.

Let

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}; x_1, \dots, x_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$$

be the family of complex curves obtained by sewing $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$, where $x_1, \dots, x_N, \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are extended from those of $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$ and are constant over $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$. For each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$, we define a linear map

$$\mathfrak{S}_q : \bigoplus_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}} \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}') \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet), \quad (4.4.1)$$

$$\bigoplus_{\mathbb{M}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}} \mapsto \sum_{\mathbb{M}} \mathcal{S} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(q).$$

Similarly, one can define $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ by replacing $\mathcal{S}$ with $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}$. Notice that $\sum_{\mathbb{M}} \tilde{\mathcal{S}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(q) = \sum_{\mathbb{M}} q^{\lambda_{\mathbb{M}}} \mathcal{S} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(q)$ for some constants $\lambda_{\mathbb{M}}$ depending only on $\mathbb{M}$. Thus $\mathfrak{S}_q$ is injective if and only if $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ is.

Theorem 4.4.1. *Choose any $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$. Then $\mathfrak{S}_q$ and $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ are injective linear maps.*

Proof. Let us fix $q_0 \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$ and let q denote a complex variable. Let us prove that $\mathfrak{S}_{q_0}$ is injective. Suppose that the finite sum $\sum_{\mathbb{M}} \mathcal{S} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(q_0)$ equals 0. We shall prove by contradiction that $\psi_{\mathbb{M}} = 0$ for any $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}$.

Suppose this is not true. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the (finite) subset of all $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}$ satisfying $\psi_{\mathbb{M}} \neq 0$. Then $\mathcal{F}$ is not an empty set. We first show that $\phi := \sum_{\mathbb{M}} \mathcal{S} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}$ (which is a multivalued holomorphic function on $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$) satisfies $\phi(q) = 0$ for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$. Choose any large enough $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then, by Theorem 4.3.1, $\phi^{\leq k}$ satisfies a linear differential equation on $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$ of the form $\partial_q \phi^{\leq k} = q^{-1} A \cdot \phi^{\leq k}$. Moreover, it satisfies the initial condition $\phi^{\leq k}(q_0) = 0$. Thus, by Theorem 1.7.1, $\phi^{\leq k}$ is constantly 0. So is ϕ .

Consider the $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{X} := \bigoplus_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}} \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$. Define a linear map $\kappa : \mathbb{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{W}_\bullet^*$ as follows. If $m \otimes m' \in \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$, then the evaluation of $\kappa(m \otimes m')$ with any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$ is

$$\langle \kappa(m \otimes m'), w_\bullet \rangle = \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_\bullet \otimes m \otimes m').$$

We claim that $\text{Ker}(\kappa)$ is a non-zero subspace of $\mathbb{X}$ invariant under the action of $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$. If this can be proved, then, by Lemma 4.4.2, we have $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}' \subset \text{ker}(\kappa)$ for some $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}$. Therefore, $\psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_\bullet \otimes m \otimes m') = 0$ for any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$ and $m \otimes m' \in \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$. Namely, $\psi_{\mathbb{M}} = 0$. So $\mathbb{M} \notin \mathcal{F}$, which gives a contradiction.

For any $n \in \mathbb{C}$, let P_n be the projection of $\mathbb{M}$ onto its L_0 -weight n subspace. Then

$$\phi(w_\bullet)(q) = \sum_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}} \sum_{n \in \mathbb{C}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_\bullet \otimes P_n \blacktriangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft) q^n.$$

Since this multivalued function is always 0, by Lemma 4.4.3, any coefficient before q^n is 0. Thus $P_n \blacktriangleright \otimes \blacktriangleleft$ (which is an element of $\mathbb{M}_{(n)} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{(n)}$) is in $\text{ker}(\kappa)$ for any n . Thus $\text{ker}(\kappa)$ must be non-empty.

Suppose now that $\sum_j m_j \otimes m'_j \in \text{Ker}(\kappa)$ where each $m_j \otimes m'_j$ belongs to some $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$. We set $\psi_{\tilde{\mathbb{M}}}(w_\bullet \otimes m_j \otimes m'_j) = 0$ if $\mathbb{M}, \tilde{\mathbb{M}} \in \mathcal{F}$ and $\mathbb{M} \neq \tilde{\mathbb{M}}$. Choose any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $l \in \mathbb{Z}$. We shall show that $\sum_j Y(u)_l m_j \otimes m'_j \in \text{Ker}(\kappa)$ for any $u \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. (Here Y denotes $Y_{\mathbb{M}}$ for a suitable $\mathbb{M}$.) Thus $\text{Ker}(\kappa)$ is $\mathbb{V} \times 1$ -invariant. A similar argument will show that $\text{Ker}(\kappa)$ is $1 \times \mathbb{V}$ -invariant, and hence $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -invariant.

Set divisors $D_1 = x_1 + \cdots + x_N$ and $D_2 = x' + x''$. Choose a natural number $k_2 \geq l$ such that $Y(u)_k m_j = Y(u)_k m'_j = 0$ for any j , any $k \geq k_2$, and any $u \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. This

is possible by the lower truncation property. By Corollary 1.2.2, we can choose $k_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $H^1(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - k_2 D_2)) = 0$. Thus, the short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - k_2 D_2) \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - l D_2) \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow 0$$

(where $\mathcal{G}$ is the quotient of the previous two sheaves) induces another one

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - k_2 D_2)) &\rightarrow H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - l D_2)) \\ &\rightarrow H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow 0. \end{aligned}$$

Choose any $u \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. Choose $v \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{G})$ to be $\mathcal{U}_\rho(\xi)^{-1} u \xi^l d\xi$ in W' and 0 in $\tilde{C} - \{x'\}$. Then v has a lift ν in $H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(k_1 D_1 - l D_2))$, which must be of the form

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}_\rho(\xi)\nu|_{W'} &= u \xi^l d\xi + \xi^{k_2} (\text{elements of } \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W')) d\xi, \\ \mathcal{U}_\rho(\varpi)\nu|_{W''} &= \varpi^{k_2} (\text{elements of } \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W'')) d\varpi. \end{aligned}$$

It is clear that $\nu \cdot m_j = Y(u)_l m_j$ and $\nu \cdot m'_j = 0$. Thus, as each $\psi_{\mathbb{M}}$ vanishes on $\nu \cdot (W_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}} \sum_j \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_{\bullet} \otimes Y(u)_l m_j \otimes m'_j) &= - \sum_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}} \sum_j \psi_{\mathbb{M}}((\nu \cdot w_{\bullet}) \otimes m_j \otimes m'_j) \\ &= - \sum_j \langle \kappa(m_j \otimes m'_j), \nu \cdot w_{\bullet} \rangle = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So $\sum_j Y(u)_l m_j \otimes m'_j \in \text{Ker}(\kappa)$. □

Lemma 4.4.2. *If $\text{Ker}(\kappa)$ is non-zero subspace of $\mathbb{X}$ invariant under the action of $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$, then it contains an irreducible summand $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$.*

Proof. Set $\mathbb{A} = \text{Ker}(\kappa)$. By basic representation theory, $\mathbb{A}$ contains an irreducible $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -submodule $\mathbb{A}_0$. (See for instance [Lang] section XVII.2.) Let $\iota : \mathbb{A}_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{X}$ be the inclusion, and let $p_{\mathbb{M}} : \mathbb{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ be the standard projection. Then $p_{\mathbb{M}} \circ \iota : \mathbb{A}_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ is non-zero for some $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{F}$. Since $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ is an irreducible $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module (see Proposition 4.5.16 and Theorem 4.5.12), $p_{\mathbb{M}} \circ \iota$ is surjective. Since $\mathbb{A}_0$ is irreducible and $p_{\mathbb{M}} \circ \iota$ is non-zero, the kernel of $p_{\mathbb{M}} \circ \iota$ must be empty. So $p_{\mathbb{M}} \circ \iota$ is an isomorphism. Hence $\mathbb{A}_0$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$. If $p_{\tilde{\mathbb{M}}} \circ \iota$ is non-zero for another $\tilde{\mathbb{M}} \in \mathcal{F}$, then the same argument shows $\mathbb{A}_0 \simeq \tilde{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \tilde{\mathbb{M}}'$, which is impossible since $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ is not isomorphic to $\tilde{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \tilde{\mathbb{M}}'$. So $\mathbb{A}_0$ must be exactly $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$. □

Lemma 4.4.3. *Let E be a finite subset of $\mathbb{C}$. Choose an element*

$$f(z) = \sum_{\alpha \in E + \mathbb{N}} c_{\alpha} z^{\alpha}$$

of $\mathbb{C}\{z\}$. Let $\epsilon > 0$. Assume that $f(z)$ converges absolutely to 0 on $\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$. Namely, for any $z \in \mathcal{D}_r^\times$, there is $C > 0$ such that

$$\sum_{\alpha \in E + \mathbb{N}} |c_\alpha z^\alpha| \leq C, \quad (4.4.2)$$

and the infinite sum $\sum_{\alpha \in E + \mathbb{N}} c_\alpha z^\alpha$ converges to 0. Then $c_\alpha = 0$ for each α .

Remark 4.4.4. Note that $f(z)$ can be written as $z^{\alpha_1} f_1(z) + \cdots + z^{\alpha_n} f_n(z)$ where $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathbb{C}[[z]]$, and any two of $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ do not differ by an integer. It is easy to see that $f(z)$ converges absolutely on $\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$ if and only if $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon)$. Indeed, the if part is obvious; the only if part follows from the root test. Moreover, it is clear that $f_1, \dots, f_n \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon)$ implies $f(z)$ converges a.l.u. on $\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$, i.e., for compact subset $K \subset \mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$, there is $C > 0$ such that (4.4.2) holds for any $z \in K$.

Proof of Lemma 4.4.3. Assume that the coefficients of f are not all 0. We can let $r \in \mathbb{R}$ be the smallest number such that $c_\alpha \neq 0$ for some $\alpha \in E + \mathbb{N}$ satisfying $\operatorname{Re}(\alpha) = r$. Let $\beta_1 = r + \mathbf{i}s_1, \dots, \beta_k = r + \mathbf{i}s_k$ be all the elements of $E + \mathbb{N}$ whose real parts are r . (So $s_1, \dots, s_k \in \mathbb{R}$.) Notice $s_i \neq s_j$ when $i \neq j$. Then

$$z^{-r} f(z) = c_{\beta_1} z^{\mathbf{i}s_1} + \cdots + c_{\beta_k} z^{\mathbf{i}s_k} + g(z)$$

where $g(z) \in \mathbb{C}\{z\}$ can be written as

$$g(z) = z^{\gamma_1} h_1(z) + \cdots + z^{\gamma_m} h_m(z)$$

for some $h_1, \dots, h_m \in \mathbb{C}[[z]]$, the real parts of $\gamma_1, \dots, \gamma_m \in \mathbb{C}$ are all > 0 , and any two of $\gamma_1, \dots, \gamma_m$ do not differ by an integer. Since $z^{-r} f(z)$ converges absolutely on $\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$, we have $h_1, \dots, h_m \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon)$ by Remark 4.4.4. Let t be a real variable. Then it is easy to see by induction that for any $j \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow -\infty} \partial_t^j g(e^t) = 0.$$

Since the j -th derivative of $e^{-rt} f(e^t)$ over t is constantly 0, we have

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow -\infty} (c_{\beta_1} s_1^{j-1} e^{\mathbf{i}s_1 t} + \cdots + c_{\beta_k} s_k^{j-1} e^{\mathbf{i}s_k t}) = 0.$$

Let $A = (s_i^{j-1})_{1 \leq i, j \leq k} \in M_{k \times k}(\mathbb{C})$. Then

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow -\infty} (c_{\beta_1} e^{\mathbf{i}s_1 t}, \dots, c_{\beta_k} e^{\mathbf{i}s_k t}) \cdot A = 0.$$

Since A is a Vandermonde matrix which is invertible, we conclude that $c_{\beta_1} e^{\mathbf{i}s_1 t}, \dots, c_{\beta_k} e^{\mathbf{i}s_k t}$ all converge to 0, which forces $c_{\beta_1}, \dots, c_{\beta_k}$ to be 0. This gives a contradiction. $\square$

Corollary 4.4.5. *There are finitely many equivalence classes of irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules.*

Recall that $\mathbb{V}$ is assumed to be C_2 -cofinite.

Proof. We let $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\mathbb{P}^1; 1; 0; \infty; z - 1; z; 1/z)$. Set $r = \rho = 1$. Let $\mathfrak{X}$ be obtained by sewing $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$. Then, for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_1^\times$, $\mathcal{C}_q$ is of genus 1. Choose $\mathcal{E}$ to be an arbitrary finite set of mutually inequivalent irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. We claim that the cardinality of $\mathcal{E}$ is bounded by dimension of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{V})$ which is finite by Theorem 3.7.3. Indeed, consider the map $\mathfrak{S}_q$ in (4.4.1), where we set $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$ to be $\mathbb{V}$. For each $\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}$, the vector space $\mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$ is nontrivial by the construction in example 3.1.6. Thus, the dimension of the domain of $\mathfrak{S}_q$ must be no less than the cardinality of $\mathcal{E}$, which is bounded by the dimension of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_q}^*(\mathbb{V})$ since $\mathfrak{S}_q$ is injective. $\square$

4.5 More on VOA modules

We fix a VOA $\mathbb{V}$. In this section, we do not assume $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite.

A criterion on weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules

Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a vector space. Let $Y_{\mathbb{W}}$ associates to each $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ an operator $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n \in \text{End}(\mathbb{W})$, and assume that the map $v \in \mathbb{V} \mapsto Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n$ is linear. Set $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n z^{-n-1} \in \text{End}(\mathbb{W})[[z, z^{-1}]]$. We assume that for each $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $w \in \mathbb{W}$, we have $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n w = 0$ for any n small enough, i.e.,

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w \in \mathbb{W}((z)).$$

We say that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_{\mathbb{W}})$ (or simply $\mathbb{W}$) is a (lower-truncated) **linear representation** of $\mathbb{V}$.

Let $\mathbb{W}^\circ$ be a subspace of the dual space $\mathbb{W}^*$ of $\mathbb{W}$. We say that $\mathbb{W}^\circ$ is **dense**, if for any $w \in \mathbb{W}$, we have $w = 0$ iff $\langle w', w \rangle = 0$ for any $w' \in \mathbb{W}^\circ$.

Proposition 4.5.1. *Let $\mathbb{W}$ be a linear representation of $\mathbb{V}$. Assume that $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{1}, z) = \mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{W}}$. Assume that $\mathbb{W}^*$ has a dense subspace $\mathbb{W}^\circ$ satisfying the following condition: For each $w' \in \mathbb{W}^\circ$, there exist $\epsilon > 0$ such that*

- (1) *for each $v \in \mathbb{V}, w \in \mathbb{W}, \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((z))$ is the laurent series expansion of an element of $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times)$;*
- (2) *for each $u, v \in \mathbb{V}, w \in \mathbb{W}$, there exists $f = f(\zeta, z) \in \mathcal{O}(\text{Conf}_2(\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times))$ such that for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $z \in \mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$,*

$$\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_n w, w' \rangle = \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} f(\zeta, z)\zeta^n d\zeta, \quad (4.5.1)$$

$$\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u)_n v, z)w, w' \rangle = \text{Res}_{\zeta-z=0} f(\zeta, z)(\zeta - z)^n d\zeta, \quad (4.5.2)$$

and for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $\zeta \in \mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$,

$$\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, \zeta)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n w, w' \rangle = \text{Res}_{z=0} f(\zeta, z)z^n dz. \quad (4.5.3)$$

Then $\mathbb{W}$ is a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

(2) says that for each $z \in \mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$, $\langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, \zeta)w \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta))$ and $\langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, z)w \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((\zeta - z))$ are respectively the Laurent series expansions of $f(\zeta, z)$ at $\zeta = 0$ and $\zeta = z$; for each $\zeta \in \mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$, $\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, \zeta)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)w, w' \rangle \in \mathbb{C}((z))$ is the Laurent series expansion of $f(\zeta, z)$ at $z = 0$.

We remark that in practice, we can often choose ϵ independent of w' .

Proof. Choose circles C_1, C_2, C_3 in $\mathcal{D}_\epsilon^\times$ surrounding 0 with radii $r_1 < r_2 < r_3$. For each $z \in C_2$, choose a circle $C(z)$ centered at z whose radius is less than $r_2 - r_1$ and $r_3 - r_2$. Choose any $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $P(z) = Q(z) - R(z)$ where

$$\begin{aligned} P(z) &= \oint_{C(z)} f(\zeta, z) \zeta^m (\zeta - z)^n d\zeta, \\ Q(z) &= \oint_{C_3} f(\zeta, z) \zeta^m (\zeta - z)^n d\zeta, \\ R(z) &= \oint_{C_1} f(\zeta, z) \zeta^m (\zeta - z)^n d\zeta. \end{aligned}$$

As in the proof of Theorem 2.1.2, we may use (4.5.1) and (4.5.2) to calculate that

$$\begin{aligned} P(z) &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u)_{n+l}v, z)w, w' \rangle z^{m-l}, \\ R(z) &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^{n-l} \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, z)Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_{m+l}w, w' \rangle z^{n-l}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, for any $h \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \oint_{C_2} P(z) z^h dz &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(Y(u)_{n+l}v)_{m+h-l}w, w' \rangle z^{m-l}, \\ \oint_{C_2} R(z) z^h dz &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^{n-l} \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{n+h-l}Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_{m+l}w, w' \rangle z^{n-l}. \end{aligned}$$

Also, by (4.5.3), it is not hard to see that

$$\begin{aligned} \oint_{C_2} Q(z) z^h dz &= \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C_3} f(\zeta, z) z^h \zeta^m (\zeta - z)^n d\zeta dz \\ &= \oint_{C_3} \oint_{C_2} f(\zeta, z) z^h \zeta^m (\zeta - z)^n dz d\zeta \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= \oint_{C_3} \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^l \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u, \zeta) Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{h+l} w, w' \rangle \zeta^{m+n-l} d\zeta \\
&= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{n}{l} (-1)^l \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(u)_{m+n-l} Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{h+l} w, w' \rangle.
\end{aligned}$$

This proves the Jacobi identity (2.2.2) since we have $\oint_{C_2} P(z) z^h dz = \oint_{C_2} Q(z) z^h dz - \oint_{C_2} R(z) z^h dz$. $\square$

Lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules

Most results in this section is well-known.

Let $(\mathbb{W}, Y_{\mathbb{W}})$ be a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module. We define its **lowest weight subspace** to be

$$\Omega(\mathbb{W}) = \{w \in \mathbb{W} : Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n w = 0 \text{ for any homogeneous } v \in \mathbb{V}, n \geq \text{wt}(v)\}.$$

Using (2.2.3), it is easy to see that $Y(v)_n \Omega(\mathbb{W}) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$ when $\text{wt}(v) = n + 1$. If $\mathbb{W}$ is admissible, then the lowest $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space of $\mathbb{W}$ is a subspace of $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. In particular, $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is non-trivial if $\mathbb{W}$ is so. Also, if $(\mathbb{W}_i)_i$ is a collection of weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, then

$$\Omega\left(\bigoplus_i \mathbb{W}_i\right) = \bigoplus_i \Omega(\mathbb{W}_i). \quad (4.5.4)$$

Indeed, it is clear that a vector w in the direct sum is annihilated by any $Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n$ (where $n \geq \text{wt}(v)$) if and only if each component of w is so. We say that $\mathbb{W}$ is a **lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module**, if $\mathbb{W}$ is generated by the lowest weight vectors, i.e., vectors in $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$.

It will be interesting to know if a weak module has non-trivial lowest weight subspace. The following lemma provides a criterion.

Lemma 4.5.2. *Assume that $\mathbb{W}$ is admissible, and let $\mathbb{M}$ be a non-trivial weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$. Then $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is non-trivial.*

Note that in general, we always have the obvious relation $\Omega(\mathbb{M}) = \Omega(\mathbb{W}) \cap \mathbb{M}$.

Proof. Choose any $w \in \mathbb{M}$. For each $k \in \mathbb{N}$, let $\mathbb{W}^{\leq k}$ be the subspace spanned by the $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vectors with weights $\leq k$. Since $\mathbb{M} = \bigcup_{k \in \mathbb{N}} (\mathbb{M} \cap \mathbb{W}^{\leq k})$, we can find the smallest k such that $\mathbb{M} \cap \mathbb{W}^{\leq k}$ is non-trivial. If $v \in \mathbb{V}$ is homogeneous, $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $n \geq \text{wt}(v)$. Then $Y(v)_n \mathbb{W}^{\leq k} \subset \mathbb{W}^{\leq k-1}$ by (2.2.6). Thus $Y(v)_n (\mathbb{M} \cap \mathbb{W}^{\leq k}) \subset \mathbb{M} \cap \mathbb{W}^{\leq k-1} = \{0\}$. So $\mathbb{M} \cap \mathbb{W}^{\leq k}$ is a non-trivial subspace of $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$. $\square$

Let $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ be the universal unital associative algebra generated freely by the elements (v, n) where $v \in \mathbb{V}$ is homogeneous and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then, $\mathbb{W}$ is a representation

of $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ defined by $(v, n) \cdot w = Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n w$. We say that (v, n) is **raising** (resp. **lowering**, **strictly raising**, **strictly lowering**) if $\text{wt}(v) - n - 1$ is ≥ 0 (resp. $\leq 0, > 0, < 0$). Then $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is precisely the subspace of vectors annihilated by all strictly lowering elements.

We let $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ be the subalgebra of $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ of generated by 1 and $(v_1, n_1) \cdots (v_k, n_k)$ where $k \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ and

$$\sum_{i=1}^k (\text{wt}(v_i) - n_i - 1) = 0.$$

Then $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})\Omega(\mathbb{W}) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$. Thus, $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is a representation of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$. Using the commutator formula (2.2.3) to move all the strictly lowering elements to the right, we see that the action of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ on $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is determined by (v, n) where v is homogeneous and $n = \text{wt}(v) - 1$.

Proposition 4.5.3. *Assume that $\mathbb{W}$ is an irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Then $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ equals the lowest nontrivial $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space, and is an irreducible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module.*

Proof. Assume without loss of generality that $\mathbb{W}(0)$ is the lowest nontrivial $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space. Clearly $\mathbb{W}(0) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$. If $w \in \Omega(\mathbb{W})$, we let $w(k)$ be the (non-zero) component of w in $\bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}(n)$ with the largest weight k . We claim $k = 0$, which shows $w \in \mathbb{W}(0)$, and hence $\Omega(\mathbb{W}) \subset \mathbb{W}(0)$. By the irreducibility of $\mathbb{W}$, there exists $x \in \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ lowering the $\tilde{L}_0$ -weights by k , such that $xw(k)$ is a non-zero vector of $\mathbb{W}(0)$. We must have $xw = xw(k)$, which shows xw is non-zero. Suppose $k > 0$. Then x must contain strictly lowering components. By using the commutator formula (2.2.3) to move all the strictly lowering components of x to the right, we can find a strictly lowering element whose action on w is non-zero. This contradicts $w \in \Omega(\mathbb{W})$.

Let U be any non-trivial $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -invariant subspace of $\mathbb{W}(0)$. By (2.2.6), it is easy to see that $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})U \cap \mathbb{W}(0) \subset \mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})U$. So $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})U \cap \mathbb{W}(0) \subset U$. $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})U$ is clearly a non-trivial weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$. Thus, by the irreducibility of $\mathbb{W}$, we have $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})U = \mathbb{W}$. Hence $\mathbb{W}(0) = U$. $\square$

Corollary 4.5.4. *Let $\mathbb{W}$ be an irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Then $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ equals the lowest non-trivial eigenspace of L_0 . In particular, $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is non-trivial and finite-dimensional.*

Proof. Set $\tilde{L}_0 = L_0$ and apply Proposition 4.5.3. $\square$

Remark 4.5.5. Let $\mathbb{W}$ be an irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Choose $\tilde{L}_0$ whose lowest weight is 0. We know that $\Omega(\mathbb{W}) = \mathbb{W}(0)$ and $\Omega(\mathbb{W}') = \mathbb{W}'(0)$. Note that $\mathbb{W}'(0)$ is the dual space of $\mathbb{W}(0)$. Moreover, if $v \in \mathbb{V}$ is homogeneous, by (2.2.10), we know that for any $w \in \mathbb{W}(0), w' \in \mathbb{W}'(0) = \mathbb{W}(0)^*$,

$$\langle Y_{\mathbb{W}'}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1} w', w \rangle = \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{wt}(v)}}{l!} \langle w', Y_{\mathbb{W}}(L_1^l v)_{\text{wt}(v)-l-1} w \rangle. \quad (4.5.5)$$

Thus, the action of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ on $\mathbb{W}'(0)$ is completely determined by that of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ on $\mathbb{W}(0)$. We will see a stronger result in Section 4.6, that the irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ is completely determined by the $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module $\mathbb{W}(0)$.

Proposition 4.5.6. *Assume that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_{\mathbb{W}})$ is a lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module with finite dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. Then $\mathbb{W}$ is an admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module.*

Proof. For any $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$, we let $\mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$ be the subspace of all $w \in \mathbb{W}$ satisfying $(L_0 - \lambda)^N w = 0$ for some $N \in \mathbb{Z}_+$. For any homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have by (2.2.5) that

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m(L_0 - \lambda) = (L_0 - (\text{wt}(v) + \lambda - m - 1))Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m.$$

Thus

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m(L_0 - \lambda)^N = (L_0 - (\text{wt}(v) + \lambda - m - 1))^N Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m, \quad (4.5.6)$$

which shows

$$Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_m \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]} \subset \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda + \text{wt}(v) - m - 1]}. \quad (4.5.7)$$

That $\bigvee_{\lambda \in \mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$ follows as in the finite dimensional case: Suppose $v_1 + \cdots + v_n = 0$ where $(L_0 - \lambda_i)^N v_i = 0$ for each $1 \leq i \leq n$ and $\lambda_i \neq \lambda_j$ when $i \neq j$. Set polynomials $p(x) = (x - \lambda_1)^N, q(x) = (x - \lambda_2)^N \cdots (x - \lambda_n)^N$. Then $p(L_0)v_1 = 0$ and $q(L_0)v_1 = q(L_0)(v_1 + v_2 + \cdots + v_n) = 0$. Since $p(x), q(x)$ have no common divisor other than 1, there exist polynomials $a(x), b(x)$ such that $a(x)p(x) + b(x)q(x) = 1$. So $v_1 = a(L_0)p(L_0)v_1 + b(L_0)q(L_0)v_1 = 0$. Similar argument shows $v_2 = \cdots = v_n = 0$.

We say that a vector $w \in \mathbb{W}$ is a generalized eigenvector of L_0 if $w \in \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$ for some $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$. Since $L_0 \Omega(\mathbb{W}) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$ and $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is finite dimension, by the Jordan canonical form for $L_0|_{\Omega(\mathbb{W})}$, $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ must be spanned by generalized eigenvectors of L_0 . By (4.5.7), the same is true for $\mathbb{W}$. We thus have grading $\mathbb{W} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \mathbb{C}} \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$. Moreover, by (4.5.7) and that $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is finite-dimensional, we may find a finite subset $E \subset \mathbb{C}$ such that $\mathbb{W} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in E + \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$, and that any two elements of E do not differ by an integer. Set $\mathbb{W}(n)$ to be $\mathbb{W}_{[\lambda]}$ if $\lambda - n \in E$ for some $\lambda \in E + \mathbb{N}$ (such λ must be unique); otherwise, set $\mathbb{W}(n) = 0$. Then (2.2.6) is satisfied, and $\mathbb{W} = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{W}(n)$. Thus, $\mathbb{W}$ is admissible. $\square$

Theorem 4.5.7. *Assume that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_{\mathbb{W}})$ is a lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module with finite dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$.*

- (1) $\mathbb{M}$ is an irreducible weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$ if and only if $\mathbb{M}$ is generated by $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$, and $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is an irreducible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module. In that case, $\mathbb{M}$ is an admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module.
- (2) There is a 1-1 correspondence between irreducible weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodules $\mathbb{M}$ of $\mathbb{W}$ and irreducible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -submodules $\mathbb{U}$ of $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. The relation is given by $\mathbb{U} = \Omega(\mathbb{M})$ and $\mathbb{M} = \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U}$.

(3) $\mathbb{W}$ is completely reducible if and only if $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is so. In that case, there are finitely many irreducible weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodules $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_n$ (which are admissible) such that

$$\mathbb{M} = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathbb{M}_i, \quad \Omega(\mathbb{M}) = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \Omega(\mathbb{M}_i).$$

Proof. By Proposition 4.5.6, $\mathbb{W}$ is admissible.

(1): Let $\mathbb{M}$ be a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$. Note that by Lemma 4.5.2, $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is nontrivial. Assume first of all that $\mathbb{M}$ is an irreducible (non-trivial) weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Then $\mathbb{M}$ is generated by any non-trivial subspace, and hence by $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$. Since $\Omega(\mathbb{M}) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$, $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is finite-dimensional. By Proposition 4.5.6, $\mathbb{M}$ is admissible. Thus, by Proposition 4.5.3, $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is irreducible. Conversely, assume $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is irreducible. Let $\mathbb{M}_1$ be a non-trivial weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{M}$. By Lemma 4.5.2, $\Omega(\mathbb{M}_1)$ is a non-trivial $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule of $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$. Thus $\Omega(\mathbb{M}_1) = \Omega(\mathbb{M})$. Suppose $\mathbb{M}$ is generated by $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$. Then $\mathbb{M}$ is generated by $\Omega(\mathbb{M}_1)$. So $\mathbb{M} \subset \mathbb{M}_1$. Hence $\mathbb{M}$ is irreducible.

(2): Note that by part (1), $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U}$ is irreducible. We shall show $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\Omega(\mathbb{M}) = \mathbb{M}$ and $\Omega(\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U}) = \mathbb{U}$. Since $\Omega(\mathbb{M})$ is a nontrivial subspace of $\mathbb{M}$, we must have $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\Omega(\mathbb{M}) \subset \mathbb{M}$ and hence, by the irreducibility of $\mathbb{M}$, that $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\Omega(\mathbb{M}) = \mathbb{M}$. Since $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U}$ is clearly nontrivial, $\Omega(\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U})$ is a nontrivial $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule of $\mathbb{U}$. So $\Omega(\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\mathbb{U}) = \mathbb{U}$.

(3) If $\mathbb{W}$ is completely reducible, i.e., equivalent to $\bigoplus_i \mathbb{W}_i$ where each $\mathbb{W}_i$ is an irreducible weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module, then by (4.5.4), $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is equivalent to $\bigoplus_i \Omega(\mathbb{W}_i)$ where each $\Omega(\mathbb{W}_i)$ is irreducible. So $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is completely reducible.

Now, assume that $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is completely reducible. Since $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is finite dimensional, it is semisimple, i.e., $\Omega(\mathbb{W}) = \bigoplus_{i=1}^N \mathbb{U}_i$ where $N \in \mathbb{Z}_+$, and each $\mathbb{U}_i$ is an irreducible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule of $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. Since $\mathbb{W}$ is generated by $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$, it is clear that $\mathbb{W} = \bigvee_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})(\mathbb{U}_i)$. Thus, $\mathbb{W}$ is a sum of irreducible modules. By basic representation theory (see for instance [Lang] section XVII.2.), $\mathbb{W}$ is completely reducible. $\square$

Definition 4.5.8. Let $\mathbb{U}$ be a finite dimensional representation of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$. We say that $\mathbb{U}$ is **$\mathbb{V}$ -admissible** if there exists a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module such that the $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is equivalent to $\mathbb{U}$. By restricting $\mathbb{W}$ to $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})\Omega(\mathbb{W})$, we may assume that $\mathbb{W}$ is a lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

By the previous results, we clearly have:

Proposition 4.5.9. *The following are equivalent.*

- (a) Every lowest weight admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ with finite dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is completely reducible.
- (b) Every lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ with finite dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is a finite direct sum of irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules.

(c) Every finite-dimensional $\mathbb{V}$ -admissible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module is semi-simple.

Definition 4.5.10. If $\mathbb{V}$ satisfies one of the three conditions of Proposition 4.5.9, we say that $\mathbb{V}$ is **rational**.

Note that by Corollary 4.5.13, if $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational, each lowest weight weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$ with finite dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is a finite direct sum of irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -modules.

Remark 4.5.11. Our definition of rationality is weaker than the usual one, which says any admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module is completely reducible. Assuming $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite, then the two notations are equivalent. Indeed, our rationality is equivalent to the semisimplicity of the Zhu's algebra $A(\mathbb{V})$ of $\mathbb{V}$. The latter is equivalent to the usual rationality due to [McR21].

Suppose now that $(\mathbb{W}, Y_+, Y_-)$ is a weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module. We let $\Omega_+(\mathbb{M})$ (resp. $\Omega_-(\mathbb{M})$) be the lowest weight subspace of $(\mathbb{W}, Y_+)$ (resp. $(\mathbb{W}, Y_-)$). Set

$$\Omega_{+-}(\mathbb{W}) = \Omega_+(\mathbb{W}) \cap \Omega_-(\mathbb{W}). \quad (4.5.8)$$

Then, it is clear that $\Omega_{+-}(\mathbb{W})$ is $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V}) \times \mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -invariant.

Some results for associative algebras

Let A be an associative algebra and U be a representation of A . It is clear that if U_1, U_2 are inequivalent irreducible representations of A , then $\text{Hom}_A(U_1, U_2) = 0$. Indeed, choose any $T \in \text{Hom}_A(U_1, U_2) = 0$. If $T \neq 0$, then $\text{Ker}(T)$ is a A -submodule of U_1 not equal to U_1 . So $\text{Ker}(T) = 0$. Also, since the range of T is a non-trivial A -submodule of U_2 , T must be surjective. This is impossible.

We say that U is **strongly irreducible**, if U is irreducible, and $\text{End}_A(U) = \mathbb{C}1_U$. We say that U is **strongly and completely reducible** if $U \simeq \bigoplus_i U_i$ where each U_i is strongly irreducible. For instance, this is so if U is a direct sum of irreducible finite dimensional representations.

We have seen in Proposition 2.2.7 that any irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module is strongly irreducible. More generally, we have:

Theorem 4.5.12. *Let $\mathbb{W}$ be an irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module with finite-dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. Then $\mathbb{W}$ is strongly irreducible (as an $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ -module), and L_0 differs $\tilde{L}_0$ by a constant. Moreover, $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ equals the lowest non-trivial eigenspaces of both L_0 and $\tilde{L}_0$, and is a (strongly) irreducible $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module.*

Note that by Corollary 4.5.4, if $\mathbb{W}$ is an irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module, then it automatically has finite-dimensional $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$.

Proof. Choose any $T \in \text{End}_{\mathbb{V}}(\mathbb{W})$. Since $[T, Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_n] = 0$ for any homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}$ and $n \geq \text{wt}(v)$, we have $T\Omega(\mathbb{W}) \subset \Omega(\mathbb{W})$. Since $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is non-trivial (since it contains the lowest $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space) and finite-dimensional, $T|_{\Omega(\mathbb{W})}$ has an eigenvalue $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$. It follows that $\text{Ker}(T - \lambda 1_{\mathbb{W}})$ is a non-trivial weak $\mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{W}$, which must be $\mathbb{W}$. So $T = \lambda 1_{\mathbb{W}}$. In particular, $\tilde{L}_0 - L_0$ is a constant. The rest of the statements follows from Proposition 4.5.3. $\square$

Corollary 4.5.13. *Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite. Let $\mathbb{W}$ be an irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V}$ -module. Then $\mathbb{W}$ is an irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -module.*

Proof. By Theorem 3.7.1 and the description (3.7.1), it is clear that each $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space is finite-dimensional. In particular, this is true for the lowest non-trivial $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight space, which by Proposition 4.5.3 is $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$. So $\Omega(\mathbb{W})$ is finite-dimensional. Thus, by Theorem 4.5.12, L_0 is diagonalizable with finite dimensional eigenspaces, and the eigenvalues are in $\lambda + \mathbb{N}$ for some $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$. $\square$

Proposition 4.5.14. *Let $\mathbf{U}$ be a strongly irreducible A -module. Let V, W be vector spaces. Consider the A -modules $\mathbf{U} \otimes V, \mathbf{U} \otimes W$ where the actions of A are on the $\mathbf{U}$ -component. Define a linear map*

$$\Phi : \text{Hom}(V, W) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U} \otimes V, \mathbf{U} \otimes W), \quad T \mapsto 1_{\mathbf{U}} \otimes T$$

Then Φ is an isomorphism of vector spaces.

Proof. Φ is clearly injective. Let us prove that Φ is surjective. Choose any $S \in \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U} \otimes V, \mathbf{U} \otimes W)$. We shall show that for each $v \in V$, there exists a (necessarily unique) $w \in W$ such that $S(u \otimes v) = u \otimes w$ for each $u \in \mathbf{U}$. Then $S = 1_{\mathbf{U}} \otimes T$ where T sends each v to w . By the uniqueness of w with respect to v , the map T is linear.

Let us fix any $v \in V$, and let $1 \otimes v$ denote the homomorphism $\mathbf{U} \rightarrow \mathbf{U} \otimes V$ sending each $u_0 \in \mathbf{U}$ to $u_0 \otimes v$. For each $w' \in W^*$, let $1 \otimes w'$ denote the homomorphism from $\mathbf{U} \otimes V$ to $\mathbf{U}$ sending each $u_0 \otimes v_0$ to $v'(v_0) \cdot u_0$. Then $(1 \otimes w')S(1 \otimes v)$ is an endomorphism of $\mathbf{U}$, which is of the form $\lambda_{w'} 1_{\mathbf{U}}$ for some $\lambda_{w'} \in \mathbb{C}$.

Choose a basis $\{e_i\}$ of $\mathbf{U}_i$. Fix a basis element e_i . Then we can find a set of vectors $\{w_j\}$ in W such that $S(e_i \otimes v) = \sum_j e_j \otimes w_j$. Choose any $w' \in W^*$. Then

$$\lambda_{w'} e_i = (1 \otimes w')S(1 \otimes v)e_i = (1 \otimes w')S(e_i \otimes v) = \sum_j w'(w_j) \cdot e_j.$$

Thus, whenever $j \neq i$, we have $w'(w_j) = 0$ for any w' , and hence $w_j = 0$. Therefore $S(e_i \otimes v) = e_i \otimes w_i$, and hence $S(u \otimes v) = u \otimes w_i$ for each $u \in \mathbf{U}$. $\square$

Set $V = \mathbb{C}$. We obtain:

Corollary 4.5.15. *Let $\mathbf{U}$ be a strongly irreducible A -module. Let V be a vector space. Consider the A -module $\mathbf{U} \otimes W$ where the action of A is on the $\mathbf{U}$ -component. Define a linear map*

$$\Phi : W \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}, \mathbf{U} \otimes W), \quad w \mapsto \Phi(w)$$

where $\Phi(w)(u) = u \otimes w$ for each $u \in \mathbf{U}$. Then Φ is an isomorphism of vector spaces.

Suppose that A, B are associative algebras, and $\mathbf{W}$ is both an A -module and a B -module. We say that $\mathbf{W}$ is an $A \times B$ -module if the actions of A and B on $\mathbf{W}$ commute.

Proposition 4.5.16. *If $\mathbf{U}$ is a strongly irreducible A -module, and $\mathbf{V}$ is an irreducible B -module, then $\mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$ is an irreducible $A \times B$ -module. If $\mathbf{V}$ is moreover strongly irreducible, then so is the $A \times B$ -module $\mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$.*

Proof. Choose any non-zero vector $w \in \mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$. Since $\mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$ is clearly completely reducible as an A -module, by basic representation theory, the submodule $(A \otimes 1)w$ is also completely reducible,¹ hence contains an irreducible submodule, which must be equivalent to $\mathbf{U}$. By Corollary 4.5.15, this submodule must be of the form $\mathbf{U} \otimes v$ for a non-zero vector $v \in \mathbf{V}$. Thus, as $(A \otimes B)(\mathbf{U} \otimes v) = \mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$, we have $(A \otimes B)w = \mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$, which proves that $\mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V}$ is irreducible.

Choose any $S \in \text{End}_{A \times B}(\mathbf{U} \otimes \mathbf{V})$. Then S commutes with the actions of A . Thus, by Proposition 4.5.14, $S = 1_{\mathbf{U}} \otimes T$ where $T \in \text{End}(\mathbf{V})$. Since S commutes with the actions of B , so does T . Thus $T \in \text{End}_B(\mathbf{V})$, which must be a scalar multiplication if $\mathbf{V}$ is strongly irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 4.5.17. *Let $\mathbf{W}$ be a representation of $A \times B$. Suppose that $\mathbf{W}$ is strongly and completely reducible as an A -module, and (resp. strongly and) completely reducible as a B -module. Then, there exist strongly irreducible A -modules $\{\mathbf{U}_i\}_{i \in \mathcal{I}}$ and (resp. strongly) irreducible B -modules $\{\mathbf{V}_i\}_{i \in \mathcal{I}}$, such that*

$$\mathbf{W} \simeq \bigoplus_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \mathbf{U}_i \otimes \mathbf{V}_i.$$

Proof. Since $A \curvearrowright \mathbf{W}$ is strongly and completely reducible, by Corollary 4.5.15, we can find a collection of mutually inequivalent strongly irreducible A -modules $\{\mathbf{U}_i\}_i$ such that the equivalence

$$\mathbf{W} \simeq \bigoplus_i \mathbf{U}_i \otimes \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W}) \tag{4.5.9}$$

holds for A -modules. Here, A is acting on $\mathbf{U}_i \otimes \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$ by acting on the $\mathbf{U}_i$ -component. Moreover, the natural embedding $\mathbf{U}_i \otimes \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{W}$ is given by $u \otimes T \mapsto Tu$ if $u \in \mathbf{U}_i, T \in \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$.

¹A submodule of a completely reducible module is completely reducible; see [Lang] section XVII.2.

Since the actions of A and B commute, each $b \in B$ can be viewed as an element of $\text{End}_A(\mathbf{W})$. Thus, $\text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$ is naturally a B -module where each $b \in B$ acts on $T \in \text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$ as bT . It is easy to see that (4.5.9) is an equivalence of $A \times B$ -module.

By the irreducibility of $\mathbf{U}_i$, for each nonzero $u \in \mathbf{U}_i$, the map $\text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W}) \rightarrow \mathbf{W}, T \mapsto Tu$ is an injective homomorphism of B -modules. It follows that each $\text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$ is equivalent to a B -submodule of $\mathbf{W}$. Thus, it is a direct sum of irreducible B -modules. We can thus write $\text{Hom}_A(\mathbf{U}_i, \mathbf{W})$ as a direct sum $\bigoplus_j \mathbf{V}_{i,j}$ of irreducible B -modules. It follows that $\mathbf{W} \simeq \bigoplus_{i,j} \mathbf{U}_i \otimes \mathbf{V}_{i,j}$. It is easy to see that any irreducible submodule of a direct sum of strongly irreducible modules is strongly irreducible (since it is isomorphic to one of the strongly irreducible summand). So $\mathbf{V}_{i,j}$ is strongly irreducible if $\mathbf{W}$ is strongly and completely reducible as a B -module. $\square$

4.6 Dual tensor products

Let

$$\mathfrak{X} = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N; x'; x''; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi; \varpi) \quad (4.6.1)$$

be an $(N+2)$ -pointed compact Riemann surface with local coordinates. Throughout this section, we fix mutually disjoint neighborhoods $W_1, \dots, W_N, W', W''$ of $x_1, \dots, x_N, x', x''$ respectively, on which the local coordinates are defined. We assume that each connected component of C contains at least one of $x_1, \dots, x_N$, and call such $\mathfrak{X}$ an **N -pointed compact Riemann surface with local coordinates and 2 outputs**. We let

$$S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + \dots + x_N, \quad D_{\mathfrak{X}} = x' + x''.$$

For each $a, b \in \mathbb{N}$, define

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n} &\equiv \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}(-(L_0 D_{\mathfrak{X}} + ax' + bx'')) \quad (\forall n \in \mathbb{N}), \\ \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b} &= \varinjlim_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}. \end{aligned}$$

Here, $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}$ is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_C$ -submodule of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}$ described as follows: Outside x' and x'' , $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}$ equals $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\leq n}$; $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}|_{W'}$ and $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}|_{W''}$ are generated by

$$\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)^{-1} \xi^{a+L_0} v \quad \text{resp.} \quad \mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\varpi)^{-1} \varpi^{b+L_0} v$$

where v is any homogeneous vector of $\mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. It is easy to check that this definition is independent of the local coordinates ξ, ϖ .

Let $\mathbb{V}$ be a VOA. We do not assume $\mathbb{V}$ to be C_2 -cofinite. Let $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules associated to $x_1, \dots, x_N$. We define a **truncated $\mathfrak{X}$ -tensor product** of $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ to be the vector space

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \frac{\mathbb{W}_\bullet}{H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b} \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_\bullet}. \quad (4.6.2)$$

Its dual space is denoted by $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and called a **truncated dual $\mathfrak{X}$ -tensor product**. Note that when $a' > a$ and $b' > b$, we have a natural injective linear map $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^* \hookrightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a',b'}^*$. We can thus define

$$\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) = \varinjlim_{a,b \in \mathbb{N}} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet),$$

called the **dual $\mathfrak{X}$ -tensor product** of $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$.

In a similar way, one can define $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}$, $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}$, and (the sheaves of) (truncated) (dual) $\mathfrak{X}$ -tensor products when $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates and M -outputs. In the case that $M = 0$, we obtain the spaces/sheaves of covacua and conformal blocks. All the results in chapters 2 and 3 can be generalized to these sheaves/vector spaces using almost the same idea. For instance, notice that in the setting (4.6.1), we have

$$\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n} / \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n-1} \simeq \mathbb{V}(n) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \Theta_C^{\otimes n}(-nD_{\mathfrak{X}} - ax' - bx''). \quad (4.6.3)$$

Thus, we have the vanishing Theorem 2.4.3 with $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$ replaced by $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\leq n}$. (Of course, the integer k_0 in that theorem should now also depend on a, b .) In the following, we will directly claim and use the generalizations of those results without proving them again.

Example 4.6.1. Let $\mathbb{M}_1, \mathbb{M}_2$ be irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. By Convention 2.2.6, their lowest $\tilde{L}_0$ -weights (with non-trivial weight subspaces $\mathbb{M}_1(0), \mathbb{M}_2(0)$) are both 0. Choose any $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M}_1 \otimes \mathbb{M}_2)$. Then there is a natural linear map

$$\Psi_\phi : \mathbb{M}_1^{\leq a} \otimes \mathbb{M}_2^{\leq b} \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$$

defined such that for any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet, m_1 \in \mathbb{M}_1^{\leq a}, m_2 \in \mathbb{M}_2^{\leq b}$,

$$\Psi_\phi(m_1 \otimes m_2)(w_\bullet) = \phi(w_\bullet \otimes m_1 \otimes m_2). \quad (4.6.4)$$

Here, $\mathbb{M}_1^{\leq a}$ is the subspace spanned by all $\tilde{L}_0$ -homogeneous vectors with weight $\leq a$, and $\mathbb{M}_2^{\leq b}$ is understood in a similar way. By taking the direct limit over (a, b) , we obtain

$$\Psi_\phi : \mathbb{M}_1 \otimes \mathbb{M}_2 \rightarrow \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet).$$

Our next goal is to define a weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module structure on $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ such that Ψ_ϕ is a homomorphism. This will imply, by the irreducibility of $\mathbb{M}_1, \mathbb{M}_2$, that Ψ_ϕ is injective when $\phi \neq 0$.

Actions of $\mathbb{V}$

Similar to the treatment for conformal blocks, one can prove that the formal sewing of a dual tensor product element is a formal dual tensor product element. Moreover, if one is sewing $\mathfrak{X}$ with $(\mathbb{P}^1; 0, 1, \infty)$ (which has 0 outputs), the a.l.u. of sewing can be proved with the help of the strong residue theorem. Thus, we are able to prove the **propagation of dual tensor product elements**. For each $a, b, n \in \mathbb{N}$, $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, we have a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}_C^{\boxtimes n}$ -modules

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^{\boxtimes n} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C-S_{\mathfrak{X}})},$$

i.e., for each open subsets $U_1, \dots, U_n \subset C$, we have a homomorphism of $\mathcal{O}(U_1) \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{O}(U_n)$ -modules

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}(U_1) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \dots \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}(U_n) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C-S_{\mathfrak{X}})}(U_1 \times \dots \times U_n),$$

(Recall that $\mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C-S_{\mathfrak{X}})}(U_1 \times \dots \times U_n) = \mathcal{O}(\text{Conf}(U_1 - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \dots, U_n - S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$.) and these maps are compatible under restrictions to open subsets. We have $\imath^0 \phi = \phi$. Moreover, for the $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N, x_1, \dots, x_N$ chosen at the beginning of this section, Theorem 3.4.6 holds verbatim if we replace $\mathcal{V}_C$ with $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}$. Since $\mathcal{V}_C$ equals $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}$ outside the output points x', x'' , Theorem 3.4.6 also holds if (following the notations of that theorem) for each $1 \leq k \leq n$, we still choose $v_k \in \mathcal{V}_k(U_k)$, but assume in addition that $x', x'' \notin U_k$. In particular, $y_1, \dots, y_n$ cannot be x', x'' . We will use this theorem only for $n = 1, 2$.

Remark 4.6.2. Write $C - \{x', x''\}$ as $C - D_{\mathfrak{X}}$ for simplicity. Note that $(\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}|_{C-D_{\mathfrak{X}}})^{\boxtimes n}$ equals $\mathcal{V}_{C-D_{\mathfrak{X}}}^{\boxtimes n}$. The restricted homomorphism

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_{C-D_{\mathfrak{X}}}^{\boxtimes n} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}-D_{\mathfrak{X}})} \quad (4.6.5)$$

is independent of the numbers a, b making ϕ belonging to $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Indeed, the case $n = 0$ is obvious. Suppose the case for $n - 1$ is true. By Theorem 3.4.6-(1), $\imath^n \phi(v_1, \dots, v_n, w_\bullet)$ is independent of a, b when v_1 is a section of $\mathcal{V}_{C-D_{\mathfrak{X}}}$ defined near $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Thus, by the argument in the proof of Proposition 3.2.4, the independence of a, b is true for any v_1 . To summarize, we have a well defined $\imath^n \phi$ in (4.6.5) for any $\phi \in \mathbb{V}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

We also regard

$$\imath^n \phi(w_\bullet) : \mathcal{V}_C^{\boxtimes n} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\text{Conf}_n(C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}-D_{\mathfrak{X}})}$$

sending each $v_1 \in \mathcal{V}_C(U_1), \dots, v_n \in \mathcal{V}_C(U_n)$ to $\imath^n \phi(v_1|_{U_1-D_{\mathfrak{X}}}, \dots, v_n|_{U_n-D_{\mathfrak{X}}}, w_\bullet)$. In particular, for each homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}$, considered as a constant section of $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W')$, we have $\imath \phi(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) \in \mathcal{O}(W' - \{x'\})$. Moreover, choose a, b such that $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Then $\xi^{\text{wt}(v)+a}v$ is an element of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}(W')$. So

$$\imath \phi(\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)^{-1}v, w_\bullet) \in \mathcal{O}_C((\text{wt}(v) + a)x')(W'). \quad (4.6.6)$$

Now, for each $v \in \mathbb{V}, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, we define

$$Y_+(v)_n : \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^*$$

as follows. Identify W' with $\xi(W')$ via ξ . (So ξ is identified with the standard coordinate z .) Identify $\mathcal{V}_{W'} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)$. Then, for any $\phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, the evaluation of $Y_+(v)_n \phi$ with any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ is

$$\boxed{Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet}) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi(v, w_{\bullet}) z^n dz} \quad (4.6.7)$$

Then, by (4.6.6), we have

$$Y_+(v)_n \phi = 0 \quad (\text{if } n \geq \text{wt}(v) + a). \quad (4.6.8)$$

Set $Y_+(v, z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} Y_+(v)_n z^{-n-1}$. Then the lower truncation property is satisfied: $Y_+(v, z) \phi \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^*[[z]]$. Thus, $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_+)$ becomes a linear representation of $\mathbb{V}$ if we can show that $Y_+(v)_n \phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.

Lemma 4.6.3. *For any homogeneous vector $v \in \mathbb{V}, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}, a, b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, we have $Y_+(v)_n \phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}, a', b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ where $a' = a + \max\{0, \text{wt}(v) - n - 1\}$.*

Proof. Let ζ be another standard coordinate of $\mathbb{C}$. So both z and ζ are identified with ξ as coordinates. (But they are independent as variables.) In the following, for a two-variable holomorphic function, we will let ζ (resp. z) denote the first (resp. second) complex variable.

Identify $W' \simeq \xi(W')$ via ξ and $\mathcal{V}_{W'} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)$ as above. One can define $\psi \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - D_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_C^*)$ such that for any section u of $\mathcal{V}_C$ defined in an open subset W of $C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - D_{\mathfrak{X}}$,

$$\psi(u) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet}) z^n dz,$$

or more precisely, if we also identify W with an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$ so that ζ is a complex variable on W , then $\psi(u)(\zeta) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})(\zeta, z) z^n dz$. If u is defined near x'' , then $\wr \phi(\xi^{b+L_0} u, \varpi^{a+L_0} v, w_{\bullet})$ is holomorphic (with no poles) near $\zeta = x'', z = x'$. Thus, $\psi(\xi^{b+L_0} u)$ has no pole at x'' . So $\psi \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - x', \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}, a', b}^*)$. We shall show $\psi \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}, a', b}^*)$. Suppose this can be proved. By Theorem 3.4.6-(1), if we identify $W_i \simeq \eta_i(W_i)$ via η_i and identify $\mathcal{V}_{W_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)$, then for any section u of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X}, a', b}(W_i) = \mathcal{V}_C(W_i)$ (which restricts to a section on $W_i - \{x_i\}$), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \psi(u)(\zeta) &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi(v, w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(u, \zeta) w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) z^n dz \\ &= Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(u, \zeta) w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N). \end{aligned}$$

So ψ restricts to $(Y_+(v)_n \phi)_{x_i}$ (defined similarly as in (3.1.5)) near each x_i . Thus, as in the proof of Theorem 3.1.2, the Residue theorem implies that $Y_+(v)_n \phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}, a', b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.

Choose any homogeneous vector $u \in \mathbb{V}$ with weight $\text{wt}(u)$, considered as a constant section of $\mathcal{V}_C(W')$. Consider $\psi(u)$ as a holomorphic function with variable ζ . We shall show that $\psi(u) \in \mathcal{O}_{W'}((\text{wt}(v) + a')x')(W')$. Set $f = f(\zeta, z)$ to be

$$f = \imath \imath \Phi(u, v, w_\bullet) \in \mathcal{O}(\text{Conf}_2(W' - \{x'\})).$$

Then, as $\zeta^{a+\text{wt}(u)}u, z^{a+\text{wt}(b)} \in \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}(W')$, we have

$$\zeta^{a+\text{wt}(u)}z^{a+\text{wt}(v)}f(\zeta, z) \in \mathcal{O}(\text{Conf}_2(W')).$$

Choose circles C_1, C_2, C_3 in W' surrounding x' with radii $r_1 < r_2 < r_3$. For each $z \in C_2$, choose a circle $C(z)$ with center z and radius less than $r_2 - r_1$ and $r_3 - r_2$. Let $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \zeta^m \psi(u) d\zeta &= \oint_{C_3} \oint_{C_2} \zeta^m z^n f dz d\zeta = \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C_3} \zeta^m z^n f d\zeta dz \\ &= \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C_1} \zeta^m z^n f d\zeta dz + \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C(z)} \zeta^m z^n f d\zeta dz. \end{aligned}$$

When $z \in C_2$, since $\zeta^{a+\text{wt}(u)}f$ has no pole at $\zeta = 0$, we have $\oint_{C_1} \zeta^m z^n f d\zeta = 0$ whenever $m \geq a + \text{wt}(u)$.

Apply Theorem 3.4.6-(2) (by choosing $U_1 = U_2$ to be $W' - \{x'\}$), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C(z)} \zeta^m z^n f d\zeta dz &= \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C(z)} \zeta^m z^n \imath \imath \Phi(u, v, w_\bullet) d\zeta dz \\ &= \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C(z)} \zeta^m z^n \imath \Phi(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, w_\bullet) d\zeta dz \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \oint_{C_2} \oint_{C(z)} (\zeta - z)^l z^{m+n-l} \imath \Phi(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, w_\bullet) d\zeta dz \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} \oint_{C_2} z^{m+n-l} \imath \Phi(Y(u)_l v, w_\bullet) dz \\ &= \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \binom{m}{l} Y_+(Y(u)_l v)_{m+n-l} \Phi(w_\bullet), \end{aligned}$$

where we have used (4.6.7) in the last step. By (4.6.8), the above expression equals 0 when

$$m + n - l \geq \text{wt}(Y(u)_l v) + a = \text{wt}(u) + \text{wt}(v) - l - 1 + a,$$

and hence when

$$m \geq \text{wt}(u) + \text{wt}(v) + a - 1 - n.$$

Thus, we conclude that $\text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \zeta^m \psi(u) d\zeta$ equals 0 when $m \geq a + \text{wt}(u) + \max\{0, \text{wt}(v) - n - 1\}$, i.e., when $m \geq \text{wt}(u) + a'$. This finishes the proof. $\square$

The weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$

We now show that the linear representation $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_+)$ is indeed a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

Lemma 4.6.4. *Choose any $\phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Identify $W' \simeq \xi(W')$ via ξ . Choose $u, v \in \mathbb{V}$, considered as constant sections of $\mathcal{V}_C(W')$ defined by $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)$. Then for any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$,*

$$Y_+(u)_m Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet}) = \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet}) \zeta^m z^n dz d\zeta. \quad (4.6.9)$$

As previously, $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})$ is short for $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})(\zeta, z)$ where ζ, z are both standard complex variables of $\mathbb{C}$.

Proof. By (4.6.7), we have

$$Y_+(u)_m Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet}) = \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \wr (Y_+(v)_n \phi)(u, w_{\bullet}) \zeta^m d\zeta.$$

Thus, (4.6.9) will follow if we can show

$$\wr (Y_+(v)_n \phi)(u, w_{\bullet}) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet}) z^n dz \quad (4.6.10)$$

for any section u of $\mathcal{V}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}$. If u is defined on an open subset of W_i , then, by Theorem 3.4.6, under the identification $\mathcal{V}_{W_i} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W_i}$ defined by $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\eta_i)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \wr (Y_+(v)_n \phi)(u, w_{\bullet}) &= (Y_+(v)_n \phi)(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y(u, \eta_i) w_i, \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \phi(v, w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y(u, \eta_i) w_i, \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) z^n dz \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet}) z^n dz. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, (4.6.10) holds when u is near $x_1, \dots, x_N$. Using the argument in the proof of Proposition 3.2.4 together with the fact that each connected component of C contains at least one of $x_1, \dots, x_N$, it is easy to see that (4.6.10) holds for any u . $\square$

Proposition 4.6.5. $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_+)$ is a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

Proof. We shall show that $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_+)$ satisfies the criteria in Proposition 4.5.1. It is clear that $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ projects to a dense subspace of the dual space of $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Also, we have $Y_+(1, z) = 1_{\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})}$ by Theorem 3.4.6-(3). Choose any $u, v \in \mathbb{V}$, $\phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. ϕ and $w_{\bullet}$ play the role of w, w' in Proposition 4.5.1. Identify W' with $\xi(W')$ via ξ , and choose $r > 0$ such that $\mathcal{D}_r \subset W'$. Identify $\mathcal{V}_{W'}$ with $\mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)$ as usual. Set $f = f(\zeta, z) \in \mathcal{O}(\text{Conf}_2(\mathcal{D}_r^{\times}))$ to be

$$f(\zeta, z) = \imath \imath \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})(\zeta, z).$$

By Lemma 4.6.4 and Theorem 3.4.6-(4), we clearly have

$$\begin{aligned} Y_+(v)_n Y_+(u)_m \phi(w_{\bullet}) &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} f(\zeta, z) \zeta^m z^n d\zeta dz, \\ Y_+(u)_m Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet}) &= \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \text{Res}_{z=0} f(\zeta, z) \zeta^m z^n dz d\zeta, \end{aligned}$$

which verify (4.5.1), (4.5.3). With the help of Theorem 3.4.6, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Res}_{z=0} \text{Res}_{\zeta=-z=0} f(\zeta, z) (\zeta - z)^m z^n d\zeta dz \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \text{Res}_{\zeta=-z=0} \imath \imath \phi(u, v, w_{\bullet})(\zeta, z) \cdot (\zeta - z)^m z^n d\zeta dz \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \text{Res}_{\zeta=-z=0} \imath \phi(Y(u, \zeta - z)v, w_{\bullet})(\zeta, z) \cdot (\zeta - z)^m z^n d\zeta dz \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \imath \phi(Y(u)_m v, w_{\bullet})(z) \cdot z^n dz, \end{aligned}$$

which, by (4.6.7), equals $Y(Y(u)_m v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet})$. This verifies (4.5.2). $\square$

The weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$

One can define similarly a weak module structure Y_- on $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ by using the sections near x'' . To be more precise, for each $v \in \mathbb{V}$, $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, we define

$$Y_-(v)_n : \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}^*$$

as follows. Identify W'' with $\varpi(W'')$ via ϖ . (So ϖ is identified with the standard coordinate z .) Identify $\mathcal{V}_{W''} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W''}$ via $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\varpi)$. Then, for any $\phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$, the evaluation of $Y_-(v)_n \phi$ with any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$ is

$$\boxed{Y_-(v)_n \phi(w_{\bullet}) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \imath \phi(v, w_{\bullet}) z^n dz} \quad (4.6.11)$$

Then $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_-)$ is also a weak $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

Recall Definition 2.2.8.

Theorem 4.6.6. Y_+ and Y_- commute. So $(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), Y_+, Y_-)$ is a weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module.

Proof. Identify $W' \simeq \xi(W')$ via ξ and $W'' \simeq \varpi(W'')$ via ϖ . Let z, ζ be the standard complex variables of W', W'' respectively. Choose any $v \in \mathbb{V}$, considered as a constant section of $\mathcal{V}_{W'}$ defined by $\mathcal{U}_{\varrho}(\xi)$. In the proof of Lemma 4.6.4, we

have shown that (4.6.10) is true for any section u of $\mathcal{V}_{C-S_{\mathfrak{X}}}$. In particular, this is true if we take $u \in \mathbb{V}$ and consider it as a constant section of $\mathcal{V}_C(W'' - \{x''\})$ defined by $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)$. Thus, we may apply $\text{Res}_{\zeta=0}(\cdots)\zeta^m d\zeta$ to obtain

$$Y_-(u)_m Y_+(v)_n \phi(w_\bullet) = \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \text{Res}_{z=0} \wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)(\zeta, z) \cdot \zeta^m z^n dz d\zeta.$$

A similar argument shows

$$Y_+(v)_n Y_-(u)_m \phi(w_\bullet) = \text{Res}_{z=0} \text{Res}_{\zeta=0} \wr \wr \phi(v, u, w_\bullet)(z, \zeta) \cdot \zeta^m z^n d\zeta dz.$$

By Theorem 3.4.6-(4), we have $\wr \wr \phi(u, v, w_\bullet)(\zeta, z) = \wr \wr \phi(v, u, w_\bullet)(z, \zeta)$ (when $z \in W', \zeta \in W''$). The commutativity of $Y_-(u)_m$ and $Y_+(v)_n$ follows. $\square$

To determine the lowest weight subspace of $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, we first need a lemma.

Lemma 4.6.7. *Choose any $a, b \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\phi \in \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Then $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ if and only if $Y_+(v)_n \phi = Y_-(u)_m \phi = 0$ whenever u, v are homogeneous, $n \geq \text{wt}(v) + a$, and $m \geq \text{wt}(u) + b$.*

Proof. The “only if” part follows from (4.6.8) and a similar equation for Y_- . We now prove the “if” part. Suppose $Y_+(v)_n \phi = Y_-(u)_m \phi = 0$ for the u, v, m, n described above. Choose any $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. Consider $\wr \phi(w_\bullet) \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - D_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*)$, whose expression near each x_i is given by (3.1.5). If ν is a section of $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}$ defined near x' , then $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)\nu$ is an $\mathcal{O}_{W'}$ -linear sum of elements of the form $v\xi^n d\xi$, where v is homogeneous and $n \geq \text{wt}(v) + a$. By (4.6.7), $\text{Res}_{\xi=0} \wr \phi(v, w_\bullet)\xi^n d\xi = 0$. So $\wr \phi(\nu, w_\bullet)$ has no pole near $\xi = 0$. Thus $\wr \phi(w_\bullet) \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - \{x''\}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*)$. A similar argument shows $\wr \phi(w_\bullet) \in H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*)$. Thus, as in the proof of Theorem 3.1.2, we may use Residue theorem to deduce $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},a,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. $\square$

Corollary 4.6.8. *We have*

$$\Omega_{+-}(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)) = \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet). \quad (4.6.12)$$

Moreover, if $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite, then $\Omega_{+-}(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet))$ is finite dimensional.

Proof. The equation follows directly from Lemma 4.6.7 and the definition of Ω_{+-} in (4.5.8). If $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite, we may show that $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is finite dimensional using the idea in the proof of Theorem 3.7.3. (In particular, the vanishing Theorem 2.4.3, in which $\mathcal{V}_C^{\leq n}$ is replaced by $\mathcal{V}_{\mathfrak{X},0,0}^{\leq n}$, is used.) $\square$

The following result is claimed in Remark 4.5.5. We are now ready to prove it. Note that neither C_2 -cofiniteness nor rationality is assumed here.

Proposition 4.6.9. *Let $\mathbb{M}, \widehat{\mathbb{M}}$ be irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. Suppose that the $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -modules $\Omega(\mathbb{M}), \Omega(\widehat{\mathbb{M}})$ are equivalent. Then $\mathbb{M} \simeq \widehat{\mathbb{M}}$.*

Proof. We set $\mathfrak{X} = (\mathbb{P}^1; 1; 0; \infty; z - 1; z; 1/z)$. Namely, we choose $C = \mathbb{P}^1$, $N = 1$, $x_1 = 1$, $x' = 0$, $x'' = \infty$, $\eta_1 = z - 1$, $\xi = z$, $\varpi = 1/z$. We set $\mathbb{W}_\bullet = \mathbb{W}_1 = \mathbb{V}$. Define $\phi \in (\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')^*$ to be $\phi(v \otimes m \otimes m') = \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, 1)m, m' \rangle$. Then, as shown in example 3.1.6, ϕ is a (non-zero) element of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$. Define $\Psi_\phi : \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}' \rightarrow \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{V})$ as in example 4.6.1, i.e., by

$$\Psi_\phi(m \otimes m')(v) = \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v, 1)m, m' \rangle = \langle Y_{\mathbb{W}}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}m, m' \rangle.$$

Ψ_ϕ is clearly a homomorphism of weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules. Since $\mathbb{M}$ and (hence) $\mathbb{M}'$ are irreducible ordinary $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, by Proposition 4.5.16, $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ is an irreducible weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module. Thus Ψ_ϕ must be injective. So $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ is isomorphic to an irreducible weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{K} := \Psi_\phi(\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$.

In a similar way, we can define $\hat{\phi}$, $\Psi_{\hat{\phi}}$ using $\hat{\mathbb{M}}$, and $\hat{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'$ is isomorphic to $\hat{\mathbb{K}} := \Psi_{\hat{\phi}}(\hat{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}')$. Now, let $T : \Omega(\mathbb{M}) \rightarrow \Omega(\hat{\mathbb{M}})$ be an isomorphism of $\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})$ -module. Then, by Remark 4.5.5, its transpose $T^t : \Omega(\hat{\mathbb{M}}') \rightarrow \Omega(\mathbb{M}')$ is also an isomorphism. Choose any $m \in \mathbb{M}$, $m' \in \mathbb{M}'$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi_{\hat{\phi}}(T^{-1}m \otimes T^t m')(v) &= \langle Y_{\hat{\mathbb{M}}}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}T^{-1}m, T^t m' \rangle \\ &= \langle Y_{\mathbb{M}}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}m, m' \rangle = \Psi_\phi(m \otimes m')(v). \end{aligned}$$

This shows that $\mathbb{K}$ and $\hat{\mathbb{K}}$ have at least one non-zero common element. So $\mathbb{K} \cap \hat{\mathbb{K}}$ is a non-trivial weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\mathbb{K}$, which must be $\mathbb{K}$ by the irreducibility of $\mathbb{K}$. Thus $\mathbb{K} \subset \hat{\mathbb{K}}$ and, similarly, $\mathbb{K} = \hat{\mathbb{K}}$. Therefore, $\mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}'$ and $\hat{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'$ are both isomorphic to $\mathbb{K} = \hat{\mathbb{K}}$ as weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules. In particular, they are equivalent as weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbf{1}$ -modules. So $\mathbb{M} \simeq \hat{\mathbb{M}}$. $\square$

The following proposition can be thought of as a converse of example 4.6.1.

Proposition 4.6.10. *Let $\mathbb{M}, \hat{\mathbb{M}}$ be $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, and let $\Phi : \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}} \rightarrow \square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ be a homomorphism of weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules. Then there exists $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}})$ such that for any $m \in \mathbb{M}$, $\hat{m} \in \hat{\mathbb{M}}$, $w_\bullet \in \mathbb{W}_\bullet$,*

$$\Phi(m \otimes \hat{m})(w_\bullet) = \psi(w_\bullet \otimes m \otimes \hat{m}).$$

Thus, using the notation of example 4.6.1, we have $\Psi_\psi = \Phi$.

Proof. Define ψ to be a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}$ whose value at $w_\bullet \otimes m \otimes \hat{m}$ is $\Phi(m \otimes \hat{m})(w_\bullet)$. Consider $\imath\Phi(m \otimes \hat{m})(w_\bullet)$, which is an element of $H^0(C - S_{\mathfrak{X}} - D_{\mathfrak{X}}, \mathcal{V}_C^*)$. By Theorem 3.4.6, its series expansion near x_i is of the form

$$\begin{aligned} &\Phi(m \otimes \hat{m})(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, \eta_i)w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N) \\ &= \psi(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(v, \eta_i)w_i \otimes \cdots \otimes w_N \otimes m \otimes \hat{m}) \end{aligned}$$

when evaluated with $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\eta_i)^{-1}v$ ($v \in \mathbb{V}$). When evaluated with $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)^{-1}v$ (considered as a constant section of $\mathcal{V}_C(W')$), it becomes, by (4.6.7),

$$\begin{aligned} \imath \Phi(m \otimes \hat{m})(v, w_\bullet) &= (Y_+(v, \xi)\Phi(m \otimes \hat{m}))(w_\bullet) = \Phi(Y_{\mathbb{M}}(v, \xi)m \otimes \hat{m})(w_\bullet) \\ &= \psi(w_\bullet \otimes Y_{\mathbb{M}}(v, \xi)m \otimes \hat{m}). \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, its evaluation with $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)^{-1}v$ is $\psi(w_\bullet \otimes m \otimes Y_{\hat{\mathbb{M}}}(v, \varpi)\hat{m})$. Thus, by Theorem 3.1.2, ψ is a conformal block. $\square$

The weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -module $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$

In application, it would be more suitable to consider $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, the $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V}) \times \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule of $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ generated by $\Omega_{+-}(\square_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet))$. Recall in Definition 4.5.10 the meaning of rationality.

Lemma 4.6.11. *Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational. Then we have the following equivalence of weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules*

$$\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \simeq \bigoplus_i \mathbb{M}_i \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}_i \quad (4.6.13)$$

where each $\mathbb{M}_i$ and $\hat{\mathbb{M}}_i$ are irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -modules.

Proof. By proposition 4.5.17 and Theorem 4.5.12, it suffices to check that $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is a direct sum of irreducible admissible (and hence ordinary by Corollary 4.5.13) $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbf{1}$ -modules and also a direct sum of irreducible admissible $\mathbf{1} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules. Indeed, suppose this is true. Then we have (4.6.13) where each $\mathbb{M}_i$ and $\hat{\mathbb{M}}_i$ are irreducible weak $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. $\mathbb{M}_i$ must be isomorphic to an irreducible weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbf{1}$ -submodule of $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, which is therefore ordinary. Similarly, $\hat{\mathbb{M}}_i$ is ordinary.

For each $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, we let $\mathfrak{U}_{-m}(\mathbb{V})$ be the elements of $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ raising the $\tilde{L}_0$ -weights by m . Namely, it is spanned by $(v_1, n_1) \cdots (v_k, n_k)$ satisfying $\sum_{i=1}^k (\text{wt}(v_i) - n_i - 1) = m$. For each $b \in \mathbb{N}$, we consider the $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbf{1}$ -module

$$\mathbb{X}_b = (\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V}) \times \mathfrak{U}_{-b}(\mathbb{V}))\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$$

whose lowest weight subspace is denoted by $\Omega_+(\mathbb{X}_b)$. Using the commutator formula (2.2.3), it is easy to see that $\mathbb{X}_b$ is annihilated by $Y_-(u)_m$ where v is homogeneous and $\text{wt}(u) - m - 1 + b < 0$ (i.e., (u, m) lowers the $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight by more than b). Thus, by Lemma 4.6.7, we obtain

$$(\mathbf{1} \times \mathfrak{U}_{-b}(\mathbb{V}))\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \subset \Omega_+(\mathbb{X}_b) \subset \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet).$$

The first inclusion shows that $\Omega_+(\mathbb{X}_b)$ generates $\mathbb{X}_b$. The second one shows that $\Omega_+(\mathbb{X}_b)$ is finite-dimensional since $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X},0,b}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is so by the proof of Theorem 3.7.3.

Thus, by the rationality of $\mathbb{V}$, $\mathbb{X}_b$ is a direct sum of irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V} \times 1$ -modules. Since $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) = \bigvee_{b \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{X}_b$, we conclude that $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is a sum, and hence a direct sum, of irreducible admissible $\mathbb{V} \times 1$ -modules. The claim for $1 \times \mathbb{V}$ is proved similarly. $\square$

Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a complete list of mutually inequivalent irreducible (ordinary) $\mathbb{V}$ -modules, which is finite by Corollary 4.4.5. The word “complete” means that any irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -module is equivalent to one object in $\mathcal{E}$. The following theorem gives a complete characterization of $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ when $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational.

Theorem 4.6.12. *Define a homomorphism of weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -modules*

$$\Psi : \bigoplus_{\mathbb{M}, \hat{\mathbb{M}} \in \mathcal{E}} \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}) \rightarrow \square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}), \quad (4.6.14)$$

$$m \otimes \hat{m} \otimes \phi \mapsto \Psi_{\phi}(m \otimes \hat{m})$$

where Ψ_{ϕ} is defined in example 4.6.1. Then Ψ is injective. If $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational, then Ψ is an isomorphism.

Note that the image of each Ψ_{ϕ} is in $\square_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\text{low}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ follows from the obvious fact that $\mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}$ is generated by $\Omega(\mathbb{M}) \otimes \Omega(\hat{\mathbb{M}})$.

Proof. If $\text{Ker}(\Psi)$ is non-trivial, then it is a non-trivial $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V}) \times \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule of the domain $\mathcal{D}(\Psi)$ of Ψ . Since $\mathcal{D}(\Psi)$ is clearly completely reducible, by basic representation theory, so is $\text{Ker}(\Psi)$. Thus, $\text{Ker}(\Psi)$ contains an irreducible $\mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V}) \times \mathfrak{U}(\mathbb{V})$ -submodule $\mathbf{W}$. The projection of $\mathbf{W}$ onto one of the irreducible component of $\mathcal{D}(\Psi)$ is non-trivial. Thus, $\mathbf{W} \simeq \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}$ for some $\mathbb{M}, \hat{\mathbb{M}} \in \mathcal{E}$. By Corollary 4.5.15, there exists a nonzero $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}})$ such that $\mathbf{W} = \mathbb{M} \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}} \otimes \phi$. As $\mathbf{W} \subset \text{Ker}(\Psi)$, we have $\Psi_{\phi} = 0$. By (4.6.4), for any $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, $m \in \mathbb{M}$, $\hat{m} \in \hat{\mathbb{M}}$, we have $\phi(w_{\bullet} \otimes m \otimes \hat{m}) = 0$. So $\phi = 0$, which gives a contradiction.

When $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational, the surjectivity of Ψ follows from Proposition 4.6.10 and Lemma 4.6.11. $\square$

4.7 Factorization

We assume the setting of Section 4.4. Thus, we recall that $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family over $\mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$ obtained by sewing an N -pointed compact Riemann surface $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}} = (\tilde{C}; x_1, \dots, x_N; x'; x''; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N; \xi, \varpi)$. Recall $S_{\mathfrak{X}} = x_1 + \dots + x_N$ and $D_{\mathfrak{X}} = x' + x''$. Note that for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$, the fiber $\mathcal{C}_q$ is nodal (with one node) if and only if $q = 0$. Moreover, $\tilde{C}$ is the normalization of the nodal curve $C := \mathcal{C}_0$. In particular, we have $\nu : \tilde{C} \rightarrow C$ defined by gluing x', x'' . Also, $\mathfrak{X}_0 = (C; x_1, \dots, x_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$.

We assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is both C_2 -cofinite and rational. By Convention 2.2.6, for each irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{M}$, its lowest $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight (with nontrivial weight space) is 0. Thus $\Omega(\mathbb{M}) = \mathbb{M}(0)$.

Choose any $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Then ϕ is a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$.

Lemma 4.7.1. ϕ is an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{x}},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

Proof. Recall that W', W'' are open discs in $\tilde{C}$ centered at x', x'' respectively and disjoint from $x_1, \dots, x_N$. A section $\mathfrak{v}$ of $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{x}},0,0} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}$ defined on $W' \cup W''$ is of the form

$$\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)\mathfrak{v}|_{W'} = \xi^{L_0} u d\xi, \quad \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)\mathfrak{v}|_{W''} = \varpi^{L_0} v d\varpi$$

where $u \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W'), v \in \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W'')$. $\mathfrak{v}$ can be viewed as an element of $\mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C((W' - x') \cup (W'' - x''))$. By the description of $\mathcal{V}_C$ and ω_C near the node (see (2.4.13) and (1.5.5)), it is easy to see that $\mathfrak{v}$ belongs to $\mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\nu(W' \cup W''))$. (Indeed, one can check that the value of $\mathfrak{v}$ at the node $y' = \nu(x') = \nu(x'')$ (as an element of $\mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C|_{y'}$) is 0.) So $\mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{x}},0,0} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}$ is naturally a subsheaf of $\mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C$. Thus, as ϕ vanishes on $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_\bullet$, it vanishes on the subspace $H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{x}},0,0} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}})) \cdot \mathbb{W}_\bullet$. This proves $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{x}},0,0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. $\square$

Lemma 4.7.2. For any homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}$,

$$Y_+(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}\phi = \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{wt}(v)}}{l!} Y_-(L_1^l v)_{\text{wt}(v)-l-1}\phi. \quad (4.7.1)$$

Proof. Consider ϕ as a conformal block on C . Choose any homogeneous $v \in \mathbb{V}^{\leq n}$. As argued in the proof of Theorem 4.4.1, one can construct $\mathfrak{v} \in H^0(\tilde{C}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}}^{\leq n} \otimes \omega_{\tilde{C}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}} + D_{\mathfrak{x}}))$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)\mathfrak{v}|_{W'} &= \xi^{L_0-1} v d\xi + \xi^n (\text{elements of } \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W')) d\xi, \\ \mathcal{U}_\varrho(\varpi)\mathfrak{v}|_{W''} &= -\varpi^{L_0-1} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v d\varpi + \varpi^n (\text{elements of } \mathbb{V}^{\leq n} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}(W'')) d\varpi. \end{aligned}$$

By (1.5.5) and (2.4.12), it is clear that $\mathfrak{v}$ can be viewed as an element of $H^0(C, \mathcal{V}_C \otimes \omega_C(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{x}}))$. Thus $\phi(\mathfrak{v} \cdot w_\bullet) = 0$.

Consider $\imath\phi(w_\bullet) \in H^0(\tilde{C} - S_{\mathfrak{x}} - D_{\mathfrak{x}}, \mathcal{V}_{\tilde{C}})$. Then $\imath\phi(\mathfrak{v}, w_\bullet) \in H^0(\tilde{C} - S_{\mathfrak{x}} - D_{\mathfrak{x}}, \omega_{\tilde{C}})$. By residue theorem, we have

$$\text{Res}_{x'} \imath\phi(\mathfrak{v}, w_\bullet) + \text{Res}_{x''} \imath\phi(\mathfrak{v}, w_\bullet) = - \sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{x_i} \imath\phi(\mathfrak{v}, w_\bullet),$$

which, by Theorem 3.4.6, equals $-\phi(\mathfrak{v} \cdot w_\bullet)$ and hence is zero. By (4.6.7), we have, under the identification $\mathcal{V}_{W'} \simeq \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{O}_{W'}$ via $\mathcal{U}_\varrho(\xi)$,

$$\text{Res}_{x'} \imath\phi(\mathfrak{v}, w_\bullet) = \text{Res}_{\xi=0} \imath\phi(\xi^{\text{wt}(v)-1} v + \dots, w_\bullet) d\xi = Y_+(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}\phi(w_\bullet).$$

By (2.3.15),

$$\varpi^{L_0-1} \mathcal{U}(\gamma_1) v = \varpi^{L_0-1} e^{L_1} (-1)^{L_0} v = \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{wt}(v)}}{l!} L_1^l v \cdot \varpi^{\text{wt}(v)-1-l} d\varpi.$$

Thus, by (4.6.11),

$$\text{Res}_{x''} \wr \phi(v, w_\bullet) = - \sum_{l \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{wt}(v)}}{l!} Y_-(L_1^l v)_{\text{wt}(v)-l-1} \phi(w_\bullet).$$

This proves (4.7.1). □

Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a complete list of mutually inequivalent irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. By Corollary 4.4.5, $\mathcal{E}$ is a finite set. Recall the map

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q : \bigoplus_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}} \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{x}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}') &\rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{x}_q}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet), \\ \bigoplus_{\mathbb{M} \in \mathcal{E}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}} &\mapsto \sum_{\mathbb{M}} \tilde{\mathcal{S}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(q) \end{aligned}$$

defined for any $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^\times$ in Section 4.4. When $q = 0$, an element in the image of $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ is a linear functional on $\mathbb{W}_\bullet$, which must be also in $\mathcal{T}_{\tilde{x}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ by Proposition 3.2.4. Recall our assumption on $\tilde{L}_0$, which implies that

$$\tilde{\mathcal{S}} \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_\bullet)(0) = \psi_{\mathbb{M}}(w_\bullet \otimes P(0) \blacktriangleright \otimes_{\mathbb{M}} \blacktriangleleft).$$

Here, $P(n)$ is the projection onto the $\tilde{L}_0$ -weight n subspace, and hence $P(0)$ is the projection onto the lowest weight subspace.

Proposition 4.7.3 (Nodal factorization). *$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_0$ is a surjective linear map.*

Indeed, one can use the same method for Theorem 4.4.1 to prove that $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_0$ is also injective.

Proof. Choose $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{x}_0}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. By Corollary 4.6.8, ϕ is in the finite-dimensional space $\Omega_{+-}(\square_{\tilde{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet))$. By Theorem 4.6.11, we can find finitely many irreducible $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_l, \hat{\mathbb{M}}_1, \dots, \hat{\mathbb{M}}_l$ such that $\bigoplus_{1 \leq i \leq l} \mathbb{M}_i \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'_i$ is a weak $\mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V}$ -submodule of $\square_{\tilde{x}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, that $\phi \in \bigoplus_{1 \leq i \leq l} \mathbb{M}_i(0) \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'_i(0)$, and that the projection of ψ to each $\mathbb{M}_i(0) \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'_i(0)$, which we denote by

$$\phi_i \in \mathbb{M}_i(0) \otimes \hat{\mathbb{M}}'_i(0),$$

is non-zero. By Lemma 4.7.2 and equation (4.5.5), we have for each i that

$$(Y_{\mathbb{M}_i}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1} \otimes \mathbf{1}) \phi_i = (\mathbf{1} \otimes Y_{\hat{\mathbb{M}}_i}(v)_{\text{wt}(v)-1}^t) \phi_i.$$

Identify $\mathbb{M}_i(0) \otimes \widehat{\mathbb{M}}'_i(0)$ naturally with $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathbb{M}_i(0), \widehat{\mathbb{M}}_i(0))$. Then the above equation shows that $\phi_i \in \text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})}(\mathbb{M}_i(0), \widehat{\mathbb{M}}_i(0))$. Since ϕ_i is assumed to be non-zero, we have $\mathbb{M}_i(0) \simeq \widehat{\mathbb{M}}_i(0)$. Thus, by Proposition 4.6.9, we have the equivalence of $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{M}_i \simeq \widehat{\mathbb{M}}_i$. We may thus assume that $\widehat{\mathbb{M}}_i = \mathbb{M}_i$. As $\phi_i \in \text{End}_{\mathfrak{U}_0(\mathbb{V})}(\mathbb{M}_i(0))$, it is a scalar multiplication. We may thus find a (non-zero) $\lambda_i \in \mathbb{C}$ such that $\phi_i = \lambda_i P(0) \blacktriangleright \otimes_i \blacktriangleleft$.

By Theorem 4.6.12 or Proposition 4.6.10, we can find for each i a non-zero conformal block $\psi_i \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_i \otimes \mathbb{M}'_i)$ such that

$$(m_i \otimes \widehat{m}'_i)(w_{\bullet}) = \psi_i(w_{\bullet} \otimes m_i \otimes \widehat{m}'_i)$$

for each $w_{\bullet} \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$, $m_i \in \mathbb{M}_i$, $\widehat{m}'_i \in \widehat{\mathbb{M}}'_i$. In particular,

$$\phi_i(w_{\bullet}) = \psi_i(w_{\bullet} \otimes \phi_i) = \lambda_i \phi_i(w_{\bullet} \otimes P(0) \blacktriangleright \otimes_i \blacktriangleleft) = \lambda_i \tilde{\mathfrak{S}} \psi_i(w_{\bullet})(0)$$

Thus $\phi = \sum_i \lambda_i \tilde{\mathfrak{S}} \psi_i(0)$. It is now clear that ϕ is in the image of $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_0$. $\square$

Theorem 4.7.4 (Factorization). *Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational. Then $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ is an isomorphism for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$, and $\mathfrak{S}_q$ is an isomorphism for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^{\times}$.*

Proof. As explained before Theorem 4.4.1, it suffices to prove that $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$ is an isomorphism for each $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}$. Let $D \in \mathbb{N}$ be the dimension of the domain of $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$, which is finite by Theorem 3.7.3 and Corollary 4.4.5. Let K_q be the dimension of the image of $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_q$. By Corollary 3.7.5, if $q \neq 0$ then K_q is independent of q . We fix $q \in \mathcal{D}_{r\rho}^{\times}$. By Proposition 1.8.1 (Nakayama's lemma), $K_q \leq K_0$. By Theorem 4.4.1, $D \leq K_q$. By Proposition 4.7.3, $K_0 \leq D$. Thus $D = K_q = K_0$. $\square$

Remark 4.7.5. The above two theorems show that if a nodal curve C (with normalization $\tilde{C}$) has one node, then its dimensions of spaces of conformal blocks can be calculated from those of $\tilde{C}$. Note that the results in Section 4.6 can be generalized to N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates and arbitrary numbers of outputs. Accordingly, we may prove the nodal factorization for an N -pointed nodal curve $(C; x_1, \dots, x_N)$ with an arbitrary number M of nodes in the same way: the dimension of the space of conformal blocks associated to the modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ is

$$\sum_{\mathbb{M}_1, \dots, \mathbb{M}_M \in \mathcal{E}} \dim \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}_{\bullet} \otimes \mathbb{M}'_{\bullet}) \quad (4.7.2)$$

where $\tilde{\mathfrak{X}}$ is the compact Riemann surface $\tilde{C}$ with $N + 2M$ marked points, and $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} = \mathbb{W}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{W}_N$, $\mathbb{M}_{\bullet} = \mathbb{M}_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{M}_M$, $\mathbb{M}'_{\bullet} = \mathbb{M}'_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathbb{M}'_M$, as usual.

Theorem 4.7.6. *Assume that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite and rational. Let $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ be a family of N -pointed complex curves. Then $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ and (hence) $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ are locally free. Consequently, the function $b \in \mathcal{B} \mapsto \dim \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}_b}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is locally constant.*

Proof. Recall that by Theorem 3.2.1, the dimensions of the fibers of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ are given by the dimensions of the spaces of conformal blocks. Outside the discriminant locus Δ , the dimensions equal (4.7.2) by applying Theorem 4.7.4 several times. In Δ , the same is true by nodal factorization (Remark 4.7.5). Thus, the rank function of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is locally constant. By Theorem 3.7.3, $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{x}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ is finite-type. Thus, it is locally free by Theorem 1.8.2. $\square$

Chapter 5

More on the connections

5.1 Connections and local coordinates

Consider a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$. Assume $\mathcal{B}$ is biholomorphic to a Stein open subset of $\mathbb{C}^m$, and $\mathfrak{X}$ admits a set of local coordinates $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$. For each $\mathfrak{y} \in \Theta_{\mathcal{B}}(\mathcal{B})$, we have defined in Section 3.6 a differential operator $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}$ depending on $\eta_{\bullet}$ and a lift $\tilde{\mathfrak{y}} \in H^0(\mathcal{C}, \Theta_{\mathcal{C}}(\bullet S_{\mathfrak{X}}))$ (satisfying $d\pi(\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}) = \pi^*\mathfrak{y}$). We have also seen that if $\eta_{\bullet}$ is fixed, then $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}$ is determined up to an $\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ -scalar addition by $\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}$. In this section, we show the same is true for the dependence of $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}$ on $\eta_{\bullet}$ if $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are simple $\mathbb{V}$ -modules.

Let $\tau_{\bullet} = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_m)$ be coordinates of $\mathcal{B}$, and write $\tau_{\bullet} \circ \pi$ also as $\tau_{\bullet}$ for simplicity. Then we can write

$$\mathfrak{y} = \sum_j g_j(\tau_{\bullet}) \partial_{\tau_j}$$

for some $g_1, \dots, g_m \in \mathcal{O}(\tau_{\bullet}(\mathcal{B}))$. Choose mutually disjoint neighborhoods $W_1, \dots, W_N$ of $\varsigma_1(\mathcal{B}), \dots, \varsigma_N(\mathcal{B})$ on which $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N$ are defined respectively. Then $(\eta_i, \tau_{\bullet})$ is a coordinate of W_i . So we can find $h_i \in \mathcal{O}((\eta_i, \tau_{\bullet})(W_i \setminus \varsigma_i(\mathcal{B})))$ such that

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}|_{W_i} = h_i(\eta_i, \tau_{\bullet}) \partial_{\eta_i} + \sum_j g_j(\tau_{\bullet}) \partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}, \quad (5.1.1)$$

where ∂_{τ_j/η_i} means the partial derivative ∂_{τ_j} defined with respect to the coordinate $(\eta_i, \tau_{\bullet})$.

Let $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_{\bullet})}$ denote the differential operator defined by $\eta_{\bullet}$ and $\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}$. Let $\mu_{\bullet}$ be another set of local coordinates of $\mathfrak{X}$, and let $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\mu_{\bullet})}$ denote the differential operator defined by $\mu_{\bullet}$ and $\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}$. Let

$$\alpha_i = (\mu_i | \eta_i) : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$$

be a holomorphic family of transformations whose value at each $b \in \mathcal{B}$ is defined similar to (3.2.14), namely $\alpha_{i,b}(z) = \mu_i \circ (\eta_i, \pi)^{-1}(z, b)$ for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$. Equivalently, consider α_i as a holomorphic function defined near $0 \times \mathcal{B} \subset \mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$,

$$\alpha_i \circ (\eta_i, \pi) = (\mu_i, \pi). \quad (5.1.2)$$

Let $\alpha'_i(0) \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ whose value at each $b \in \mathcal{B}$ is $\partial_z \alpha_{i,b}(z)|_{z=0}$. Assume $\mathbb{V}$ has central charge c , and $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are simple $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. For each $\mathbb{W}_i$, we let $\Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \in \mathbb{C}$ be the unique number such that $\mathbb{W}_i = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (\mathbb{W}_i)_{(\Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} + n)}$ and $(\mathbb{W}_i)_{(\Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i})}$ is non-trivial. Thus, according to Convention 2.2.6, $L_0 - \tilde{L}_0 = \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \mathbf{1}$ on $\mathbb{W}_i$. $\Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i}$ is called the **conformal weight** of $\mathbb{W}_i$.

Theorem 5.1.1. *Let $f \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ be*

$$f = \sum_{i=1}^N \left(\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \frac{c}{12} h_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mu_i d\eta_i - \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \sum_{j=1}^m g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j} \log \alpha'_i(0) \right). \quad (5.1.3)$$

Then for each section s of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$,

$$\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_\bullet)} s - \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\mu_\bullet)} s = -f s.$$

Consequently, for each section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$,*

$$\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_\bullet)} \phi - \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\mu_\bullet)} \phi = f \phi.$$

Note that the first part on the right hand side of (5.1.3) is similar to $\frac{c}{12} C_i$ where C_i is defined in Remark 4.3.10. Also, the residue $\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0}$ is taken with respect to the coordinate $(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet)$.

Proof. Choose $w_1 \in \mathbb{W}_1, \dots, w_N \in \mathbb{W}_N$. Recall $w_\bullet = w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes w_N$. Let $s = \mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet)^{-1} w_\bullet \in \mathcal{W}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$. So

$$\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet) s = \mathcal{U}(\alpha_1) w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\alpha_N) w_N. \quad (5.1.4)$$

By (3.6.8) and (3.6.10),

$$\mathcal{U}(\eta_\bullet) \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_\bullet)} s = \sum_i w_1 \otimes w_2 \otimes \dots \otimes \tilde{w}_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_N$$

where

$$\tilde{w}_i = -\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} h_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, \eta_i) w_i d\eta_i.$$

Thus

$$\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet) \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_\bullet)} s = \sum_i \mathcal{U}(\alpha_1) w_1 \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i) \tilde{w}_i \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\alpha_N) w_N. \quad (5.1.5)$$

By (4.1.5),

$$\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\alpha_i|\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}}))\mathbf{c} = \mathcal{U}(\varrho(\mu_i|\eta_i))\mathbf{c} = (\partial_{\eta_i}\mu_i)^2\mathbf{c} + \frac{c}{12}\mathbf{S}_{\eta_i}\mu_i \cdot \mathbf{1}.$$

Using Theorem 2.4.1, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)\tilde{w}_i &= -\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} h_i \cdot \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, \eta_i)w_id\eta_i \\ &= -\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} h_i \cdot Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathcal{U}(\varrho(\alpha_i|\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{C}}))\mathbf{c}, \mu_i)\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_id\eta_i \\ &= -\text{Res}_{\mu_i=0} h_i\partial_{\eta_i}\mu_i \cdot Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, \mu_i)\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_id\mu_i - \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \frac{c}{12}h_i\mathbf{S}_{\eta_i}\mu_i \cdot \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_id\eta_i. \end{aligned} \quad (5.1.6)$$

We write $\tilde{\eta}$ in the $(\mu_i, \tau_{\bullet})$ -coordinate:

$$\tilde{\eta}|_{W_i} = \left(h_i\partial_{\eta_i}\mu_i + \sum_j g_j\partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}\mu_i \right) \partial_{\mu_i} + \sum_j g_j\partial_{\tau_j/\mu_j}.$$

Recall (5.1.4), apply (3.6.8) and (3.6.10) again, and use the above expression of $\tilde{\eta}$ in the $(\mu_i, \tau_{\bullet})$ -coordinate, we have

$$\mathcal{U}(\mu_{\bullet})\nabla_{\eta}^{(\mu_{\bullet})}s = \sum_i \mathcal{U}(\alpha_1)w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathbf{v}_i \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathcal{U}(\alpha_N)w_N \quad (5.1.7)$$

where (defining $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}$ using $\mu_{\bullet}$)

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}_i &= \sum_j g_j\partial_{\tau_j}\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_i - \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(\tilde{\eta})\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_i. \\ &= \sum_j g_j\partial_{\tau_j}\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_i - \text{Res}_{\mu_i=0} \left(h_i\partial_{\eta_i}\mu_i + \sum_j g_j\partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}\mu_i \right) Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, \mu_i)\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_id\mu_i. \end{aligned}$$

From (5.1.2), it is easy to see

$$\partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}\mu_i = (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i)(\eta_i, \pi) = (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i)(\alpha_i^{-1}(\mu_i, \pi), \pi)$$

where α_i^{-1} is the fiberwise inverse of α_i . Identify W_i with a neighborhood of $0 \times \mathcal{B}$ via (μ_i, π) so that (μ_i, π) is identified with $(z, \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{B}})$, and think of α_i as a family of transformation and write the parameter of $\mathcal{B}$ as the subscript of α_i , we have

$$\partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}\mu_i(z, b) = (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i)(\alpha_i^{-1}(z, b), b) = (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i)_b(\alpha_{i,b}^{-1}(z))$$

or simply

$$\partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i}\mu_i = (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i) \circ \alpha_i^{-1}.$$

Use this relation and apply Lemma 5.1.2 to the family α_i , we have

$$\partial_{\tau_j}\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_i = \text{Res}_{z=0} (\partial_{\tau_j}\alpha_i)(\alpha_i^{-1}(z))Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, z)\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_idz - \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i}\partial_{\tau_j}\log \alpha'_i(0)\mathcal{U}(\alpha_i)w_i$$

$$= \text{Res}_{\mu_i=0} \partial_{\tau_j/\eta_i} \mu_i \cdot Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, \mu_i) \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i) w_i d\mu_i - \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \partial_{\tau_j} \log \alpha'_i(0) \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i) w_i.$$

Thus

$$\mathbf{v}_i = -\text{Res}_{\mu_i=0} h_i \partial_{\eta_i} \mu_i Y_{\mathbb{W}_i}(\mathbf{c}, \mu_i) \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i) w_i d\mu_i - \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \sum_j g_j \partial_{\tau_j} \log \alpha'_i(0) \mathcal{U}(\alpha_i) w_i. \quad (5.1.8)$$

Combine (5.1.5), (5.1.6), (5.1.7), (5.1.8) together, and notice (5.1.4), we obtain $\mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet) \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\eta_\bullet)} s - \mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet) \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}^{(\mu_\bullet)} s = -f \mathcal{U}(\mu_\bullet) s$. $\square$

Lemma 5.1.2. *Let T be an open subset of $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\rho : T \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$, $\zeta \mapsto \rho_\zeta$ be a holomorphic family of transformations. Then for any $\mathbb{V}$ -module $\mathbb{W}$, if we let $A = L_0 - \tilde{L}_0$, then*

$$\partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w = \text{Res}_{z=0} (\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta)(\rho_\zeta^{-1}(z)) Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, z) \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w dz - \partial_\zeta \log \rho'_\zeta(0) A \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w. \quad (5.1.9)$$

Proof. Choose any $\zeta_0 \in T$ and apply Lemma 2.3.4 and Remark 2.3.5 to the family $\zeta \mapsto \rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta) w|_{\zeta=\zeta_0} &= \partial_\zeta \mathcal{U}(\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}) \mathcal{U}(\rho_{\zeta_0}) w|_{\zeta=\zeta_0} \\ &= \text{Res}_{z=0} \partial_\zeta (\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})(z) Y_{\mathbb{W}}(\mathbf{c}, z) \mathcal{U}(\rho_{\zeta_0}) w dz|_{\zeta=\zeta_0} - \partial_\zeta (\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})'(0) A \mathcal{U}(\rho_{\zeta_0}) w|_{\zeta=\zeta_0}. \end{aligned}$$

$\partial_\zeta (\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})(z)$ is just $(\partial_\zeta \rho_\zeta)(\rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}(z))$. Note that $\rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}$ is the inverse function of ρ_{ζ_0} , whose derivative is $1/(\rho'_{\zeta_0} \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})$. Thus

$$(\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})' = (\rho'_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}) \cdot (\rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})' = \frac{\rho'_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}}{\rho'_{\zeta_0} \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}}$$

whose value at $z = 0$ (noticing $\rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1}(0) = 0$) is $\rho'_\zeta(0)/\rho'_{\zeta_0}(0)$. Therefore,

$$\partial_\zeta (\rho_\zeta \circ \rho_{\zeta_0}^{-1})'(0)|_{\zeta=\zeta_0} = \partial_\zeta \rho'_\zeta(0)/\rho'_{\zeta_0}(0)|_{\zeta=\zeta_0} = \partial_\zeta \log \rho'_\zeta(0)|_{\zeta=\zeta_0}.$$

This proves the desired equation at $\zeta = \zeta_0$. $\square$

5.2 Projective flatness of connections

Our goal of this section is to calculate the curvature of the connection associated to a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$. Choose sections $\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}$ of $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}$ defined on Stein open subsets of $\mathcal{B}$. Choose lifts $\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}, \tilde{\mathfrak{z}}$ as in the previous section as in Section 5.1 or 3.6. We write their local expressions at W_i as

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}|_{W_i} = h_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i} + \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j},$$

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{z}}|_{W_i} = k_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \partial_{\eta_i} + \sum_j l_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j}.$$

For brevity, in the above expressions, we set

$$Y = \sum_j g_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j}, \quad Z = \sum_j l_j(\tau_\bullet) \partial_{\tau_j},$$

which have the same expressions as $\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}$, although their meanings are slightly different. We let $[\tilde{\mathfrak{y}}, \tilde{\mathfrak{z}}]$ be the lift of $[\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}]$. Define $\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}}, \nabla_{\mathfrak{z}}, \nabla_{[\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}]}$ using these lifts and the local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$. Let $R(\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}) = \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}} \nabla_{\mathfrak{z}} - \nabla_{\mathfrak{z}} \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}} - \nabla_{[\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z}]}$. Choose $\mathbb{V}$ with central charge c , and $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$.

Theorem 5.2.1. *Let $f \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ be*

$$f = - \sum_{i=1}^N \left(\text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \frac{c}{12} \partial_{\eta_i}^3 h_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \cdot k_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) d\eta_i \right). \quad (5.2.1)$$

Then for each section s of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$,

$$R(\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z})s = -fs.$$

Consequently, for each section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$,*

$$R(\mathfrak{y}, \mathfrak{z})\phi = f\phi.$$

Thus, the (local) connections defined by these differential operators are projectively flat, and the curvatures depend only on the central charge c of $\mathbb{V}$, but not on $\mathbb{V}$ or its modules.

Proof. We have

$$\nabla_{\mathfrak{z}} s = Zs - \sum_i (k_i c d\eta_i) \cdot s$$

and hence

$$\nabla_{\mathfrak{y}} \nabla_{\mathfrak{z}} s = YZs - Y \sum_i (k_i c d\eta_i) \cdot s - \sum_i (h_i c d\eta_i) Zs + \sum_{i,j} (h_i c d\eta_i) (k_j c d\eta_j) s.$$

Similarly,

$$\nabla_{\mathfrak{z}} \nabla_{\mathfrak{y}} s = ZYs - Z \sum_i (h_i c d\eta_i) \cdot s - \sum_i (k_i c d\eta_i) Ys + \sum_{i,j} (k_j c d\eta_j) (h_i c d\eta_i) s.$$

Note that $[Y, k_i c d\eta_i] = (Yk_i) c d\eta_i$ and $[Z, k_i c d\eta_i] = (Zk_i) c d\eta_i$ since Y, Z are orthogonal to $d\eta_i$. Also, if $i \neq j$ then $h_i c d\eta_i$ and $k_j c d\eta_j$ are acting on different

tensor-components of s . So they commute. Using Proposition 3.5.1, we see that in the case that $i = j$, the action of $[h_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i, k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i]$ on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ equals

$$\begin{aligned} [h_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i, k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i] &= \mathbf{L}_{h_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i} k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i \stackrel{(3.5.3)}{=} \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{1}{n!} (\partial_{\eta_i}^n h_i) k_i Y(\mathbf{c})_n \mathbf{c} d\eta_i \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{1}{n!} (\partial_{\eta_i}^n h_i) k_i L_{n-1} \mathbf{c} d\eta_i \stackrel{\text{Rem. 2.1.3}}{=} h_i k_i L_{-1} \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + 2(\partial_{\eta_i} h_i) k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + \frac{c}{12} (\partial_{\eta_i}^3 h_i) k_i \mathbf{1} d\eta_i \end{aligned}$$

where the three summands in the last expression correspond respectively to $n = 0, 1, 3$, the only cases that $L_{n-1} \mathbf{c} \neq 0$. By Lemma 3.5.2,

$$\begin{aligned} [h_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i, k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i] &= -\partial_{\eta_i} (h_i k_i) \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + 2(\partial_{\eta_i} h_i) k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + \frac{c}{12} (\partial_{\eta_i}^3 h_i) k_i \mathbf{1} d\eta_i \\ &= (\partial_{\eta_i} h_i) k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i - h_i (\partial_{\eta_i} k_i) \mathbf{c} d\eta_i + \frac{c}{12} (\partial_{\eta_i}^3 h_i) k_i \mathbf{1} d\eta_i \end{aligned}$$

when acting on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} [\nabla_{\eta}, \nabla_{\mathfrak{z}}]s &= [Y, Z]s - \sum_i (Y k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i) s + \sum_i (Z h_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i) s \\ &\quad + ((\partial_{\eta_i} h_i) k_i \mathbf{c} d\eta_i) s - (h_i (\partial_{\eta_i} k_i) \mathbf{c} d\eta_i) s - f s. \end{aligned} \quad (5.2.2)$$

On the other hand,

$$[\tilde{\eta}, \tilde{\mathfrak{z}}]|_{W_i} = (h_i \partial_{\eta_i} k_i - k_i \partial_{\eta_i} h_i + Y k_i - Z h_i) \partial_{\eta_i} + [Y, Z],$$

which shows $\nabla_{[\eta, \mathfrak{z}]} s$ equals the sum of all the terms on the right hand side of (5.2.2) except $-f s$. This proves the desired relation. $\square$

5.3 Constructing flat connections

The goal of this section is to define flat connections on sheaves of conformal blocks depending on as few parameters as possible. We adopt the following notation: If $\mathcal{L}$ is a line bundle on a complex manifold X , then for any sections s_1, s_2 of $\mathcal{L}$ on an open $U \subset X$, if s_2 is nowhere zero, then $\frac{s_1}{s_2}$ is the unique element of $\mathcal{O}(U)$ whose multiplication with s_2 is s_1 .

Assume $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are simple $\mathbb{V}$ -modules. We explain how to obtain a flat connection associated to sheaves of covacua and conformal blocks of $\mathbb{V}$. Let

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N; \nu_1, \dots, \nu_N)$$

be a **family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with jets**. This means that $(\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_1, \dots, \varsigma_N)$ is N -pointed, and the jet

$$\nu_i \in \varsigma_i^* \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\mathcal{B})$$

is nowhere zero for each $1 \leq i \leq N$. Thus, for each $b \in \mathcal{B}$, $\nu_i(b)$ can be regarded as a (holomorphic) cotangent vector of $\mathcal{C}_b$ at $\varsigma_i(b)$.

Example 5.3.1. If $\mathfrak{X}$ is a family of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces with local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$, then $\mathfrak{X}$ has a natural choice of jets: let $\nu_i = \varsigma_i^* d\eta_i$.

Example 5.3.2. Assume $\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma_\bullet)$ is N -pointed. For each i , we let $\mathcal{B}^i$ be the open subset of non-zero vectors of the line bundle $\varsigma_i^* \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$. Let $p_i : \mathcal{B}^i \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ be the projection sending the vectors to their initial points. Using these projections, we define the relative product $\mathcal{B}^\Delta = \mathcal{B}^1 \times_{\mathcal{B}} \mathcal{B}^2 \times_{\mathcal{B}} \cdots \times_{\mathcal{B}} \mathcal{B}^N$, i.e., the closed submanifold of all $(\gamma^1, \dots, \gamma^N) \in \mathcal{B}^1 \times \cdots \times \mathcal{B}^N$ satisfying $p_1(\gamma^1) = \cdots = p_N(\gamma^N)$. Let $p : \mathcal{B}^\Delta \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ be the natural projection defined by $p_1, \dots, p_N$. Then we may pull back $\mathfrak{X}$ along $p : \mathcal{B}^\Delta \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ to obtain an N -pointed $\mathfrak{X}^\Delta = (\pi : \mathcal{C}^\Delta \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\Delta; \varsigma_\bullet^\Delta)$. More precisely: we let $\mathcal{C}^\Delta = \mathcal{C} \times_{\mathcal{B}} \mathcal{B}^\Delta$ which can be considered as a submanifold of $\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{B}^\Delta$. ς_i^Δ is determined by $\varsigma_i^\Delta(b^\Delta) = (\varsigma_i(p(b^\Delta)), b^\Delta)$ for every $b^\Delta \in \mathcal{B}^\Delta$. Then $\mathfrak{X}^\Delta$ has natural jets $\nu_\bullet$ such that for each $b^\Delta \in \mathcal{B}^\Delta$, if we consider $b^\Delta = (\gamma^1, \dots, \gamma^N)$ as an element of $\mathcal{B}^1 \times \cdots \times \mathcal{B}^N = \varsigma_1^* \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}} \times \cdots \times \varsigma_N^* \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}$ and set $b = p(b^\Delta)$, then $\nu_i(b^\Delta)$, a cotangent vector of $\mathcal{C}_{b^\Delta}^\Delta = \mathcal{C}_b \times b^\Delta \simeq \mathcal{C}_b$ at $\varsigma_i^\Delta(b^\Delta) = (\varsigma_i(b), b^\Delta) \simeq \varsigma_i(b)$, is γ^i .

Let $\mathfrak{X}$ be N -pointed with jets $\nu_\bullet$ as above. Fix a C_2 -cofinite rational VOA $\mathbb{U}$ with non-zero central charge $c_{\mathbb{U}}$. We assume that $\mathbb{U}$ is holomorphic, i.e., $\mathbb{U}$ has only one simple module which is $\mathbb{U}$ itself. For instance, one can take $\mathbb{U}$ to be the VOA associated to an even self-dual lattice, or the moonshine VOA. By factorization, any space of conformal block associated to $\mathbb{U}$ and a pointed curve has dimension one. Thus the sheaves of conformal blocks of $\mathbb{U}$ are line bundles. We fix the sheaf of conformal blocks of $\mathbb{U}$ associated to $\mathfrak{X}$ and the $\mathbb{U}$ -modules $\mathbb{U}, \dots, \mathbb{U}$:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\mathbb{U}} = \mathcal{F}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{U} \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathbb{U})$$

and consider it as a line bundle on $\mathcal{B}$.

Flat connections depending on $\nu_\bullet$ and a nowhere zero $\theta \in \mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{B})$

We assume that there is a nowhere zero section $\theta \in \mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{X}}^{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{B})$. Then we shall define a flat connection ∇^θ independent of local coordinates and lifts of tangent vectors. It suffices to define such connection locally. So we assume temporarily that $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein and small enough so that we can choose local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$. For each i , $\varsigma_i^* d\eta_i \in \varsigma_i^* \omega_{\mathcal{C}/\mathcal{B}}(\mathcal{B})$ is nowhere zero. Thus $\varsigma_i^* d\eta_i / \nu_i \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$. If $\mu_\bullet$ is another set of local coordinates, we define α_i and hence $\alpha'_i(0) \in \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{B})$ as in (5.1.2). Then it is easy to see

$$\varsigma_i^* d\mu_i = \alpha'_i(0) \cdot \varsigma_i^* d\eta_i. \quad (5.3.1)$$

For each section η of $\Theta_{\mathcal{B}}$, choose a lift $\tilde{\eta}$. Define $\nabla^{(\eta_\bullet)}$ using $\eta_\bullet$ and $\tilde{\eta}$ as in Section 3.6. For each section ϕ of $\mathcal{F}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, let

$$\nabla_\eta^\theta \phi = \nabla_\eta^{(\eta_\bullet)} \phi - \frac{c}{c_{\mathbb{U}}} \cdot \frac{\nabla_\eta^{(\eta_\bullet)} \theta}{\theta} \cdot \phi - \sum_{i=1}^N \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \cdot \eta \left(\log \frac{\varsigma_i^* d\eta_i}{\nu_i} \right) \cdot \phi. \quad (5.3.2)$$

Theorem 5.3.3. ∇^θ is a flat connection of $\mathcal{I}_x^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Moreover, ∇^θ depends on the jets $\nu_\bullet$ and the nowhere zero section $\theta \in \mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U}(\mathcal{B})$ but not on $\eta_\bullet$ or the lift $\tilde{\eta}$ of η . Therefore, ∇^θ can be defined globally without assuming $\mathcal{B}$ is Stein or local coordinates exist.

Proof. By Proposition 3.6.6 and Remark 3.6.7, ∇_η^θ is independent of $\tilde{\eta}$. That ∇_η^θ is independent of the local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$ follows from (5.3.1) and Theorem 5.1.1. Note that if $f\theta = \nabla_j^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta$, then $\nabla_\eta^{(\mu_\bullet)}\nabla_j^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta = \nabla_\eta^{(\mu_\bullet)}(f\theta) = \eta(f)\theta + f\nabla_\eta^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta$. From this we see

$$\eta\left(\frac{\nabla_j^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta}{\theta}\right) = \frac{\nabla_\eta^{(\mu_\bullet)}\nabla_j^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta}{\theta} - \frac{\nabla_\eta^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta}{\theta} \cdot \frac{\nabla_j^{(\mu_\bullet)}\theta}{\theta}.$$

With help of this relation and Theorem 5.2.1, it is straightforward to check that ∇ is has zero curvature. $\square$

Example 5.3.4. In the case that one cannot find a nowhere zero $\theta \in \mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U}(\mathcal{B})$, one can consider a “central extension” of $\mathfrak{X}$ as follows. Regard $\mathcal{B}$ as a closed submanifold of $\mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U}$ consisting of zero vectors. Note that we have a natural projection

$$p : \mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$$

sending each vector to its initial point. We can pull back $\mathfrak{X}$ along $p : \mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U} - \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ and obtain a new family $\mathfrak{Y}$ (with base manifold $\mathcal{L}_x^\mathbb{U} - \mathcal{B}$). One can also pullback the jets of $\mathfrak{X}$. Then $\mathfrak{Y}$ has a natural global nowhere section θ of $\mathcal{L}_\mathfrak{Y}^\mathbb{U}$.

Connections depending on $\nu_\bullet$ and a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$

Suppose $\mathfrak{X}$ has a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$ and jets $\nu_\bullet$, one can define a connection $\nabla^\mathfrak{P}$ as follows. Choose a lift $\tilde{\eta}$ of the tangent field η , and let h_i be as in (5.1.1). Then

$$\nabla_\eta^\mathfrak{P}\phi = \nabla_\eta^{(\eta_\bullet)}\phi - \sum_{i=1}^N \text{Res}_{\eta_i=0} \frac{c}{12} h_i(\eta_i, \tau_\bullet) \mathbf{S}_{\eta_i} \mathfrak{P} d\eta_i - \sum_{i=1}^N \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_i} \cdot \eta \left(\log \frac{\zeta_i^* d\eta_i}{\nu_i} \right) \cdot \phi. \quad (5.3.3)$$

Theorem 5.3.5. $\nabla^\mathfrak{P}$ is independent of the choice of $\eta_\bullet$ and the lift $\tilde{\eta}$ of η .

Proof. To compare the definition of ∇ using two sets of local coordinates $\eta_\bullet$ and $\mu_\bullet$, it suffices to assume $\mu_1, \dots, \mu_N$ belong to $\mathfrak{P}$. Then the coincidence follows from Theorem 5.1.1. When the local coordinates belong to $\mathfrak{P}$, ∇ is independent of the choice of lift by Remark 3.6.7 and Lemma 4.2.1 (or equation (4.2.4)). Thus, for a general $\eta_\bullet$, the independence on $\tilde{\eta}$ is also true. $\square$

Note that unlike the previous connection, $\nabla^\mathfrak{P}$ might not be flat.

5.4 Functoriality

Assume for simplicity that $\mathbb{V}$ is C_2 -cofinite so that the sheaves of conformal blocks are holomorphic vector bundles. If $F_i : \mathbb{W}_i \rightarrow \mathbb{M}_i$ is a homomorphism of $\mathbb{V}$ -modules for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, then we clearly have an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -module homomorphism $F_{\bullet}^* : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{M}_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ defined by sending each ϕ to $\phi \circ (F_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes F_n)$. If we have $G_i : \mathbb{M}_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_i$ where each $\mathbb{P}_i$ is also an $\mathbb{V}$ -module, then by setting $(GF)_i = G_i F_i$, we have $(GF)_{\bullet}^* = F_{\bullet}^* G_{\bullet}^*$. Moreover, if each F_i is identity, then so is $F_{\bullet}^*$. Thus, we have a contravariant functor $\mathbb{W}_{\bullet} \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$.

We may also fix $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$, and consider morphisms between two families of compact Riemann surfaces. To be more precise, if $\mathfrak{X}^j = (\pi^j : \mathcal{C}^j \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^j; \varsigma_1^j, \dots, \varsigma_N^j)$ ($j = 1, 2$) are families of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces, then a **morphism** $F : \mathfrak{X}^1 \rightarrow \mathfrak{X}^2$ is a pair $F = (F_C, F_B)$ where $F_C : \mathcal{C}^1 \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^2$ and $F_B : \mathcal{B}^1 \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^2$ are holomorphic maps, $\pi^2 \circ F_C = F_B \circ \pi^1$, $F_C \circ \varsigma_i^1 = \varsigma_i^2$ for each $1 \leq i \leq N$, and F_C restricts to an isomorphism of compact Riemann surfaces $\mathcal{C}_b^1 \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{F_B(b)}^2$ for each $b \in \mathcal{B}^1$. We will write both F_C and F_B as F for short when no confusion arises.

We can pull back $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$ along F_B to get an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}^1}$ -module $F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet}) \equiv F_B^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})$. Thus we have $F^* : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V) \rightarrow F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(F^{-1}(V))$ for each open $V \in \mathcal{B}^2$. We can define a similar map

$$F^{\diamond} : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(F^{-1}(V)) \quad (5.4.1)$$

as follows. For each $b \in F^{-1}(V)$, F_C restricts to an isomorphism of N -pointed fibers $\mathcal{C}_b^1 \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{F(b)}^2$. This gives a natural isomorphism

$$F_b^{\diamond} : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_{F(b)} \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})|_b.$$

Then $F^{\diamond}$ is defined such that for each $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_{\bullet})(V)$ and $b \in F^{-1}(V)$, $(F^{\diamond}\phi)(b) = F_b^{\diamond}\phi(F(b))$. One can write down the explicit formula: Assume the restriction $\mathfrak{X}_V^2$ admits local coordinates $\eta_{\bullet}^2$. Then one can define local coordinates $\eta_{\bullet}^1$ of the restricted family $\mathfrak{X}_{F^{-1}(V)}^1$ such that

$$\eta_i^1 = \eta_i^2 \circ F_C \quad (5.4.2)$$

for each $1 \leq i \leq N$. Choose $w \in \mathbb{W}_{\bullet}$. Then

$$(F^{\diamond}\phi)(\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}^1)^{-1}w) = \phi(\mathcal{U}(\eta_{\bullet}^2)^{-1}w). \quad (5.4.3)$$

If $G : \mathfrak{X}^2 \rightarrow \mathfrak{X}^3$ is another morphism, we clearly have

$$(GF)^{\diamond} = F^{\diamond} G^{\diamond}. \quad (5.4.4)$$

Also, if F is the identity map, then $F^{\diamond}$ is clearly also the identity.

$F^\diamond$ and F^* can be related in the following way. Define an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}^1}$ -module isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi_F : F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet), \\ \Phi_F F^* \phi &= F^\diamond \phi\end{aligned}\tag{5.4.5}$$

for each section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Namely, it is defined by $\Phi_F(f \cdot F^* \phi) = f F^\diamond \phi$ for any holomorphic function f of $\mathcal{B}^1$. To check that Φ_F is well-defined and is an $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}^1}$ -isomorphism, note that for each $b \in \mathcal{B}^1$ we define an isomorphism of vector spaces $F_b^* \equiv (F_B)_b^* : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_{F(b)} \rightarrow F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_b$ by pullback. Then we can define an isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi_{F,b} : F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_b &\xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)|_b, \\ \Phi_{F,b} F_b^* &= F_b^\diamond.\end{aligned}$$

Then it is clear that $\Phi_F(f \cdot F^* \phi)(b) = f(b) \cdot (F^\diamond \phi)(b) = f(b) \cdot F_b^\diamond \cdot \phi(b) = f(b) \cdot \Phi_{F,b} F_b^* \cdot \phi(b)$ which depends only on $f(b)\phi(b)$. So Φ_F is a well-defined isomorphism of vector bundles whose restriction to each fiber over b is $\Phi_{F,b}$. To summarize, we have

Theorem 5.4.1. *For each morphism $F : \mathfrak{X}^1 \rightarrow \mathfrak{X}^2$ of families of N -pointed compact Riemann surfaces, there is an isomorphism of (holomorphic) vector bundles $\Phi_F : F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ such that $\Phi_F F^* \phi = F^\diamond \phi$ for each section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, and $F^\diamond \phi$ is described by (5.4.3). If F is the identity morphism, then Φ_F is the identity map. If $G : \mathfrak{X}^2 \rightarrow \mathfrak{X}^3$ is also a morphism, then for each open $W \subset \mathcal{B}^3$, the following maps from $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^3}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(W) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(F^{-1}G^{-1}(W))$ are equal.*

$$\Phi_{GF} \cdot (GF)^* = \Phi_F \cdot F^* \cdot \Phi_G \cdot G^*.$$

The last equation is due to (5.4.4).

Recall that if ∇ is a connection on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$, then its pullback $F^* \nabla = F_B^* \nabla$ is a connection on $F^* \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ defined by $(F^* \nabla)_\eta(F^* \phi) = F^*(\nabla_{dF(\eta)} \phi)$ for each section ϕ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ and each tangent vector η of $\mathcal{B}^1$.

Suppose that $\mathfrak{X}^2$ admits jets $\nu_\bullet^2$. Then one can define jets $\nu_\bullet^1$ of $\mathfrak{X}^1$ such that for each $b \in \mathcal{B}^1$, the cotangent vector $\nu_i^1(b)$ of $\mathcal{C}_b^1$ at $\varsigma_i^1(b)$ is $F^* d\nu_i^2(b)$. If $\mathfrak{X}^2$ also admits a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}^2$, then one can define a projective chart (and hence a projective structure) $\mathfrak{P}^1$ consisting of all $(F_C^{-1}(U), \eta \circ F_C)$ where (U, η) belongs to $\mathfrak{P}^1$. (In particular, U is an open subset of $\mathcal{C}^2$ and $\eta \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ is univalent on each fiber.) Then for the connections defined by (5.3.3) (assume $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are simple), it is not hard to check that for any tangent field η of $\mathcal{B}^1$,

$$\nabla_\eta^{\mathfrak{P}^1} = \Phi_F \cdot (F^* \nabla^{\mathfrak{P}^2})_\eta \cdot \Phi_F^{-1}\tag{5.4.6}$$

when acting on sections of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$.

Alternatively, suppose that, instead of projective structures, we have a global section θ^2 of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{X}^2}^{\mathbb{U}}$. We can define a global section of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathfrak{X}^1}^{\mathbb{U}}$ to be $\theta^1 = F^\diamond \theta^2 = \Phi_F F^* \theta^2$. Then for the flat connections defined by (5.3.2), we also have

$$\nabla_{\eta}^{\theta^1} = \Phi_F \cdot (F^* \nabla^{\theta^2})_{\eta} \cdot \Phi_F^{-1}. \quad (5.4.7)$$

Example 5.4.2. Let G be a group of automorphisms of $\mathfrak{X}$, i.e., we have a homomorphism $G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{X})$. For each $g \in G$, we have an action $g^\diamond = \Phi_g \cdot g^* : \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(g^{-1}V)$ for each open $V \subset \mathcal{B}$, and we have $(gh)^\diamond = h^\diamond g^\diamond$ for each $g, h \in G$. Thus, we have a right action of G on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$.

Suppose that $\mathfrak{X}$ admits jets $\nu_\bullet$ and a projective structure $\mathfrak{P}$, and both are invariant under the action of G . Suppose also that $\mathcal{B}$ is simply-connected and $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}}$ is flat. We can define the vector space $\mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ of all $\phi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)(\mathcal{B})$ which are parallel under $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}}$, i.e., annihilated by $\nabla_{\eta}^{\mathfrak{P}}$ for each tangent field η of $\mathcal{B}$. Then $\dim \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$ is equal to the rank of the vector bundle $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. Moreover, $g \in G \rightarrow (g^{-1})^\diamond$ defines a (left) action of G on the vector space $\mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{X}}(\mathbb{W}_\bullet)$. This is also true when we not assume the existence of a set of G -invariant jets, but assume $\mathbb{W}_1, \dots, \mathbb{W}_N$ are all $\mathbb{V}$ so that $\Delta_{\mathbb{W}_1} = \dots = \Delta_{\mathbb{W}_N} = 0$.

5.5 Modular invariance

Let $\mathbb{V}$ be C_2 -cofinite and rational. Let $\tilde{\mathfrak{Y}} = (\mathbb{P}^1; 1, 0, \infty)$. We associate local coordinates z to 0 and z^{-1} to ∞ . Then we can sew $\tilde{\mathfrak{Y}}$ along 0, ∞ to get a family $\mathfrak{Y} = (\mathcal{R} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_1^\times; \sigma)$ of 1-pointed elliptic curves. Recall $\mathcal{D}_1^\times$ is the punctured unit open disc. Associate to 1, 0, ∞ simple $\mathbb{V}$ -modules $\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{M}, \mathbb{M}'$ where $\mathbb{M}'$ is contragredient to $\mathbb{M}$. Then for each $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{Y}}}^*(\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$, we have the sewn conformal block $\tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{Y}}^*(\mathbb{W})(\mathcal{D}_1^\times)$ and $\mathcal{S}\psi = q^{\Delta_{\mathbb{M}}} \tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$. Let $\tilde{\Omega}$ be unique projective structure of $\mathbb{P}^1$, i.e., the one containing $(\mathbb{C}, z)$. This in turn gives a projective structure Ω of $\mathfrak{Y}$. More precisely: the local coordinate $z-1$ of $\mathbb{P}^1$ at 1 extends constantly (with respect to sewing) to a local coordinate μ of $\mathfrak{Y}$. Ω is the projective structure containing μ .

Let γ be a jet of $\mathfrak{Y}$ whose value at each $q \in \mathcal{D}_1^\times$ is the cotangent vector $d\mu$. Then the definition of the connection $\nabla^{(\mu)}$ of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{Y}}^*(\mathbb{W})$ using the local coordinate μ (as in Section 3.6) is the same as the connection $\nabla^{\Omega, \lambda}$ defined by Ω and the jet γ (as in (5.3.3)), and is independent of the choice of lifts. Since the local coordinates of 0, ∞ belong to Ω , by Theorem 4.3.9 and Remark 4.3.10, $\mathcal{S}\psi$ is parallel under $\nabla^{\Omega, \mu}$.

Let $\mathbb{H}$ be the (open) upper half plane of $\mathbb{C}$. Define

$$\mathcal{B} = \mathbb{H} \times \mathbb{C}^\times.$$

Define an action of $\mathbb{Z}^2$ on $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ such that for each $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $(z, \tau, \zeta) \in \mathbb{C} \times \mathbb{H} \times \mathbb{C}^\times$, $(a, b)(z, \tau, \zeta) = (z + a + b\tau, \tau, \zeta)$. Then we have a (universal) family of 1-pointed elliptic curves

$$\mathfrak{X} = (\pi : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}; \varsigma)$$

where

$$\mathcal{C} = (\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B})/\mathbb{Z}^2,$$

the projection π is defined by the standard one $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$, and ς comes from the section $\mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$, $(\tau, \zeta) \mapsto (0, \tau, \zeta)$. Let Γ be the modular group, i.e.,

$$\Gamma = SL_2(\mathbb{Z}) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} : a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{Z}, ad - bc = 1 \right\}.$$

Then we have a group action of Γ on $\mathfrak{X}$ such that for any $g = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \Gamma$,

$$g : \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}, \quad g(\tau, \zeta) = \left(\frac{a\tau + b}{c\tau + d}, (c\tau + d)\zeta \right),$$

and the action of g on $\mathcal{C}$ descends from the one on $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ determined by

$$g : \mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}, \quad g(z, \tau, \zeta) = \left(\frac{z}{c\tau + d}, \frac{a\tau + b}{c\tau + d}, (c\tau + d)\zeta \right).$$

Then we have $\mathfrak{X}/\Gamma = (\mathcal{C}/\Gamma \rightarrow \mathcal{B}/\Gamma; \varsigma)$ where $\mathcal{B}/\Gamma$ is the (fine) moduli space of 1-pointed elliptic curves with jet.¹ The jet of $\mathfrak{X}/\Gamma$ come from ν of $\mathfrak{X}$ which will be described later. By example 5.4.2, Γ acts on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})(\mathcal{B})$.

There are two natural choices of flat connections on $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$. We have a morphism $F : \mathfrak{X} \rightarrow \mathfrak{Y}$ described as follows. As a holomorphic map between base manifolds, we have

$$F : \mathcal{B} = \mathbb{H} \times \mathbb{C}^\times \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_1^\times, \quad (\tau, \zeta) \mapsto \exp(2i\pi\tau).$$

The map $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{R}$ is defined such that for each $(\tau, \zeta) \in \mathcal{B}$, the map

$$\mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1, \quad z \mapsto \exp(2i\pi z)$$

descends to $\mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{R}_{\exp(2i\pi\tau)}$, and furthermore descends to $\mathcal{C}_{(\tau, \zeta)} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{R}_{\exp(2i\pi\tau)}$. Then we can pullback the projective structure Ω and the jet λ of $\mathfrak{Y}$ to $\mathfrak{P}', \nu'$ of $\mathfrak{X}$ as described above (5.4.6). Then by (5.4.6), $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'}$ is equivalent to $F^*\nabla^{\Omega, \lambda}$ via $\Phi_F : F^*\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{Y}}^*(\mathbb{W}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$, and is therefore flat since $\nabla^{\Omega, \lambda}$ is acting on a 1-dimensional complex manifold. So

$$F^\diamond \mathcal{S}\psi = \Phi_F F^* \mathcal{S}\psi = e^{2i\pi\tau\Delta_{\mathbb{M}}} \cdot \Phi_F F^* \tilde{\mathcal{S}}\psi$$

is a global section of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$ parallel under $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'}$. (Recall that $F^\diamond$ is described by (5.4.3).) By factorization, $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$ is $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}$ -generated by, and hence the vector

¹One reason to work with $\mathcal{B}$ instead of $\mathbb{H}$ and to consider jets is that pointed elliptic curves with jet have trivial automorphism groups. So we can have a fine moduli space.

space of $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'}$ -parallel sections in $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})(\mathcal{B})$ is spanned by all $F^\diamond \mathcal{S}\psi$ where $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{Y}}^*(\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$ and $\mathbb{M}$ is a simple $\mathbb{V}$ -module.

Unfortunately, neither $\mathfrak{P}'$ nor ν' is modular invariant (i.e. Γ -invariant). As a consequence, $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'}$ is not modular invariant. To get modular invariant ones, we let $\mathfrak{P}$ be the projective structure of $\mathfrak{X}$ whose pull back to the family $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ is the standard one, i.e., its restriction to each fiber $\mathbb{C}$ is the one containing $(\mathbb{C}, z)$. We let ν be the jet of $\mathfrak{X}$ to be

$$\nu = \zeta \cdot dz$$

i.e., for each $(\tau, \zeta) \in \mathcal{B}$, $\nu(\tau, \zeta)$ is the cotangent vector ζdz of the fiber $\mathcal{C}_{(\tau, \zeta)}$ at 0 (when lifted to $\mathbb{C}$) where dz is defined by the standard coordinate z of $\mathbb{C}$. Then both $\mathfrak{P}$ and ν are modular invariant. So is $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu}$.

Theorem 5.5.1. *Let τ, ζ also denote the standard coordinates of $\mathbb{H}, \mathbb{C}^\times$ respectively. Then, when acting on sections of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$, we have*

$$\begin{aligned}\nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu} &= \nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'} + \frac{\mathbf{i}c\pi}{12} \mathbf{1}, \\ \nabla_{\partial_\zeta}^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu} &= \nabla_{\partial_\zeta}^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'} + \frac{\Delta_{\mathbb{W}}}{\zeta} \mathbf{1}.\end{aligned}$$

As an immediate consequence, $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu}$ is also flat.

Proof. ν' is the differential of $\exp(2\mathbf{i}\pi z)$ at $z = 0$. So $\nu' = 2\mathbf{i}\pi dz$, and hence $\nu = \frac{\zeta}{2\mathbf{i}\pi} \nu'$. Hence $\partial_\zeta(\log(\nu/\nu')) = \zeta^{-1}$. This, together with (5.3.3), shows the second the identity. Since $\partial_\tau(\log(\nu/\nu')) = 0$, we have $\nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu} = \nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'}$. Thus, it suffices to prove $\nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu} = \nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'} + \frac{\mathbf{i}c\pi}{12} \mathbf{1}$. Let η be the local coordinate of $\mathfrak{X}$ defined by the standard coordinate dz of $\mathbb{C}$. Let η' be the pullback of μ along F , i.e., $\eta' = \exp(2\mathbf{i}\pi z) - 1$. Then η belongs to $\mathfrak{P}$ and η' belongs to $\mathfrak{P}'$. Let $\tilde{\eta}$ be a lift of ∂_τ , and assume its expression near $\varsigma(\mathcal{B})$ is

$$h(\eta, \tau, \zeta) \partial_\eta + \partial_\tau$$

where the partial derivatives are defined by the coordinates (η, τ, ζ) . Then by Theorem 5.1.1 and relation (5.3.3), we have $\nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu} - \nabla_{\partial_\tau}^{\mathfrak{P}', \nu'} = f \mathbf{1}$ where

$$f = \text{Res}_{\eta=0} \frac{c}{12} h(\eta, \tau, \zeta) \mathbf{S}_\eta \eta' d\eta.$$

It is easy to calculate that $\mathbf{S}_\eta \eta' = \mathbf{S}_z(\exp(2\mathbf{i}\pi z) - 1) = (2\mathbf{i}\pi)^2 - \frac{3}{2}(2\mathbf{i}\pi)^2 = 2\pi^2$. We can pullback $\tilde{\eta}$ to a global meromorphic tangent field of $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ whose poles are in $\mathbb{Z}^2 \cdot (\{0\} \times \mathcal{B})$. Denote this pullback also by $\tilde{\eta}$, and notice η is just the standard coordinate z of $\mathbb{C}$, we have $\tilde{\eta} = h(z, \tau, \zeta) \partial_z + \partial_\tau$ and h is a meromorphic function

on $\mathbb{C} \times \mathcal{B}$ with poles in $\mathbb{Z}^2 \cdot (\{0\} \times \mathcal{B})$. Moreover, $\tilde{\eta}$ is invariant under the action of $\mathbb{Z}^2$. From this it is easy to see that

$$h(z + 1, \tau, \zeta) = h(z, \tau, \zeta), \quad h(z + \tau, \tau, \zeta) = h(z, \tau, \zeta) + 1.$$

Let γ_τ be an anticlockwise parallelogram of $\mathbb{C}$ around 0 described by $A_\tau \rightarrow B_\tau \rightarrow C_\tau \rightarrow D_\tau \rightarrow A_\tau$, where $A_\tau = -0.5 - 0.5\tau$, $B_\tau = 0.5 - 0.5\tau$, $C_\tau = 0.5 + 0.5\tau$, $D_\tau = -0.5 + 0.5\tau$. Then by the above relation,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{A_\tau B_\tau} h dz + \int_{C_\tau D_\tau} h dz &= \int_{A_\tau B_\tau} h dz - \int_{A_\tau B_\tau} (h + 1) dz = - \int_{A_\tau B_\tau} dz = -1, \\ \int_{B_\tau C_\tau} h dz + \int_{D_\tau A_\tau} h dz &= \int_{A_\tau D_\tau} h dz - \int_{A_\tau D_\tau} h dz = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So

$$\text{Res}_{z=0} h dz = \frac{1}{2i\pi} \oint_{\gamma_\tau} h dz = -\frac{1}{2i\pi}.$$

Thus $f = \text{Res}_{z=0} \frac{c}{12} h \cdot 2\pi^2 dz = \frac{ic\pi}{12}$, which completes the proof. $\square$

Corollary 5.5.2. *For any simple $\mathbb{M}$ and any $\psi \in \mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{g}}^*(\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{M} \otimes \mathbb{M}')$,*

$$\zeta^{-\Delta_{\mathbb{W}}} \exp\left(-\frac{i c \pi}{12} \tau\right) F^\diamond \mathcal{S} \psi \quad (5.5.1)$$

is a multivalued (with respect to ζ) global section of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^(\mathbb{W})$ parallel under the modular invariant flat connection $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu}$. Moreover, any such $\nabla^{\mathfrak{P}, \nu}$ -parallel section of $\mathcal{T}_{\mathfrak{X}}^*(\mathbb{W})$ is a $\mathbb{C}$ -linear combination of sections of this form.*

If we let $q_\tau = F(\tau) = \exp(2i\pi\tau)$, then the projective factor $\exp(-\frac{ic\pi}{12}\tau)$ becomes the celebrated $q_\tau^{-\frac{c}{24}}$.

Corollary 5.5.3 (Modular invariance). *For any ϕ in the form (5.5.1), and for any $g \in \Gamma = SL_2(\mathbb{Z})$, $g^\diamond \phi$ is also a $\mathbb{C}$ -linear combination of sections of the form (5.5.1).*

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